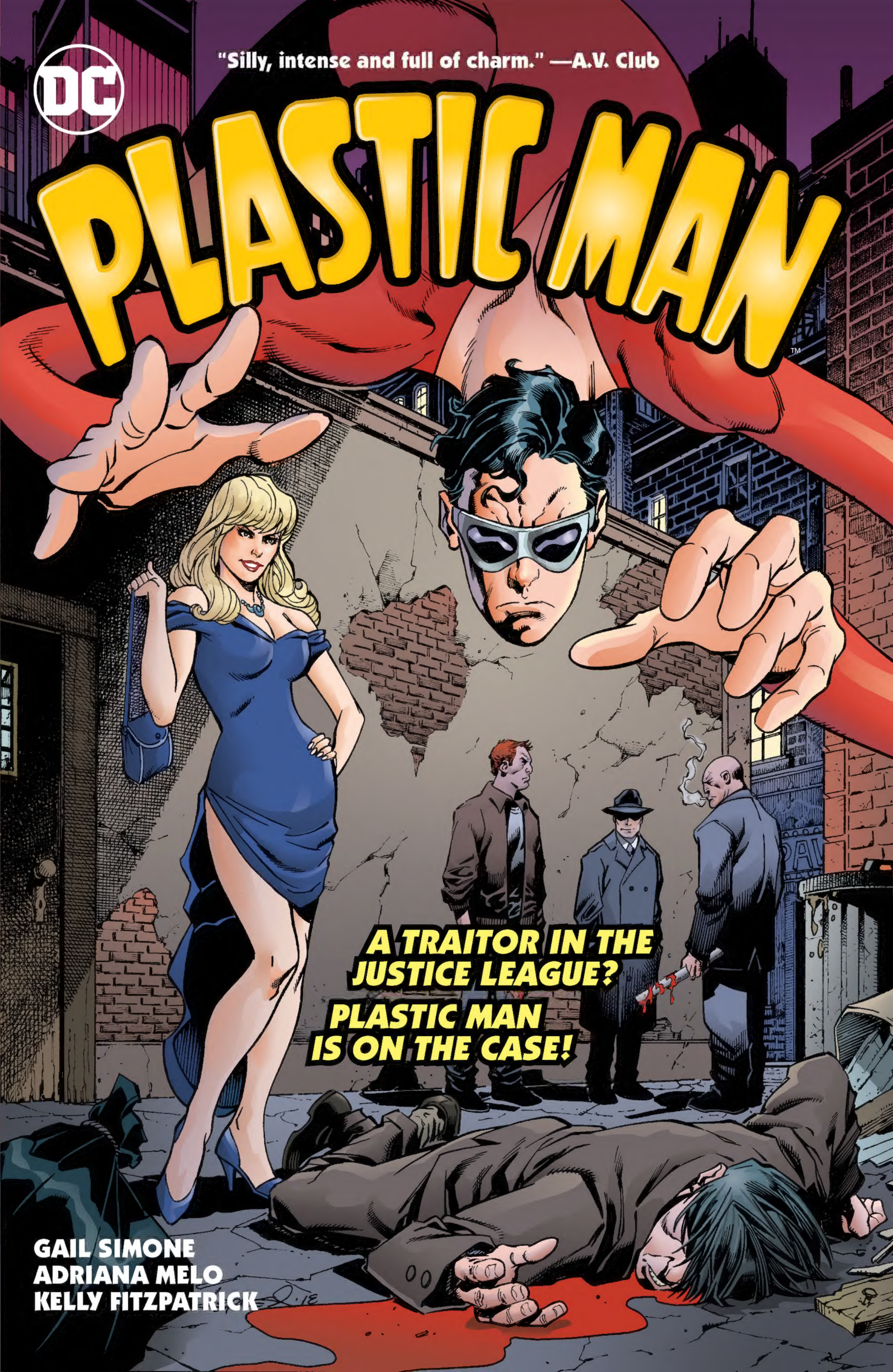




"Silly, intense and full of charm." —A.V. Club

PLASTIC MAN



**A TRAITOR IN THE
JUSTICE LEAGUE?
PLASTIC MAN
IS ON THE CASE!**

**GAIL SIMONE
ADRIANA MELO
KELLY FITZPATRICK**

PLASTIC MAN

PLASTIC MAN



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CHAPTER ONE

PLASTIC MAN

Cover art by Aaron Lopresti

COLE CITY.

A CITY WHERE COMMERCE
TAKES PLACE IN THE
ALLEYS AND GUTTERS.

BUT NOT WITHOUT
A CERTAIN STYLE...

BUT, SAMMY,
YA **PROMISED**
ME A NIGHT ON
THE TOWN!

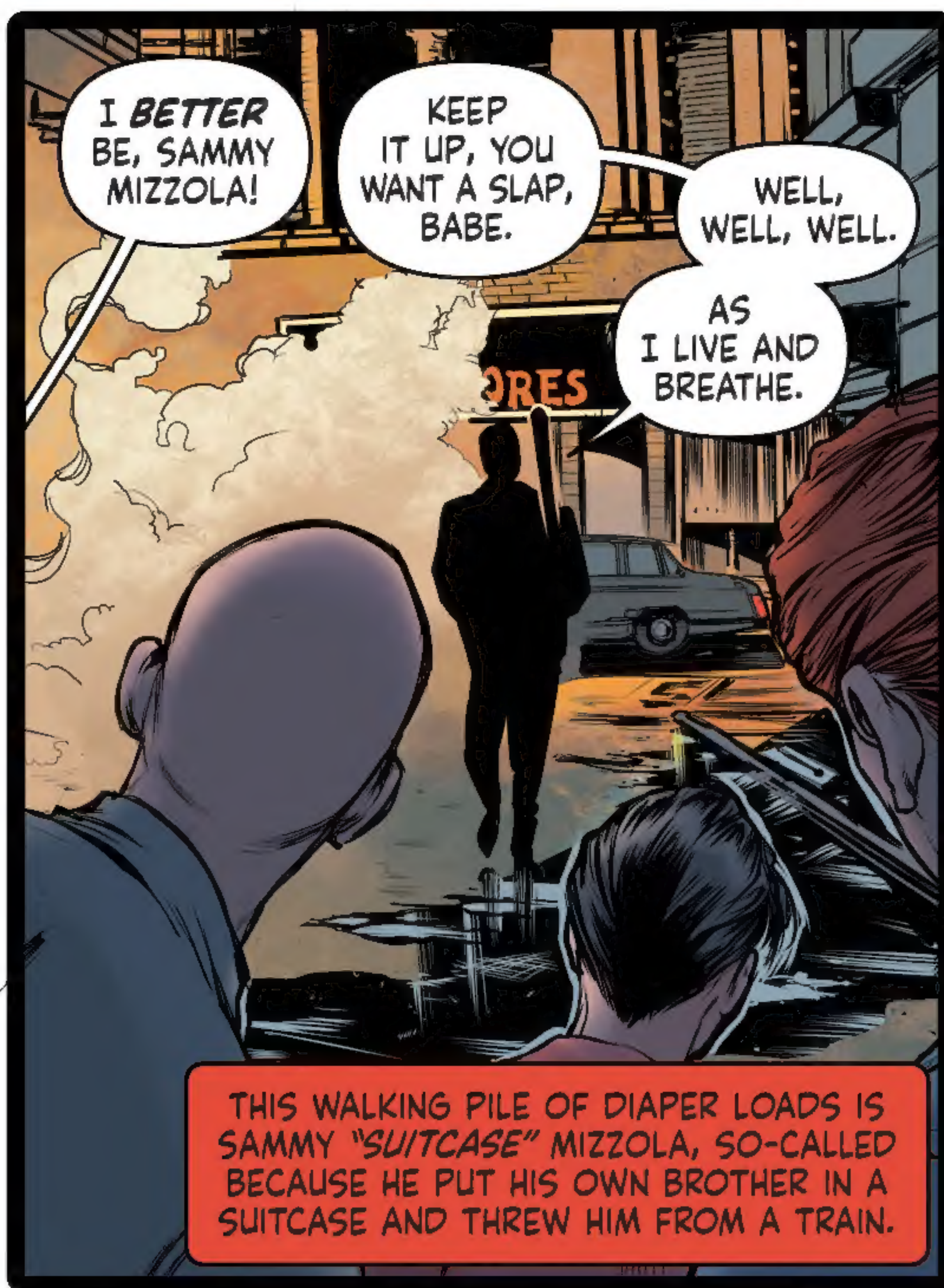
YA SAID
**LOBSTER AND
DANCIN'.**

JANET, BABE.
DADDY'S GOTTA
WORK FOR A
MINUTE, HERE.

I PROMISE.
SOON YOU'LL BE
NECK DEEP IN **BIBS**
AND **DRAWN**
BUTTER.

SO, THERE I
WAS JUST MINDING
MY OWN BUSINESS,
RIGHT?

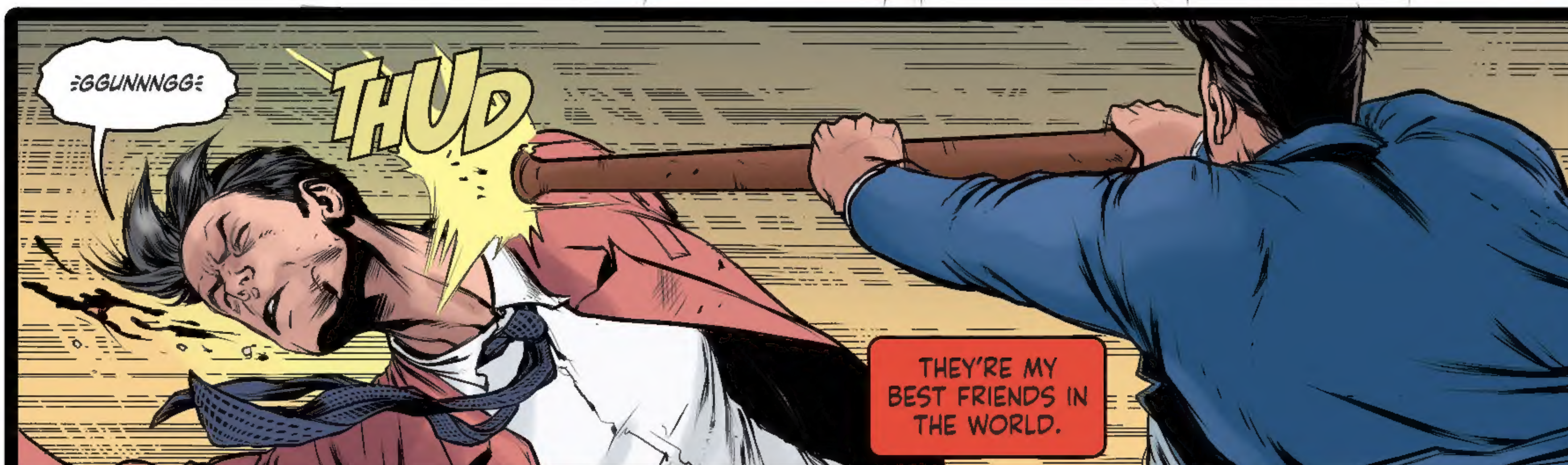
PLAS



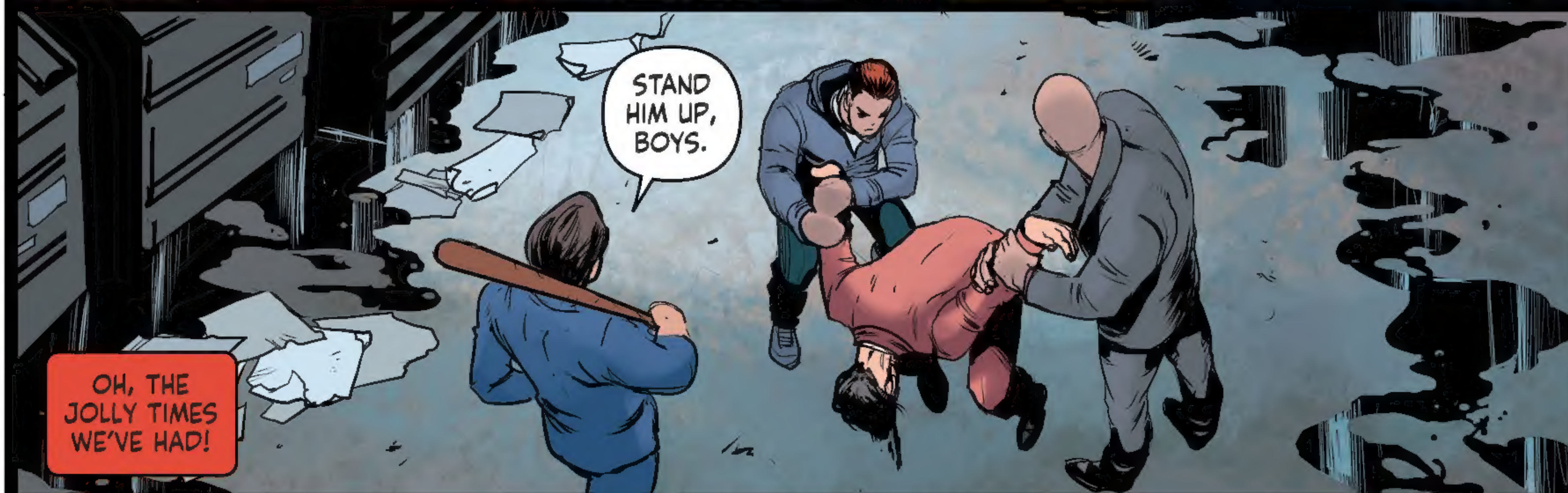
THIS WALKING PILE OF DIAPER LOADS IS SAMMY "SUITCASE" MIZZOLA, SO-CALLED BECAUSE HE PUT HIS OWN BROTHER IN A SUITCASE AND THREW HIM FROM A TRAIN.



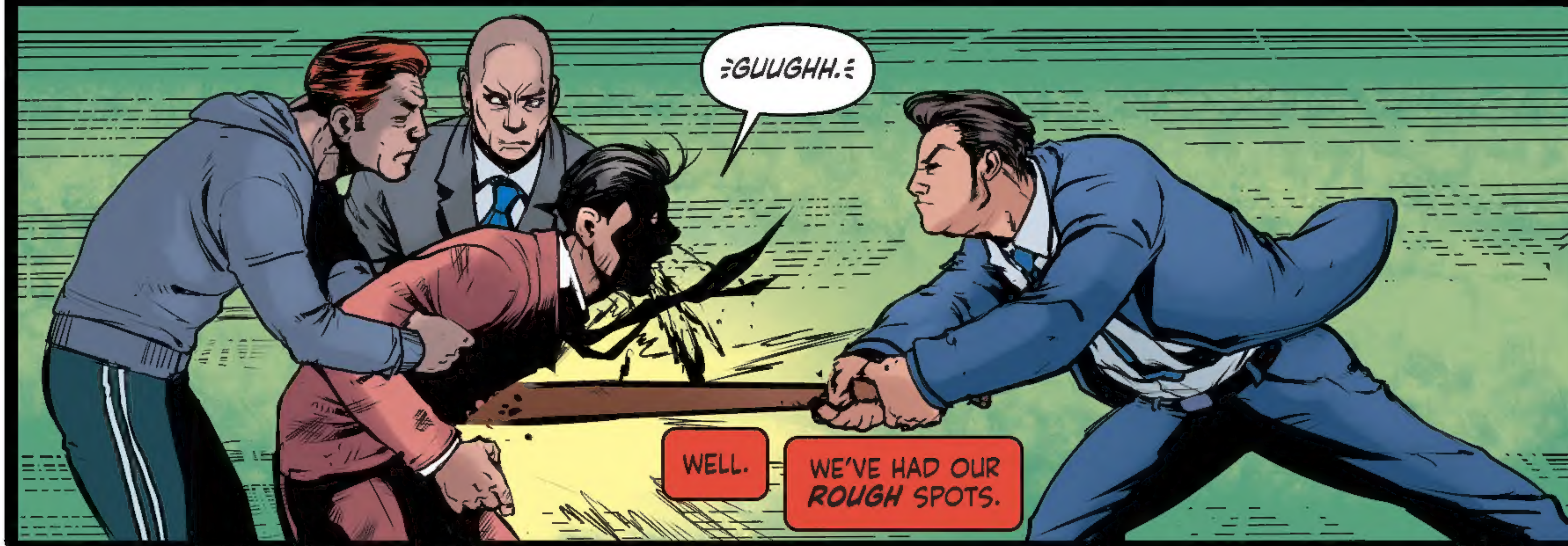
THE OTHER TWO ARE "BRUTAL" BENNY TURLIN AND "DIZZY" DARREN FITZROY.



THEY'RE MY BEST FRIENDS IN THE WORLD.



OH, THE JOLLY TIMES WE'VE HAD!



WELL. WE'VE HAD OUR ROUGH SPOTS.



DOIN' OKAY THERE, SPORT?

I'VE BEEN WORKING ON MY SWING, YOU KNOW.

SHU...HEHHE HEY. HEY, SAMMY.

DO ME A SOLID.

WHAT'S THAT, HOME PLATE?



I LEFT SOME RUBBERS AT YOUR MOM'S HOUSE.

ON THE NIGHTSTAND.

CAN I GET THOSE BACK?

YOUR *SISTER'S* IN TOWN.



YOU ALWAYS WERE A FUNNY GUY.

HOLD HIS LEG, DIZZY.

SORRY 'BOUT THIS, PAL.

"SORRY"? YOU *THREW* ME OUT OF THE *GETAWAY CAR*.



GEEZ, WHY YOU GOTTA ALWAYS TAKE EVERYTHING SO *PERSONAL*, EEL?

BATTER UP.

GGGGGG!

THING LIKE THIS CAN REALLY DESTROY *TRUST*.



SEE? I'M FUNNY, TOO.

YOU BREATHE A *WORD* ABOUT THAT FACTORY HEIST?

WE COME BACK AND BREAK WHAT'S *LEFT*.

SORRY, EEL. BUT YOU SHOULDN'T OUGHTA HAVE COME BACK FROM THE GRAVE AN' ALL, OKAY?





EEL
O'BRIAN.

I'M
PADO.

SUAVE PADO
SWAKATOON,
PRINCE OF PINE
STREET.

OKAY.



THREE
GUYS ON ONE,
THAT'S JUST
WANG.

SEE YA
AROUND, EEL
O'BRIAN.

WAIT.



IS WANG
GOOD OR
BAD?

DOES IT
STILL MEAN
PENIS?



DAMN.



A-MAZ-ING
GRACE



HOW
GREAT THOU
ART...

POP

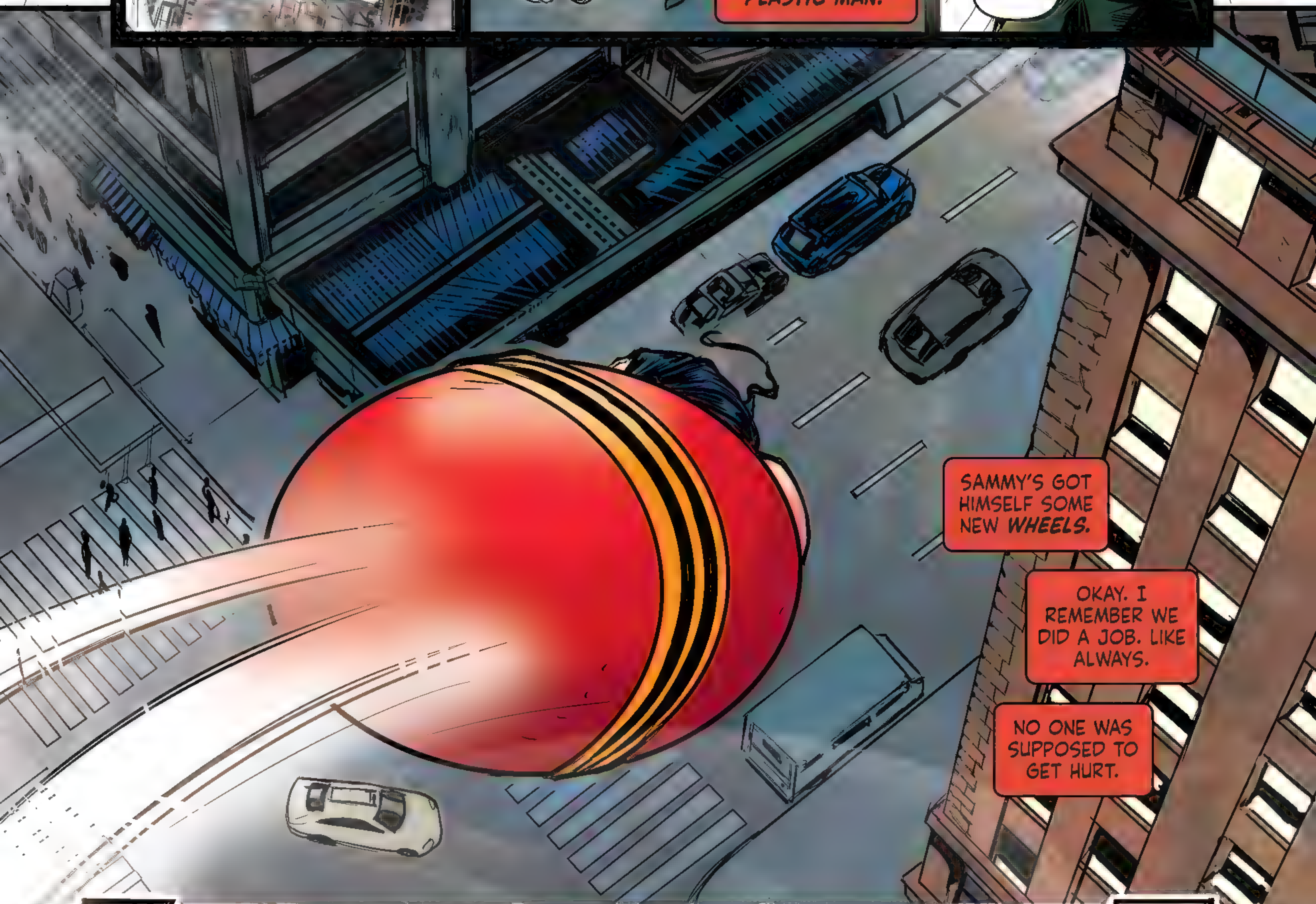


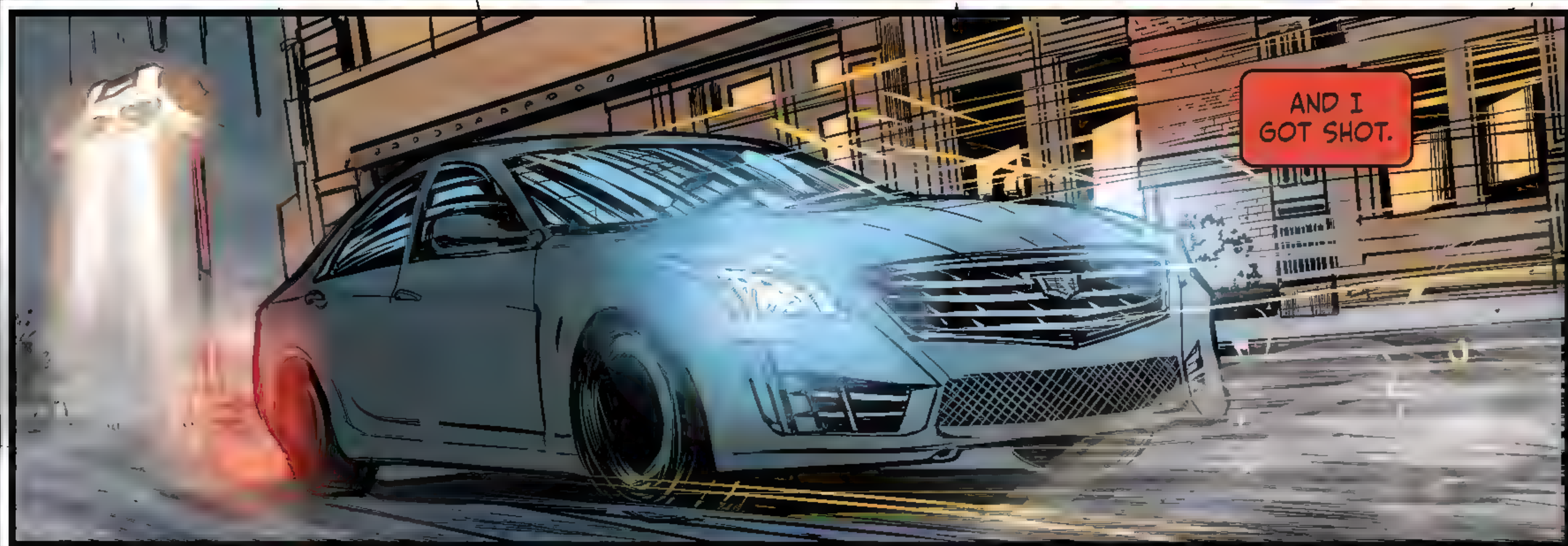
THAT GAVE...
A STRETCH... TO
MEEEEEE.

OKAY.

NOW I
KNOW WHERE
THE *RATS*
ARE.

THAT'S SO
WANG!





AND I GOT SHOT.



SO DID THE GUARD.

AND I DON'T REMEMBER WHICH OF THESE MASSIVE TOOLS PULLED THE TRIG.

DAMMIT.



SINCE THE HEIST, THEY BEEN LYING LOW. ONE THING WE KNOW HOW TO DO IS HIDE.

SO I HAD TO DRAW THEM OUT. LIKE A WORM ON A HOOK.

THAT'S A TERRIBLE ANALOGY.



OH, BENNY.

TONIGHT YOU GET PAYBACK, LIKE A WORM ON A--

NEVER MIND.

BENNY'S NEVER GONNA TALK TO SOME WEIRDO MADE OF USED GUM.

THIS REQUIRES FINESSE.



FORTUNATELY, I KNOW WHAT KIND OF THING HE'S AFRAID OF.

BENNY TURLIN.

DID YOU THINK YOU COULD ESCAPE JUSTICE?

HUH?



IN
THE NAME OF
HERA, GODDESS
OF...
...**WHATEVER!**

I CALL YOU
TO **SURRENDER**
TO MY WOMANLY
FEMALENESS WHICH
IS TOTALLY BETTER
THAN DUDES!



SEE?

CLASSIC FEAR
OF WOMEN. SO
HOSTILE HE DON'T
EVEN **THINK**.

ARRRR!

WHAT?
TOO MUCH
CLEAVAGE?

OR MAYBE
HE JUST DON'T
LIKE CAPES.

ON THIS, WE'RE
KINDA OF LIKE **MINDS**,
YOU KNOW?



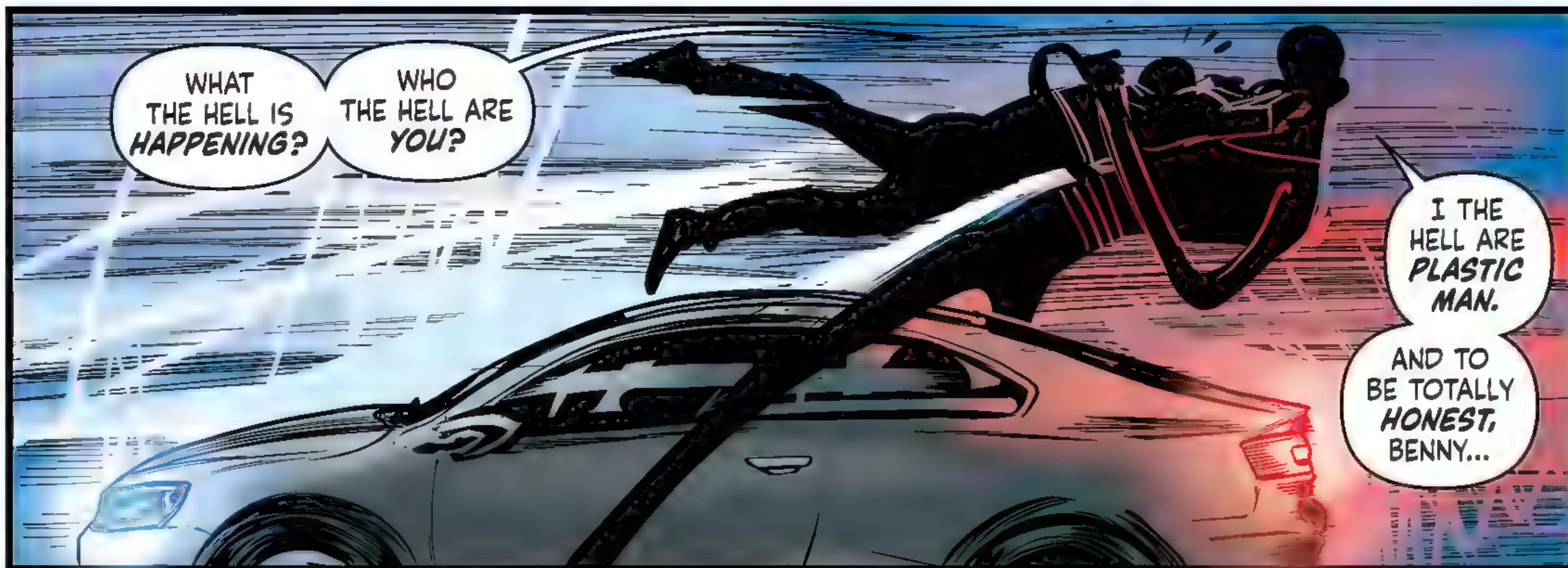
IF HE DOESN'T KILL ME,
THIS WILL BE **EXCELLENT**
DETECTIVE WORK.

WAY TO
GO, ME!



HONNNNNK

Uh-oh.

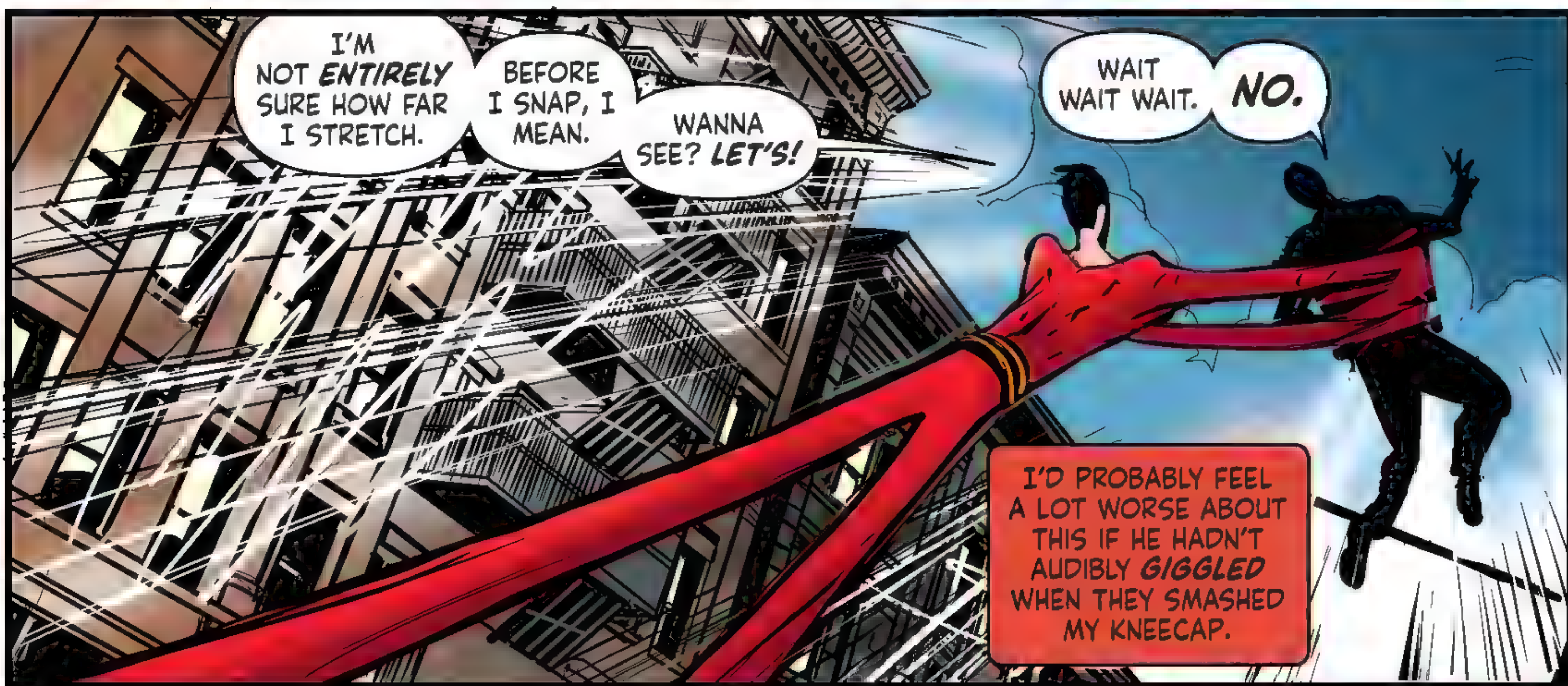


WHAT THE HELL IS HAPPENING?

WHO THE HELL ARE YOU?

I THE HELL ARE PLASTIC MAN.

AND TO BE TOTALLY HONEST, BENNY...



I'M NOT ENTIRELY SURE HOW FAR I STRETCH.

BEFORE I SNAP, I MEAN.

WANNA SEE? LET'S!

WAIT WAIT WAIT.

NO.

I'D PROBABLY FEEL A LOT WORSE ABOUT THIS IF HE HADN'T AUDIBLY GIGGLED WHEN THEY SMASHED MY KNEECAP.



STOP IT! PLEASE! FOR THE LOVE OF GOD!

THE CHEMICAL FACTORY HEIST, BENNY.

I KNOW YOU DID IT.

THE GUARD, BENNY.

WHO SHOT THE GUARD?



I... CAN'T.

THEY'LL KILL ME!

YOU THINK I'M PLAYING HUMAN ELEVATOR FOR FUN, BENNY?



IT WAS EEL.

EEL O'BRIAN CAPPED THAT RENT-A-COP!

GET ME DOWN. PLEASE.

OH.

OH NO.



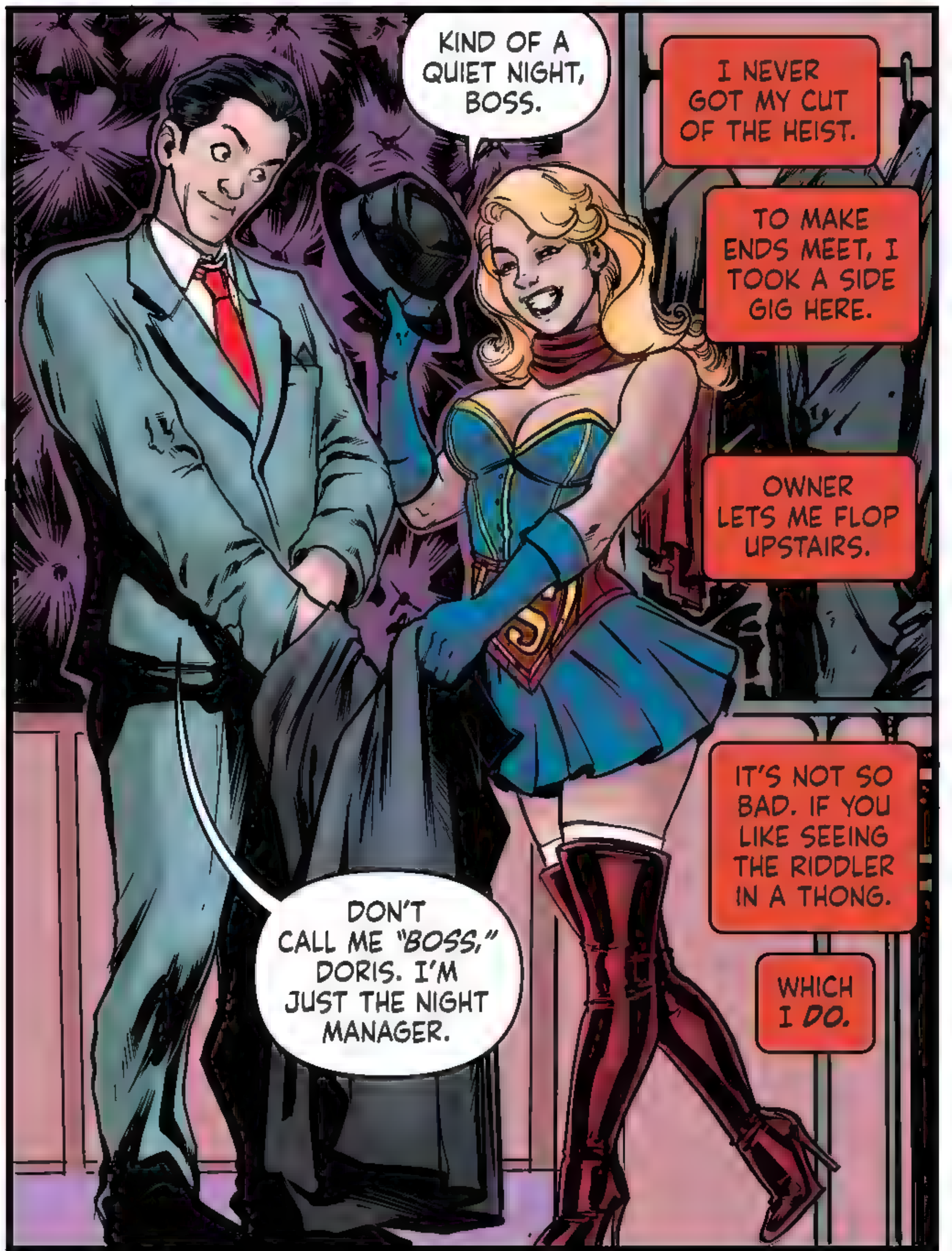
IT CAN'T
BE TRUE. IT
CAN'T BE.

I DIDN'T WANT
IT TO BE TRUE.

BUT WHY ELSE WOULD
I HAVE FORGOTTEN
EVERYTHING FROM THAT
NIGHT?

I'M NOT
ONLY A HEEL
AND A CREEP.

I'M A
MURDERER.



KIND OF A
QUIET NIGHT,
BOSS.

I NEVER
GOT MY CUT
OF THE HEIST.

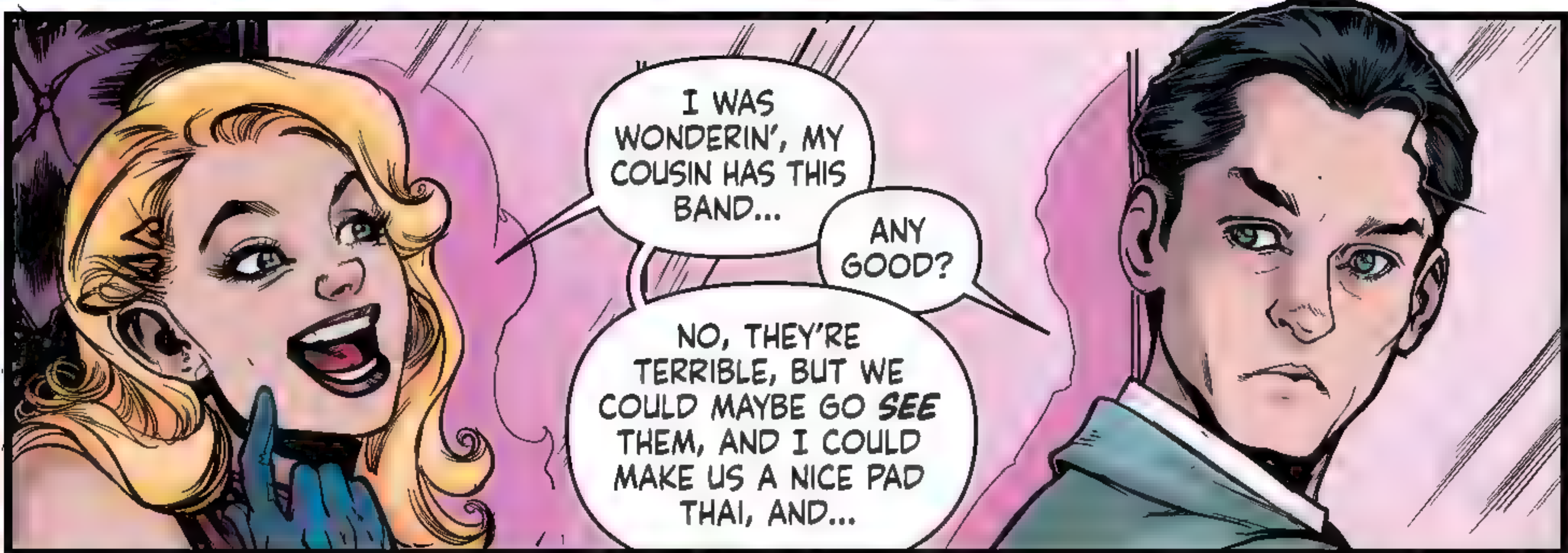
TO MAKE
ENDS MEET, I
TOOK A SIDE
GIG HERE.

OWNER
LETS ME FLOP
UPSTAIRS.

IT'S NOT SO
BAD. IF YOU
LIKE SEEING
THE RIDDLER
IN A THONG.

WHICH
I DO.

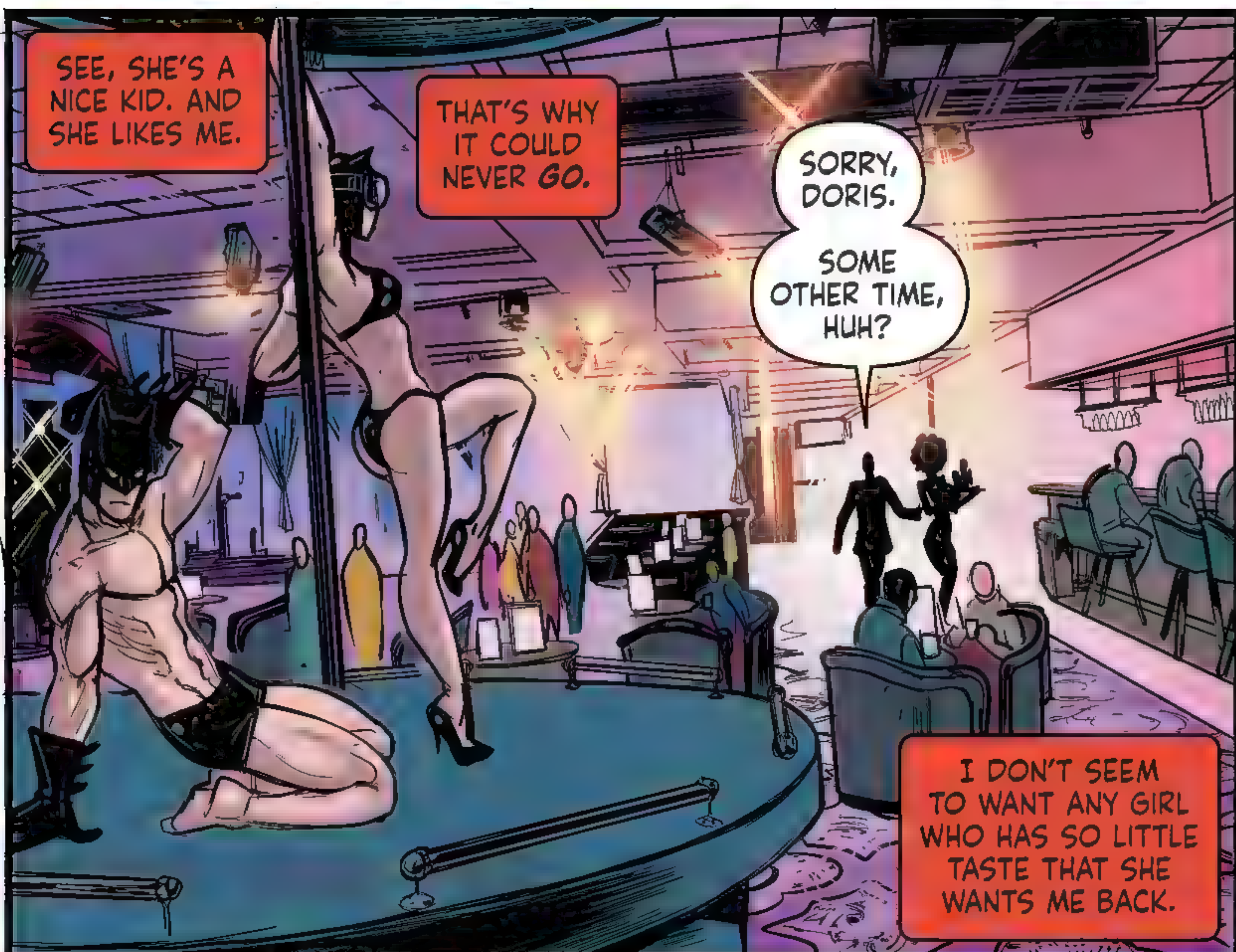
DON'T
CALL ME "BOSS,"
DORIS. I'M
JUST THE NIGHT
MANAGER.



I WAS
WONDERIN', MY
COUSIN HAS THIS
BAND...

ANY
GOOD?

NO, THEY'RE
TERRIBLE, BUT WE
COULD MAYBE GO *SEE*
THEM, AND I COULD
MAKE US A NICE PAD
THAI, AND...



SEE, SHE'S A
NICE KID. AND
SHE LIKES ME.

THAT'S WHY
IT COULD
NEVER GO.

SORRY,
DORIS.

SOME
OTHER TIME,
HUH?

I DON'T SEEM
TO WANT ANY GIRL
WHO HAS SO LITTLE
TASTE THAT SHE
WANTS ME BACK.



LILA.

EEL.

I'VE
TOLD YOU.

LISTEN, I GOT
SOME BAD NEWS
TONIGHT, AND I
WAS WONDERING
IF YOU'D--

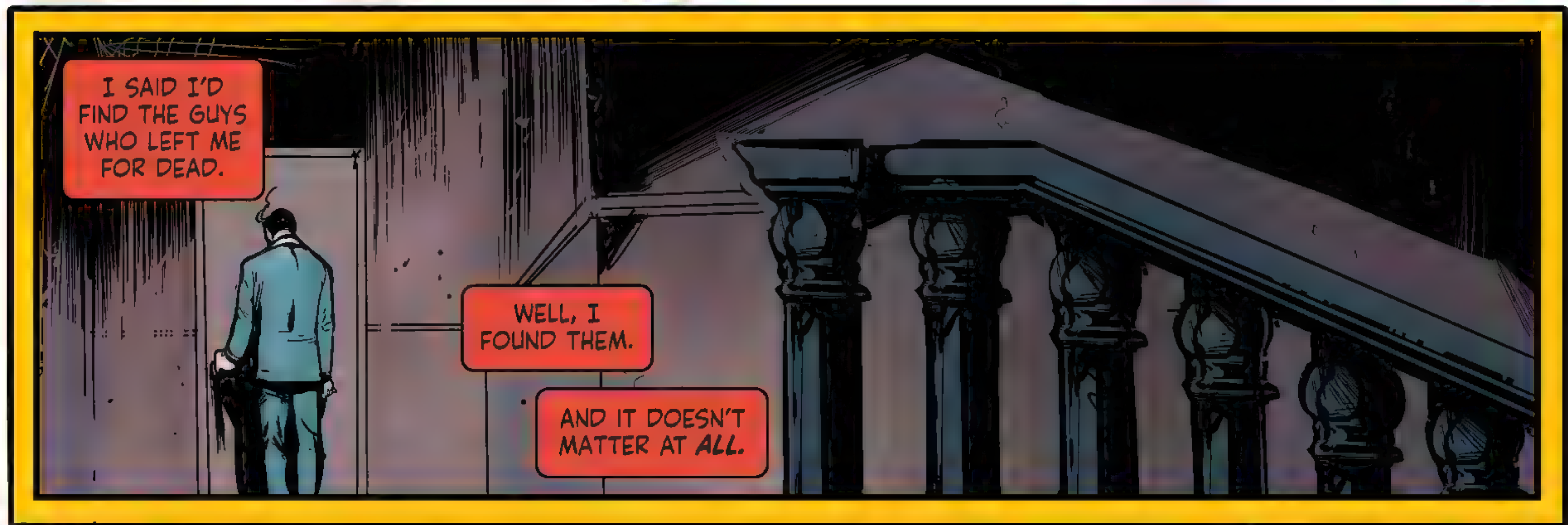


YOU'RE
A NICE GUY.
BUT YOU'RE A
CRIMINAL.

AND I
WON'T DATE A
CRIMINAL.

I'M
SORRY.

COURSE, FORTUNATELY,
THERE'S NO SHORTAGE OF
WOMEN WHO THINK I'D
MAKE AN EXCELLENT DATE
FOR A DUMPSTER FIRE.



I SAID I'D
FIND THE GUYS
WHO LEFT ME
FOR DEAD.

WELL, I
FOUND THEM.

AND IT DOESN'T
MATTER AT ALL.



DAMMIT.

SEE, THE
DUCHESS SAYS
SHE'LL PAY HALF
A MIL FOR THE
CONTENTS OF
THAT SAFE.

I DON'T LIKE
IT, SAMMY. WHO PUTS
SECURE INFORMATION
ON *PAPER* ANYMORE?
IT'S ALL ENCRYPTED
DIGITAL CRAP NOW.

THE
CLOUD AND
JUNK.

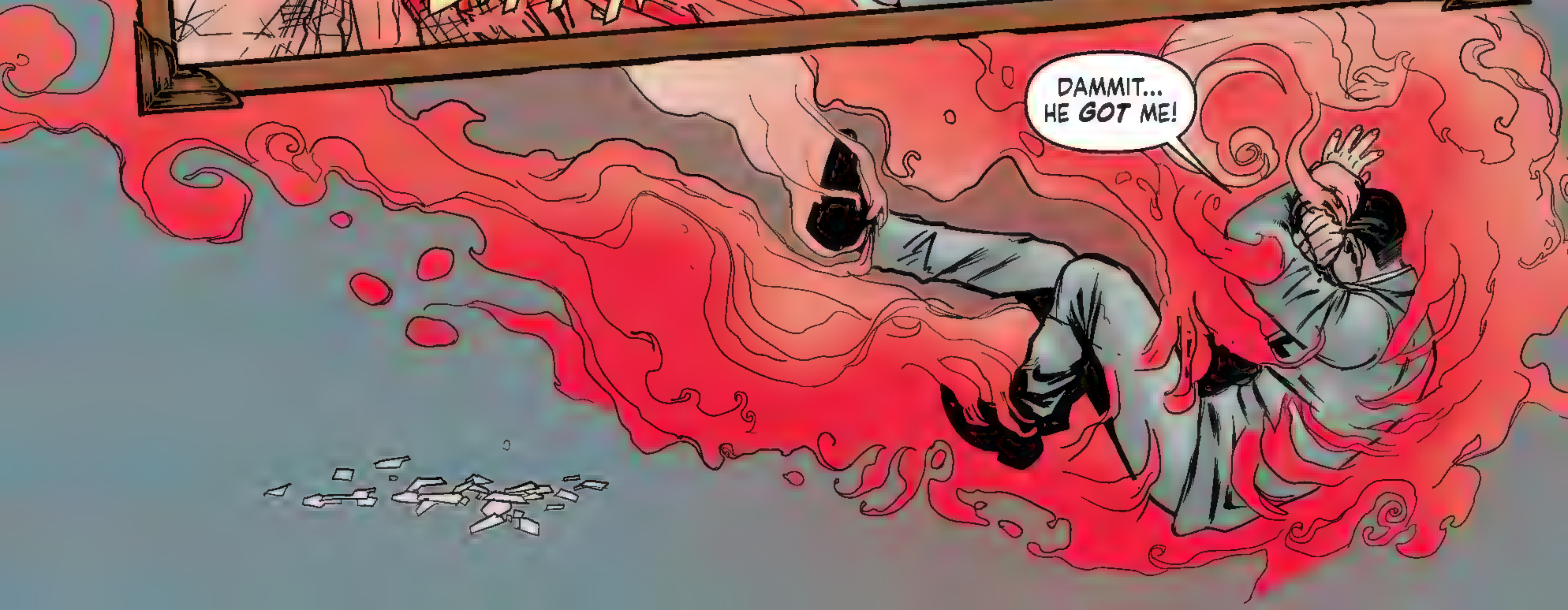
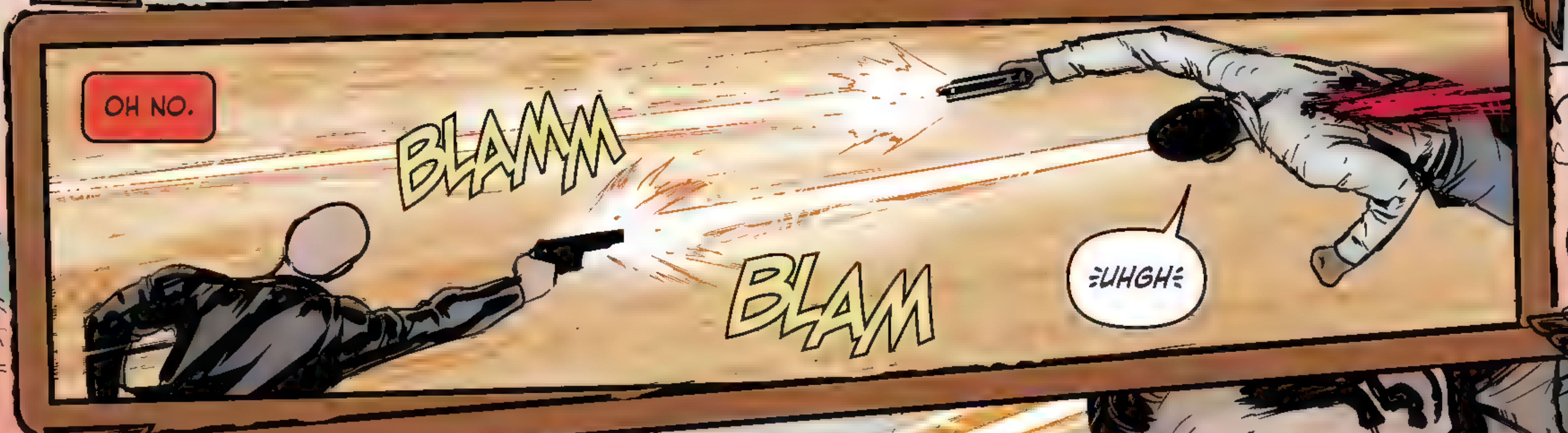
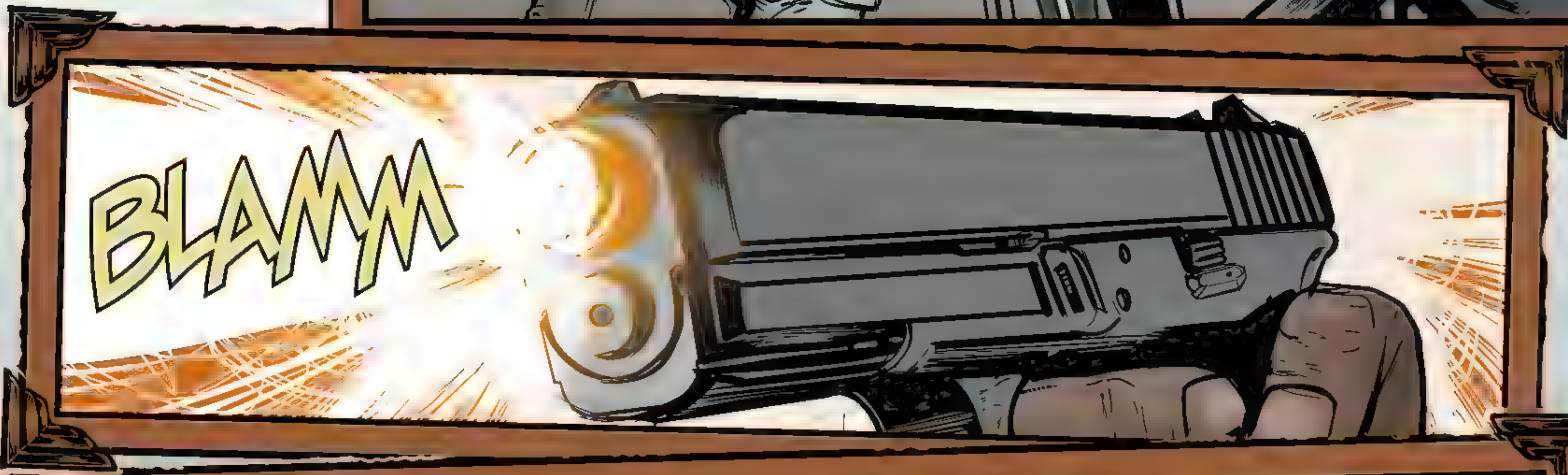
DUCHESS
SAYS THE
OWNER'S DOIN'
ALL THIS ILLEGAL
RESEARCH.

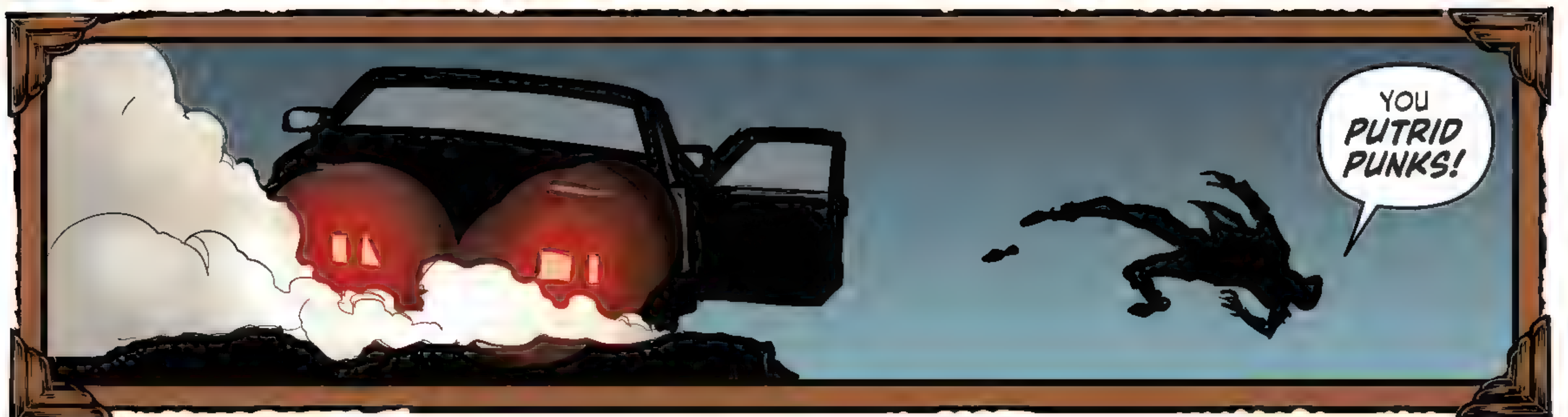
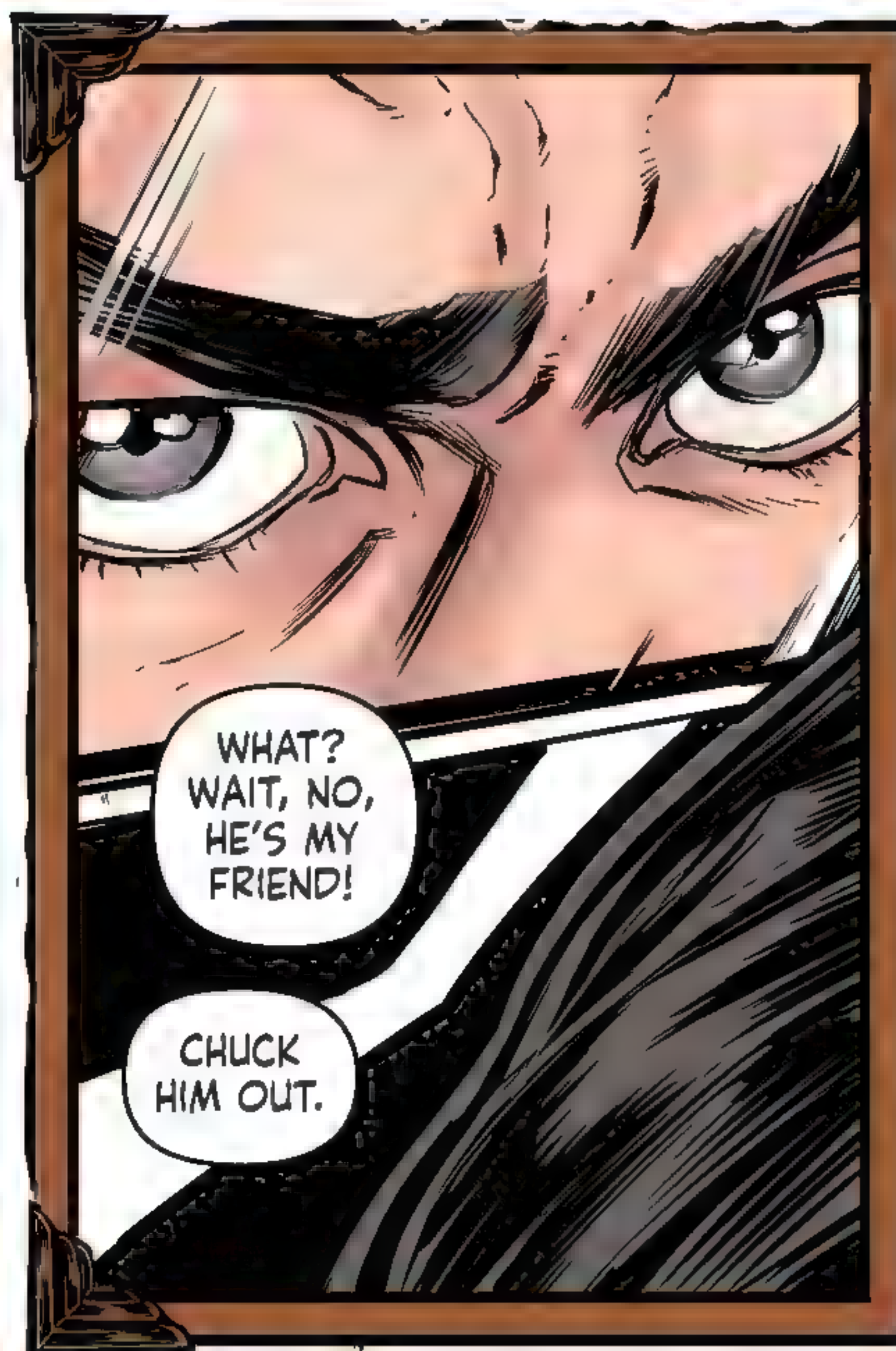
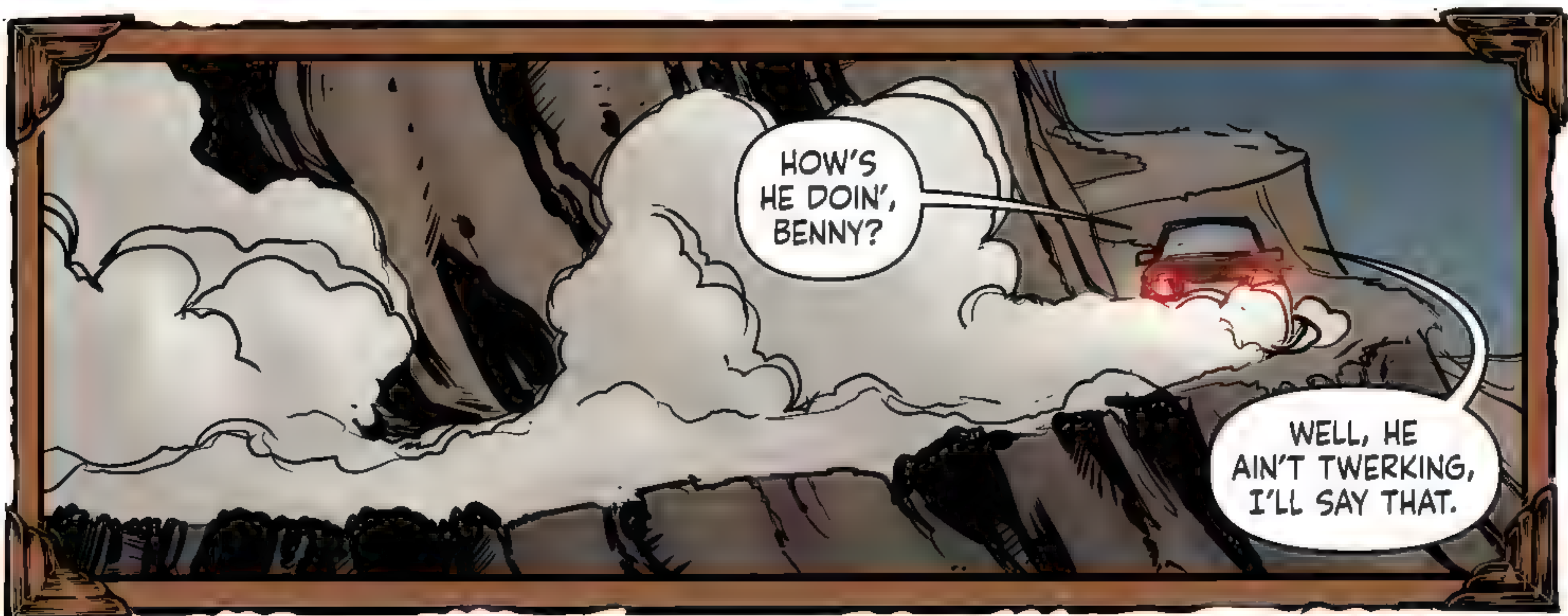
TOXIC
WASTE AND
WHATNOT. *NONE*
OF THIS IS ON
THE BOOKS.

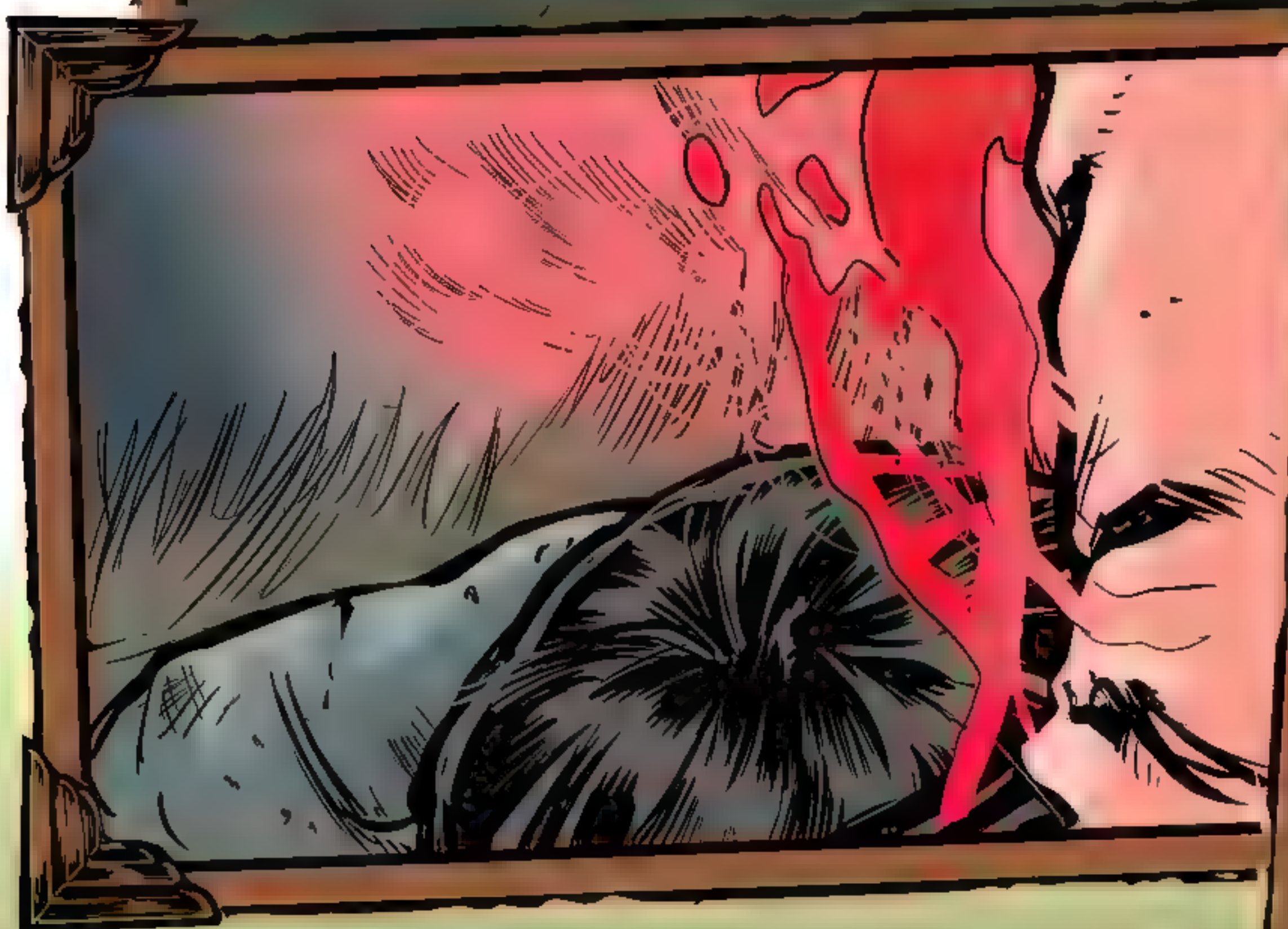
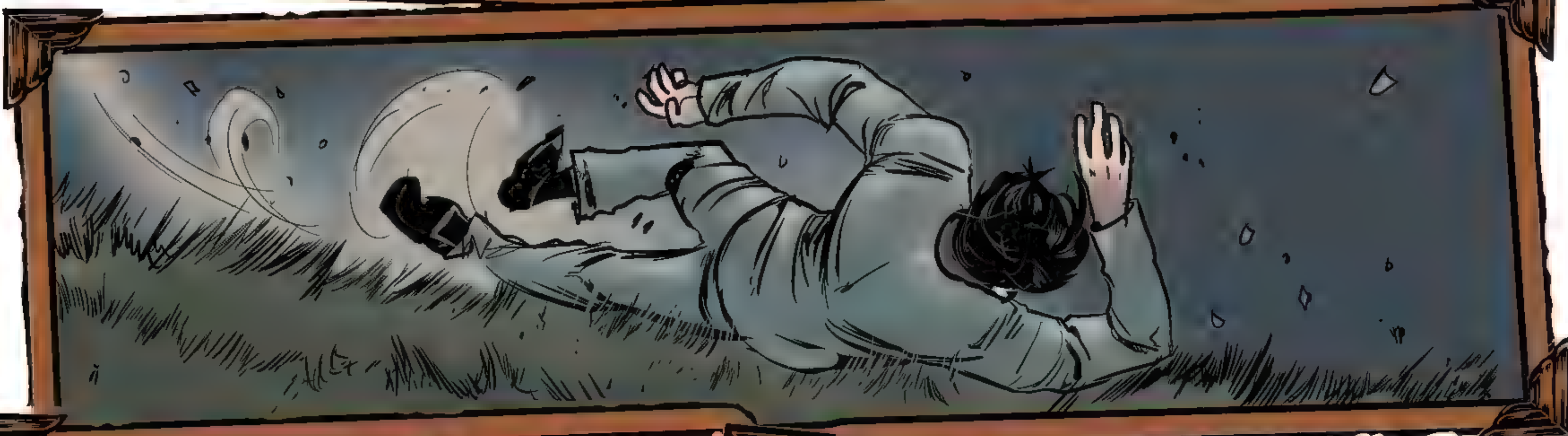
SO NO
DIGITAL TRAIL,
RIGHT?

HANG ON.
I THINK I
GOT IT.









I'M SORRY.

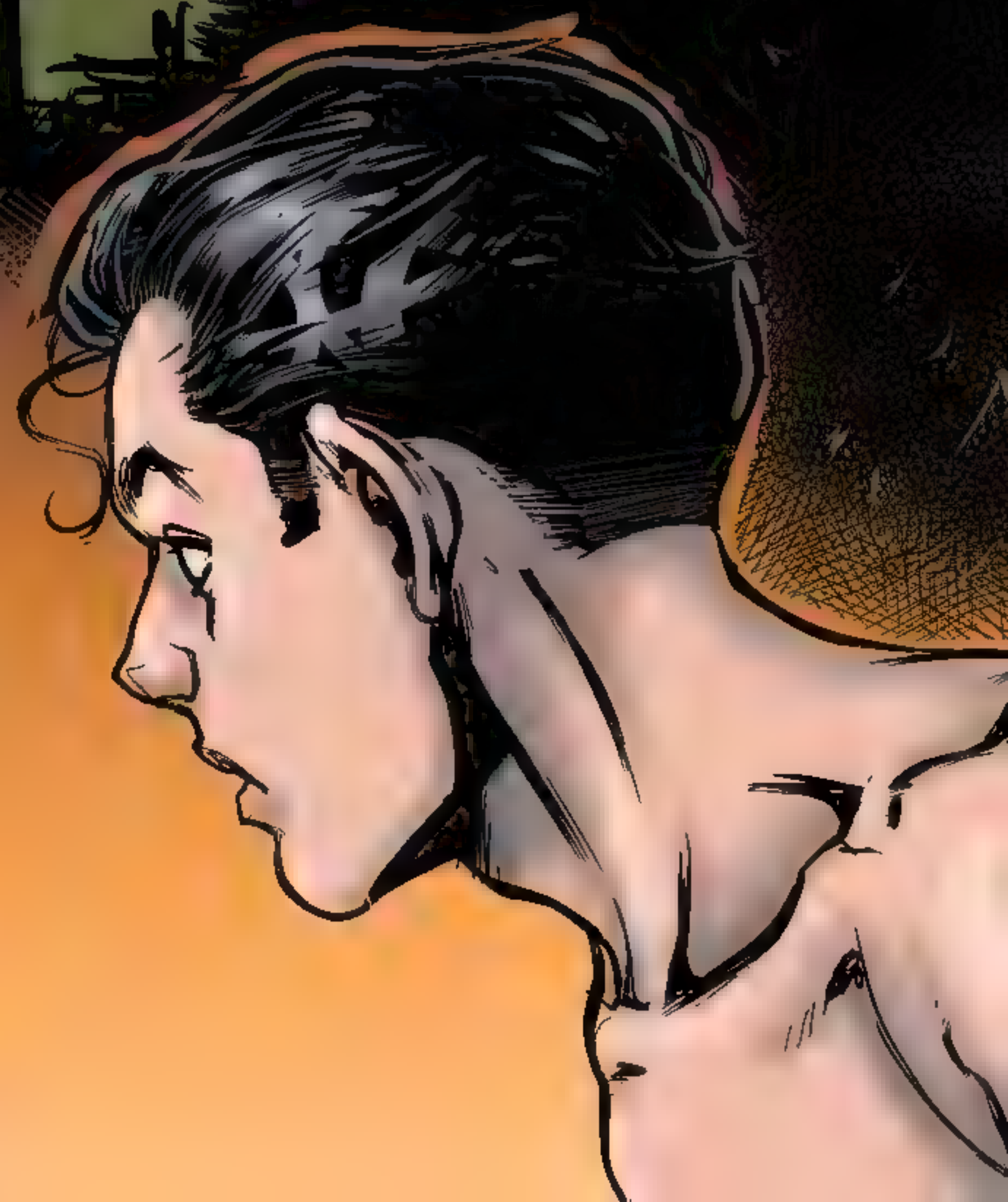
EEL O'BRIAN, WHAT HAVE YOU DONE?



NOW, MYSELF, I HAVE TO THINK THAT A MAN WHO WAKES UP LIKE THAT HAS A GUILTY CONSCIENCE.

HELLO, MR. O'BRIAN.

A.K.A. PLASTIC MAN.





...
I'M FIXING
TO MAKE
COFFEE.

I DON'T HAVE
ANY DAINTIES ON,
WOULD YOU MIND
TURNING AROUND,
MYSTERY LADY?



I DON'T TURN
MY BACK ON WANTED
FELONS, MR.
O'BRIAN.

SUIT
YOURSELF.

WHO
ARE YOU,
AGAIN?

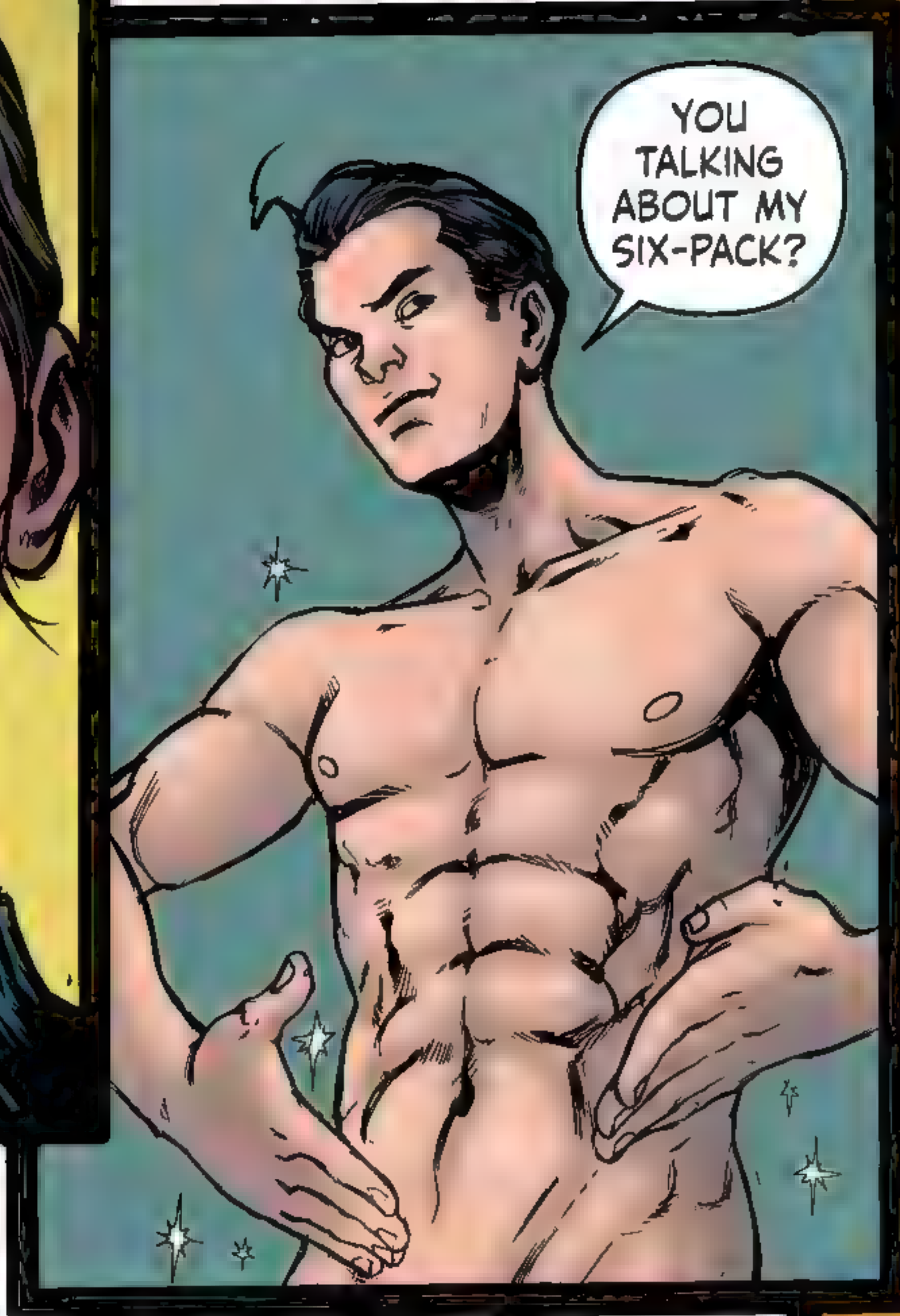
MY
CODE NAME
IS *OBSCURA*.
I WORK FOR
SPYRAL.

THAT'S ALL
YOU NEED TO
KNOW ABOUT
ME.

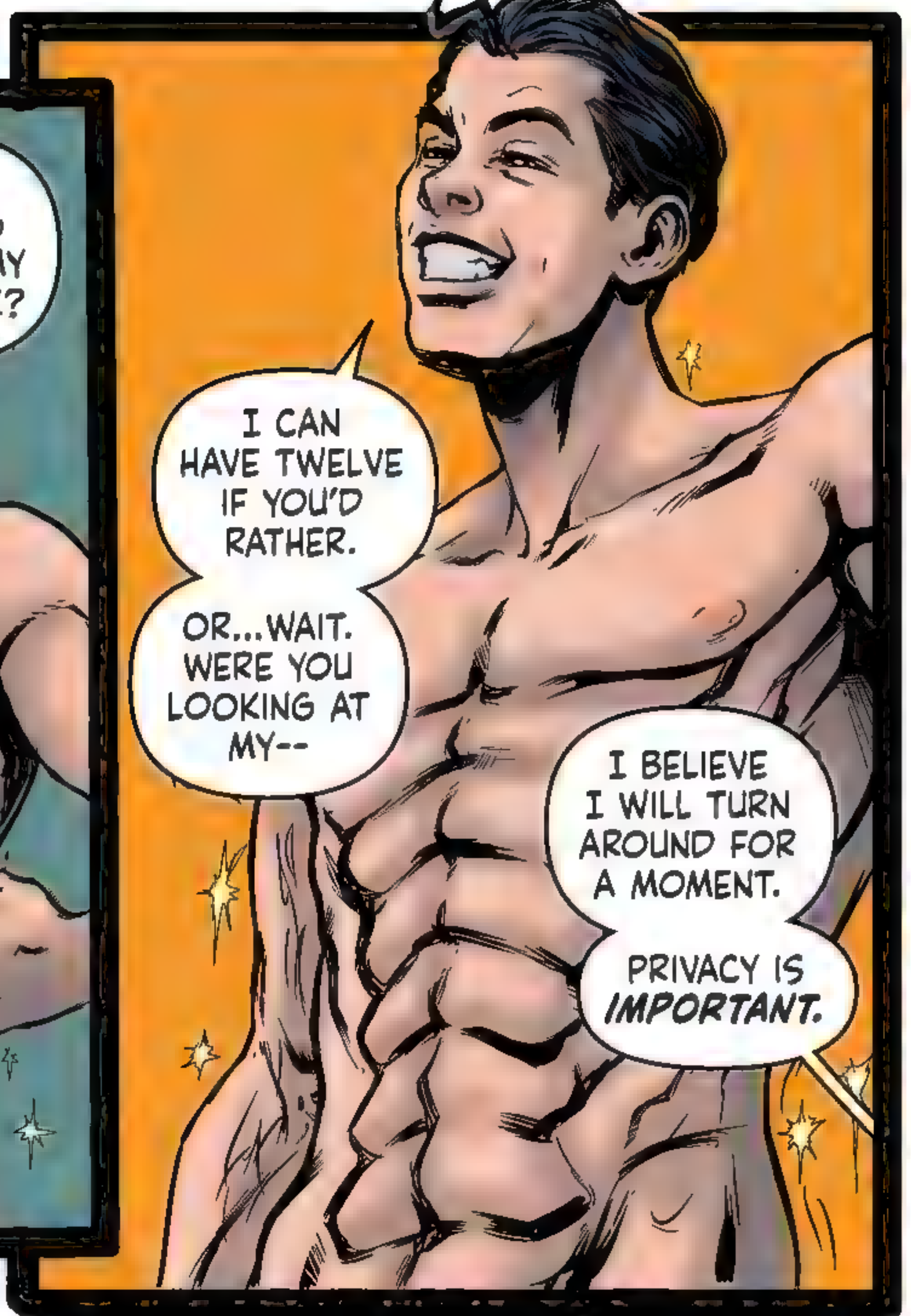
HOLD THAT
THOUGHT.
CAFFEINE!



OH MY.



YOU
TALKING
ABOUT MY
SIX-PACK?

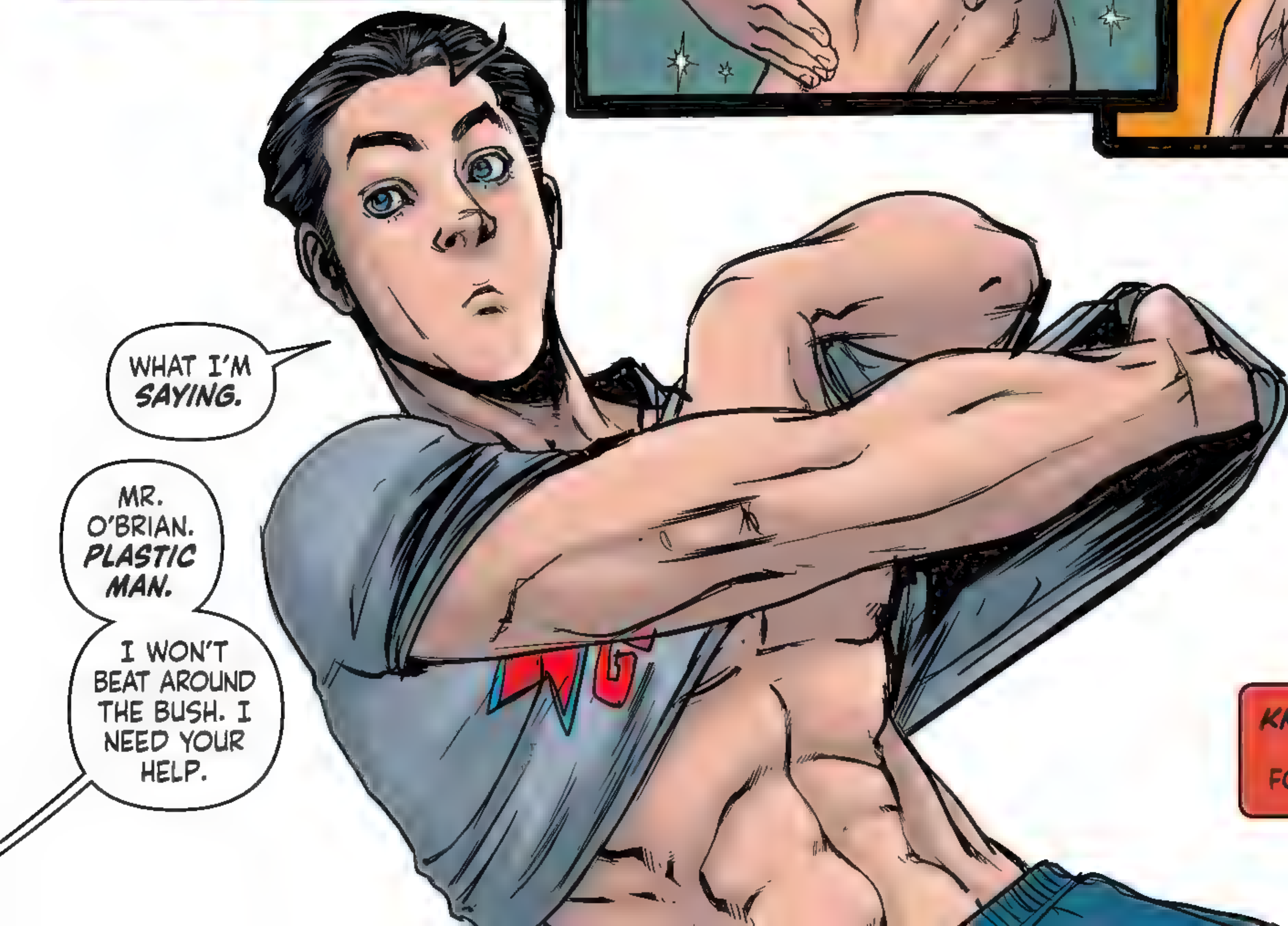


I CAN
HAVE TWELVE
IF YOU'D
RATHER.

OR...WAIT.
WERE YOU
LOOKING AT
MY--

I BELIEVE
I WILL TURN
AROUND FOR
A MOMENT.

PRIVACY IS
IMPORTANT.



WHAT I'M
SAYING.

MR.
O'BRIAN.
PLASTIC
MAN.

I WON'T
BEAT AROUND
THE BUSH. I
NEED YOUR
HELP.

KNEW SOMEONE
HAD BEEN
FOLLOWING ME.

OKAY, FINE.
SHE *KNOWS*.



YOU CAN
TURN AROUND
NOW, MISS
PRISS.

THERE'S
A CONSPIRACY
OUT THERE, MR.
O'BRIAN. MADE
UP OF A COUNCIL
OF THE MOST
HEINOUS MINDS IN
THIS WORLD'S
HISTORY.

AND NOT
JUST THIS
WORLD.



THEY DON'T WANT MONEY. THEY WANT THE
COMPLETE DISMANTLING OF ANY GOVERNMENT OR
FORCE THAT CAN OPPOSE THEIR WILL. AND
THEY'LL **GET** IT.

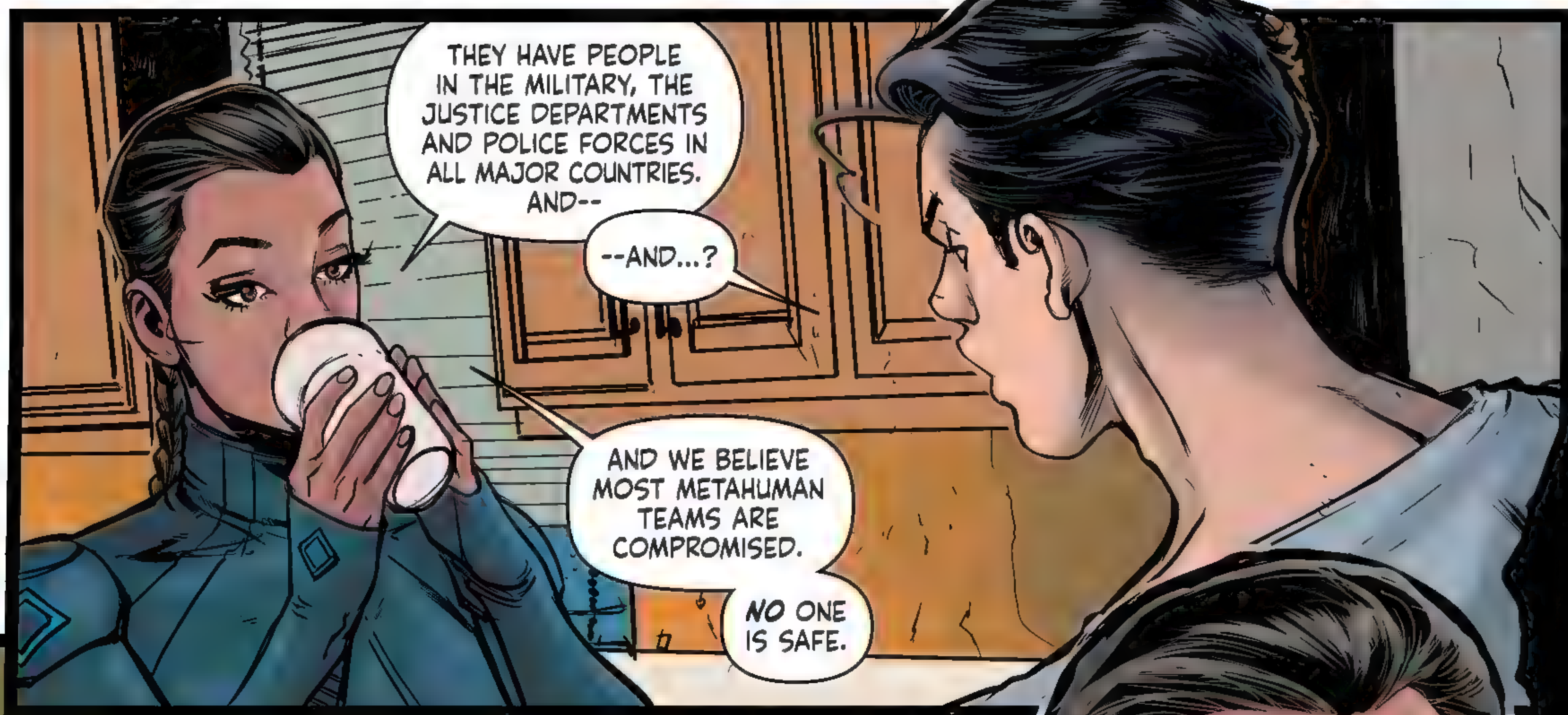
THEY'RE
PARTIALLY THERE
ALREADY.



SO WHY TELL ME?
CALL IN THE TEEN JUSTICE
TITANS OR WHATEVER
THE HELL.

BECAUSE
YOU HAVE UNIQUE
INFILTRATION SKILLS,
MR. O'BRIAN.

BUT SO
DO **THEY.**

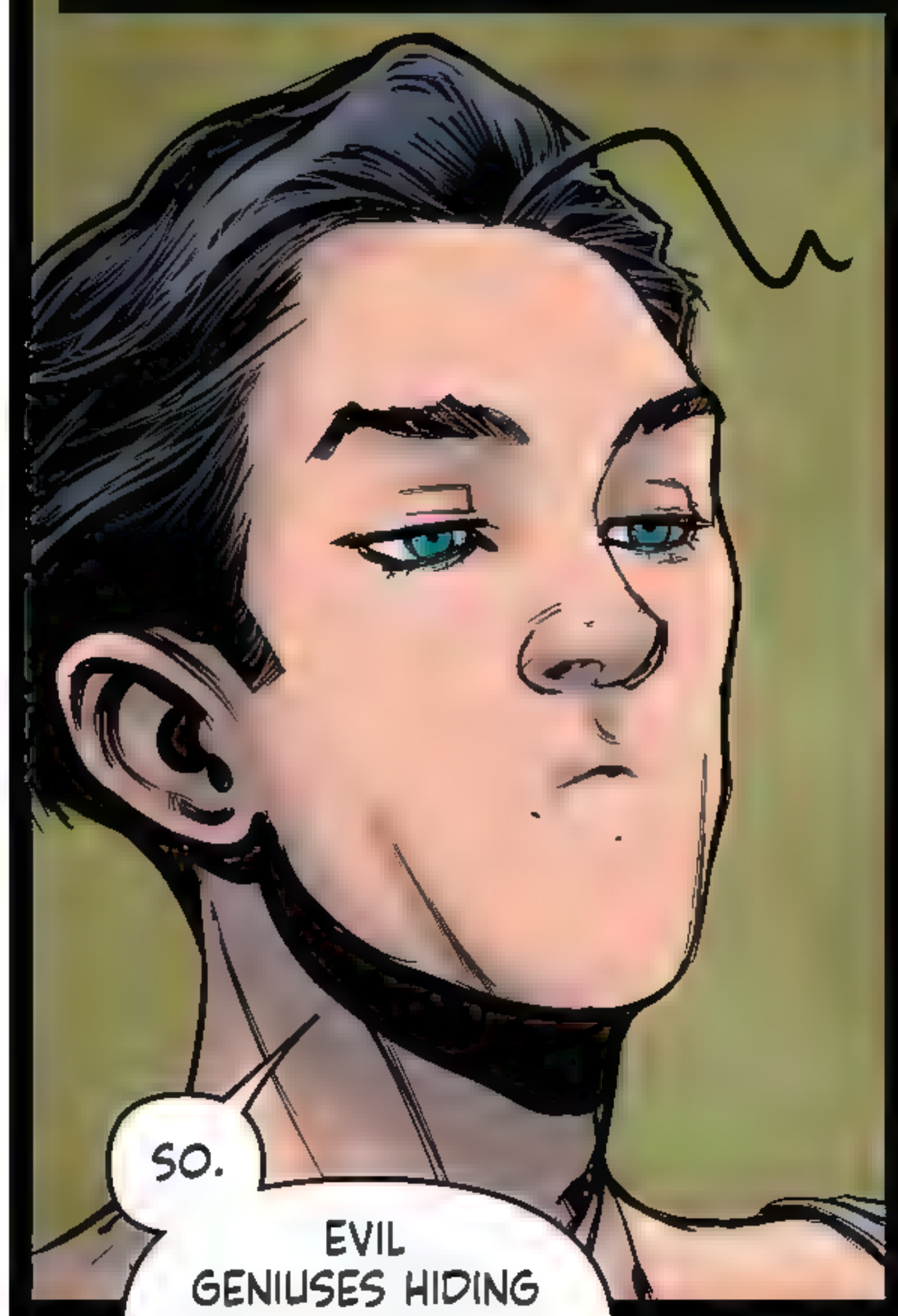


THEY HAVE PEOPLE
IN THE MILITARY, THE
JUSTICE DEPARTMENTS
AND POLICE FORCES IN
ALL MAJOR COUNTRIES.
AND--

--AND...?

AND WE BELIEVE
MOST METAHUMAN
TEAMS ARE
COMPROMISED.

NO ONE
IS SAFE.



SO.

EVIL
GENIUSES HIDING
RIGHT NEXT TO THE
BIG GUNS, YOU'RE
SAYING?



LADY--

YOU'RE
FULL OF
WANG.

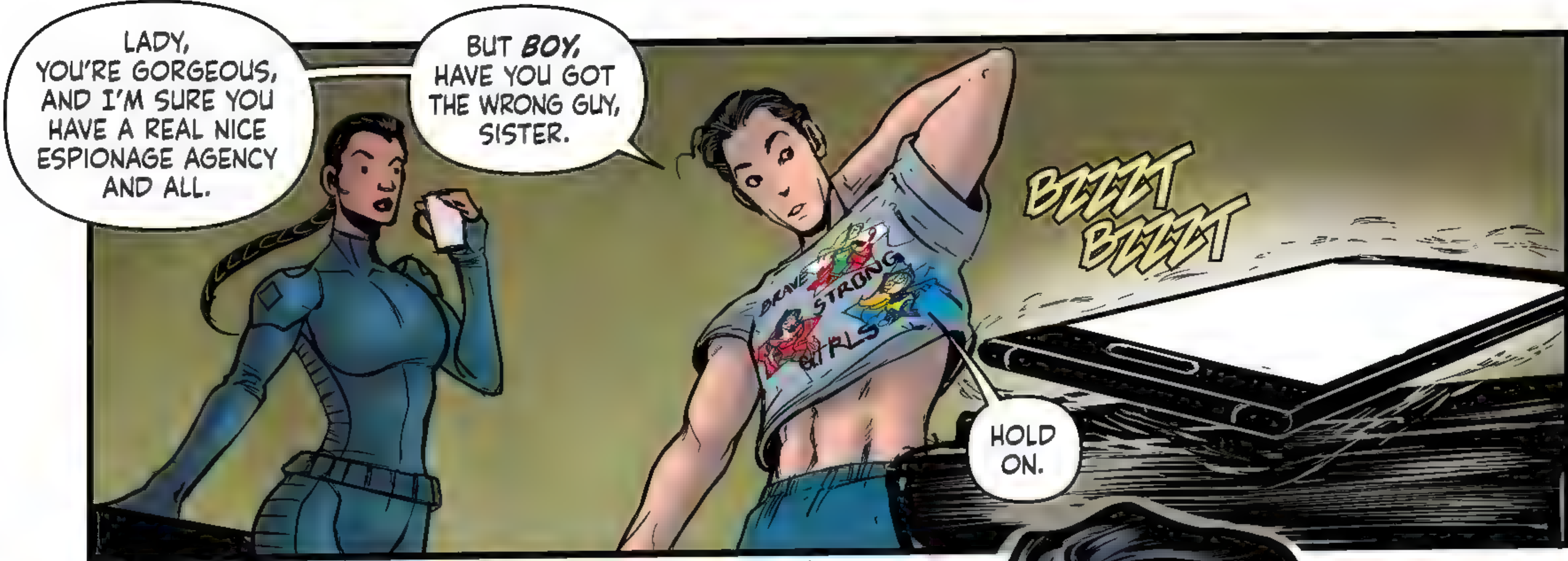


I...

LOOK.

WE NEED
TO PUT SOMEONE
INSIDE THIS...
THIS...**CABAL.**

SOMEONE
NO ONE
KNOWS.

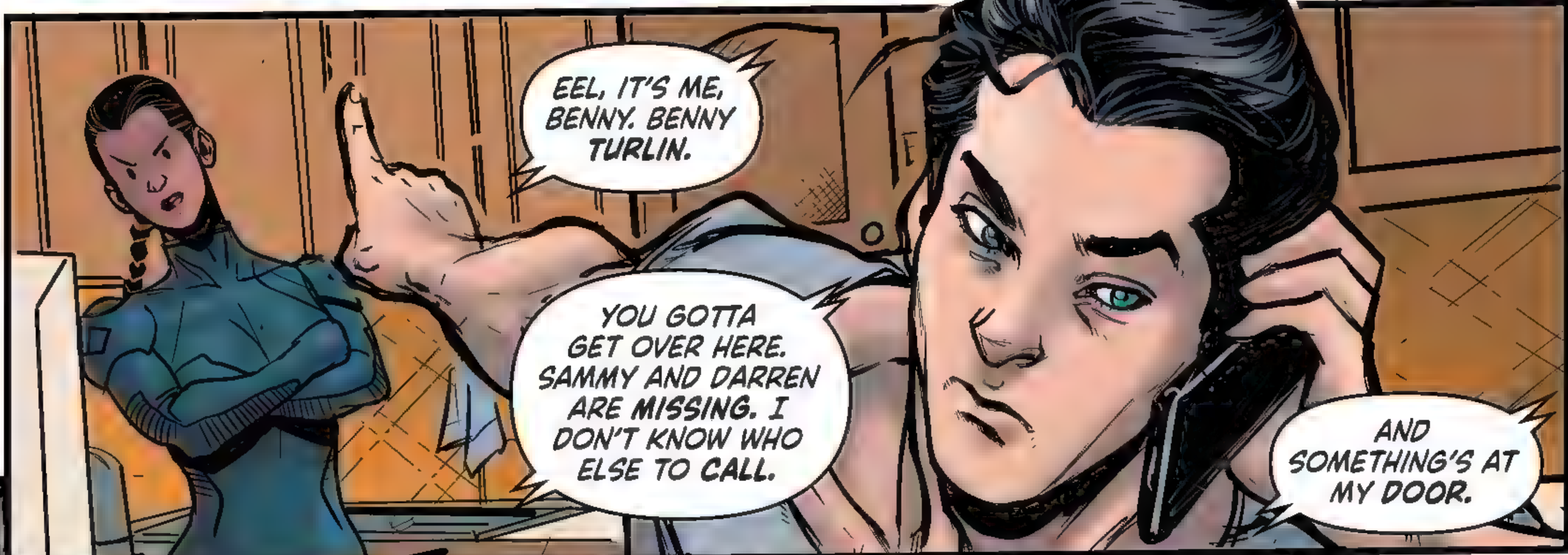


LADY, YOU'RE GORGEOUS, AND I'M SURE YOU HAVE A REAL NICE ESPIONAGE AGENCY AND ALL.

BUT *BOY*, HAVE YOU GOT THE WRONG GUY, SISTER.

HOLD ON.

BZZT BZZT



EEL, IT'S ME, BENNY. BENNY TURLIN.

YOU GOTTA GET OVER HERE. SAMMY AND DARREN ARE MISSING. I DON'T KNOW WHO ELSE TO CALL.

AND SOMETHING'S AT MY DOOR.



I DON'T THINK IT'S HUMAN.

WE USED TO BE PALS, RIGHT? PLEASE. YOU NEED TO COME, NOW!



LISTEN, I GOTTA--

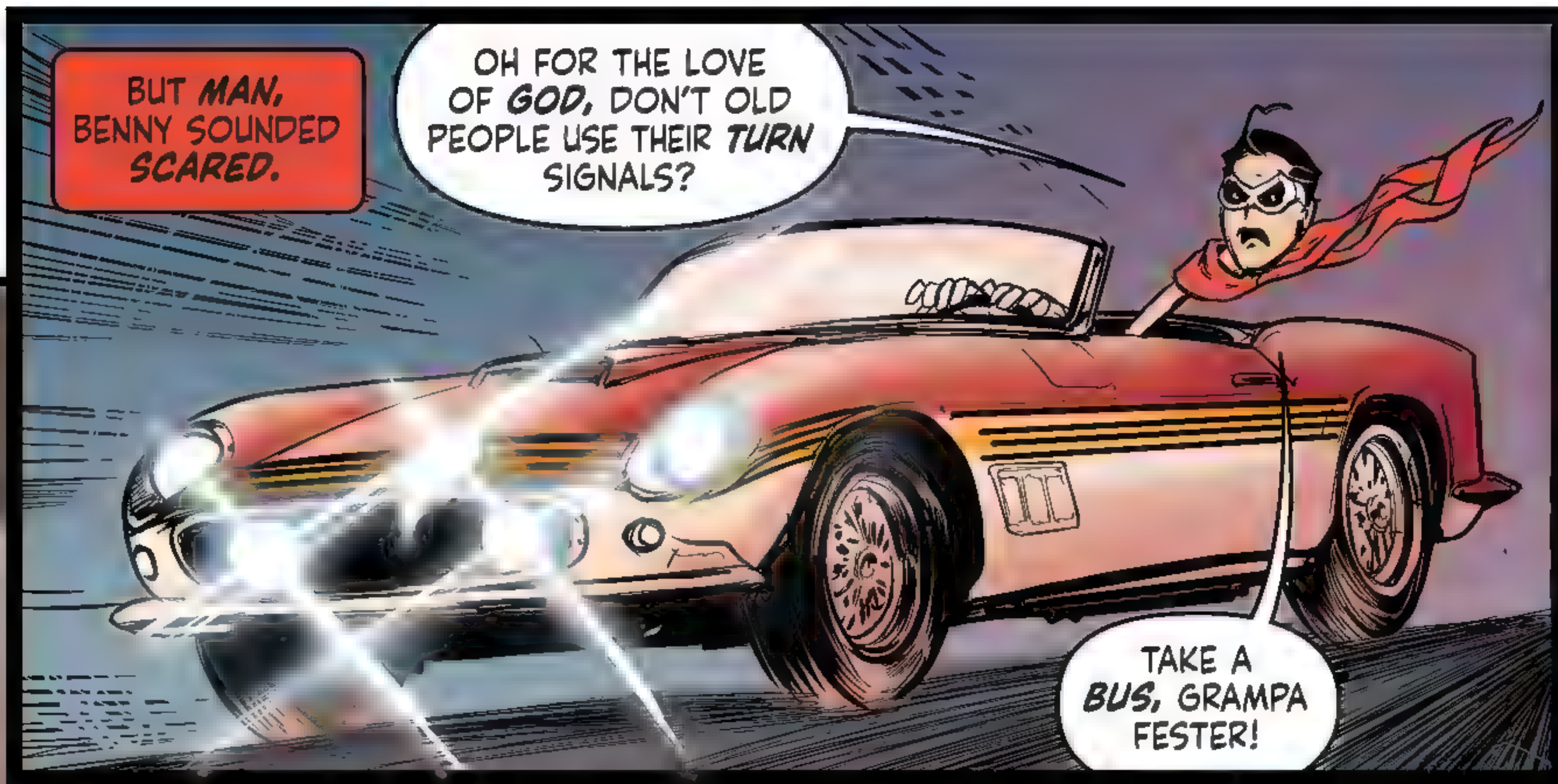
GO, GO. I'LL MEET YOU THERE.



"GO!"

IT COULD BE A SETUP.

IT'S PROBABLY A SETUP.



BUT *MAN*, BENNY SOUNDED SCARED.

OH FOR THE LOVE OF *GOD*, DON'T OLD PEOPLE USE THEIR *TURN* SIGNALS?

TAKE A *BUS*, GRAMPA FESTER!



OH. OH *MAN*.

SO, *WHY* DO I CARE IF THIS FORMER FRIEND/ RECENT ATTEMPTED MURDERER IS OKAY?

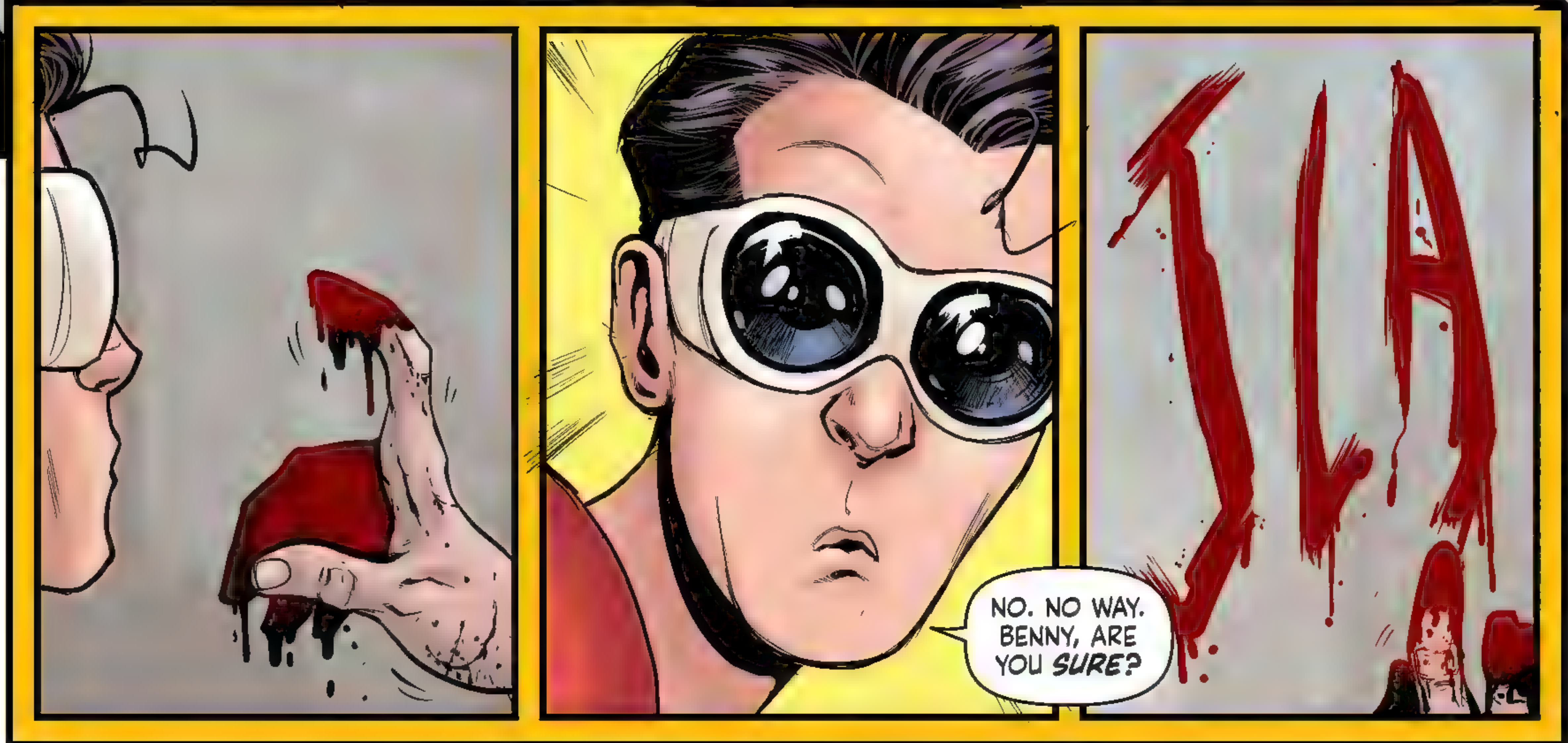
I DON'T KNOW. BUT I *DO*. ALL RIGHT?



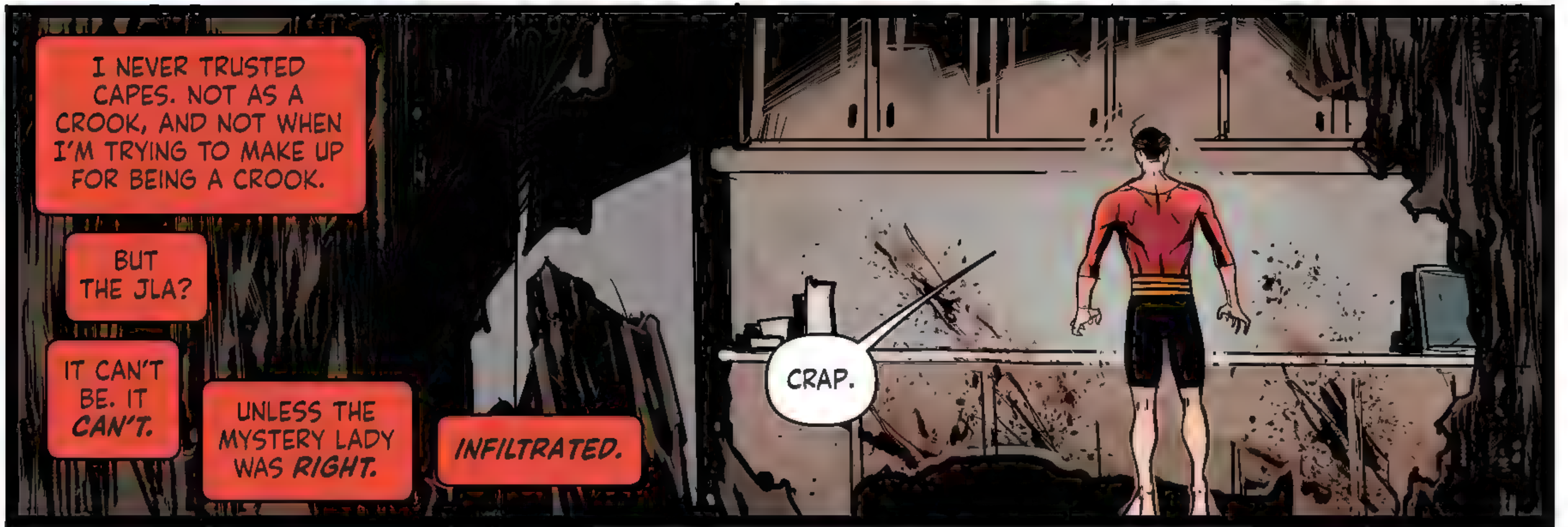
OH BENNY.

I'M SO SORRY.

BENNY. WHO *DID* THIS? WHO KILLED YOU?



NO. NO WAY. BENNY, ARE YOU *SURE*?





Bikinis
Every '18
Mat
Lopes

CHAPTER TWO

WHERE THE

*&^%

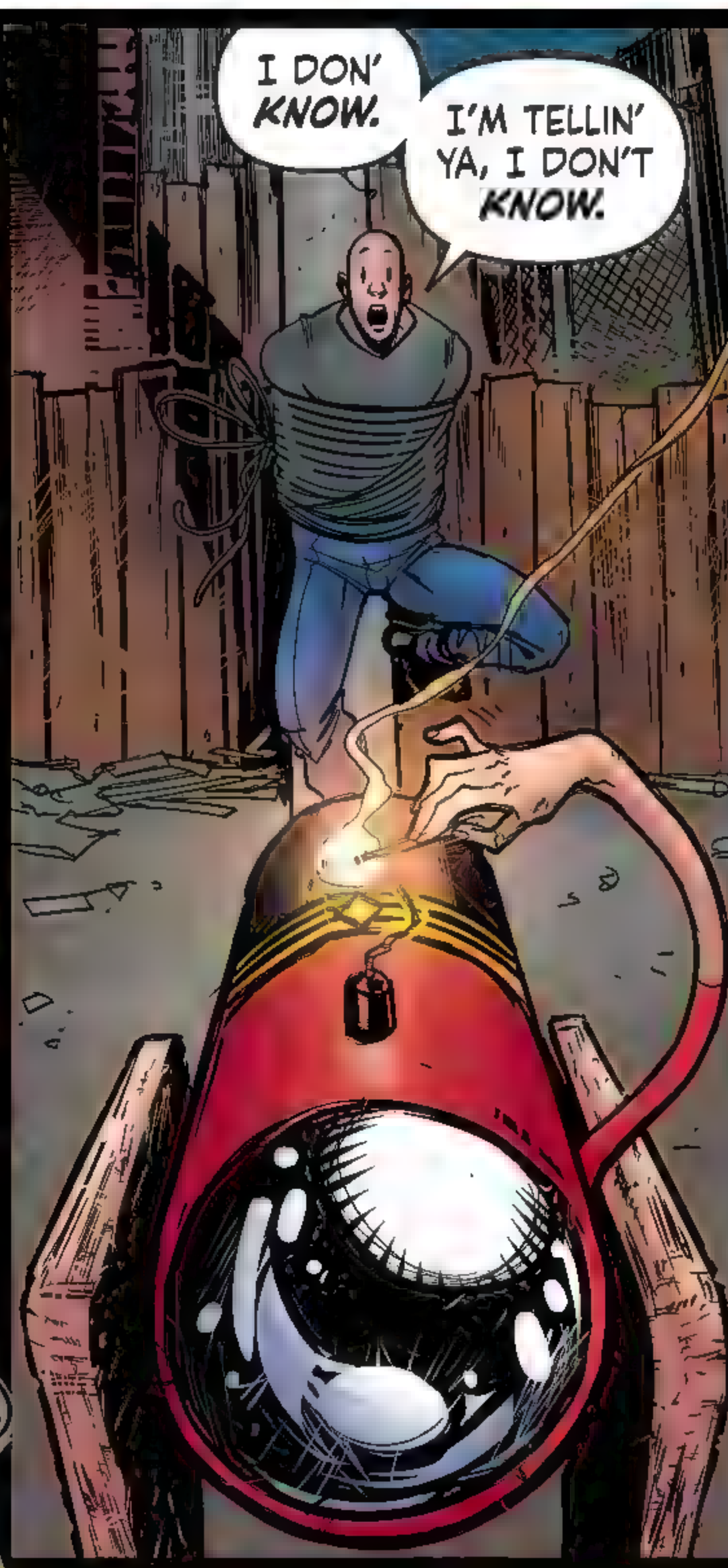
IS PADO SWAKATOON?

Cover art by Bilquis Evelyn



I HAVEN'T SEEN HIM! I HAVEN'T SEEN ANYBODY!

PLEASE DON'T CARPENTRY MY HEAD.



I DON' KNOW.

I'M TELLIN' YA, I DON'T KNOW.



MY CAR.

YOU DESTROYED MY CAR!



WE TOLD YOU.

WE AIN'T SEEN HIM.



HAVE I SEEN A SAD OLD RACCOON?

CAN'T SAY AS I HAVE, YOUNG LADY!



NO, I HAVEN'T SEEN ANYONE LIKE THAT.

AND NO, I DON'T WANT TO SEE YOUR "SLIDE TROMBONE."

SERIOUSLY.

EW.



KID!
IT'S ME.
MR. STRETCH!



HE'S ABOUT
YEA TALL,
OKAY? AND I
THINK HE'S IN
TROUBLE.

WE AIN'T
SEEN HIM,
BABY.

HOPE
YOU FIND HIM,
STRING BEAN.



I SAID HE
WEARS A HOODIE AND
SAYS EVERYTHING IS
"WANG" AND I DON'T
ENTIRELY KNOW WHAT
THAT MEANS, BUT--

WE'VE
CALLED THE
POLICE, SIR.



AND HE CALLS
HIMSELF THE SUAVE
PRINCE AND I
THOUGHT THAT WAS
WEIRD BUT--

AT NIGHT
THE PIGEONS
LOSE THEIR
FEATHERS
AND BECOME
RATS!



AND IT'S LIKE
THIS, I MEAN, HE
HELPED ME.

WAIT.

BAD
TIMING?

CARRY ON,
SOLDIERS.



I DON'T
REALLY *KNOW*
HIM, BUT...

...I GOTTA
FIND THAT KID.
THAT'S IT.

I JUST
HAVE TO.

WHAT
HAPPENED TO
BERNICE?



HEY,
KIDS!

**FIND THESE FUN ITEMS IN THE PAINFUL, DEHUMANIZING
MORASS OF IMMORALITY AND POVERTY SHOWN ABOVE!**

A DOG EXPERIENCING ENNUI!

A STREET HUSTLER SELLING ROBOT VACUUMS!

A FAMILY OF STREET-FIGHTING EMUS!

A KID WHO WILL IRONICALLY PROBABLY END UP AS ROBIN FOR ABOUT TEN ISSUES!

DEEP MORAL TURPITUDE!

A CHALLENGER OF THE UNKNOWN!

DAN DIDIO!

OLD GUM!

WHERE
THE *&^% IS PADO
SWAKATOON?





WALK
YOU OUT TO
YOUR CAR,
DORIS?

THAT'D BE
NICE, LILA.
JUST A SEC,
LET ME GRAB
MY BAG.



NIGHT,
ERIC. NIGHT,
SPENCE.

NIGHT,
DORIS. NIGHT,
LILA.



LOOK.
I'M NOT SAYING
HE'S A BAD GUY,
EXACTLY.

IT'S JUST...
HE'S A CRIMINAL,
DORIS. A SMALL-
TIME GOON.

YOU CAN
DO SO MUCH
BETTER.

I
COULD.
BUT--

NO
BUTS.



I WANT YOU
TO **PROMISE** ME
THAT YOU'LL STAY
AWAY FROM--

--EEL
O'BRIAN!



WELL,
THERE YOU
GO.

HE
DEAD?

LILA! WHAT A
HORRIBLE THING
TO SAY!

HE'S
BREATHING.
HELP ME GET
HIM INSIDE!



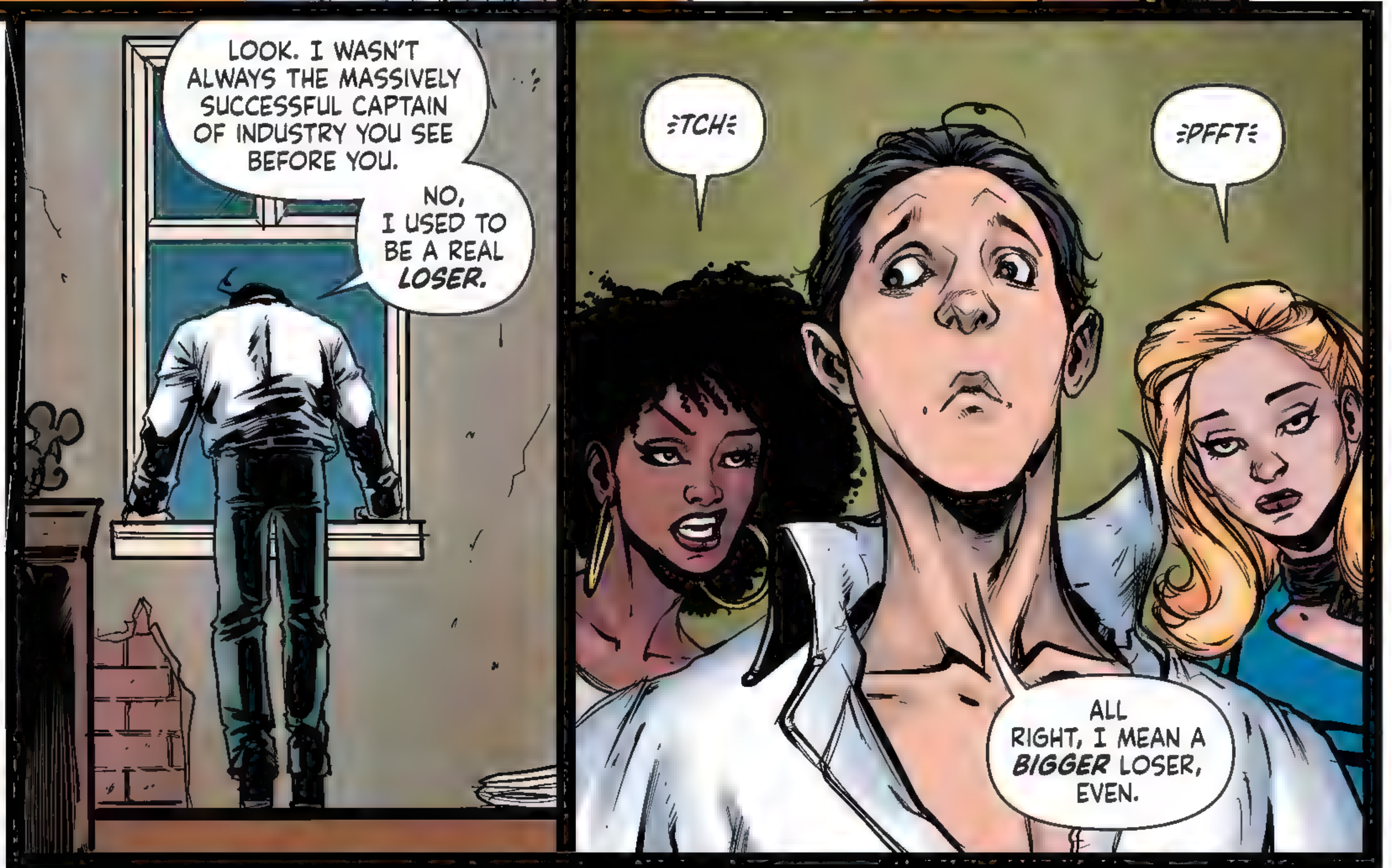
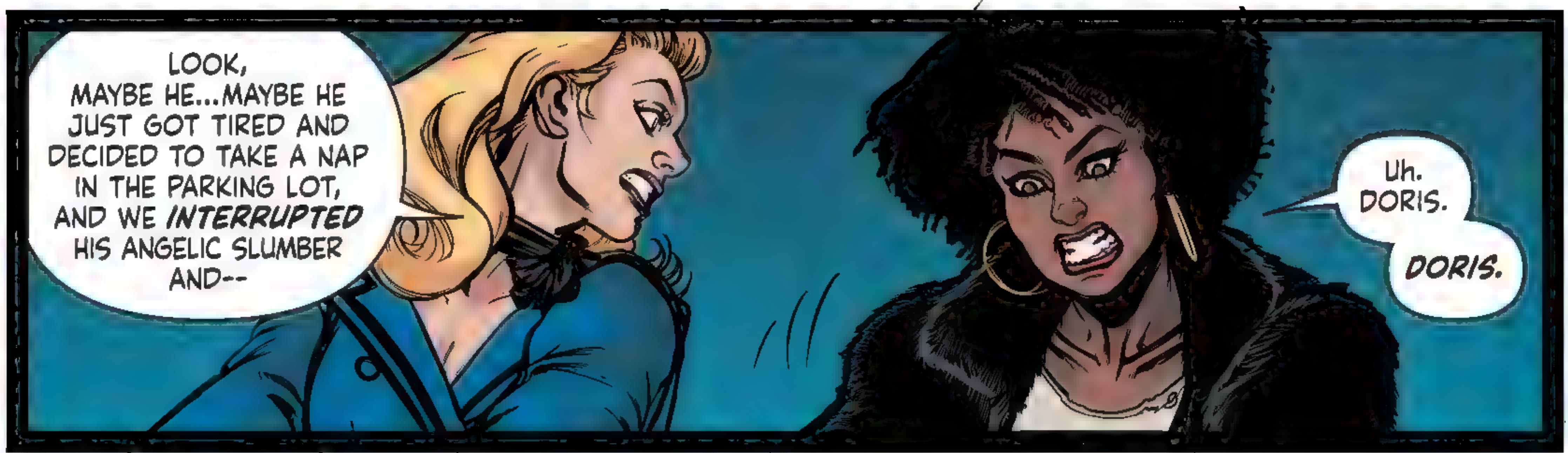
COME ON,
GRAB A WRIST.
PLEASE.

GIRL,
HOW DO YOU
KNOW HE'S
NOT DEAD?

OH,
FINE.

WE'LL
DRAG HIM
INSIDE.

THEN
I'M GOING
HOME.



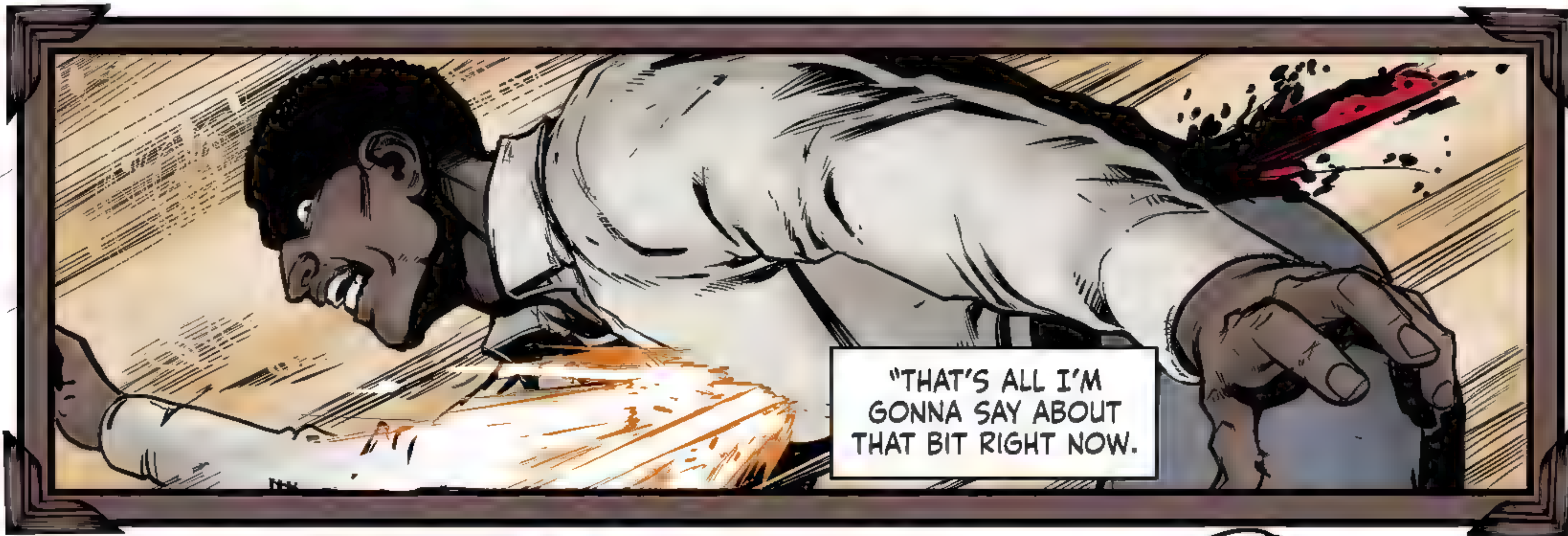


"SO, I HAD A GANG OF JERKS.
WE RAN PROTECTION AND
NUMBERS, THE OCCASIONAL B&E.

"ANYTHING TO
PICK THE OTHER
GUY'S POCKET,
THAT WAS US.

"ONE NIGHT,
WE WERE ON A GIG
FOR THE DUCHESS.

"SOMETHING
WENT WRONG.
BAD WRONG.



"THAT'S ALL I'M
GONNA SAY ABOUT
THAT BIT RIGHT NOW.



I GOT SHOT.
SOME CHICKEN FLU
OR SOME SPOILED
TARTAR SAUCE *STD*
GOT IN THE
WOUND.

MY
OWN BUDDIES
THREW ME OUT
OF A MOVING
CAR AND LEFT
ME TO DIE.



NOW I CAN DO THIS.
DO YOU GET THAT? I DIE
AND COME BACK, THE LEAST
WORTHY RECIPIENT OF A
MIRACLE EVER.

AND
NOTHING IS REAL
TO ME ANYMORE.
GRAVITY, MORTALITY,
PHYSICS...

I'M
IMMUNE TO
ALL OF 'EM.

AND
I DON'T
GET IT.



WHY
ME? I MEAN, IF
THERE'S A GOD,
AND ALL.

WHY
ME?

YOU SAID
THERE WAS
A *KID*, EEL.

WHAT
HAPPENED
TO THIS
KID?

OH,
THAT'S A
FUN STORY.

"SO, I GET A PANICKED
CALL FROM MY FORMER GANG
MEMBER BENNY. SOMETHING'S
COMING FOR HIM, HE SAYS.

"AND I GET THERE, HE'S
DYING. HIS LAST MESSAGE
IS JUST THREE LETTERS,
SCRAWLED IN BLOOD.

"JLA.

"COPS WERE
ALREADY ON THEIR
WAY. SOMEONE SET
ME UP."

I SAW
THAT MAN KILL
MY NEIGHBOR
IN **COLD
BLOOD!**

"OKAY, SO I
STARTED RAMBLING.
**COPS MAKE ME
NERVOUS, ALL
RIGHT?"**

NOW,
LOOK.

I JUST
SHOWED UP HERE,
I'M INNOCENT,
GUYS.

WELL, NOT
"INNOCENT,"
EXACTLY, I MEAN,
I'VE DONE A LOT
OF TERRIBLE
STUFF, BUT...

I NEVER
KILLED
NOBODY.

OKAY, NOW
WHEN I SAY **"NEVER
KILLED NOBODY,"** THAT
MIGHT BE A **SLIGHT**
EXAGGERATION,
BUT...

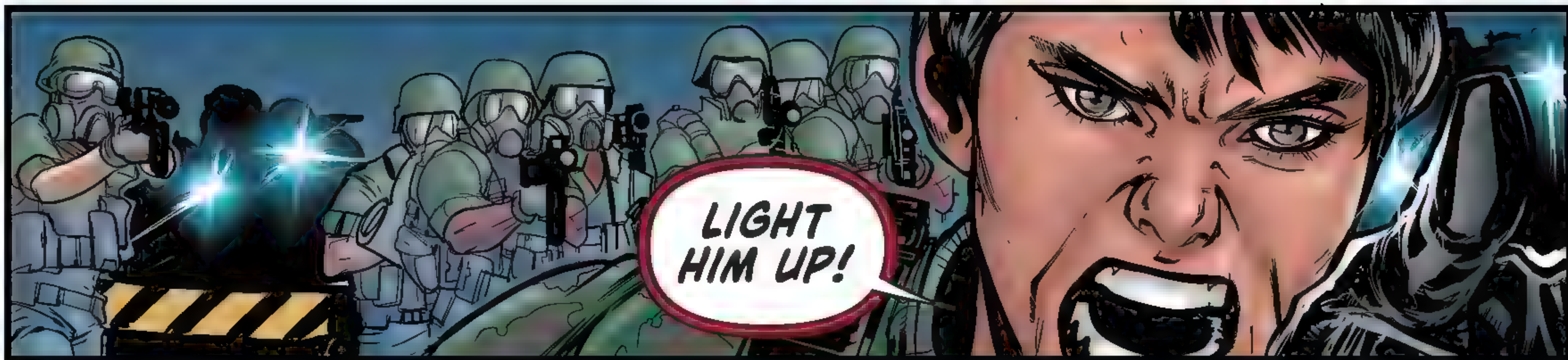
SHUT UP, MOUTH!
SHUT UP, SHUT UP,
SHUT UP!

HE'S
GOING FOR
HIS **GUN!**

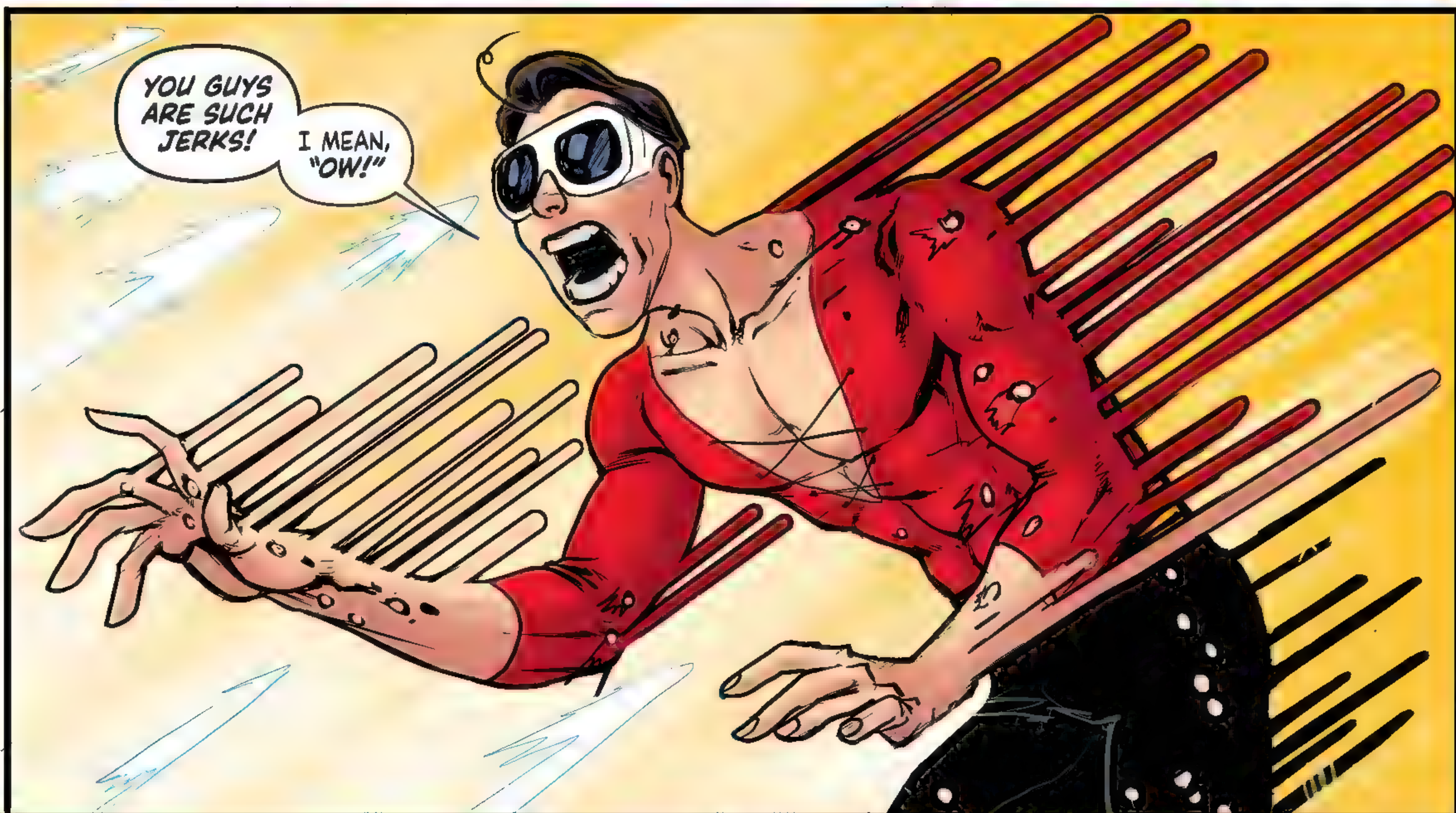
WAIT.
WHAT?

NO,
I'M NOT.

WHAT
GUN,
EVEN?

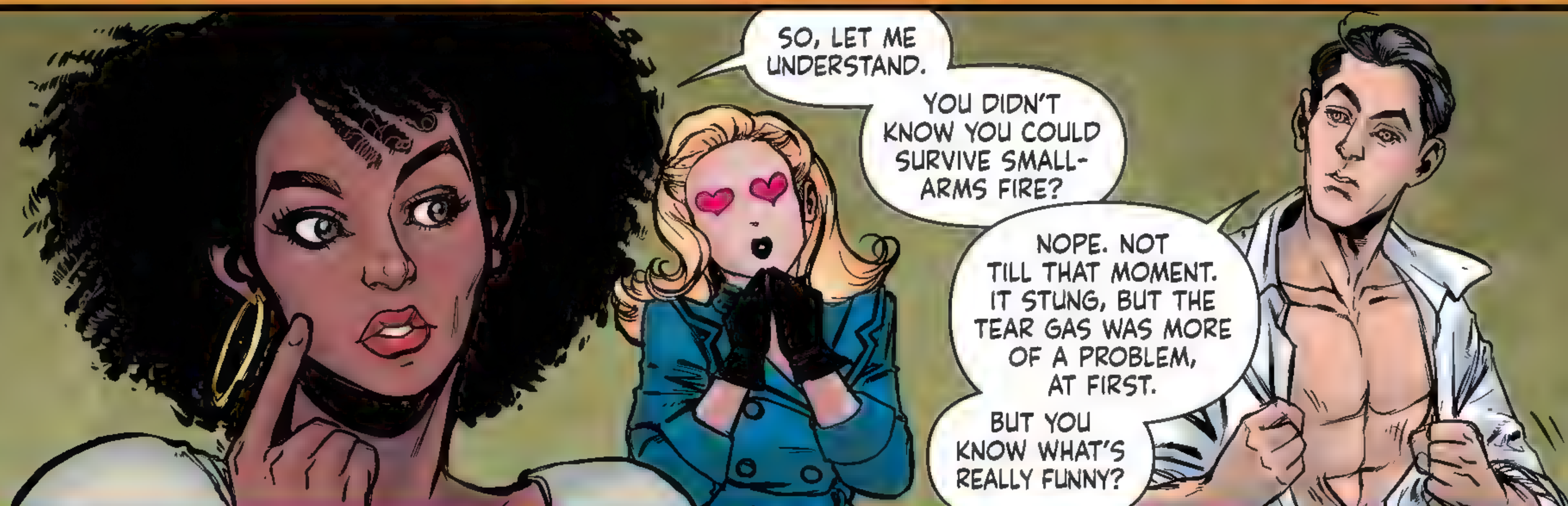


LIGHT HIM UP!



YOU GUYS ARE SUCH JERKS!

I MEAN, "OW!"



SO, LET ME UNDERSTAND.

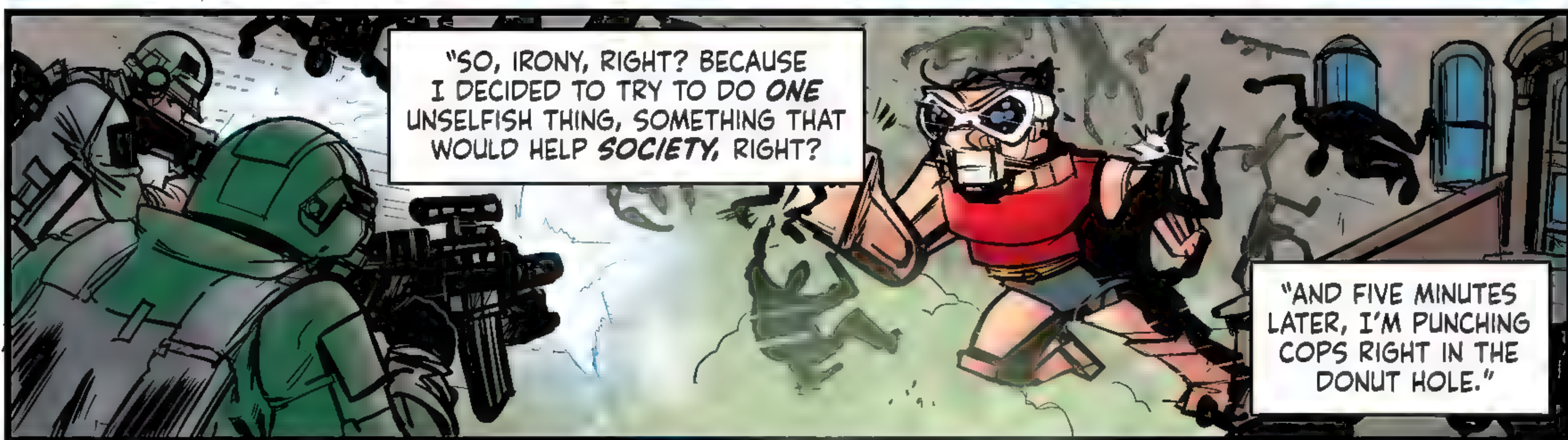
YOU DIDN'T KNOW YOU COULD SURVIVE SMALL-ARMS FIRE?

NOPE. NOT TILL THAT MOMENT. IT STUNG, BUT THE TEAR GAS WAS MORE OF A PROBLEM, AT FIRST.

BUT YOU KNOW WHAT'S REALLY FUNNY?

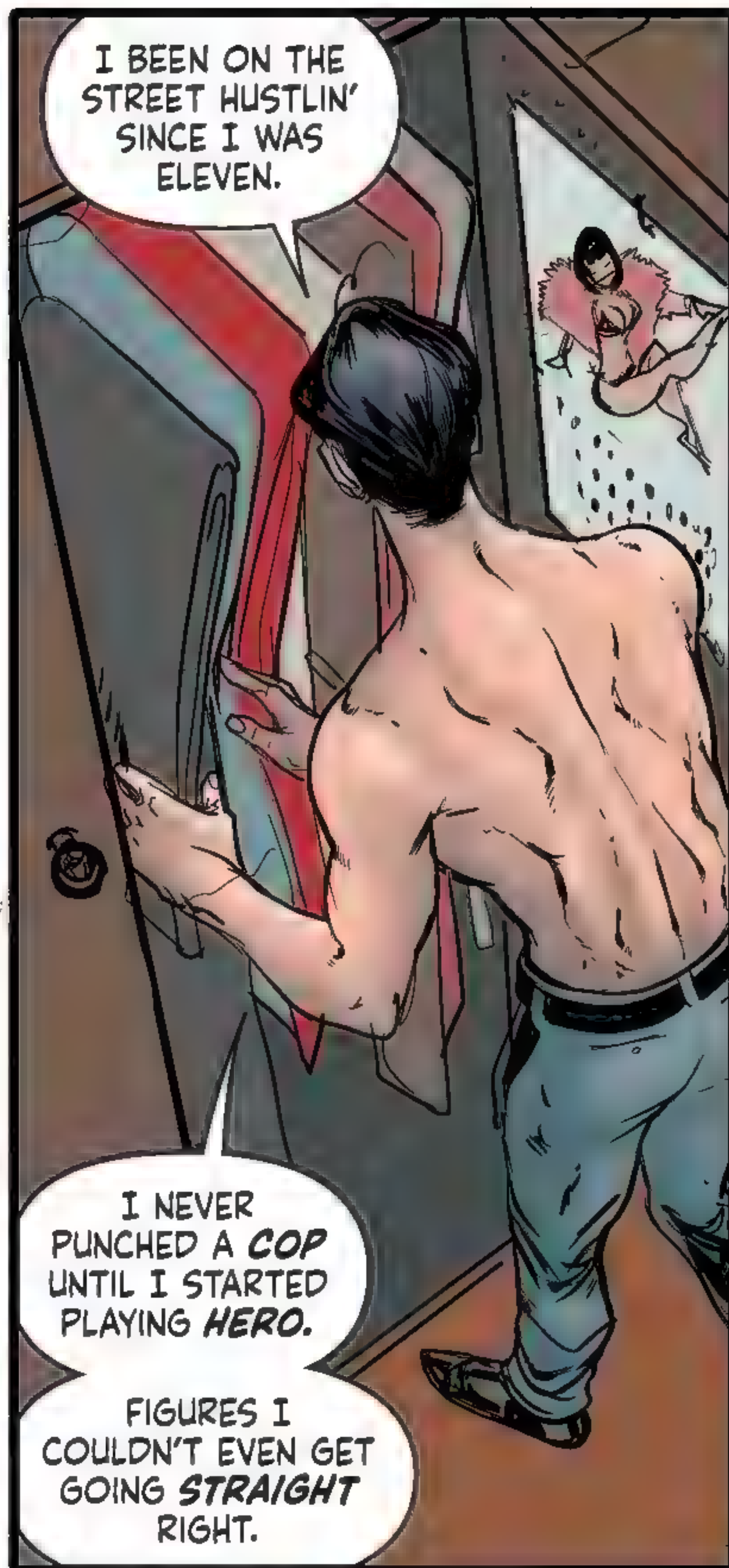


"ANDY AND BARNEY GOT **GRENADE** LAUNCHERS NOW.



"SO, IRONY, RIGHT? BECAUSE I DECIDED TO TRY TO DO **ONE** UNSELFISH THING, SOMETHING THAT WOULD HELP **SOCIETY**, RIGHT?"

"AND FIVE MINUTES LATER, I'M PUNCHING COPS RIGHT IN THE DONUT HOLE."



I BEEN ON THE STREET HUSTLIN' SINCE I WAS ELEVEN.

I NEVER PUNCHED A *COP* UNTIL I STARTED PLAYING *HERO*.

FIGURES I COULDN'T EVEN GET GOING *STRAIGHT* RIGHT.



"I'M LIKE RUBBER, RIGHT? I DIDN'T FIGURE TASERS WOULD HURT.

"ONLY I WAS WRONG."

GGGGGGGG

THIS IS A TERRIBLE DAY ALL AROUND, YOU GUYS.



"THAT'S WHEN I SAW HIM, BECKONING ME FROM ACROSS THE STREET."

HEY, MR. *STRETCH!*

THIS WAY!



"SO, FUZZY-HEADED, EYES AND NOSE BURNING, BARELY KNOWING WHAT DAY IT IS...

"I TRUSTED A KID MORE THAN *AUTHORITY*."

"THAT'S THE CROOK IN ME, I GUESS."

I THINK YOU'RE THINKING OF SOME *OTHER* GUY, KID.

I KNOW A PLACE. *RUN!*



YOU KNOW WHAT?

SCREW THIS, SUAVE PRINCE.

LET'S *WING* IT!

WHAT I'M GETTING AT IS, THE GUY IS LIKE A TOTAL **SMARTY-PANTS**, BUT HE CAN'T FIGURE OUT THAT HIS WIFE IS GETTING IT **REGULAR** FROM A GUY WHO SMELLS LIKE **TUNA**, RIGHT?

I MIGHT NEED YOU TO GUIDE ME, KID. EYES ARE MESSED RIGHT **UP**.

HOLY **WANG**.

"TURNS OUT IF YOU'RE A BIG PUDDLE OF GOO, COP CHOPPERS HAVE A HARD TIME FINDING YOU. WE MADE IT TO PADO'S SECRET HIDEOUT SAFE.

"FOR A **WHILE**."

HEY. HEY, KID.

THAT WHOLE **TUNA** THING WAS REALLY INAPPROPRIATE FOR ME TO DISCUSS WITH YOU.

SORRY.

I THINK WE'RE SAFE. COPS DON'T LIKE COMING TO GHOST TOWN.

YOU DID ME A SOLID THERE, SHORTSTOP.

THANKS.

HEY. McNUGGET.

YOU **LIVE** HERE?

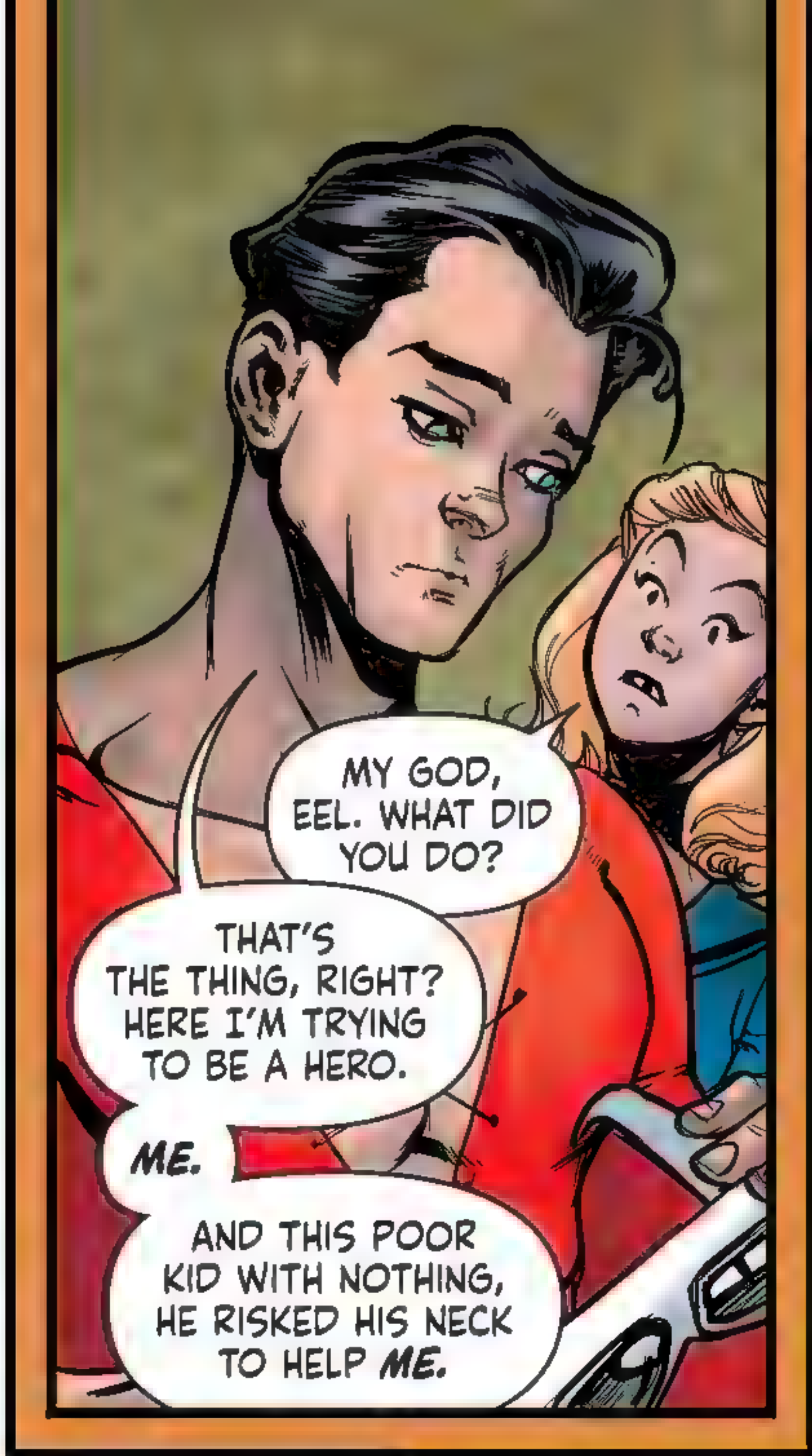
JUST A STREET KID WITH NOTHING AND NOBODY.

AND THEN IT HAPPENED.

WHAT HAPPENED, EEL?

"BATMAN
HAPPENED."





MY GOD, EEL. WHAT DID YOU DO?

THAT'S THE THING, RIGHT? HERE I'M TRYING TO BE A HERO.

ME.

AND THIS POOR KID WITH NOTHING, HE RISKED HIS NECK TO HELP ME.

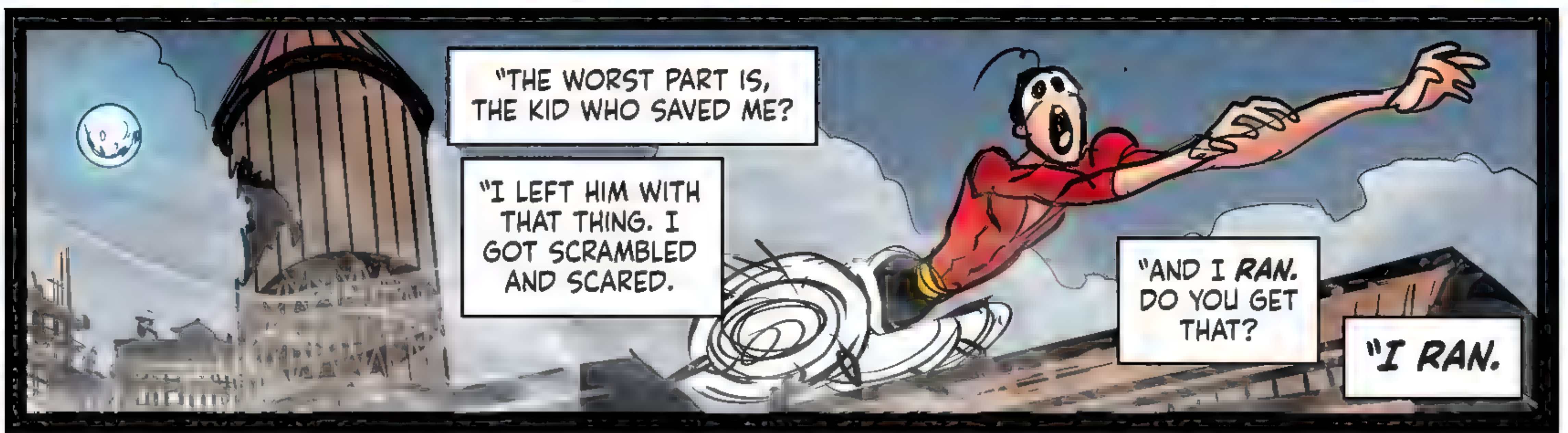


SKREEEE!

"HE HIT ME WITH SOME SORT OF SONIC GRENADE.

"I ALMOST PEED MY STRETCHPANTS RIGHT THERE.

"BUT THAT ISN'T THE **WORST** PART. NOPE.

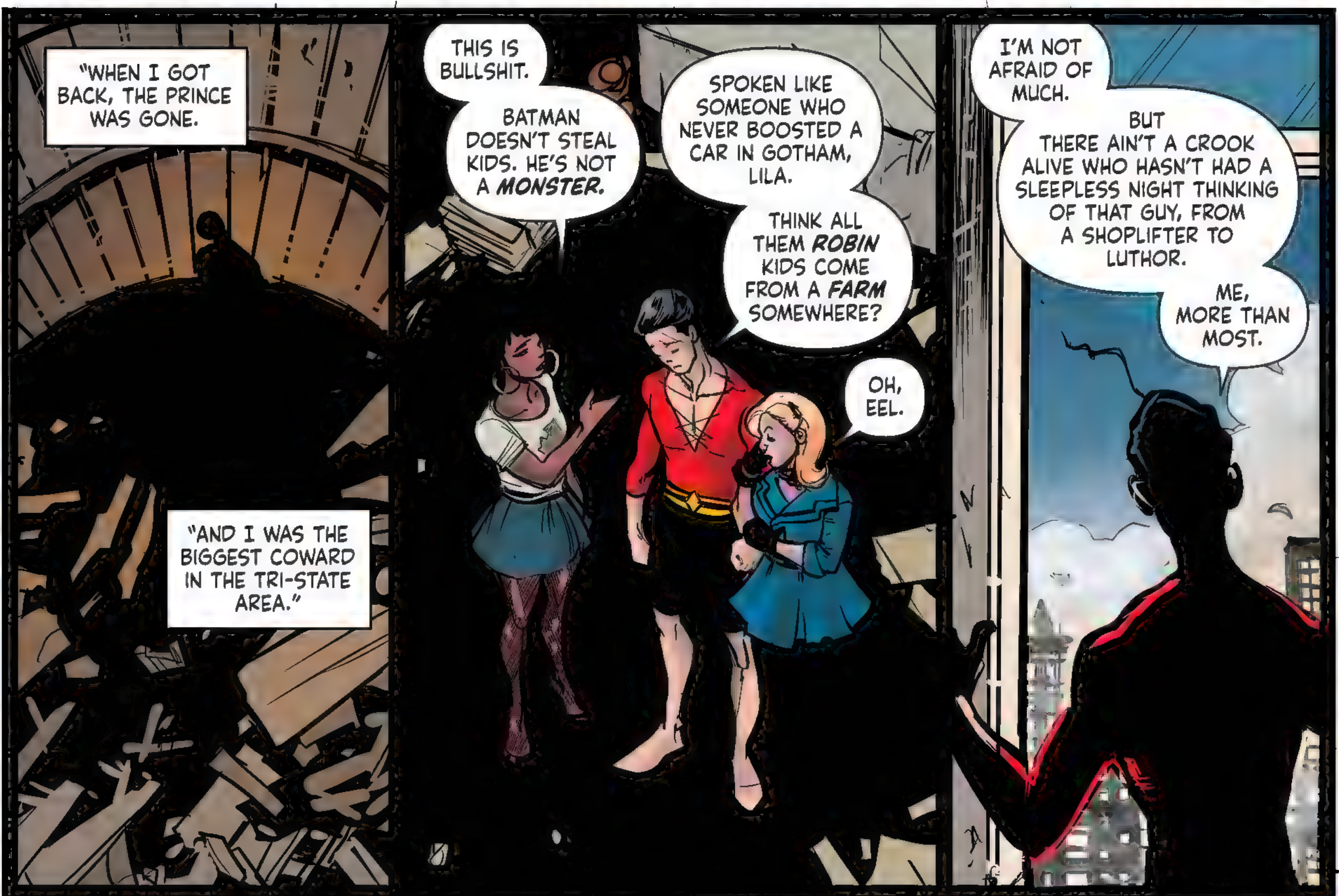


"THE WORST PART IS, THE KID WHO SAVED ME?

"I LEFT HIM WITH THAT THING. I GOT SCRAMBLED AND SCARED.

"AND I **RAN**. DO YOU GET THAT?

"**I RAN.**



"WHEN I GOT BACK, THE PRINCE WAS GONE.

"AND I WAS THE BIGGEST COWARD IN THE TRI-STATE AREA."

THIS IS BULLSHIT.

BATMAN DOESN'T STEAL KIDS. HE'S NOT A **MONSTER**.

SPOKEN LIKE SOMEONE WHO NEVER BOOSTED A CAR IN GOTHAM, LILA.

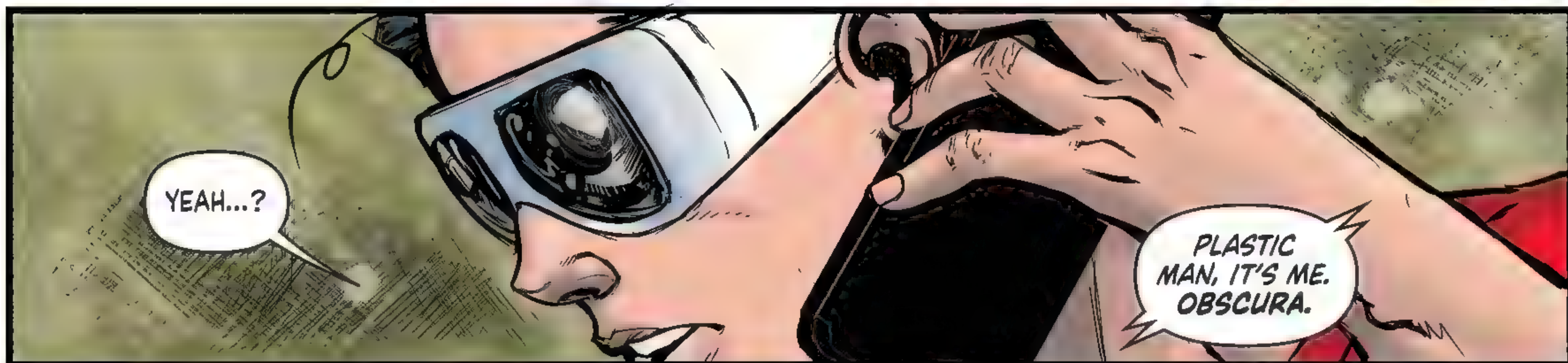
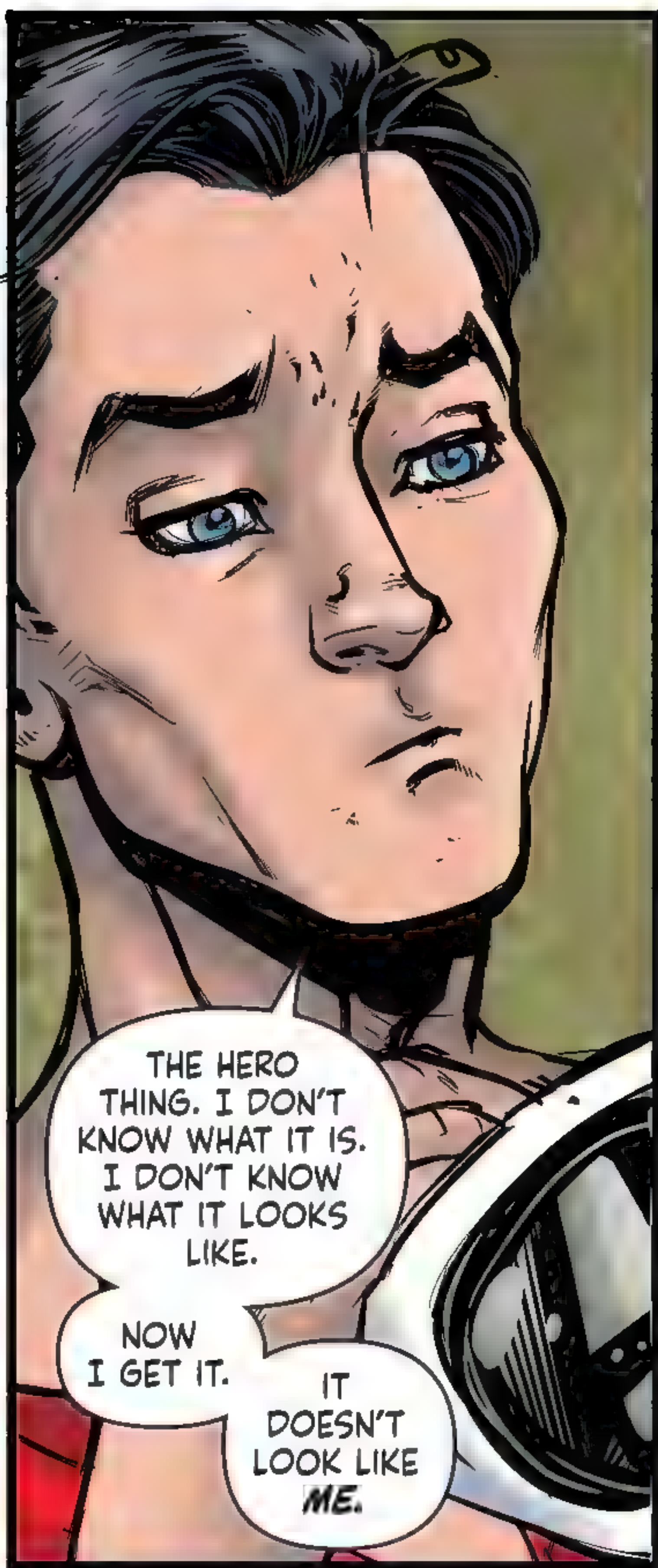
THINK ALL THEM **ROBIN** KIDS COME FROM A **FARM** SOMEWHERE?

OH, EEL.

I'M NOT AFRAID OF MUCH.

BUT THERE AIN'T A CROOK ALIVE WHO HASN'T HAD A SLEEPLESS NIGHT THINKING OF THAT GUY, FROM A SHOPLIFTER TO LUTHOR.

ME, MORE THAN MOST.





YOU WERE
RIGHT ABOUT HIM.
HE ABANDONED
A *KID*.

YOU WERE
RIGHT.

WAS I?



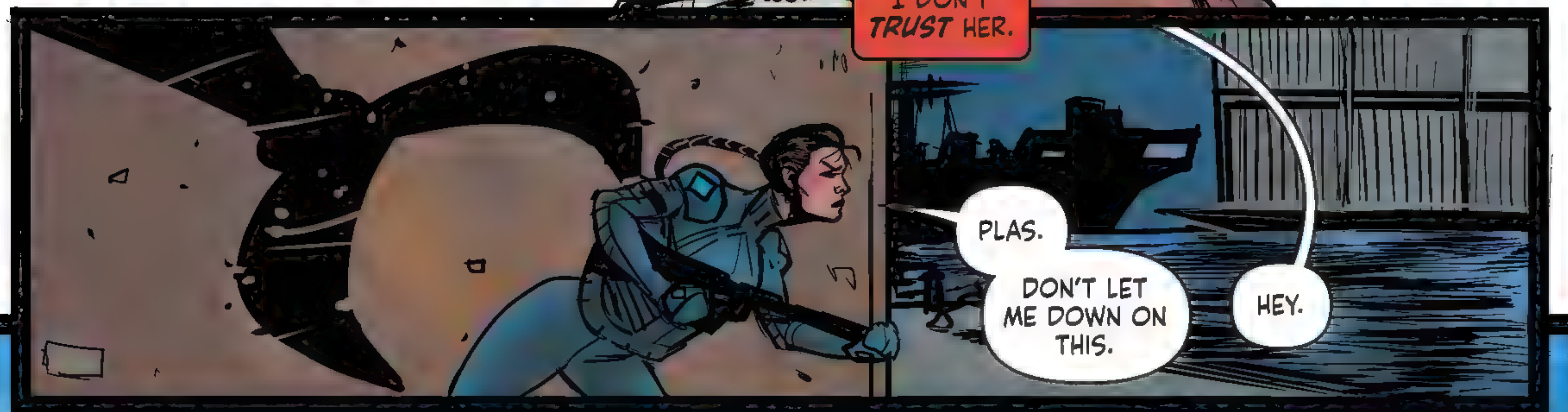
HE'S RUSHING
HEADFIRST TO FACE
THE ONLY THING HE'S
SCARED OF.

TO *FIX*
SOMETHING
HE MESS'D
UP.

THAT
MIGHT BE THE
DEFINITION
OF A HERO.

SHE *SAYS* SHE'S WITH
A SECRET GOVERNMENT
AGENCY.

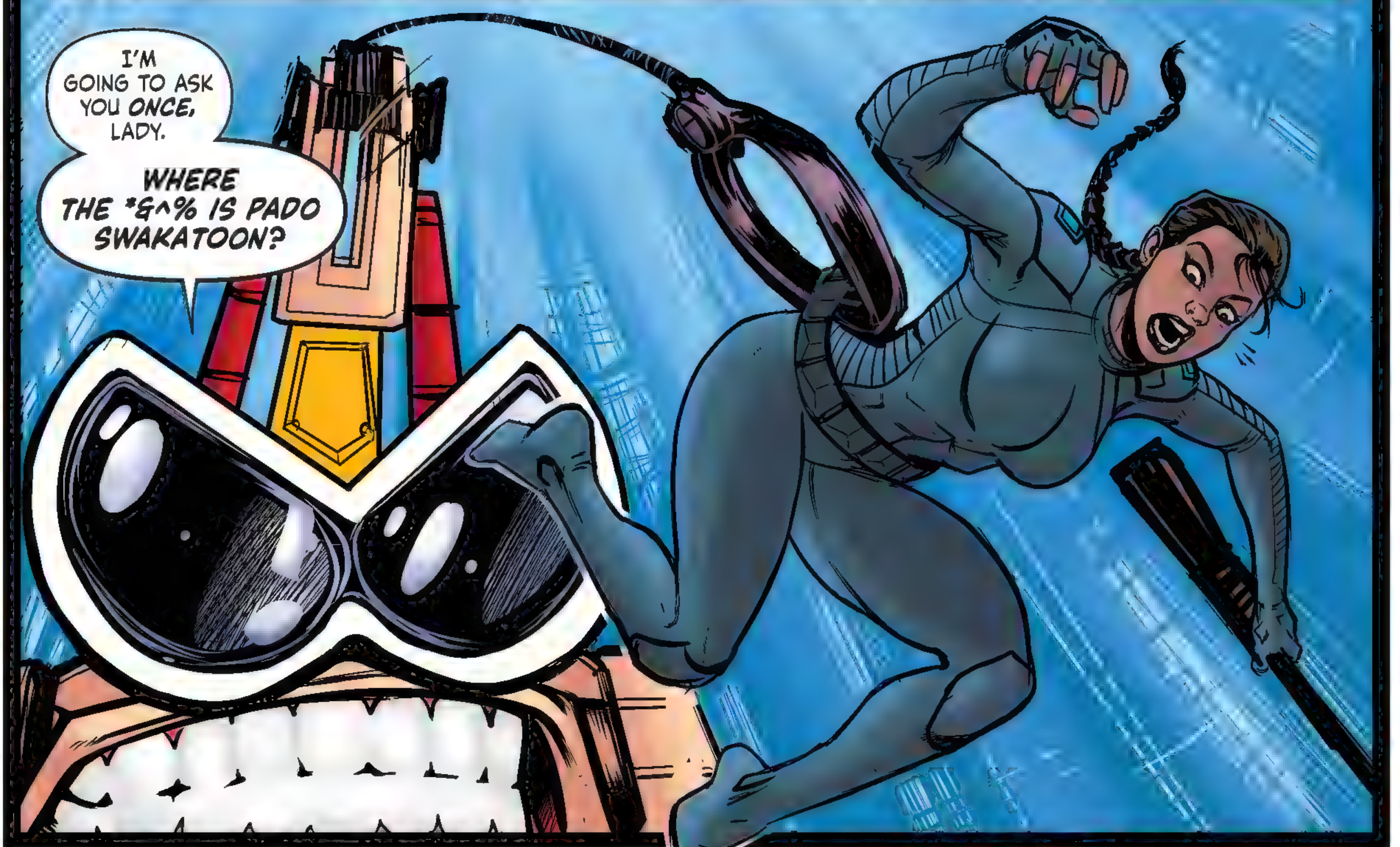
I DON'T
TRUST HER.



PLAS.

DON'T LET
ME DOWN ON
THIS.

HEY.



I'M
GOING TO ASK
YOU *ONCE*,
LADY.

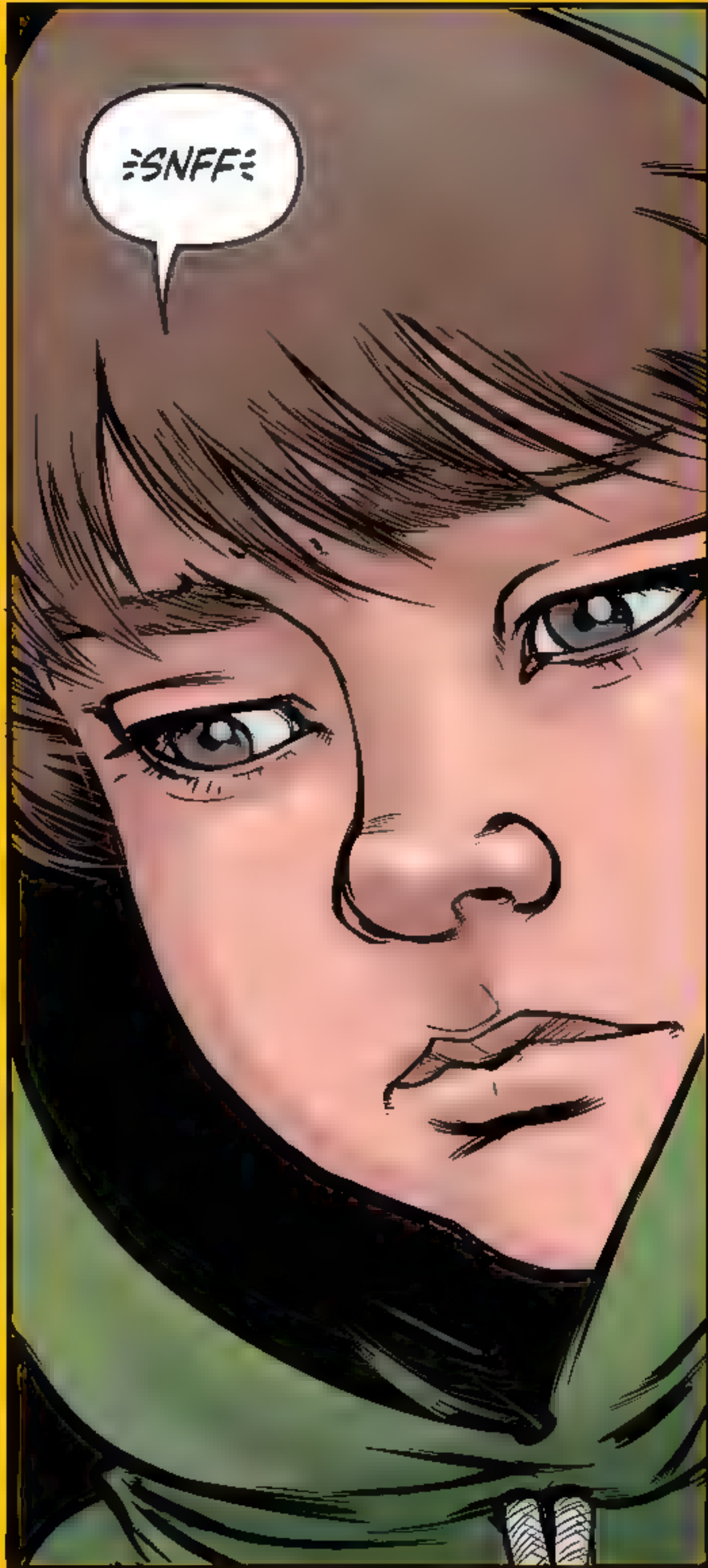
WHERE
THE *G^% IS PADO
SWAKATOON?



YOU
*G^%ING *G^%S
BETTER LET ME
GO.

I'M
THE *SUAVE*
PRINCE!

I'LL BUST
A CAP IN ALL
Y'ALL ASSES!



≡SNFF≡



WHAT ARE
YOU GOING
TO DO WITH
ME?

AFTER
YOU HAVE SERVED
AS BAIT, YOU WILL
BE DISPOSED
OF.



I'M ONLY
ELEVEN.

WE
HAVE KILLED
YOUNGER.



I'M AN
ORPHAN.

THEN
NO ONE WILL
MISS YOU.

WELL.
I GUESS
THAT'S IT,
THEN.





HE'S IN THERE.

THESE AREN'T THE HONORABLE SPORTSMAN VILLAINS, EEL.

POOR PEOPLE AREN'T PEOPLE TO THEM.

I DON'T BELIEVE YOU, LADY.



I DON'T BELIEVE THE JLA'S BEEN INFILTRATED.

BUT IF THEY TOOK THE KID BECAUSE YOU TRIED TO RECRUIT ME...



I WILL COME BACK FOR YOU.

WE CLEAR ON THAT?



HEY, KID.

SNFF

MR. STRETCH...?



YEAH. LET'S GET YOU SOMEPLACE NICE, THIS BOAT IS A DUMP.

I WASN'T CRYING.

COURSE NOT.

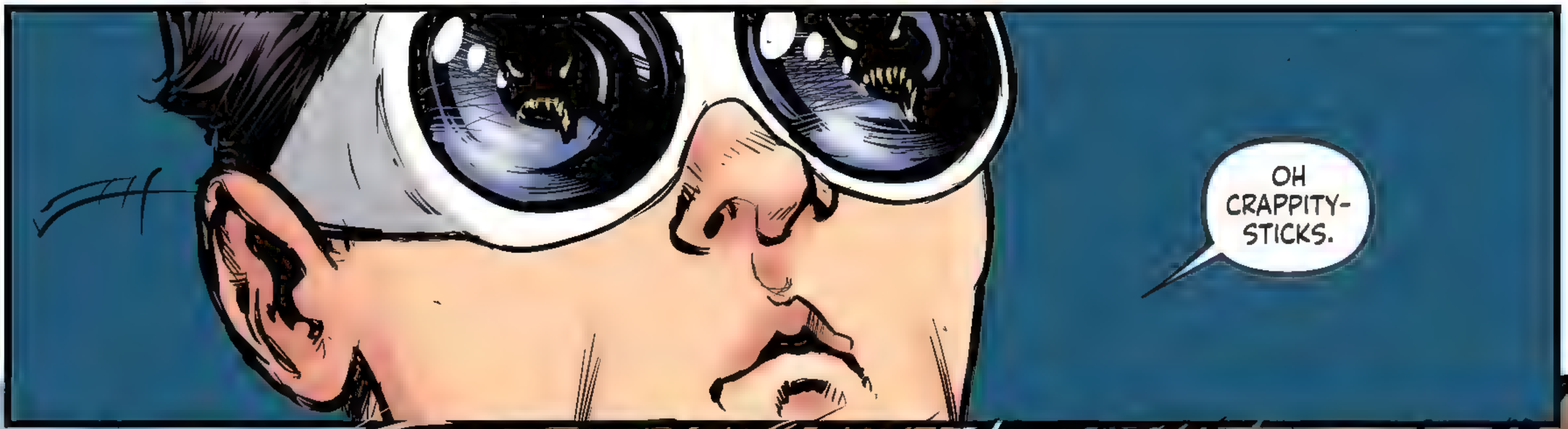
I GOT ALLERGIES.

I WAS JUST ABOUT TO BE GONNA KICK ALL THEIR ASSES.



WELL, IT'S A GOOD THING I GOT HERE, THEN.

THEY MIGHTA GOT HURT.



OH
CRAPPITY-
STICKS.

IT'S HIM. MY
NIGHTMARE.



SKREEE!

BATMAN.

I'M GONNA
PEE AGAIN.



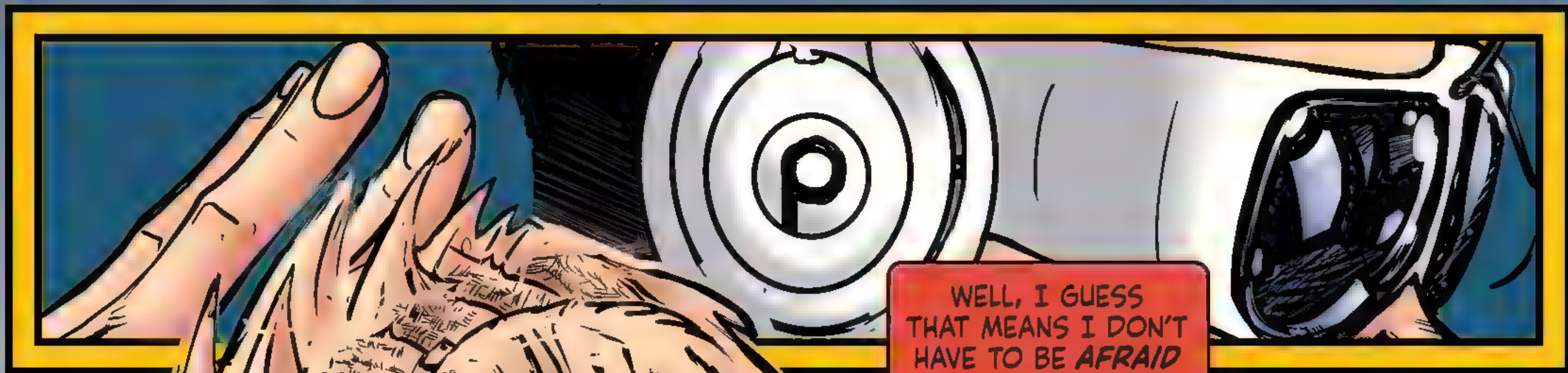
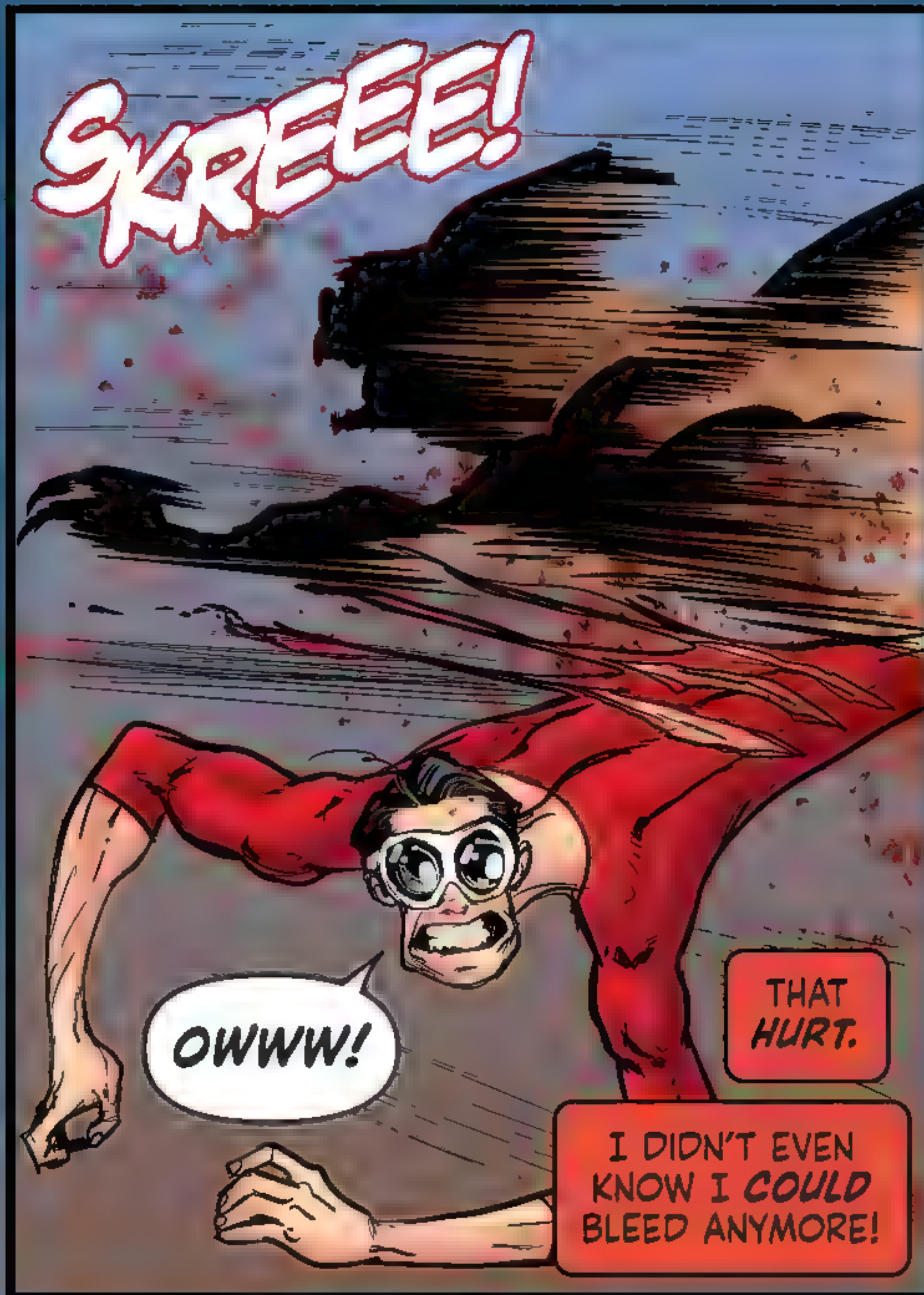
MR.
STRETCH!

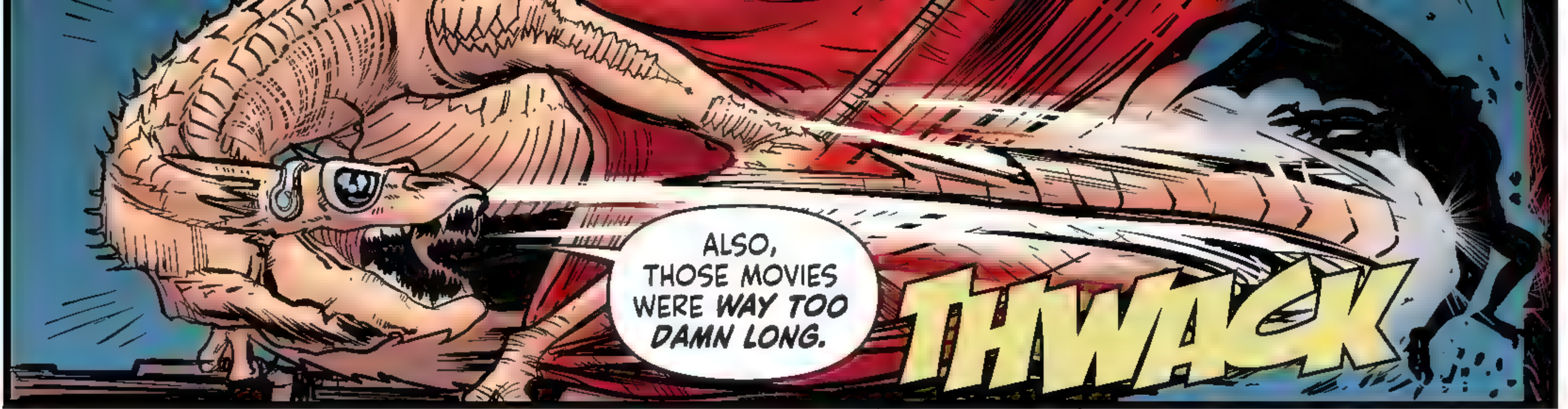
I'M
COMING,
KID!



URRRGH!

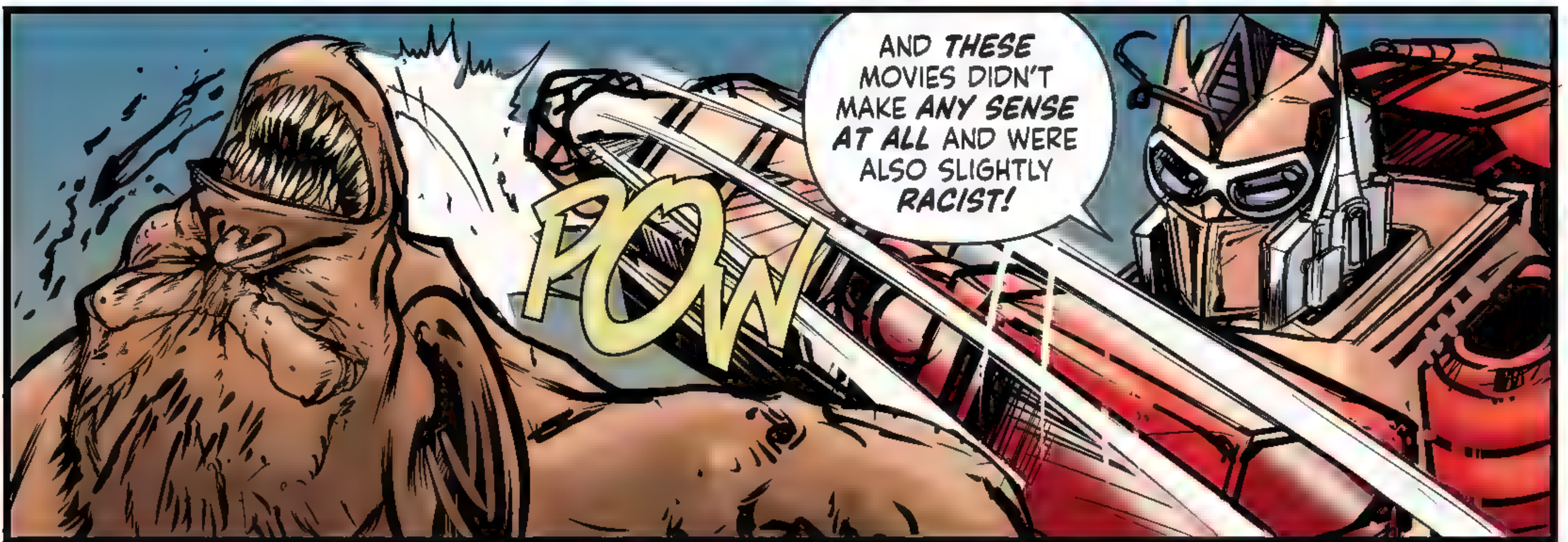
GOTTA
CATCH 'EM,
MOSTLY!





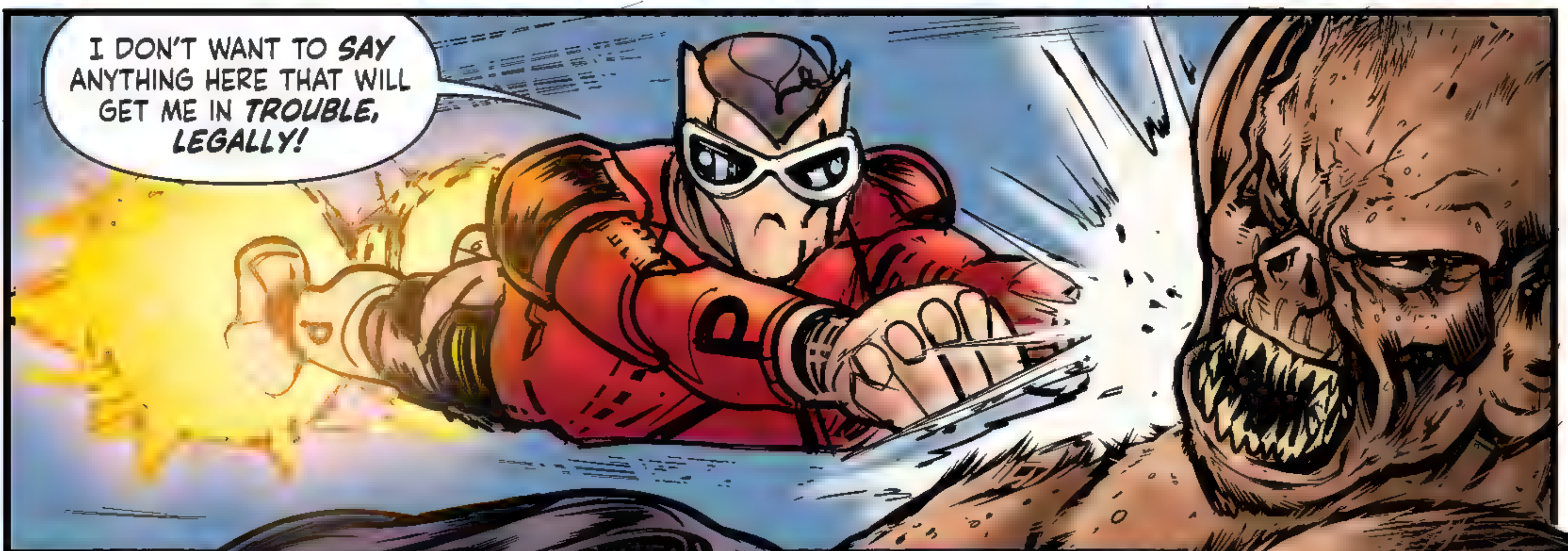
ALSO,
THOSE MOVIES
WERE WAY TOO
DAMN LONG.

THWACK



AND THESE
MOVIES DIDN'T
MAKE ANY SENSE
AT ALL AND WERE
ALSO SLIGHTLY
RACIST!

POW



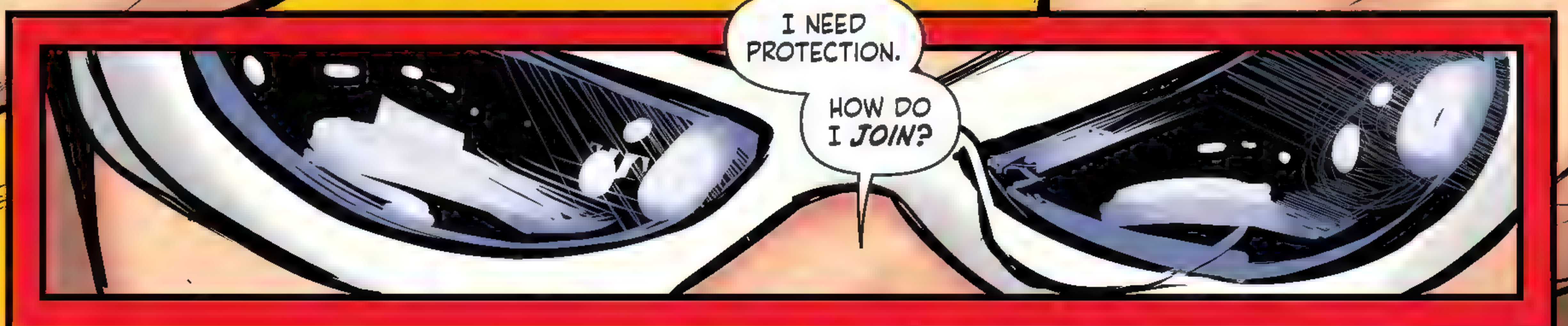
I DON'T WANT TO SAY
ANYTHING HERE THAT WILL
GET ME IN TROUBLE,
LEGALLY!



NOW
YOU LISTEN TO
ME, YOU LITTLE
FLYING TURD.

I GOT
PEOPLE
AFTER ME.

I DON'T
WANT TO FIGHT
THE CABAL,
OKAY?



I NEED
PROTECTION.

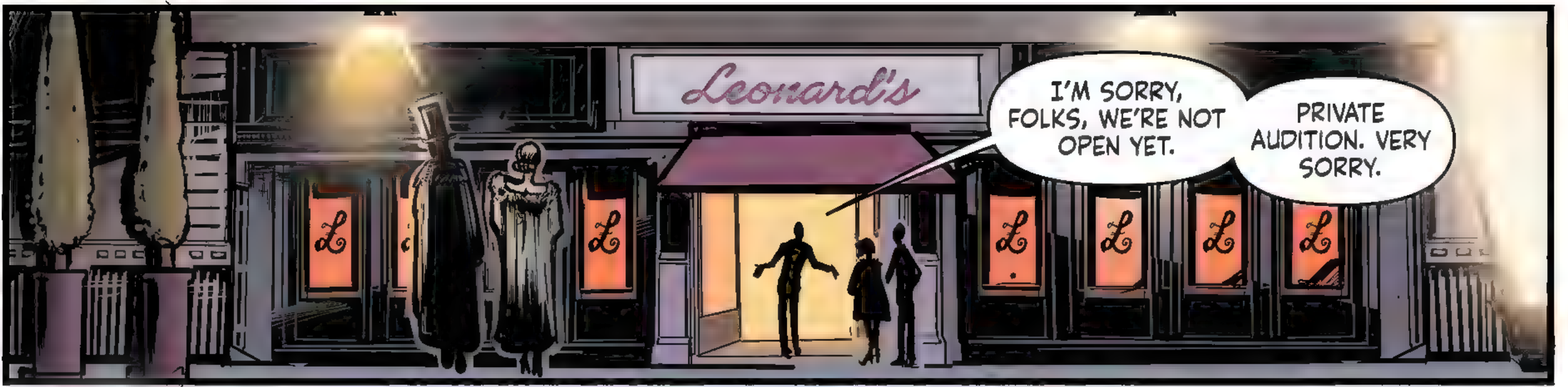
HOW DO
I JOIN?



CHAPTER THREE

UNDER COVER OF DARKNESS!

Cover art by Alex Ross



I'M SORRY, FOLKS, WE'RE NOT OPEN YET.

PRIVATE AUDITION. VERY SORRY.



SAMMY, HAVE A HEART. I MEAN, I KNOW SHE'S YOUR GIRLFRIEND...

BACKING OUT ALREADY, THERE, LENNY?

I DON'T SEEM TO REMEMBER YOU DISPARAGIN' MY COMPANY THAT WAY WHEN THOSE GUYS WAS GONNA SHANK YOU AT BLACKGATE.



NOW, SUITCASE--

DON'T CALL ME THAT.

SAMMY.

THAT CHAPTER OF MY LIFE, PEOPLE DON'T KNOW ABOUT, OKAY?

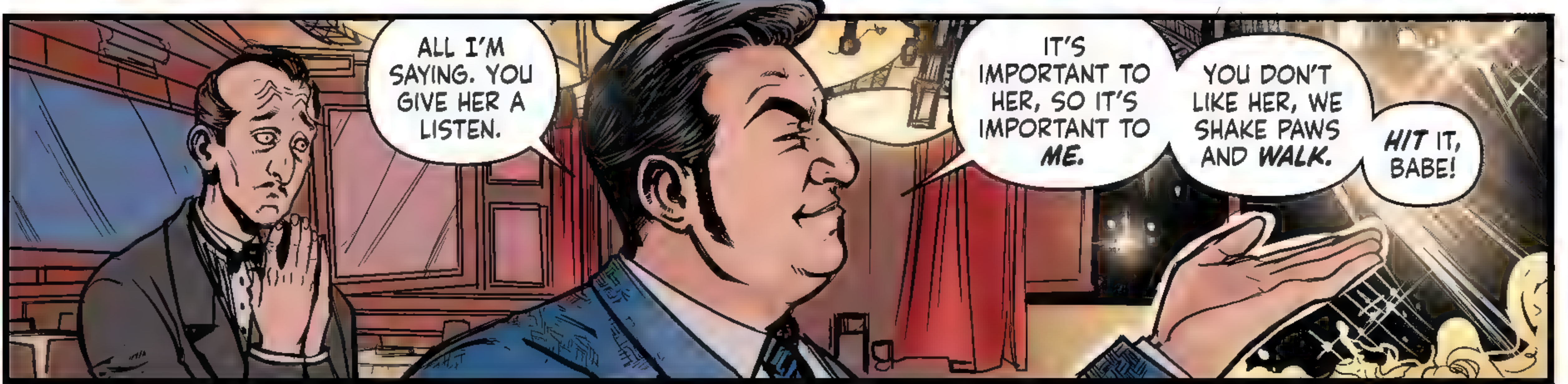


I OWE YOU. I'M NOT DENYING.

BUT THIS CLUB, IT'S ALL I HAVE. IF SHE CAN'T **PERFORM--**

NOW, THAT'S A FAIR CONCERN, LENNY.

AND AIN'T I ALWAYS BEEN A FAIR MUG?



ALL I'M SAYING. YOU GIVE HER A LISTEN.

IT'S IMPORTANT TO HER, SO IT'S IMPORTANT TO **ME.**

YOU DON'T LIKE HER, WE SHAKE PAWS AND WALK.

HIT IT, BABE!



YOU GOT
IT, SAMMY,
SWEETIE.

HOLY
MOTHER.
GIVE
THE DOG A
BONE!

WHAT
I *SAID*,
RIGHT?

SHE'S GOT,
WHAT, *STAR*
QUALITY.



I USED TO LOVE YOU, BABY, I USED TO BE YOUR DOLL. AND NOW YOU'RE SAYING MAYBE, WE CAN'T REALLY HAVE IT ALL.

WOMEN WANT DIAMONDS AND CARS AND FURS, BUT I JUST WANT TO BE LOVED. WOMEN WANT ALL THAT MONEY OF YOURS, BUT I JUST WANT TO BE LOVED.

JAYSUS WORE A CODPIECE, WHAT'S THAT NOISE?

WOMEN WANT TRIPS TO PARIS AND ROME, BUT I JUST WANT TO BE LOVED.

WOMEN WANT FLOWERS TO FILL UP THEIR HOME, BUT I JUST WANT TO BE LOOOOOVED!

NO. NO. SHOOT ME IF YOU MUST, SAMMY.

BUT THAT CATERWAULING CRUMPET IS NEVER SINGING IN MY JOINT. NEVER.

SHE NEEDS A CORK, PALLY. I'M SORRY.

MAYBE IF SHE HAD A GIMMICK.

I'M SORRY.

WAIT, LEN. WAIT.

SHE JUST NEEDS GUIDANCE!

ARRROOOO!

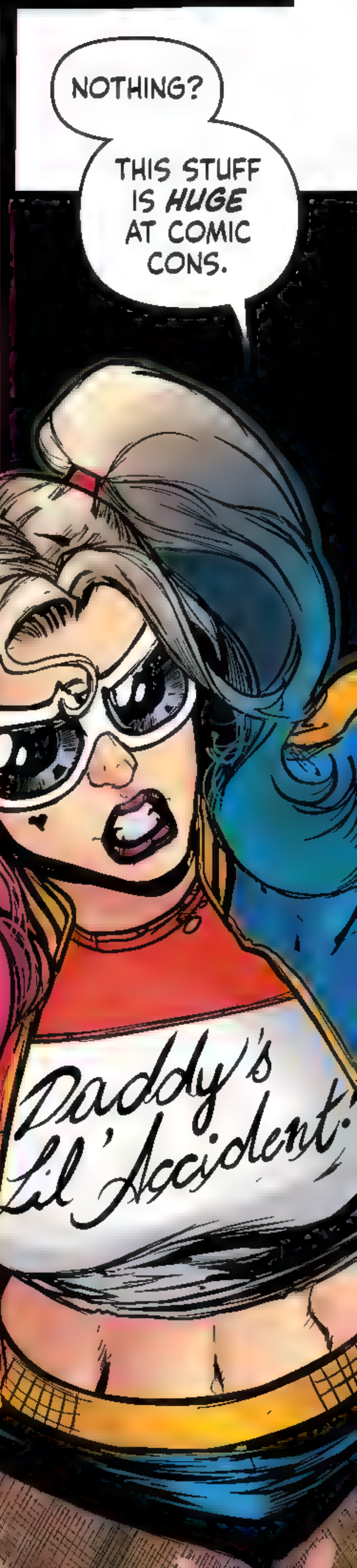
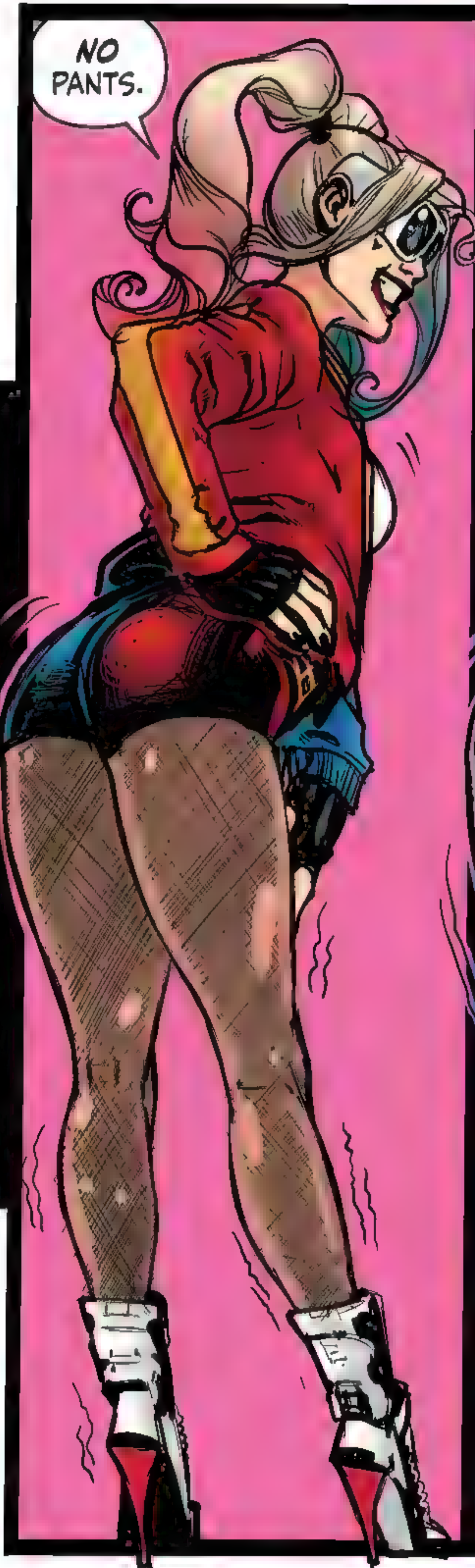
IS *THIS*
WHAT IT
TAKES TO GET
NOTICED?

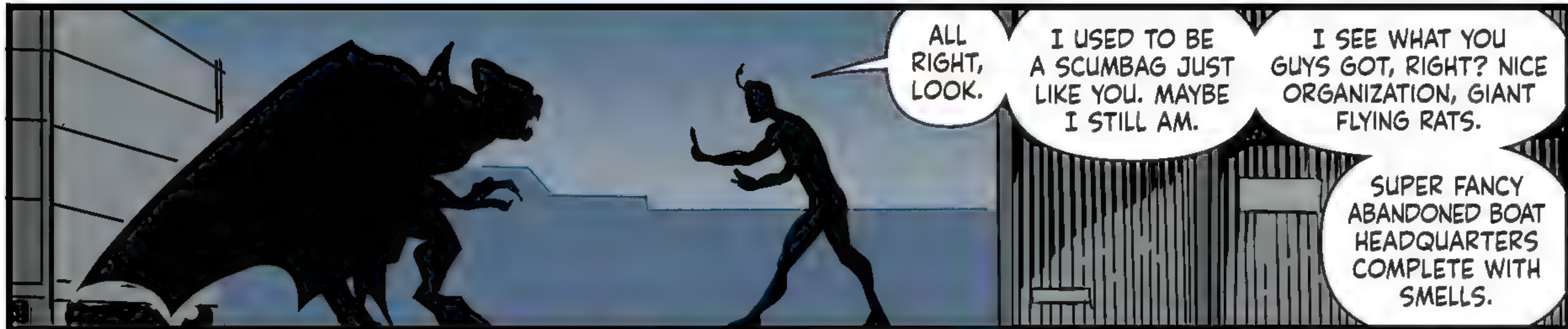
IS *THIS*
WHAT IT
TAKES TO BE
HEARD?

I JUST
WANT TO BE
LOVED!

UNDER COVER OF
DARKNESS







ALL
RIGHT,
LOOK.

I USED TO BE
A SCUMBAG JUST
LIKE YOU. MAYBE
I STILL AM.

I SEE WHAT YOU
GUYS GOT, RIGHT? NICE
ORGANIZATION, GIANT
FLYING RATS.

SUPER FANCY
ABANDONED BOAT
HEADQUARTERS
COMPLETE WITH
SMELLS.



I AM
CLEARLY
TERRIBLE AT THE
WHITE HAT THING,
ALL RIGHT?

AND I
KNOW. I KNOW
ALL ABOUT YOUR
SECRET CLUB.

**THE
CABAL.**

SUPER
BOSS **NAME**
THERE, BY
THE WAY.



I DON'T
WANT TO FIGHT,
MAN-BAT.

I WANT
IN.



LET THE
KID GO, AND GET
ME A SECRET LAIR
ACCESS PASS.

YOU
GOT ME.



AND WHAT IF WE
DON'T WANT YOU,
"PLASTIC MAN"?

YOU'RE
A JOKE.

OUR
ORGANIZATION
DOESN'T TRADE
IN YOUR KIND.

I'M
SUPER CAUCASIAN
AND THAT **STILL**
SOUNDS RACIST.

**SICK
BURN!**



YOU ARE
AN UNWANTED
WITNESS.

OUR
ORGANIZATION
DOESN'T HAVE
UNWANTED
WITNESSES.

THAT
SOUNDS LIKE
A THREAT,
WEIRD ROBOT
VOICE.

YESSIR,
IT SURELY
DOES.



OKAY.
FINE.

LAST
TIME I'LL SAY
THIS. LET THE
KID GO.

SHE
DID ME A
KINDNESS.

SHE
DOESN'T *BELONG*
AROUND PEOPLE
LIKE US.

I'M...
I'M NOT
SCARED.

I'M THE
*SUAVE PRINCE OF
PINE STREET!*



BET YOUR
ASS, KID.

ONLY, WITH
YOU ON MY SIDE,
THE ODDS JUST
WOULDN'T BE FAIR
FOR THOSE GUYS,
OKAY?

THE CHILD IS
AN UNWANTED
WITNESS.

OUR
ORGANIZATION
DOESN'T HAVE
UNWANTED
WITNESSES.



TRIED TO
BLUFF. IT
DIDN'T *GO.*

AND WHATEVER THEY GOT
IN THOSE SHOCK THINGS,
I KNOW IT CAN HURT ME.
MAYBE *KILL* ME.

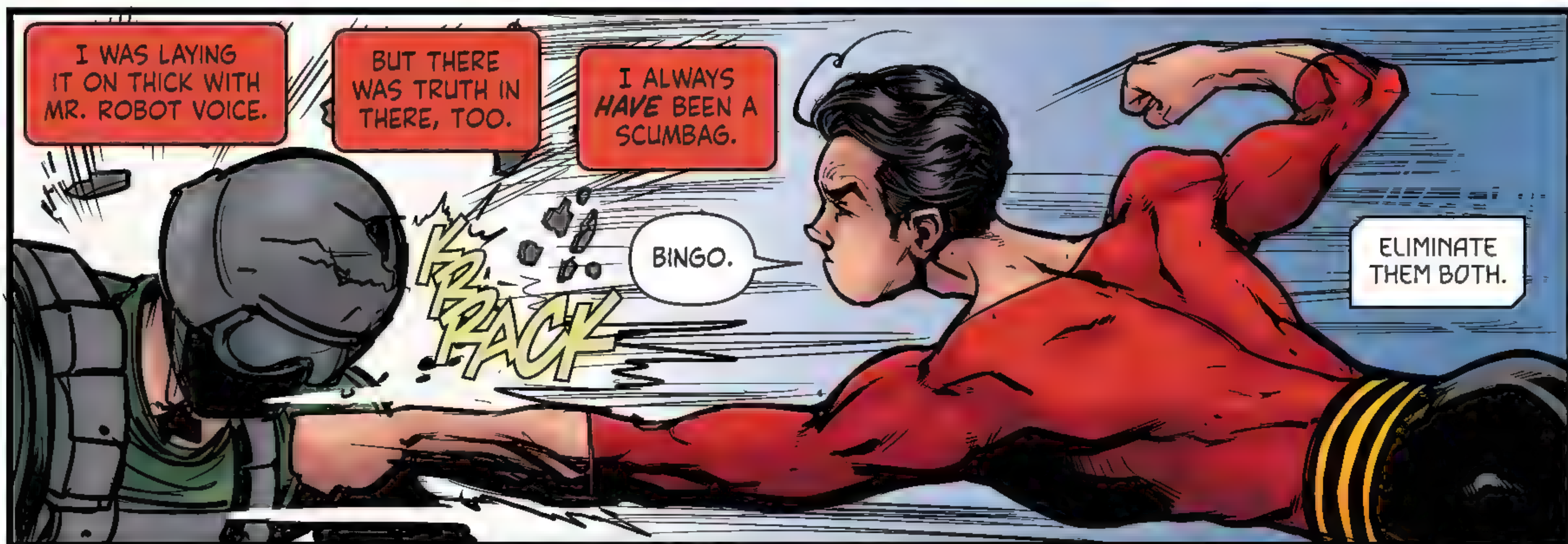
TIME TO LET
THE SCUZZBALL
ROAR, I GUESS.

FINE.
I WARNED
YOU.

YOU
DIDN'T
LISTEN.

I'M
READY.

LET'S BUST
SOME NOSES,
SHALL WE?



I WAS LAYING IT ON THICK WITH MR. ROBOT VOICE.

BUT THERE WAS TRUTH IN THERE, TOO.

I ALWAYS HAVE BEEN A SCUMBAG.

BINGO.

ELIMINATE THEM BOTH.

KRACK



BUT I NEVER THREATENED NO KID.

AND PLASTIC MAN, MAYBE HE IS A CLOWN.

BUT EEL O'BRIAN WAS NO JOKE WITH HIS MITTS EITHER.

BANGO.

UUUH.



HEY. I NEVER SAID HE WAS SMART.

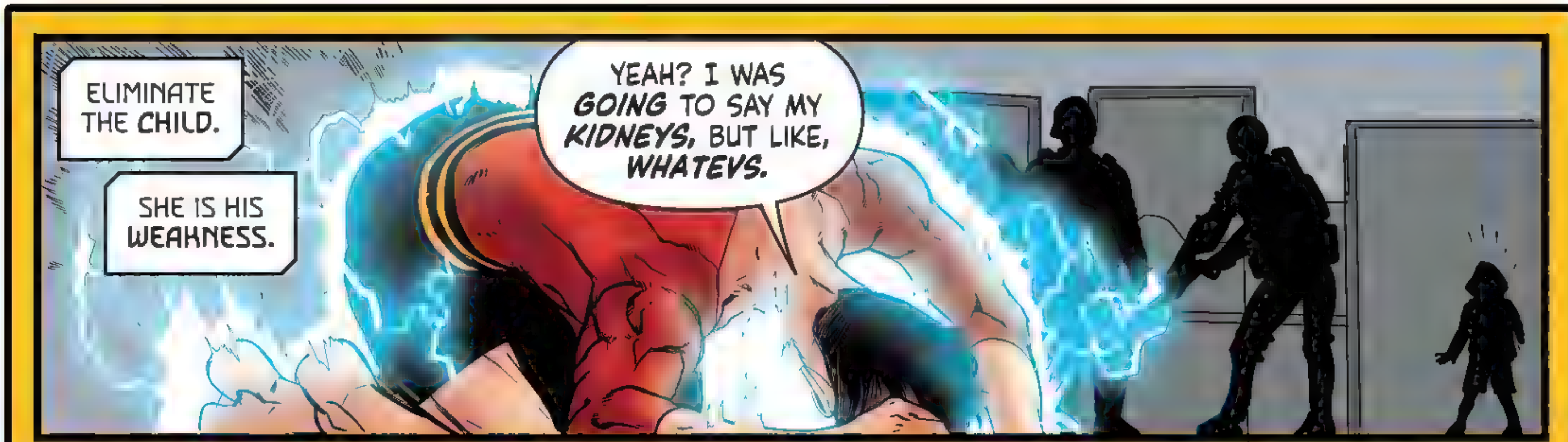
NNNNGG.

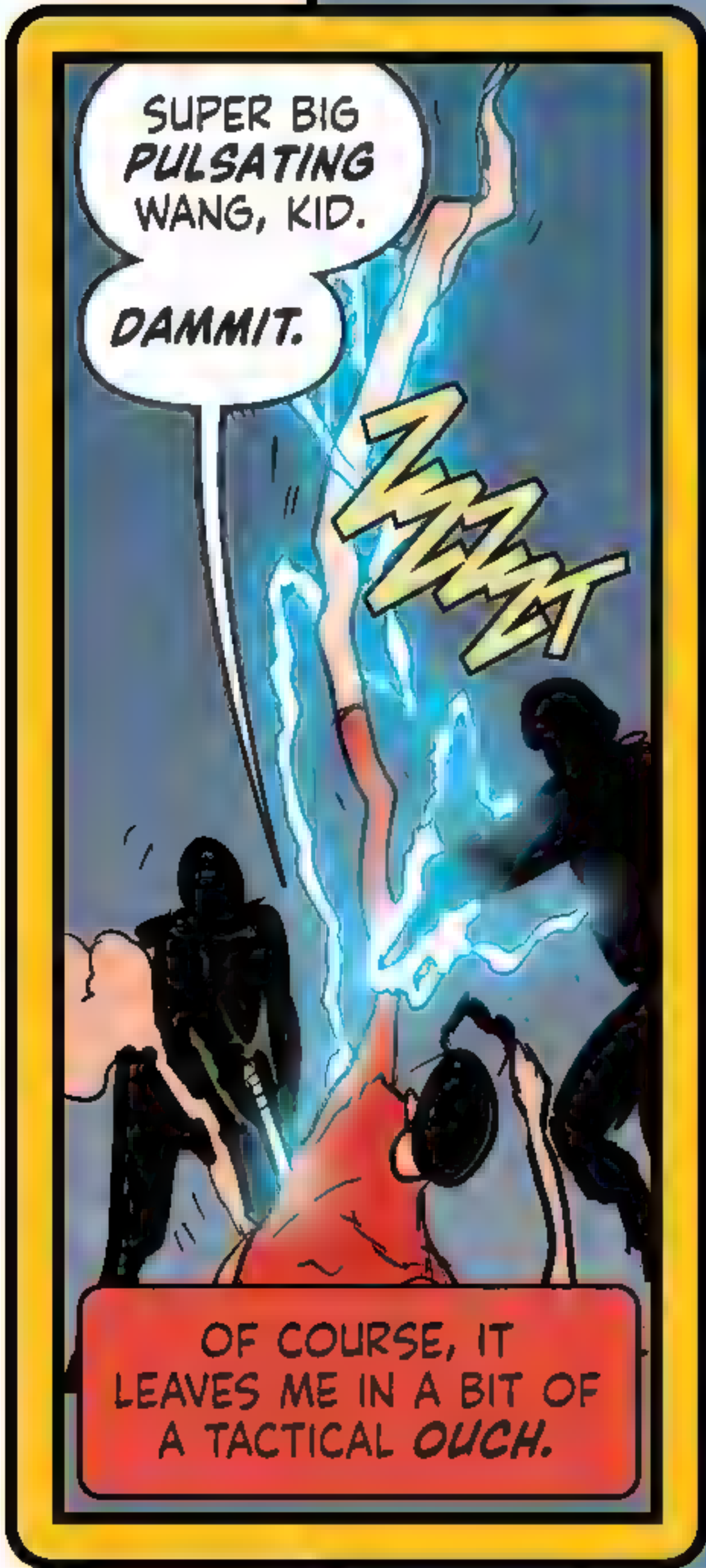
ZZZZZT



OW. I MEAN DAMMIT, REALLY.

OKAY, THIS IS STARTING TO P ME O.





SUPER BIG
PULSATING
WANG, KID.
DAMMIT.

ZZZZ

OF COURSE, IT
LEAVES ME IN A BIT OF
A TACTICAL OUCH.



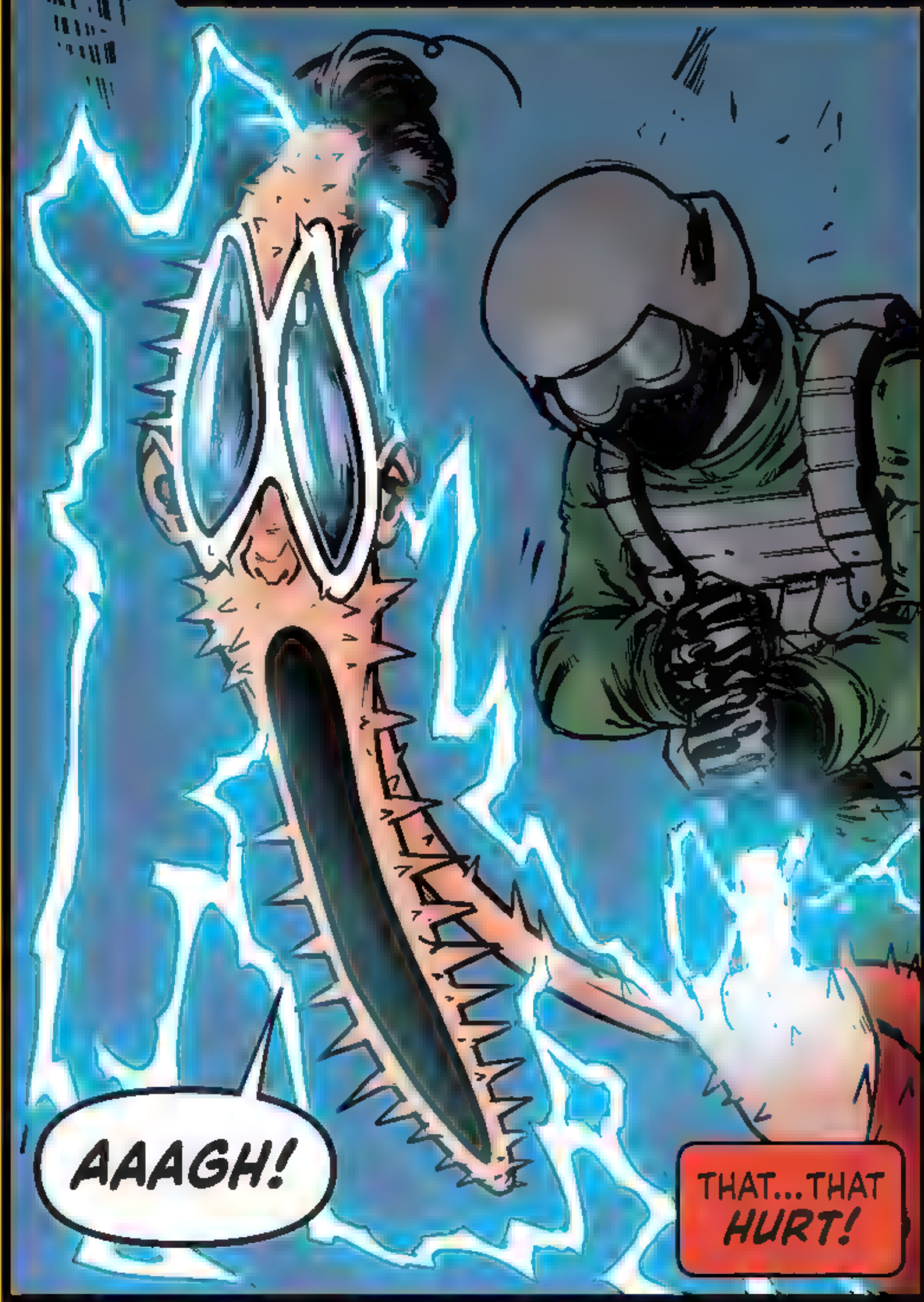
SCREW IT.

NO MORE
MR. NICE
RUBBER.

WHAM



STUN' PACIFY



AAAGH!

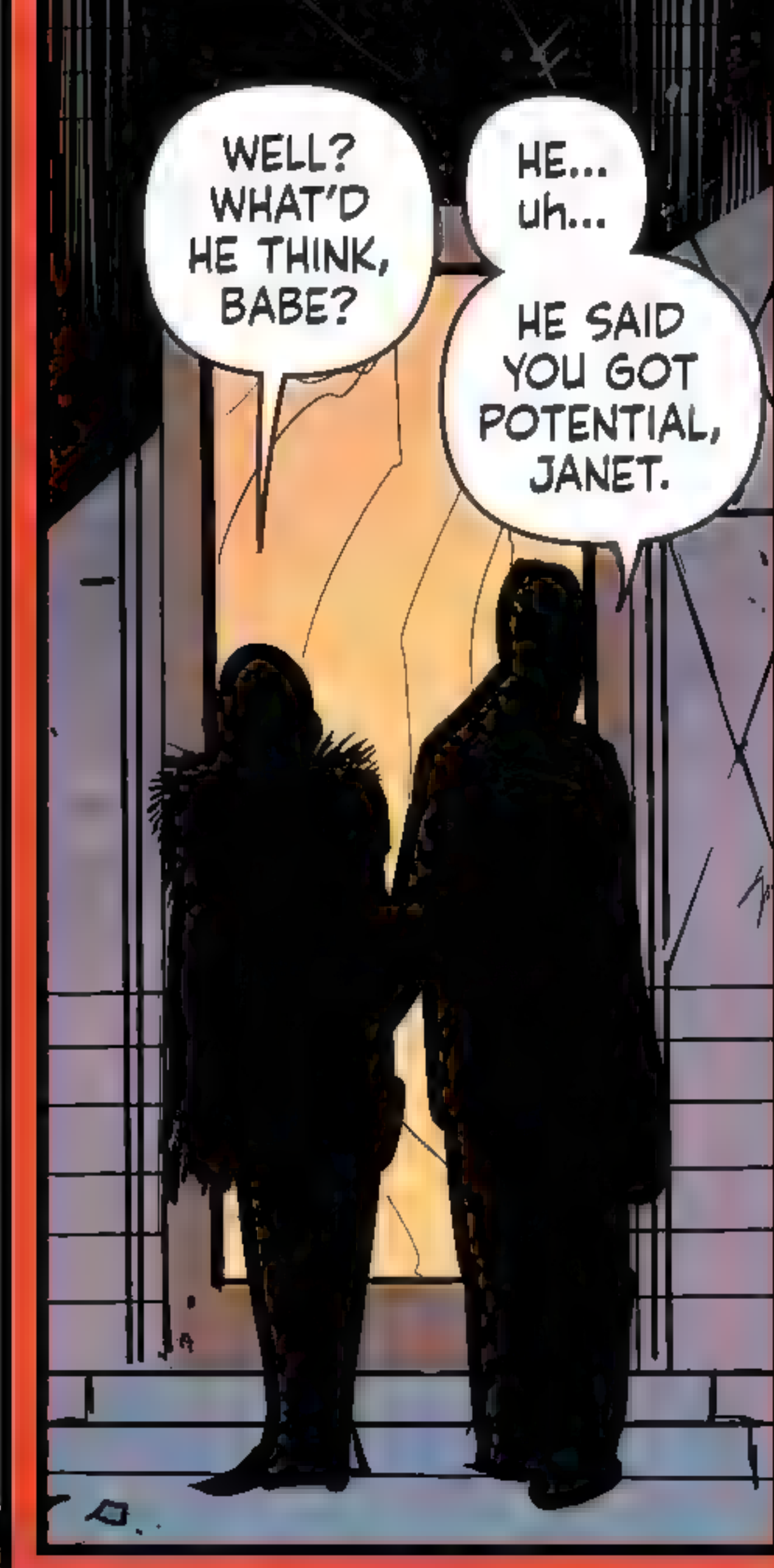
THAT...THAT
HURT!



OH.
OH NO.

I DROPPED
HER.

I FREAKING
DROPPED HER!



WELL?
WHAT'D
HE THINK,
BABE?

HE...
uh...

HE SAID
YOU GOT
POTENTIAL,
JANET.



OH, I
KNEW IT.

I **KNEW**
I WAS GOING
TO BE A STAR
SOMEDAY.

IT'S
ALL I EVER
WANTED.

SHUT UP
A MINUTE,
WILL YOU?

I HAVE
TO THINK.

HANG
ON--PHONE'S
GOIN' OFF.
IT'S DIZZY.



SAMMY.
HE'S DEAD.
BENNY'S
DEAD.

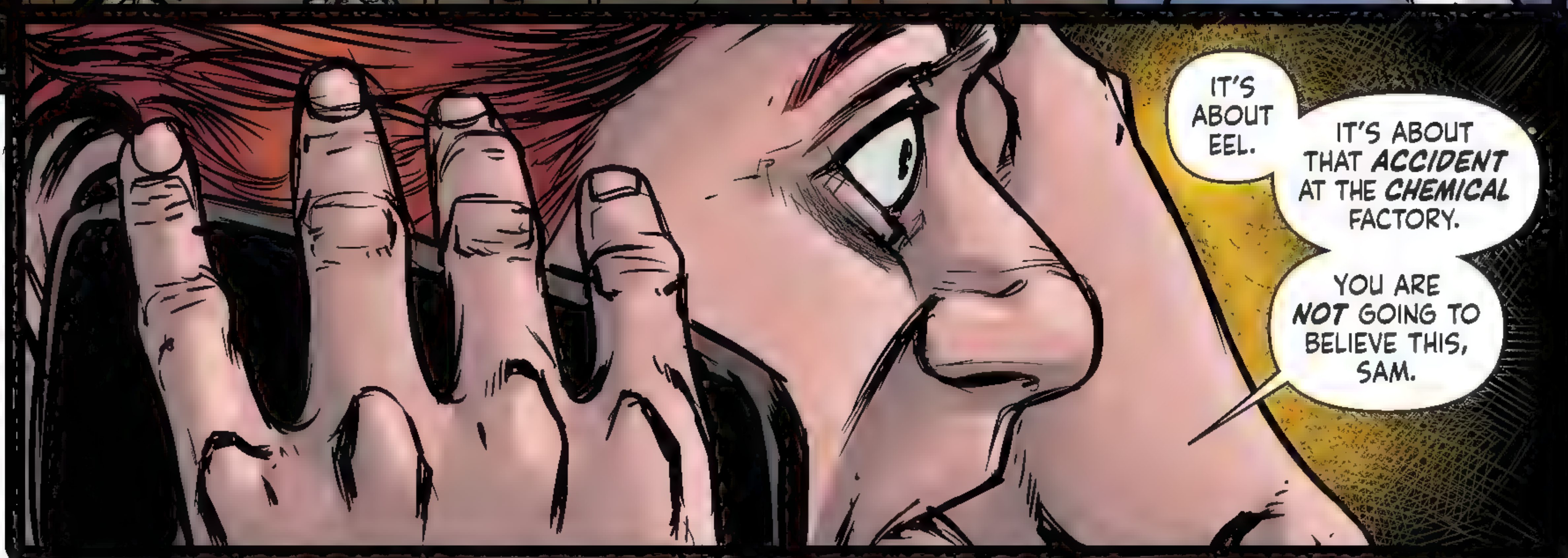
THEY
GOT HIM,
MAN! HE'S
DEAD.

WHAT?
WHO GOT
BENNY?



THE JLA,
MAN! THEY
TOOK HIM
OUT.

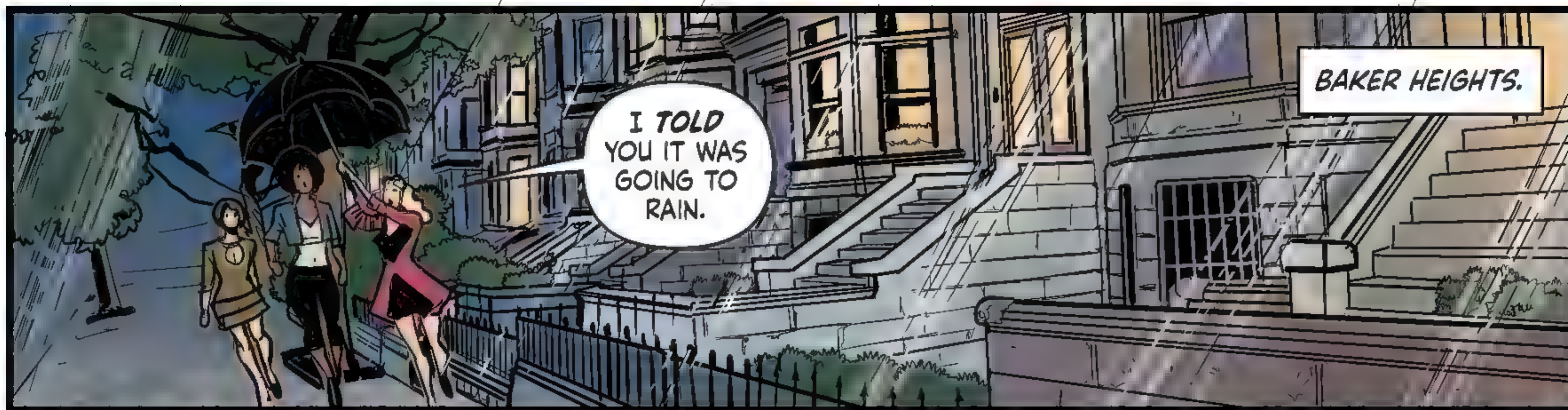
AND
THAT'S NOT
ALL, SAMMY.



IT'S
ABOUT
EEL.

IT'S ABOUT
THAT **ACCIDENT**
AT THE **CHEMICAL**
FACTORY.

YOU ARE
NOT GOING TO
BELIEVE THIS,
SAM.



BAKER HEIGHTS.

I TOLD
YOU IT WAS
GOING TO
RAIN.



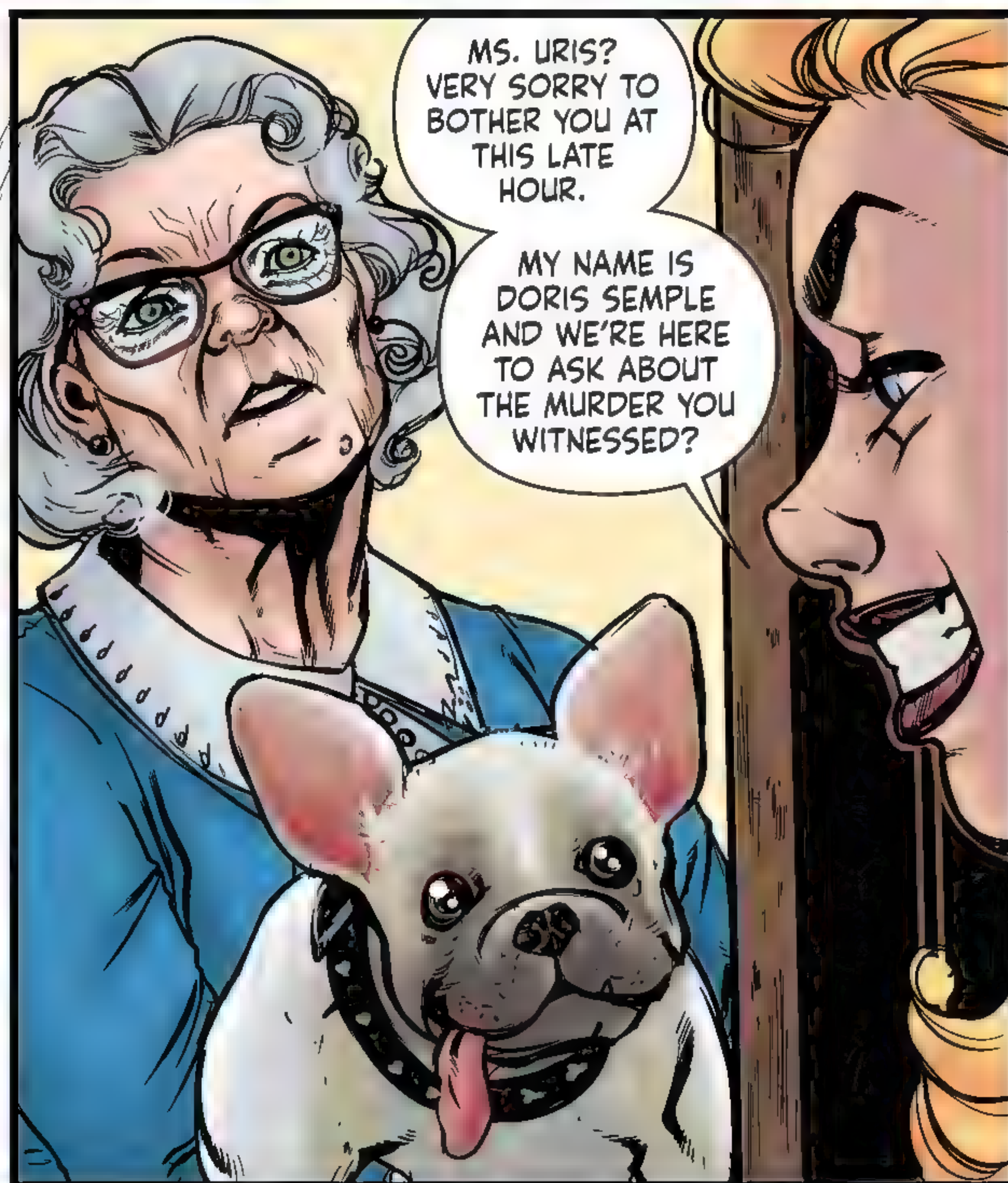
THIS IS
RIDICULOUS. YOU REALIZE
WE ARE INTERFERING IN A
MURDER INVESTIGATION,
RIGHT?

FOR
A LOWLIFE
WE BARELY
KNOW?

LILA MEEKS,
IF YOU THINK THAT
MR. O'BRIAN IS **CAPABLE**
OF MURDERING **ANYONE**,
YOU CAN JUST GO BACK
TO SUPERIORS BY
YOURSELF.

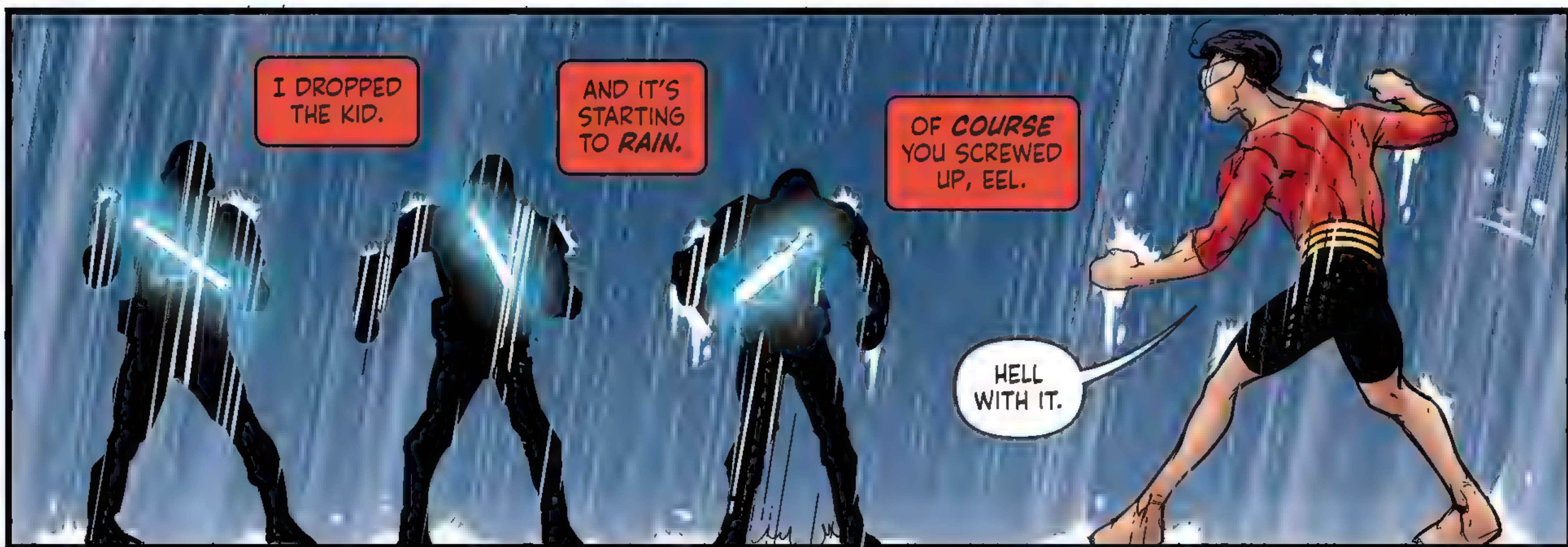
HE'S DOWN
ON HIS LUCK,
AND HE NEEDS
OUR **HELP**.

I THINK
SOMEONE'S
GOT A **CRUSH**,
MAYBE.



MS. URIS?
VERY SORRY TO
BOTHER YOU AT
THIS LATE
HOUR.

MY NAME IS
DORIS SEMPLE
AND WE'RE HERE
TO ASK ABOUT
THE MURDER YOU
WITNESSED?

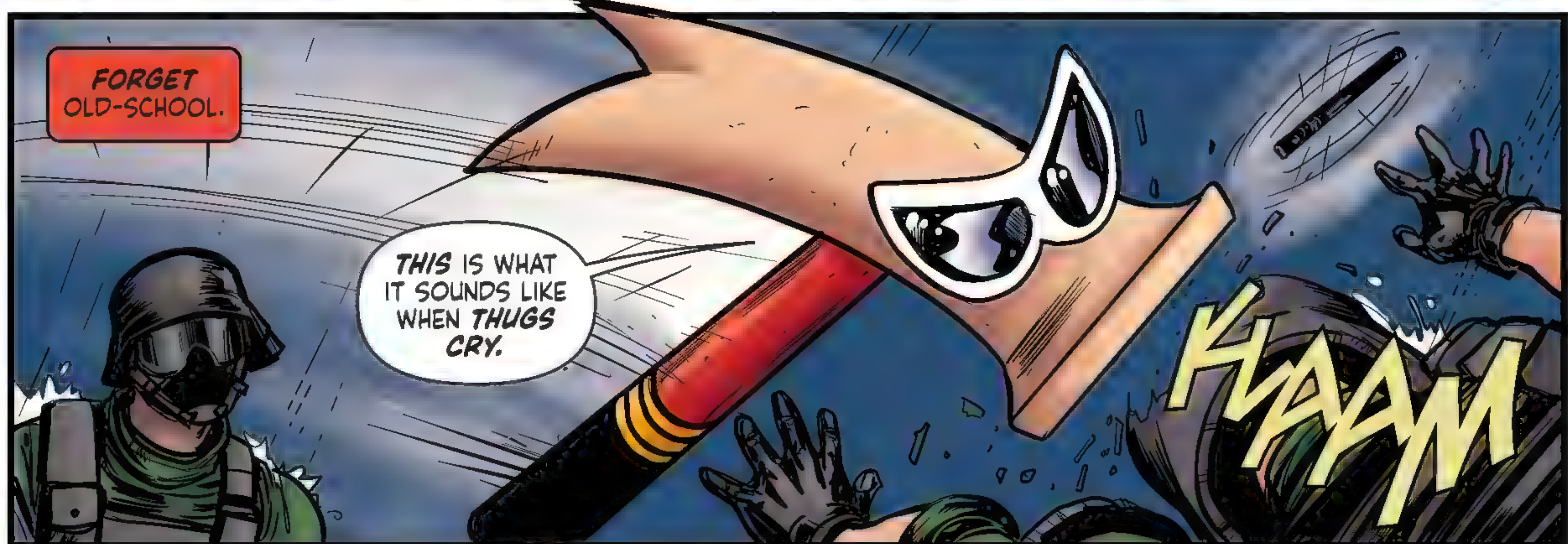


I DROPPED
THE KID.

AND IT'S
STARTING
TO RAIN.

OF **COURSE**
YOU SCREWED
UP, EEL.

HELL
WITH IT.



FORGET
OLD-SCHOOL.

THIS IS WHAT
IT SOUNDS LIKE
WHEN **THUGS**
CRY.

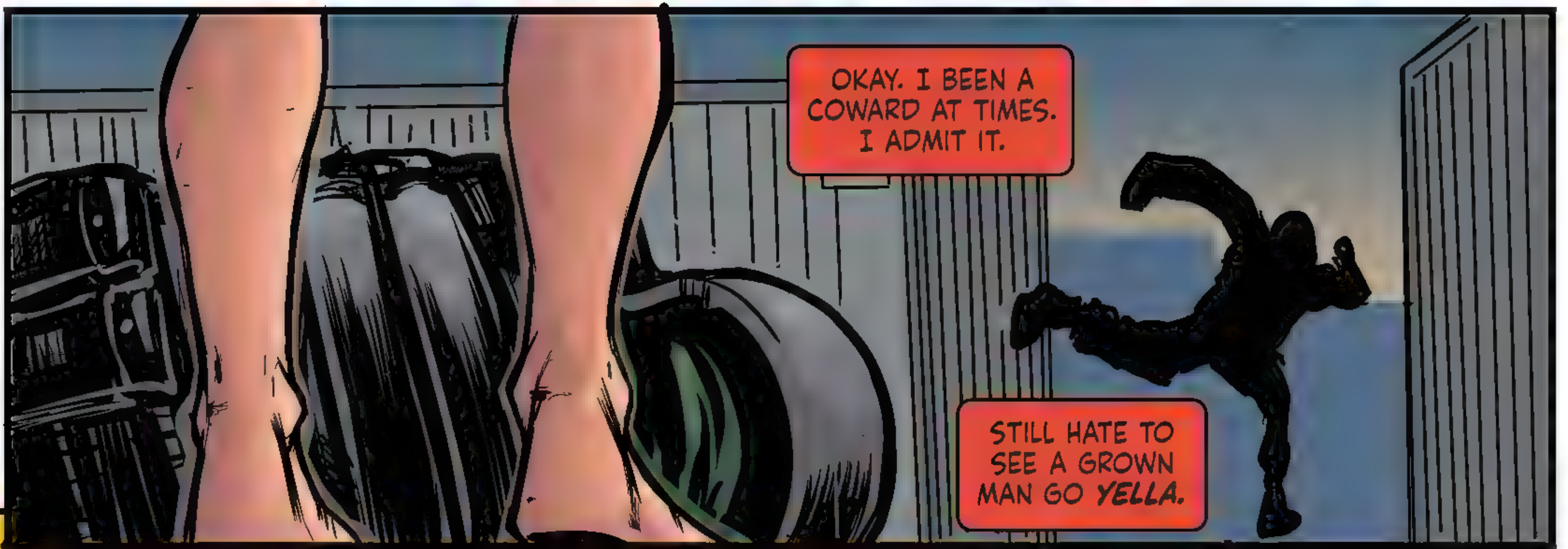
KLAAM



GOT IT.



HOW DO
YOU LIKE IT,
KAREN?



OKAY. I BEEN A
COWARD AT TIMES.
I ADMIT IT.

STILL HATE TO
SEE A GROWN
MAN GO YELLA.



I'M
COMING, KID.

DON'T
DROWN, ALL
RIGHT?



GUUHH

DON'T YOU
DROWN.



OH
MY STRETCHY
JOCKSTRAP.

OKAY.
I DIDN'T SEE
THIS COMING.



YOU
CAUGHT
HER?

IS
SHE...

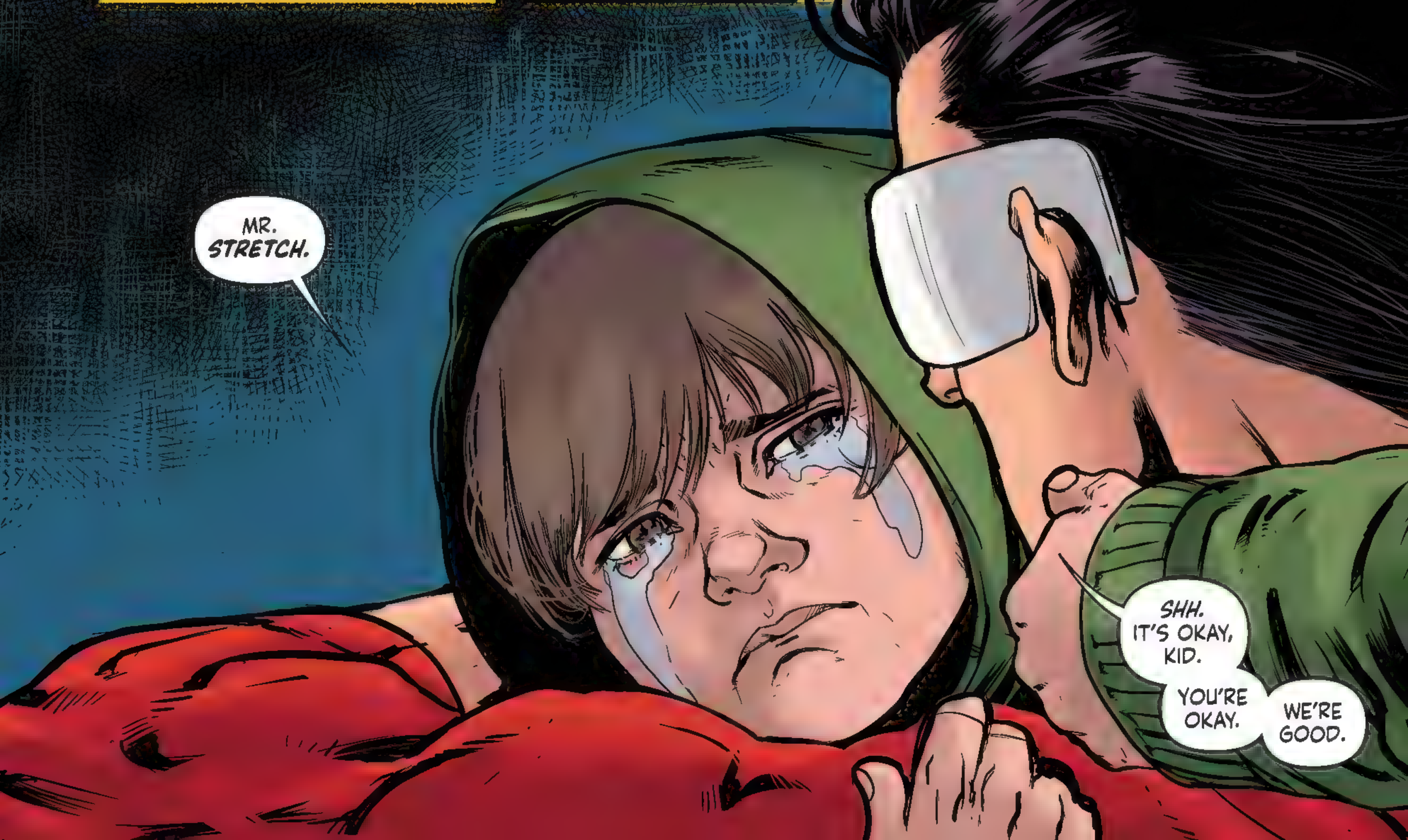
LISTEN,
MAN.
MAN-BAT
MAN.

I JUST
WANT TO
SAY...



I OWE
YOU.

OKAY?
YOU
HAVE MY
MARKER.

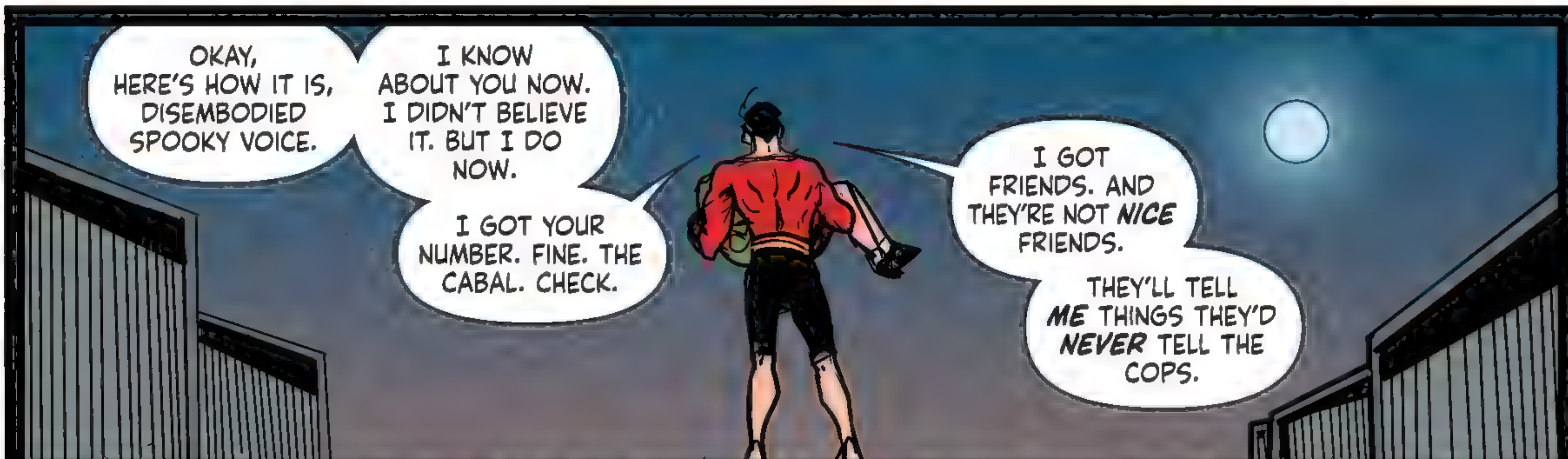


MR.
STRETCH.

SHH.
IT'S OKAY,
KID.

YOU'RE
OKAY.

WE'RE
GOOD.



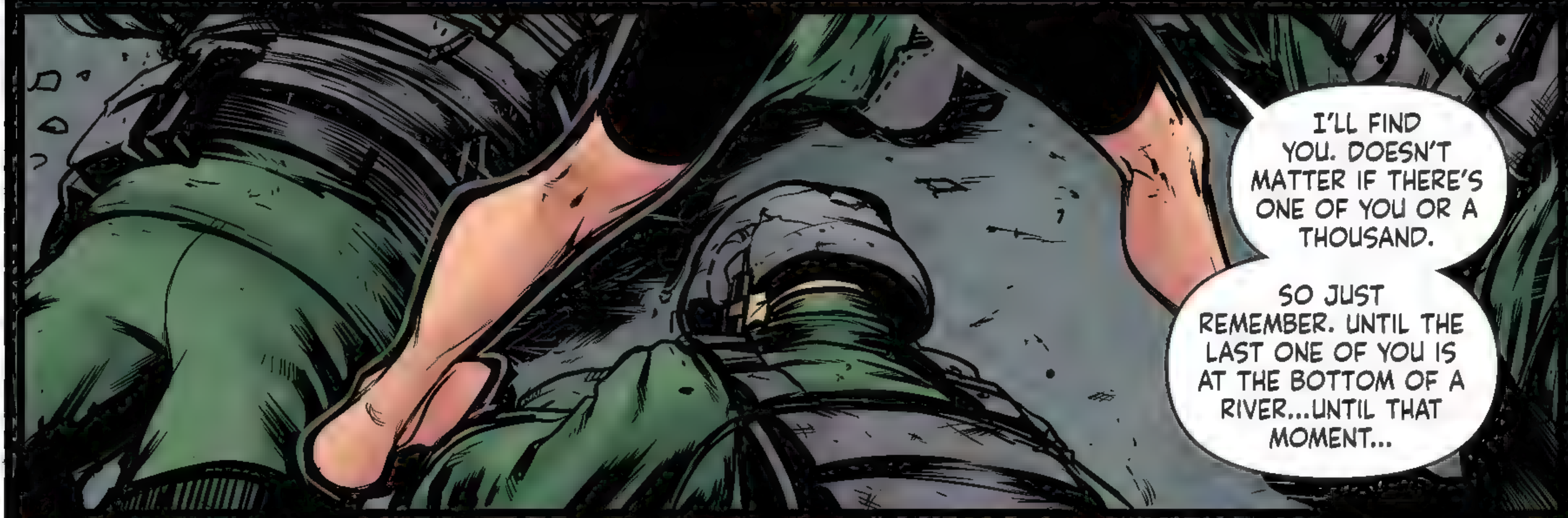
OKAY,
HERE'S HOW IT IS,
DISEMBODIED
SPOOKY VOICE.

I KNOW
ABOUT YOU NOW.
I DIDN'T BELIEVE
IT. BUT I DO
NOW.

I GOT YOUR
NUMBER. FINE. THE
CABAL. CHECK.

I GOT
FRIENDS. AND
THEY'RE NOT *NICE*
FRIENDS.

THEY'LL TELL
ME THINGS THEY'D
NEVER TELL THE
COPS.



I'LL FIND
YOU. DOESN'T
MATTER IF THERE'S
ONE OF YOU OR A
THOUSAND.

SO JUST
REMEMBER. UNTIL THE
LAST ONE OF YOU IS
AT THE BOTTOM OF A
RIVER...UNTIL THAT
MOMENT...



...I'M
RUBBER AND
YOU'RE *GLUE*.



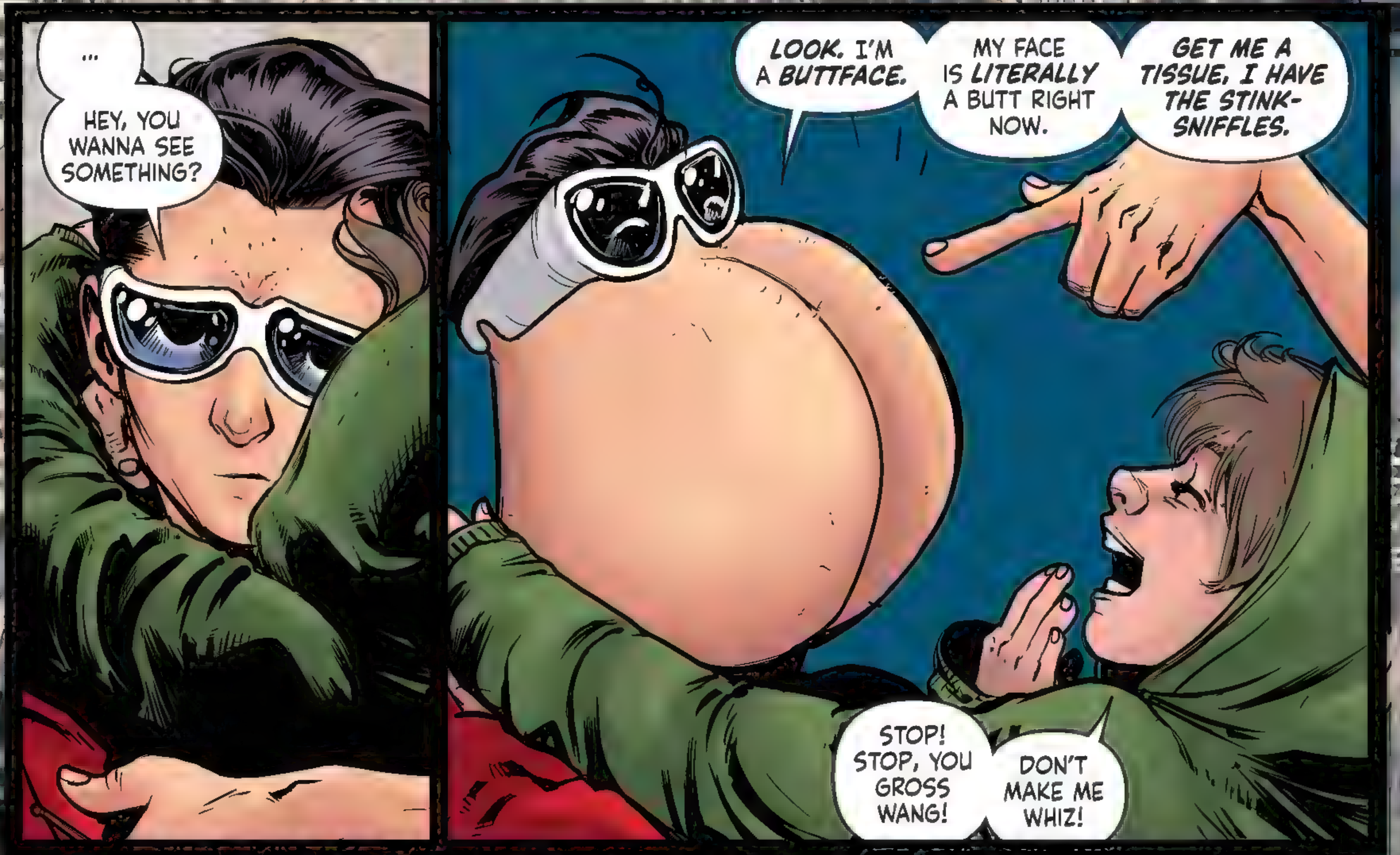
MS. URIS,
IS IT AT *ALL*
POSSIBLE THAT
YOU MADE A
MISTAKE?

OH, NO,
DEAR. I KNEW MR. BENNY
QUITE WELL, WE PLAYED
CANASTA ON THURSDAY
NIGHTS.

I EVEN
TOOK A PHOTO
OF THE KILLER.
HOLD ON.

I'M SORRY.
THERE'S NO
MISTAKE.

YOUR FRIEND
MURDERED *MY*
FRIEND IN COLD
BLOOD.



ALL RIGHT,
OBSCURA, OR
WHATEVER YOUR
NAME IS.

I DIDN'T BELIEVE
YOU, BUT NOW I DO.
THERE REALLY *IS* A
SECRET CABAL OF THE
WORST GENIUSES IN
THE GALAXY.

AND
I'M GOING TO
SHUT IT RIGHT
THE HELL
DOWN.

THAT GIRL
SHOULD BE IN
PROTECTIVE
CUSTODY, MR.
O'BRIAN.

YOU
HAVE NO *IDEA*
HOW BAD THESE
MONSTERS
ARE.

THAT AIN'T
HAPPENING.

I'M TAKING
HER SOMEPLACE
WHERE I CAN
WATCH *OUT* FOR
HER.

END OF
STORY.

SO GIVE ME
SOME *NAMES*,
I'M GELLIN' FOR
FELONS.

THIS IS SO
HUMILIATING.

WELL. WE
DON'T HAVE A
SINGLE CONFIRMED
NAME YET, JUST
SUSPECTS.

ER DEGATON
DR. THADDEUS BODOG SIVANA
BLOCKBUSTER
VANDAL SAVAGE
DR. ALBERT DESMOND
DR. BARBARA MINERVA
BLACK MANTA
SEBASTIAN BLOOD

I'LL
UPLOAD
TO YOUR
PHONE.

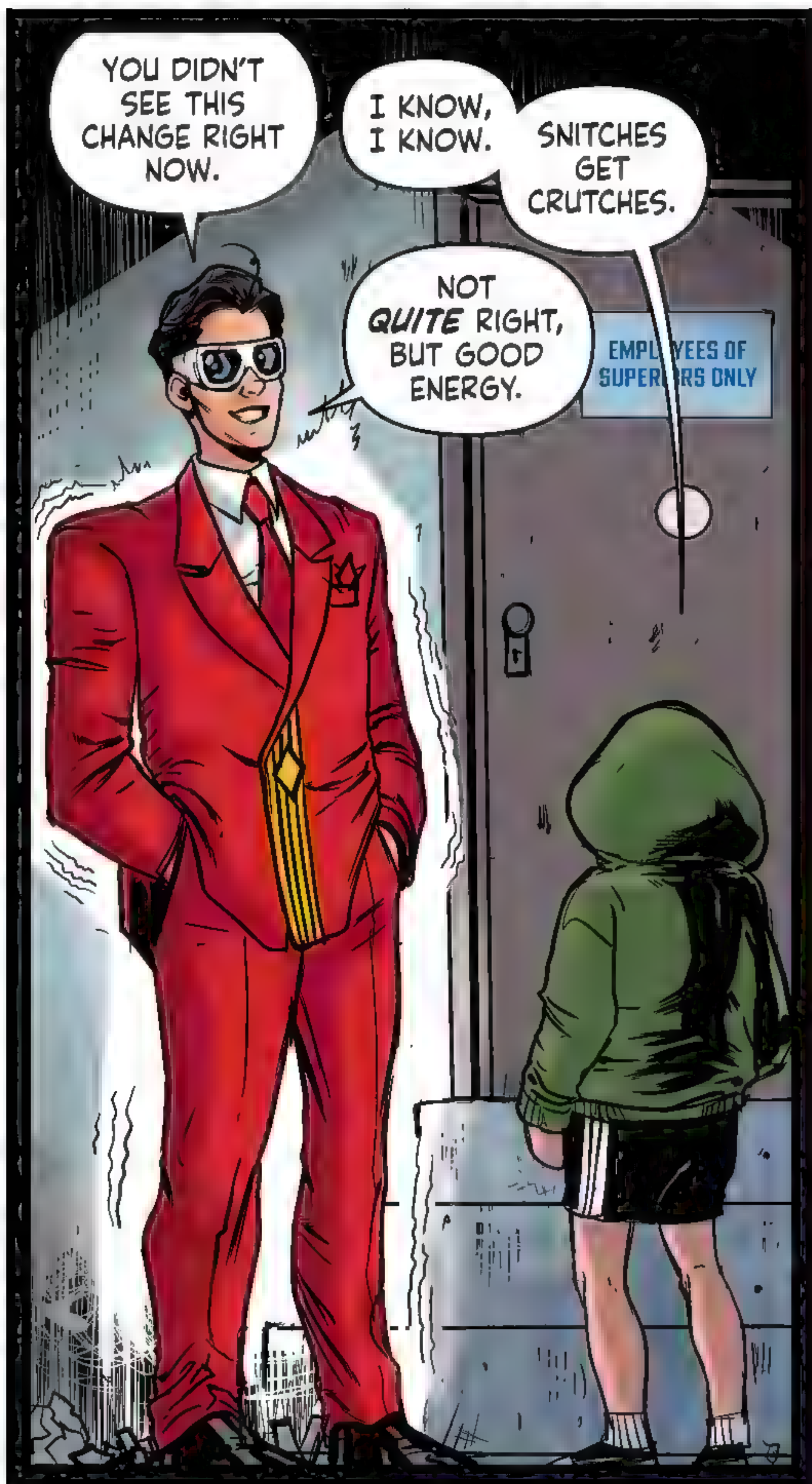
IT'S GONNA
BE UGLY, MR.
O'BRIAN. WE ARE
OUTGUNNED
BADLY.

SUPERIORS

I GET
IT.

GOOD
THING NO ONE
WILL MISS US
WHEN WE DIE,
RIGHT?

PLASTIC
MAN *OUT*.



YOU DIDN'T
SEE THIS
CHANGE RIGHT
NOW.

I KNOW,
I KNOW.

SNITCHES
GET
CRUTCHES.

NOT
QUITE RIGHT,
BUT GOOD
ENERGY.

EMPLOYEES OF
SUPERHERS ONLY



HEY!

SORRY,
KID.

EEL! WE
WERE GETTING
WORRIED.

WE HAVE
A LOT TO
TELL YOU.

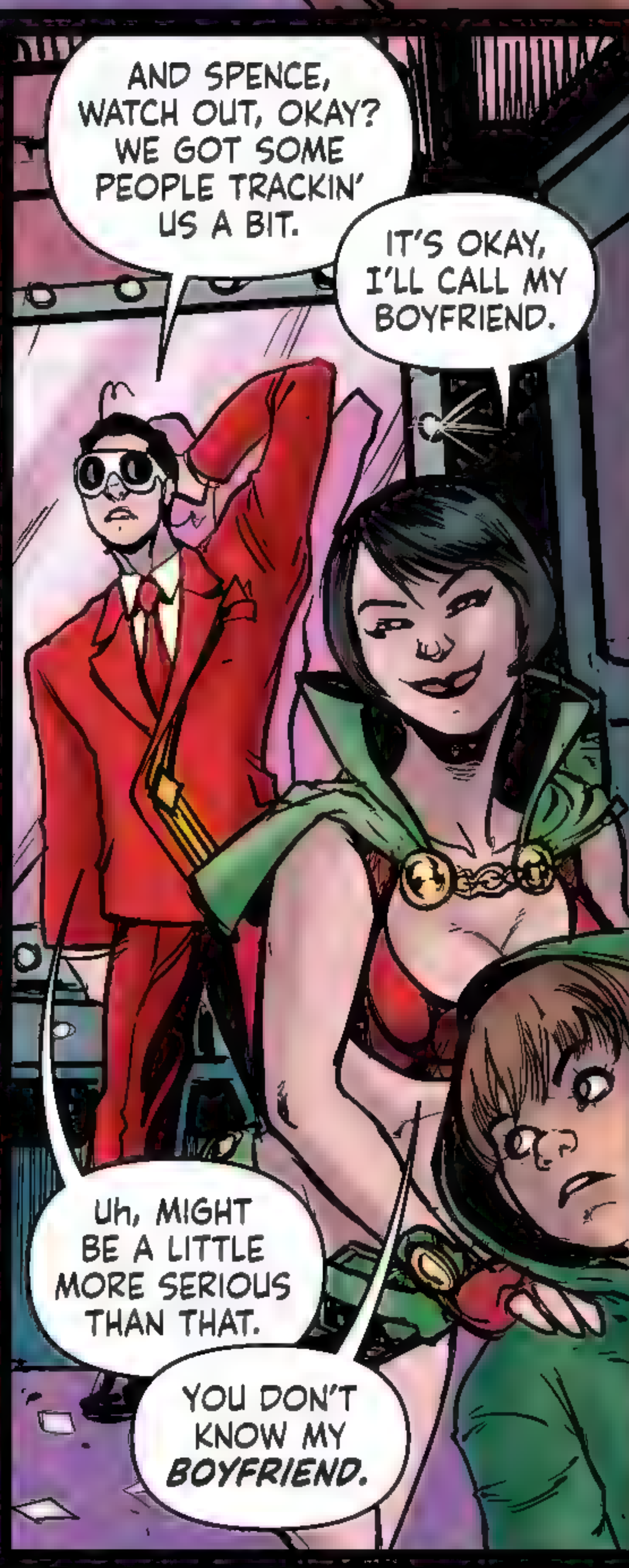


YEAH?
ALL RIGHT.

LISTEN.
PADO. SPENCER'S
GONNA MAKE YOU
A SANDWICH,
OKAY?

YOU KEEP
CALLING ME "HER"
AND I HAVEN'T
DECIDED YET.

KID, YOU
BE WHAT YOU
WANT, THAT'S
WHAT I DO.



AND SPENCE,
WATCH OUT, OKAY?
WE GOT SOME
PEOPLE TRACKIN'
US A BIT.

IT'S OKAY,
I'LL CALL MY
BOYFRIEND.

Uh, MIGHT
BE A LITTLE
MORE SERIOUS
THAN THAT.

YOU DON'T
KNOW MY
BOYFRIEND.



JUST
SO YOU
KNOW.

I'D
MISS YOU.

EXCUSE
YOU?

I WOULD
MISS YOU.



IF YOU
DIED.

SO
JUST DON'T,
OKAY?



EEL.
LISTEN. THERE
WAS WRITING
AT THE CRIME
SCENE.

AND THE
WITNESS HAD
PICTURES.
OF YOU.

WAIT.
I SWEAR I
DIDN'T--



NEVERTHELESS,
SOMEONE WHO LOOKS
JUST **LIKE** YOU DID
THE DEED.

AND THE
WRITING...WE
LOOKED IT UP.
IT'S NOT FROM
EARTH, YOU
HEAR ME?

I BET
HE'D BE A
GREAT FATHER,
REALLY.



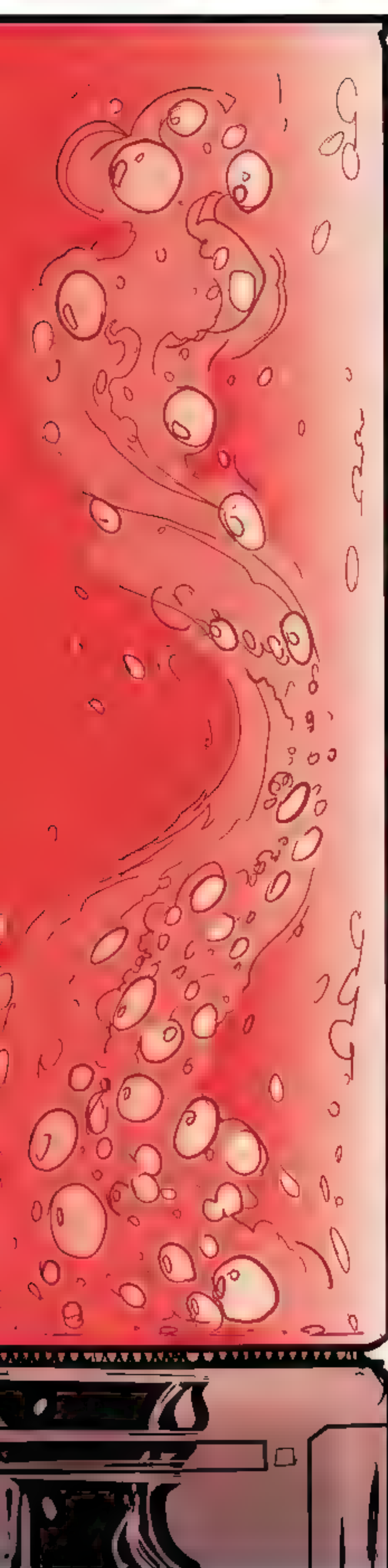
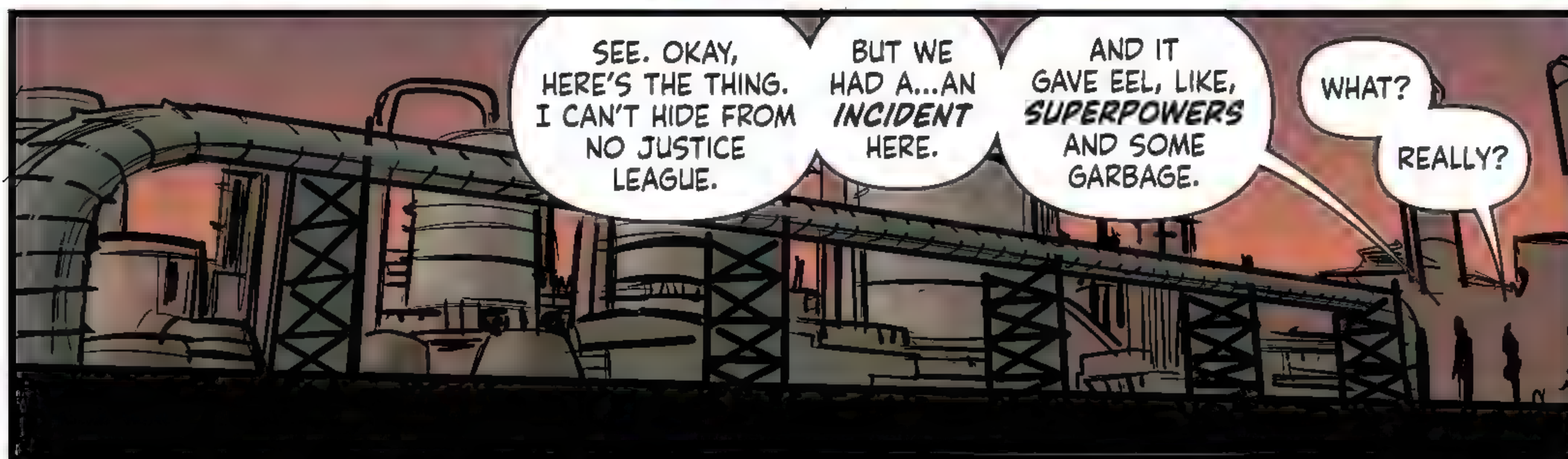
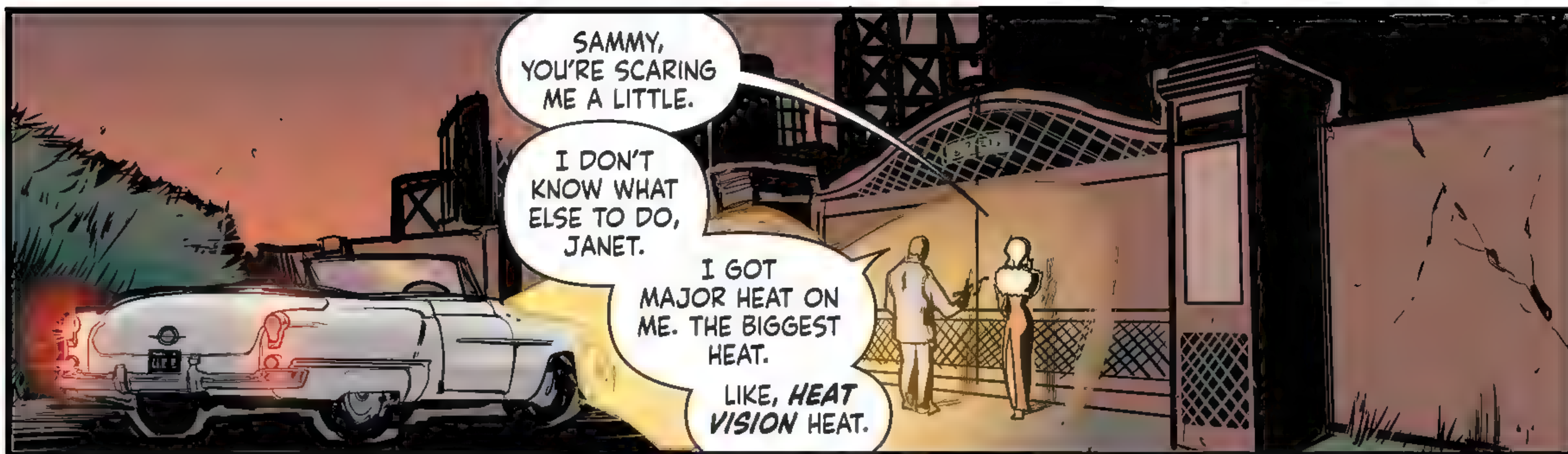
OKAY. THIS IS
OFFICIALLY A TURF
WAR, I GUESS.

WHAT
ARE YOU
GOING TO
DO, EEL?



I'M THE
BOUNCER,
RIGHT?

GUESS I'M
GONNA SHOW
THESE **CABAL**
CREEPS HOW TO
BOUNCE.





LOPACON 100
Luis McArthur

CHAPTER FOUR

REVENGE OF THE
OF THE HORROR
OF THE CREATURE

Cover art by Emanuela Lupacchino
with Ray McCarthy and Tomeu Morey





WHAT? N...
NO, NO, NEVER,
DOLL FACE.

YOU
LOOK--

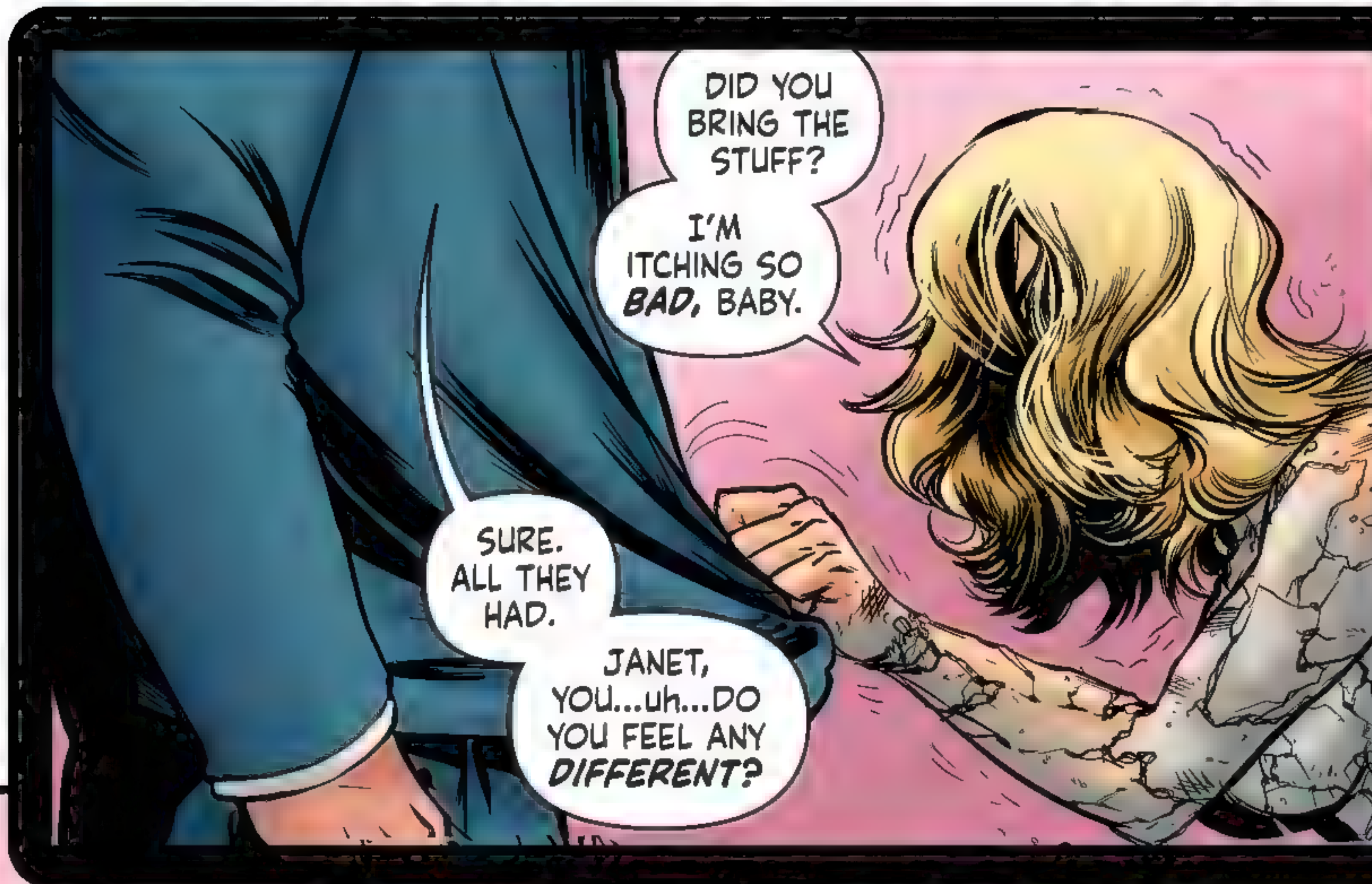
YOU
LOOK LIKE A
MILLION...

YOU
LOOK LIKE A
PILE OF...

YOU
LOOK...
URK!

SILLY
SAMMY.

YOU SAY
THE SWEETEST
THINGS.



DID YOU
BRING THE
STUFF?

I'M
ITCHING SO
BAD, BABY.

SURE.
ALL THEY
HAD.

JANET,
YOU...uh...DO
YOU FEEL ANY
DIFFERENT?



"DIFFERENT"?

WELL,
NO, NOT REALLY.
I MEAN, I'M
ITCHING REAL
BAD.

AND IT'S
GETTING SO BAD
THAT I ALMOST
WANT...



TO RIP MY
OWN SKIN OFF TO THE
BLOODY BONE AND THEN
RIP EVERYONE ELSE'S
SKIN OFF AND WEAR IT
AND DANCE THROUGH
THE STREETS SINGING
THE NATIONAL
ANTHEM--

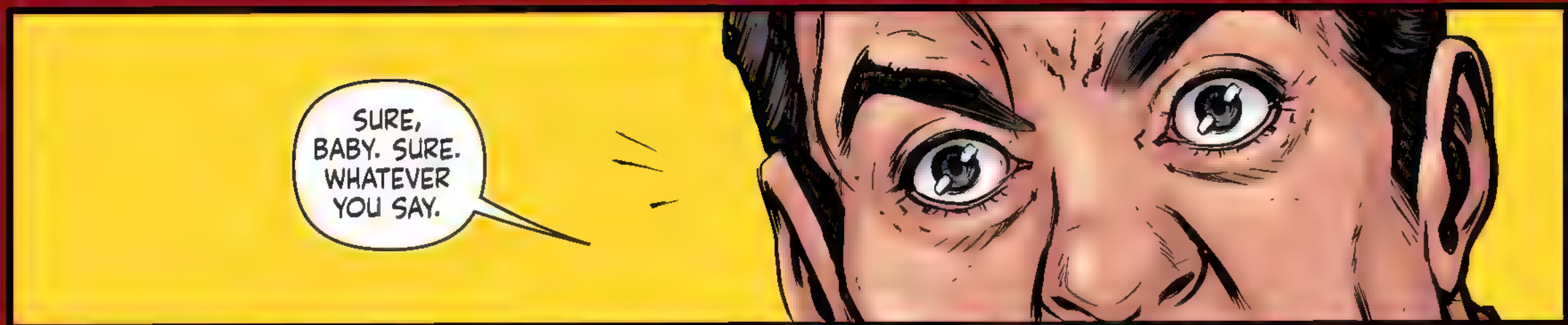


Huh.

WHATEVER.

THE
LOTION,
SAMMY.

MY
SKIN'S SO
DRY.



SURE,
BABY. SURE.
WHATEVER
YOU SAY.



THIS
IS *YOUR* FAULT,
EEL O'BRIAN.

YOU GETTING
POWERS FROM
THAT LOUSY
FACTORY.

LOOK WHAT
YOU MADE ME
DO TO HER!

REVENGE of the CURSE of the HORROR of the CREATURE

SEE, OKAY, YES.
I'M TRYING NOT
TO BE A BAD
GUY ANYMORE.

I'M
TRYING.

BUT THE THING IS, IT
TOOK ME A LONG TIME
TO EARN RESPECT ON
THE STREET. LOTTA
STITCHING AND NO
SNITCHING, IF YOU GET
MY MEANING.

SO, YEAH.
I KINDA
MISS IT.

THEY
ALL KNOW
YOU.

THAT
THEY DO,
KIDDO-
ROO.

BUT YOU
SAID YOU'RE
A **GOOD** GUY,
AND THEY'RE
ALL...

SCUM?

KINDA.

HEY.
NOW, LISTEN. I
WON'T HAVE YOU
BAD-MOUTHING
SCUM.

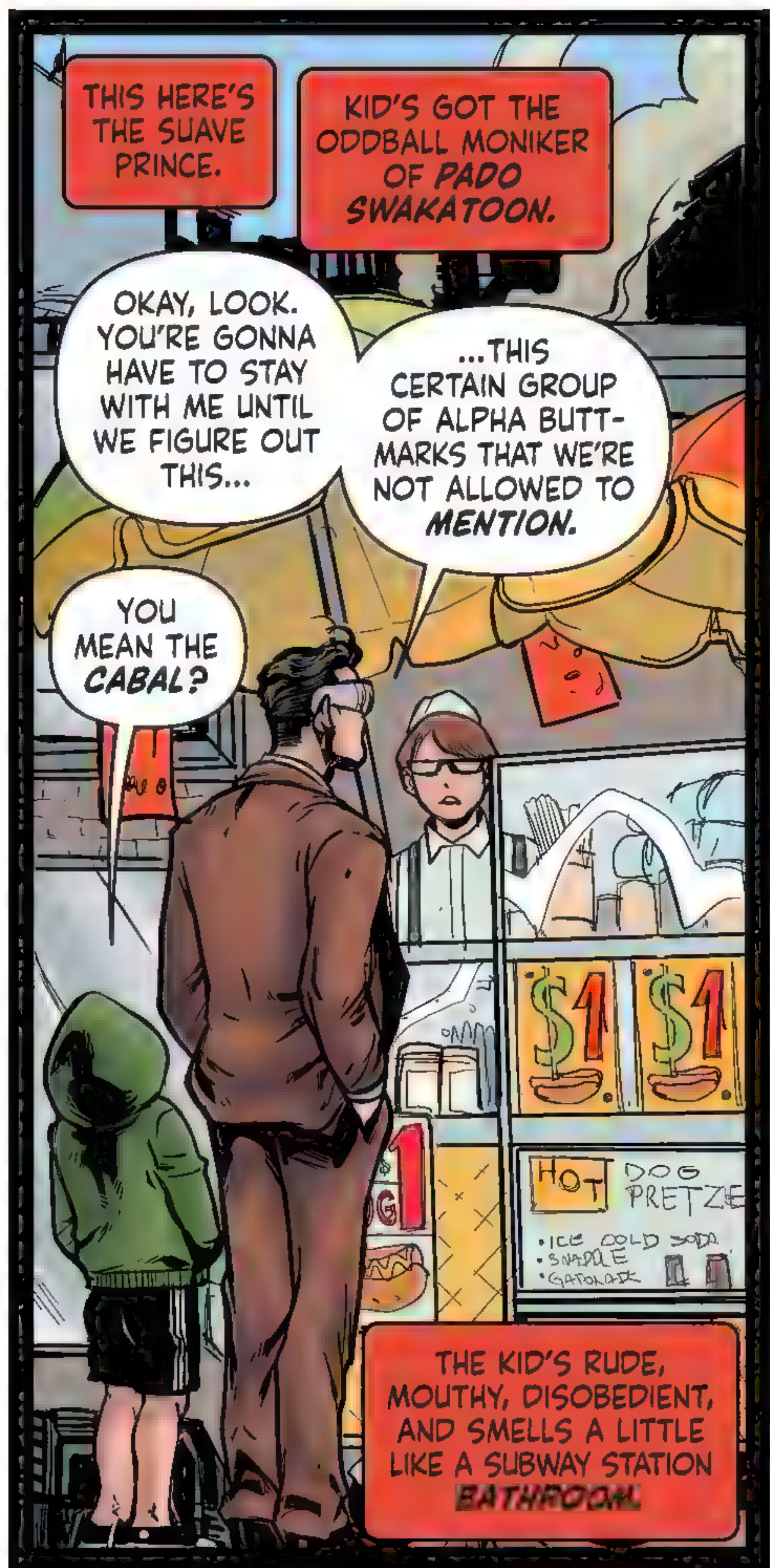
SOME
OF MY BEST
SCUM ARE
SCUM.

ALSO,
STAND UP
STRAIGHT.

NEVER THOUGHT
I'D BE WALKING
AROUND SCUM ALLEY
WITH NO **KID**.

'SPECIALLY A KID WHO
REMINDS ME OF ME,
RIGHT NOW, TRYING
TO FIGURE OUT WHO
THEY ARE.

GOOD
ON HIM.



THIS HERE'S
THE SUAVE
PRINCE.

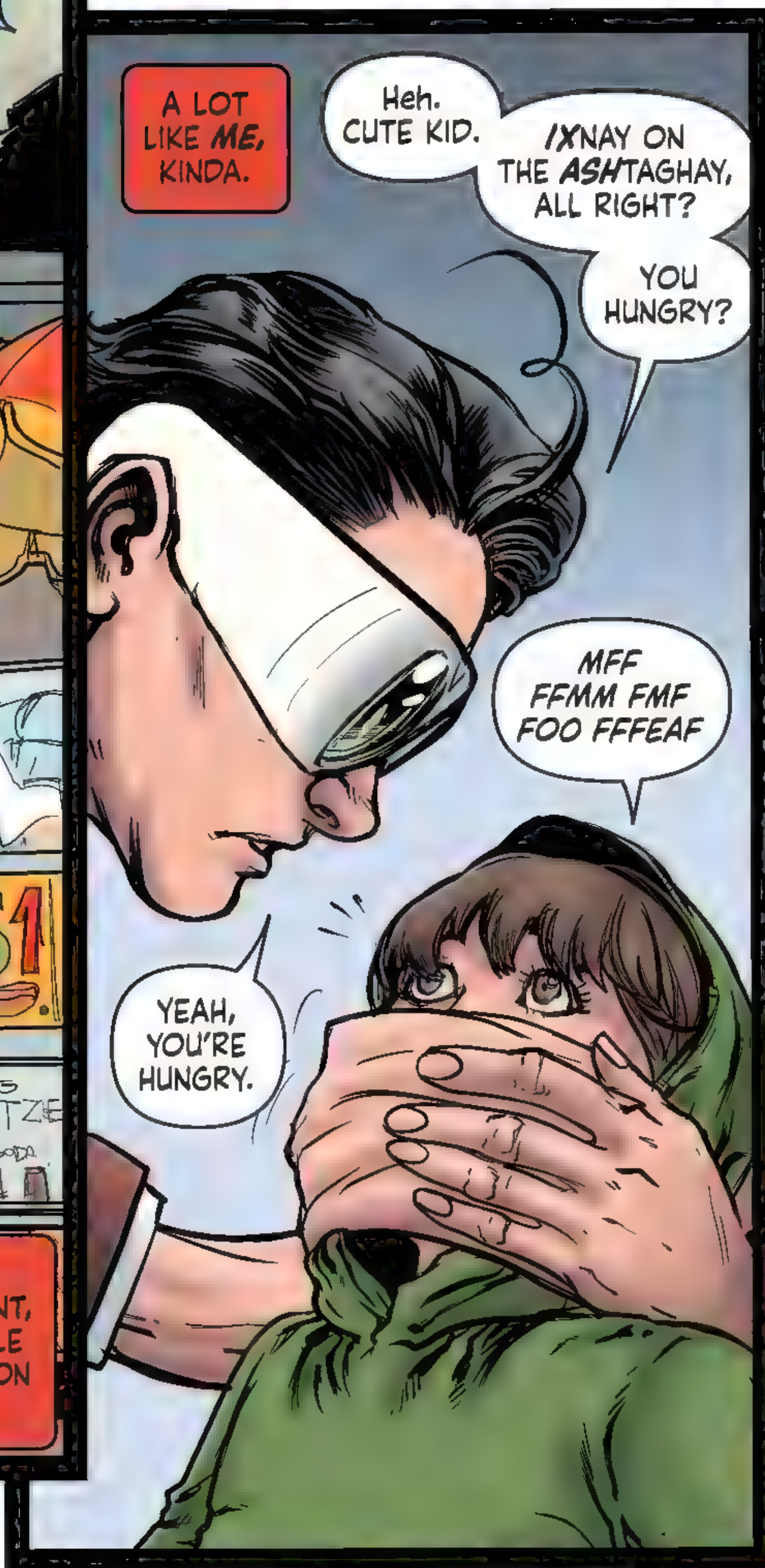
KID'S GOT THE
ODDBALL MONIKER
OF PADO
SWAKATOON.

OKAY, LOOK.
YOU'RE GONNA
HAVE TO STAY
WITH ME UNTIL
WE FIGURE OUT
THIS...

...THIS
CERTAIN GROUP
OF ALPHA BUTT-
MARKS THAT WE'RE
NOT ALLOWED TO
MENTION.

YOU
MEAN THE
CABAL?

THE KID'S RUDE,
MOUTHY, DISOBEDIENT,
AND SMELLS A LITTLE
LIKE A SUBWAY STATION
BATHROOM.



A LOT
LIKE ME,
KINDA.

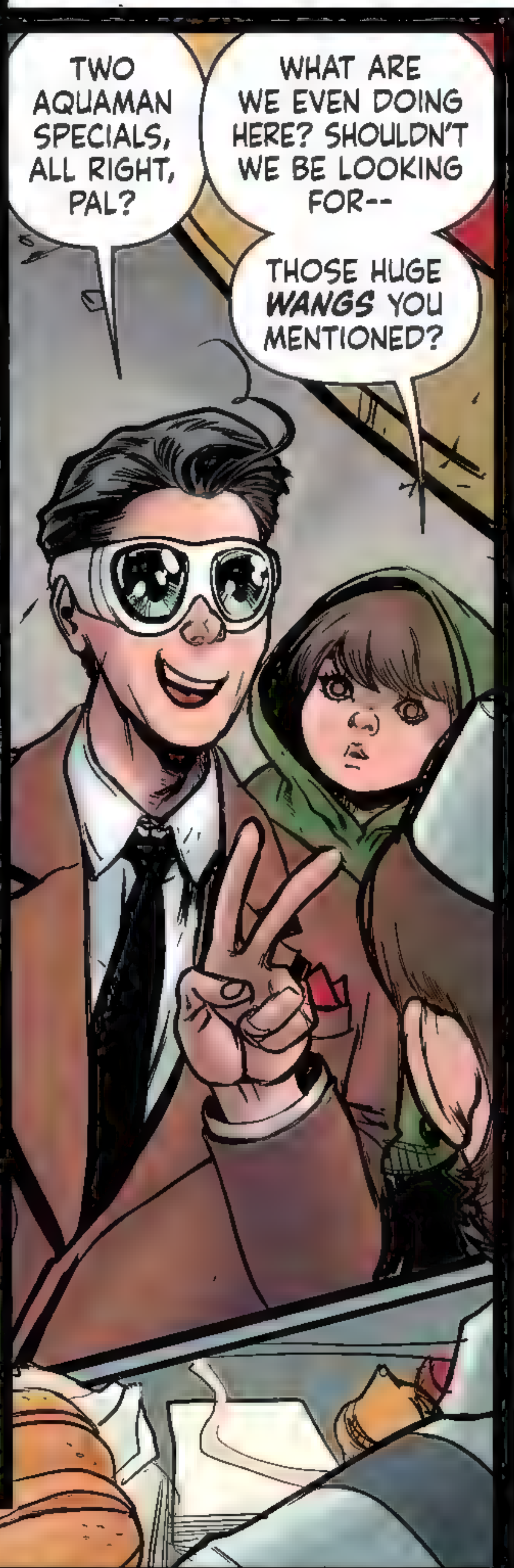
Heh.
CUTE KID.

IXNAY ON
THE ASHTAGHAY,
ALL RIGHT?

YOU
HUNGRY?

MFF
FFMM FMF
FOO FFEAF

YEAH,
YOU'RE
HUNGRY.



TWO
AQUAMAN
SPECIALS,
ALL RIGHT,
PAL?

WHAT ARE
WE EVEN DOING
HERE? SHOULDN'T
WE BE LOOKING
FOR--

THOSE HUGE
WANGS YOU
MENTIONED?



THERE YOU GO,
ONE RED HOT
WITH ANCHOVIES
AND HERRING.

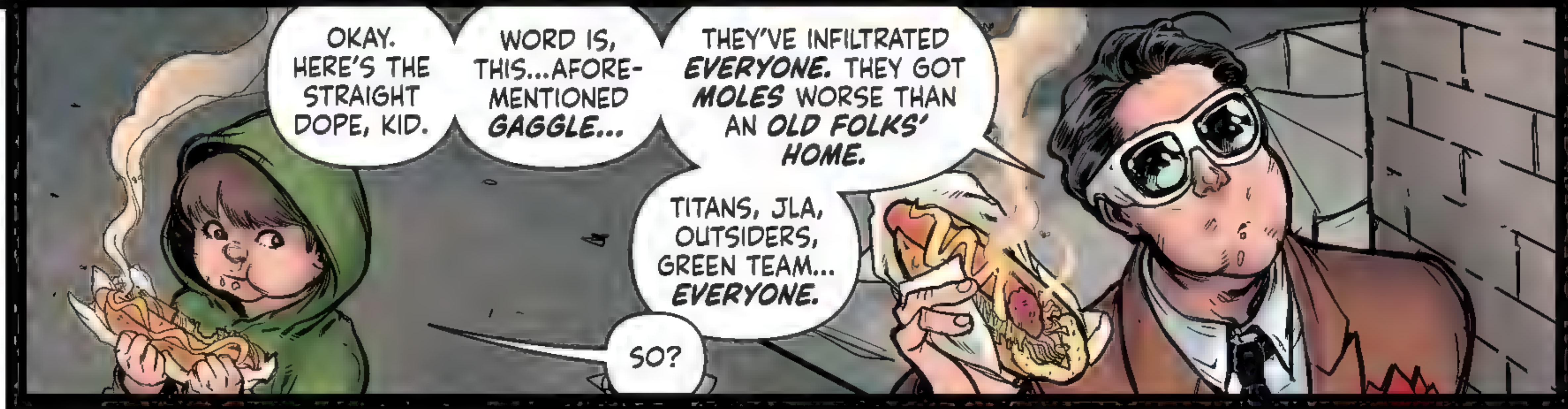
REALLY?

Eww.

I HEARD
IT SMELLS LIKE
AQUAMAN'S
THRONE.

Uh.

FORGET I
SAID THAT.



OKAY.
HERE'S THE
STRAIGHT
DOPE, KID.

WORD IS,
THIS...AFORE-
MENTIONED
GAGGLE...

THEY'VE INFILTRATED
EVERYONE. THEY GOT
MOLES WORSE THAN
AN OLD FOLKS'
HOME.

TITANS, JLA,
OUTSIDERS,
GREEN TEAM...
EVERYONE.

SO?



KID. I KNOW YOU HAD IT HARD. I KNOW YOU'VE BEEN LIVING ROUGH. AND I AIN'T NOBODY'S SUPERFELLA.

BUT I'M NOT GONNA LET YOU GET HURT.

NOT NO WAY AND NOT NO HOW.



OH, FOR THE LOVE OF PETE'S UGLY SISTER, PETEGINA!

'SCUZE ME. SORRY.



LOOK. DOOFUS.

THAT IS NO WAY TO BOOST A WALLET, JACK.

YOU MIGHT BE THE WORST KNUCKLER I EVER SEEN.

I DON'T KNOW WHAT YOU'RE TALKING ABOUT.



CRIMINY CRACKERS.

GUY AS CLUMSY AS YOU GOTTA HAVE A SPOT MAN. A DISTRACTION. THAT'S YOUR STALL.

THEN YOU GO FOR THE BUMP, GET IT? THEN YOU SKIN THE POKE.



WHAT IS IT? CAN'T YOU SEE I'M DOING SOMETHIN'?

THERE ARE A LOT OF BAD GUYS ALREADY, MR. O'BRIAN.

I LIKED YOU BETTER NOT, IF THAT'S OKAY.

LIKE I SAID.

MOUTHY. DISOBEIENT. JUDGMENTAL.

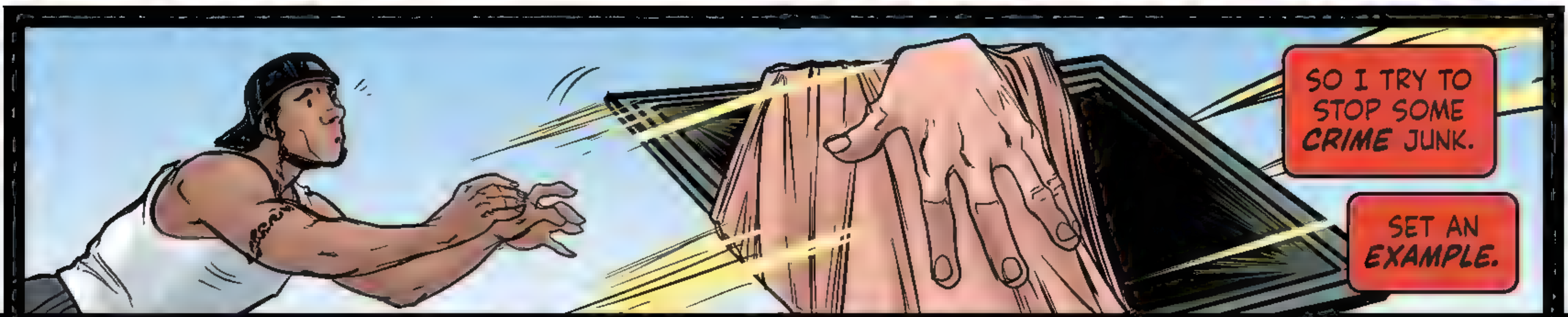


DON'T EVEN KNOW WHAT'S GOOD ON A HOT DOG.

AAAH, GET LOST, MISCREANT. GO CALL YOUR MOTHER!

OKAY, PLASTIC MAN.

BE THE GUY HE THINKS YOU ARE.



SO I TRY TO
STOP SOME
CRIME JUNK.

SET AN
EXAMPLE.



EXCUSE
ME, LADIES!



OKAY. SO...DO YOU,
WHAT, GO TO SCHOOL OR
SOMETHING?

NOT
REALLY.

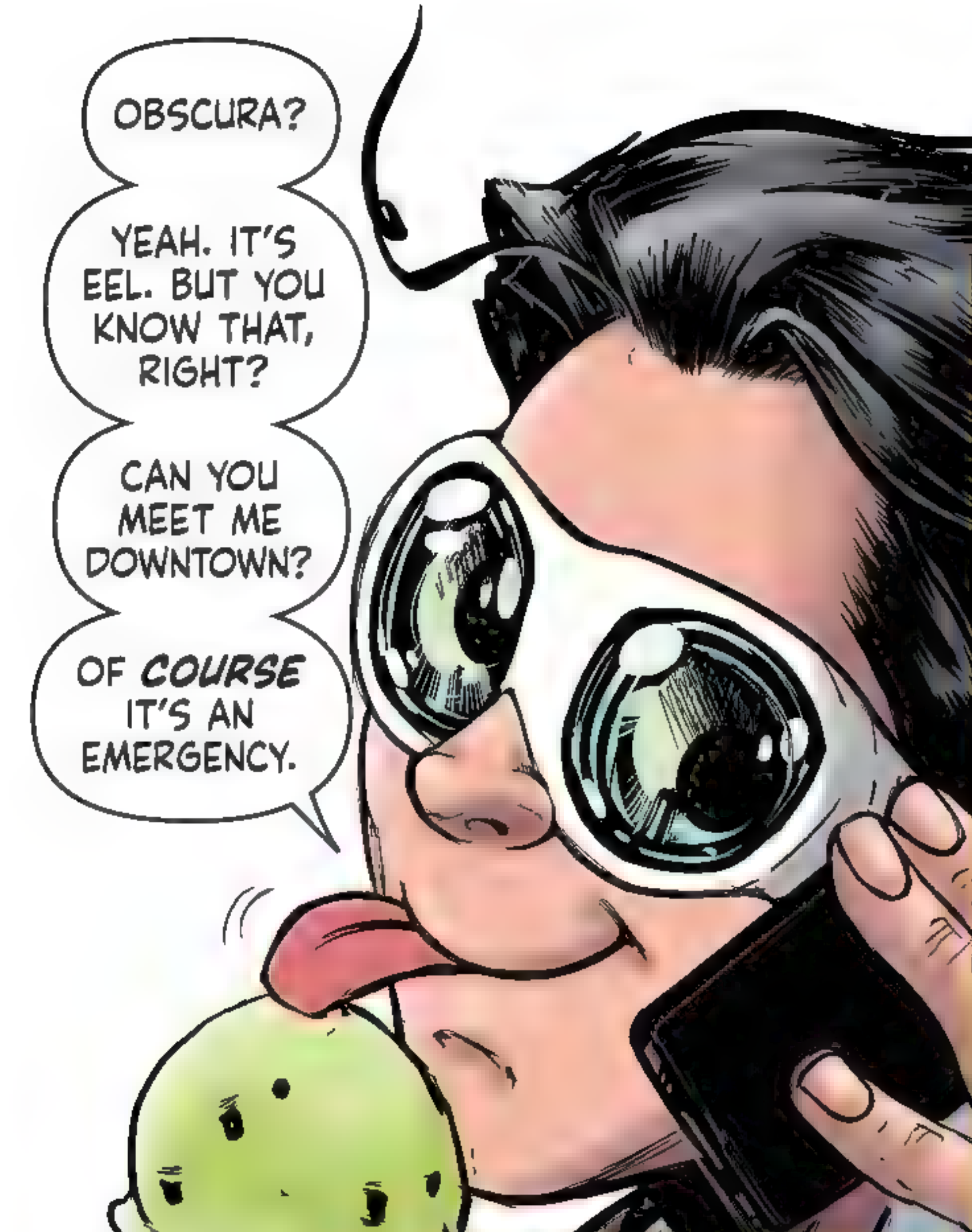
AND
HOW OLD ARE
YOU...FIVE? I
DON'T KNOW
KIDS.

I'M
ELEVEN.

SO DON'T
PISS ME
OFF, MR.
STRETCH.

CAN I BE
YOUR SPOT
MAN?



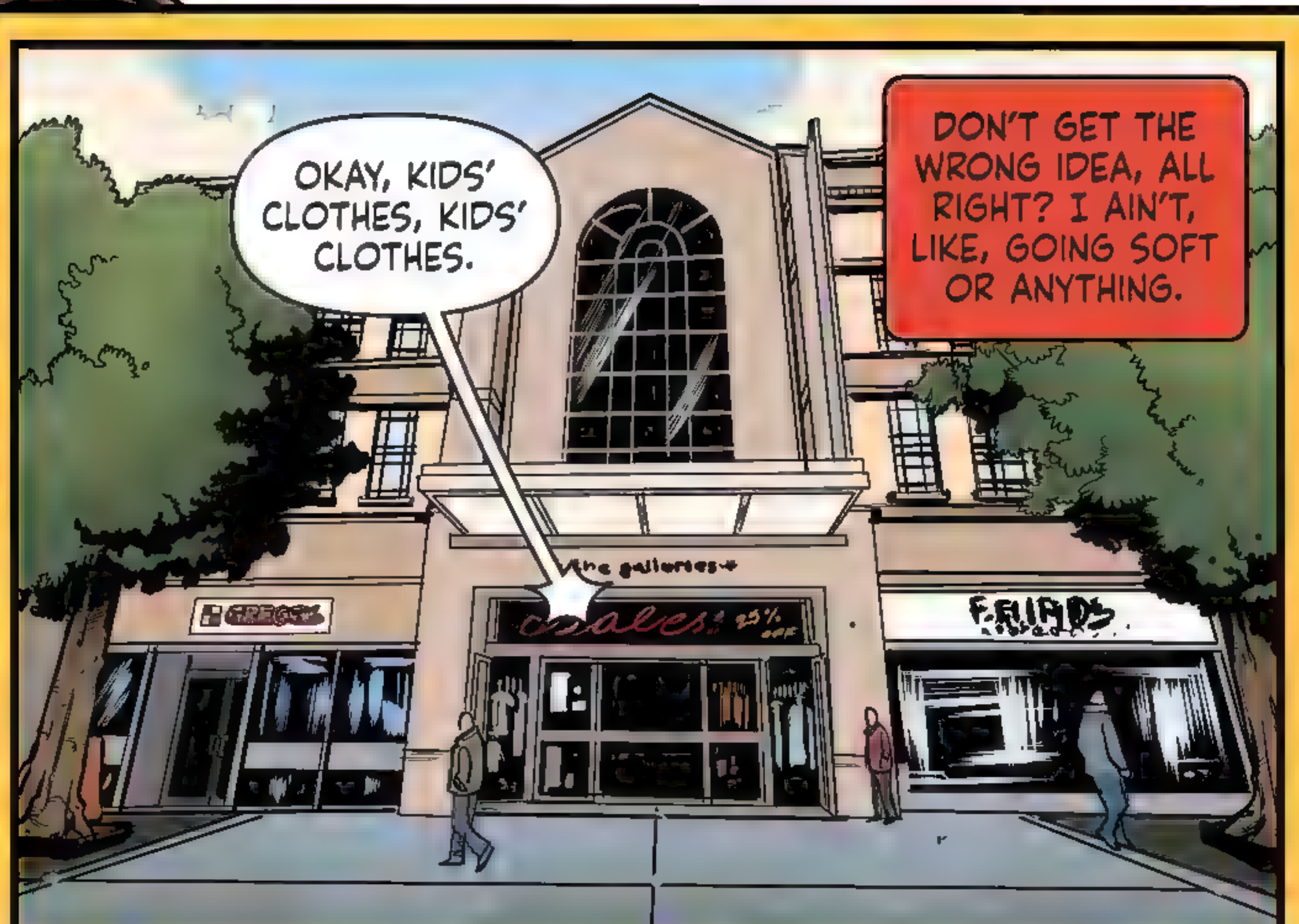


OBSCURA?

YEAH. IT'S EEL. BUT YOU KNOW THAT, RIGHT?

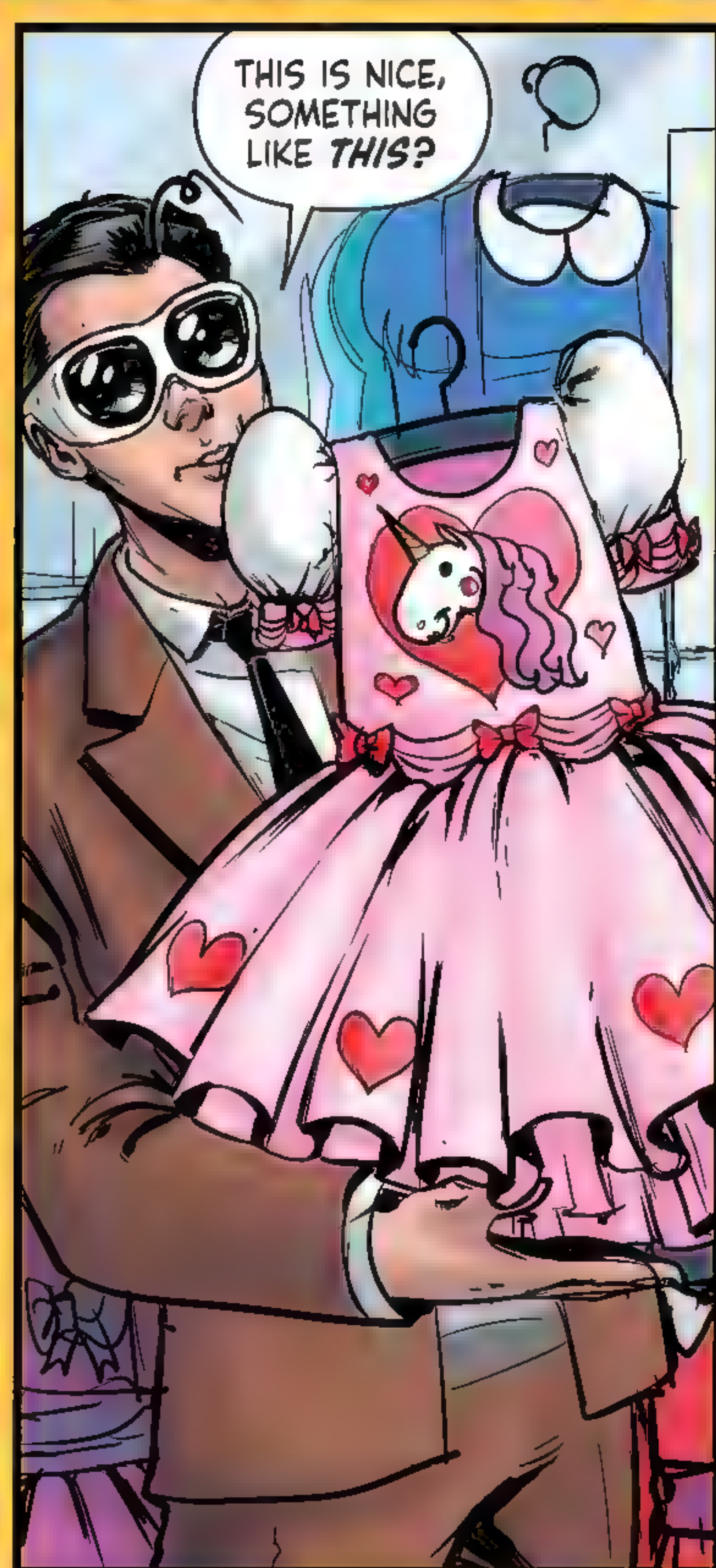
CAN YOU MEET ME DOWNTOWN?

OF COURSE IT'S AN EMERGENCY.

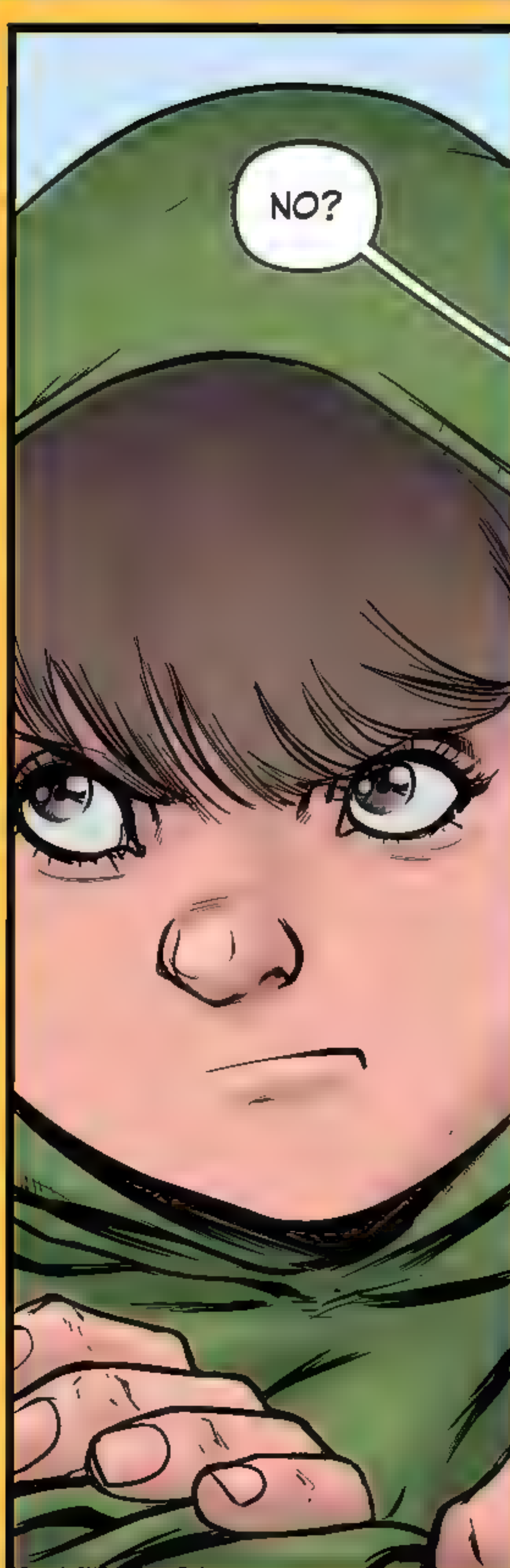


OKAY, KIDS' CLOTHES, KIDS' CLOTHES.

DON'T GET THE WRONG IDEA, ALL RIGHT? I AIN'T, LIKE, GOING SOFT OR ANYTHING.



THIS IS NICE, SOMETHING LIKE THIS?



NO?

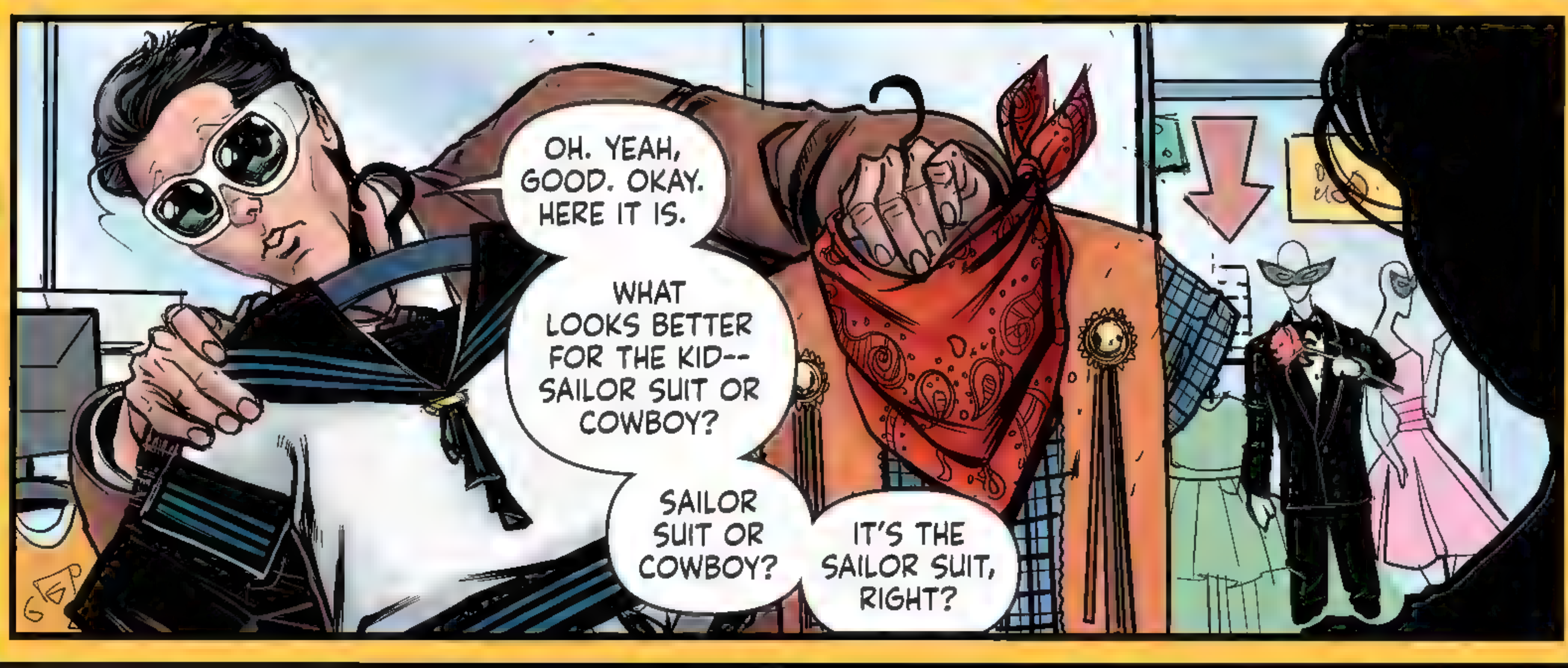


KID. I'M SORRY, BUT YOU GOTTA GO TO SCHOOL.

YOU GOTTA LEARN ALL THE BASICS SO YOU CAN FORGET THEM LATER.

O'BRIAN. I'M HERE.

WHAT'S THE EMERGENCY?



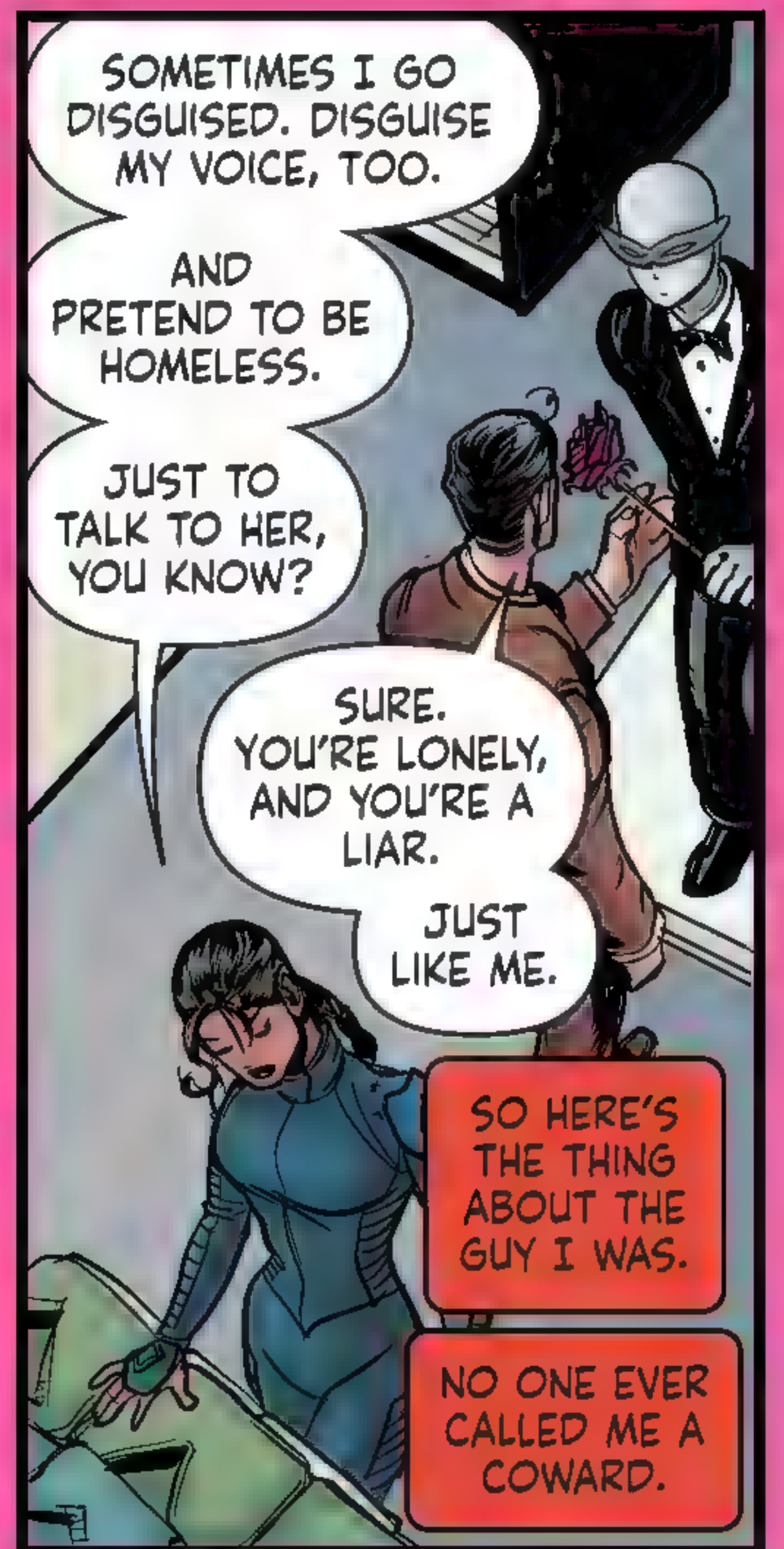
OH. YEAH, GOOD. OKAY. HERE IT IS.

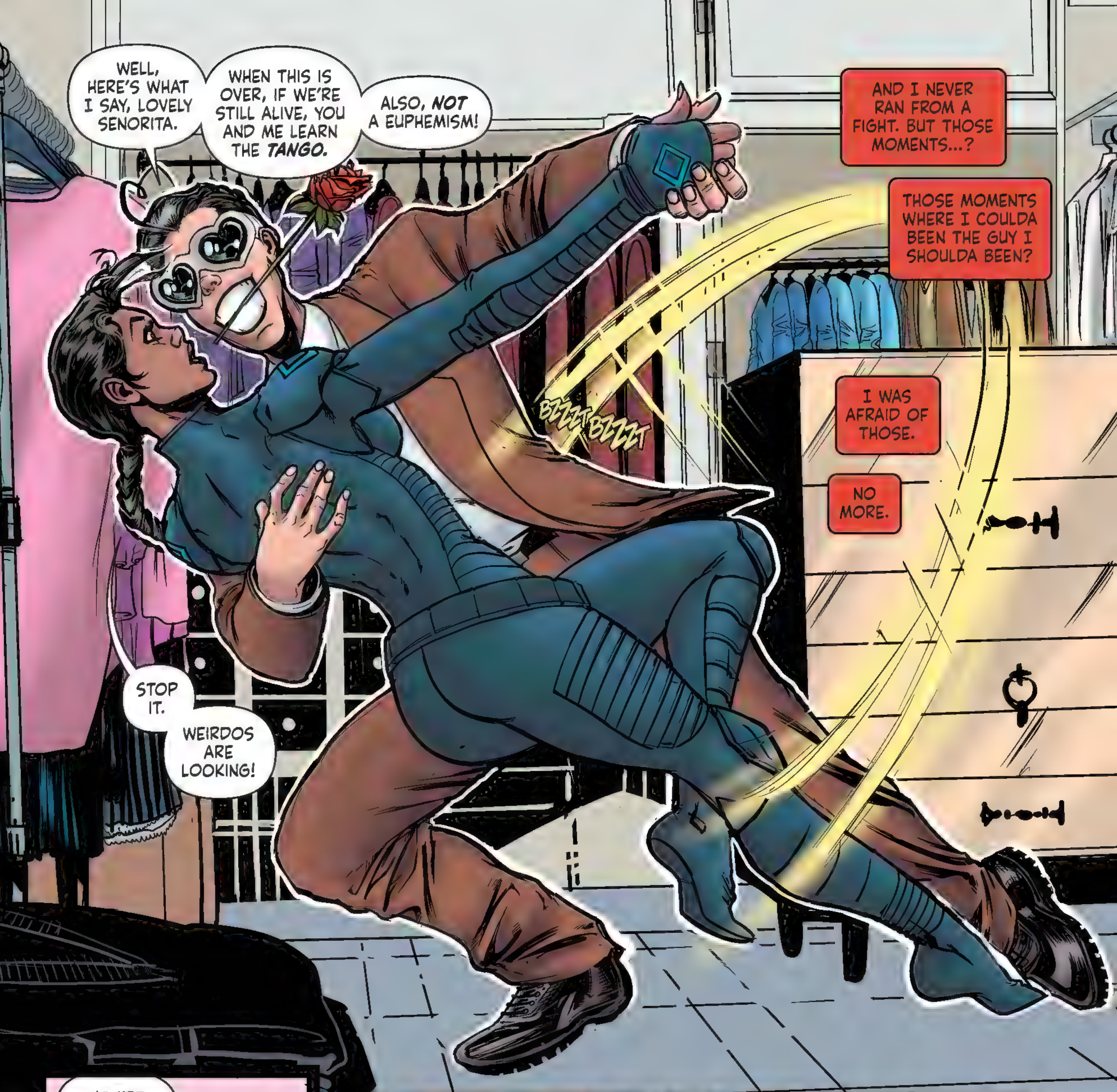
WHAT LOOKS BETTER FOR THE KID-- SAILOR SUIT OR COWBOY?

SAILOR SUIT OR COWBOY?

IT'S THE SAILOR SUIT, RIGHT?







WELL,
HERE'S WHAT
I SAY, LOVELY
SENORITA.

WHEN THIS IS
OVER, IF WE'RE
STILL ALIVE, YOU
AND ME LEARN
THE *TANGO*.

ALSO, *NOT*
A EUPHEMISM!

AND I NEVER
RAN FROM A
FIGHT. BUT THOSE
MOMENTS...?

THOSE MOMENTS
WHERE I COULDA
BEEN THE GUY I
SHOULDA BEEN?

I WAS
AFRAID OF
THOSE.

NO
MORE.

BZZT BZZT

STOP
IT.

WEIRDOS
ARE
LOOKING!

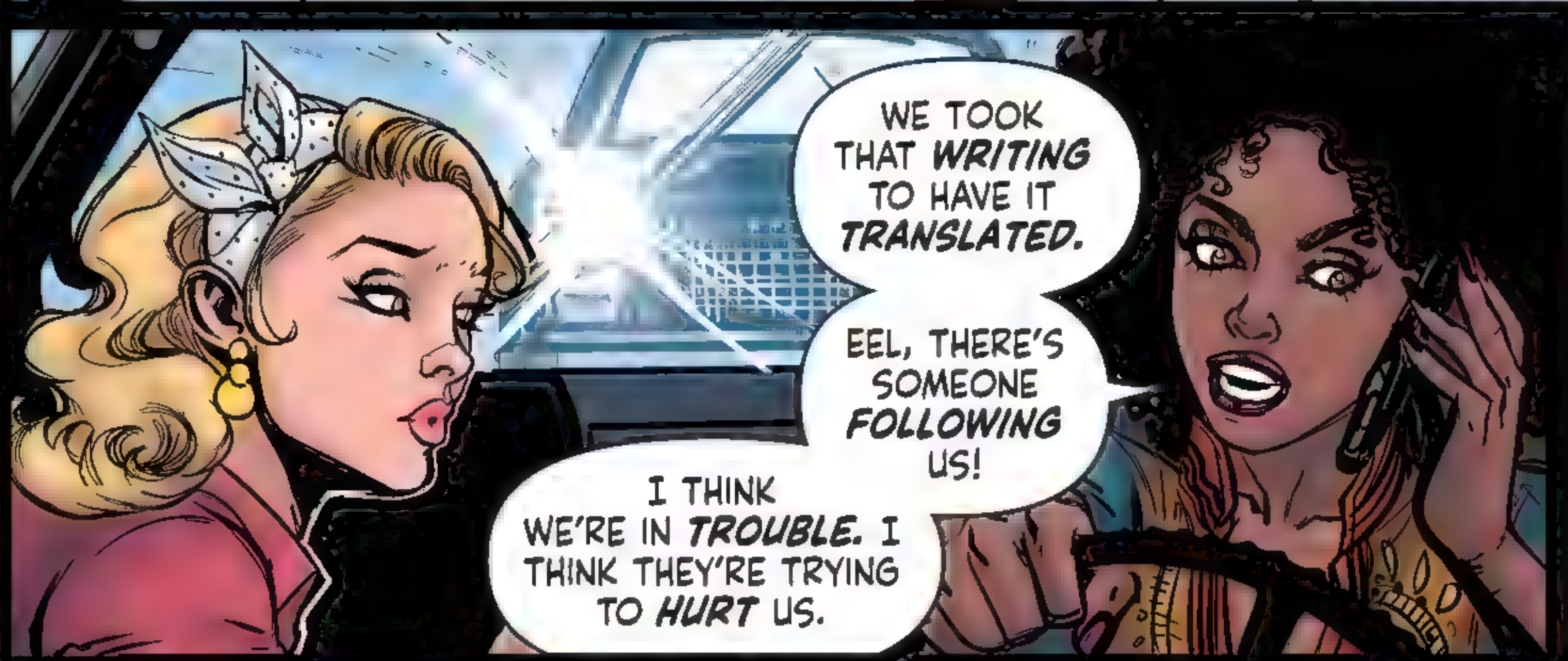


YOU'RE
BEING SILLY.

STOP.

HOLD THAT
UNTAMED SPIRIT
FOR A SEC, OKAY?
IT'S MY OTHER
GIG.

LILA?



WE TOOK
THAT *WRITING*
TO HAVE IT
TRANSLATED.

EEL, THERE'S
SOMEONE
FOLLOWING
US!

I THINK
WE'RE IN *TROUBLE*. I
THINK THEY'RE TRYING
TO *HURT* US.



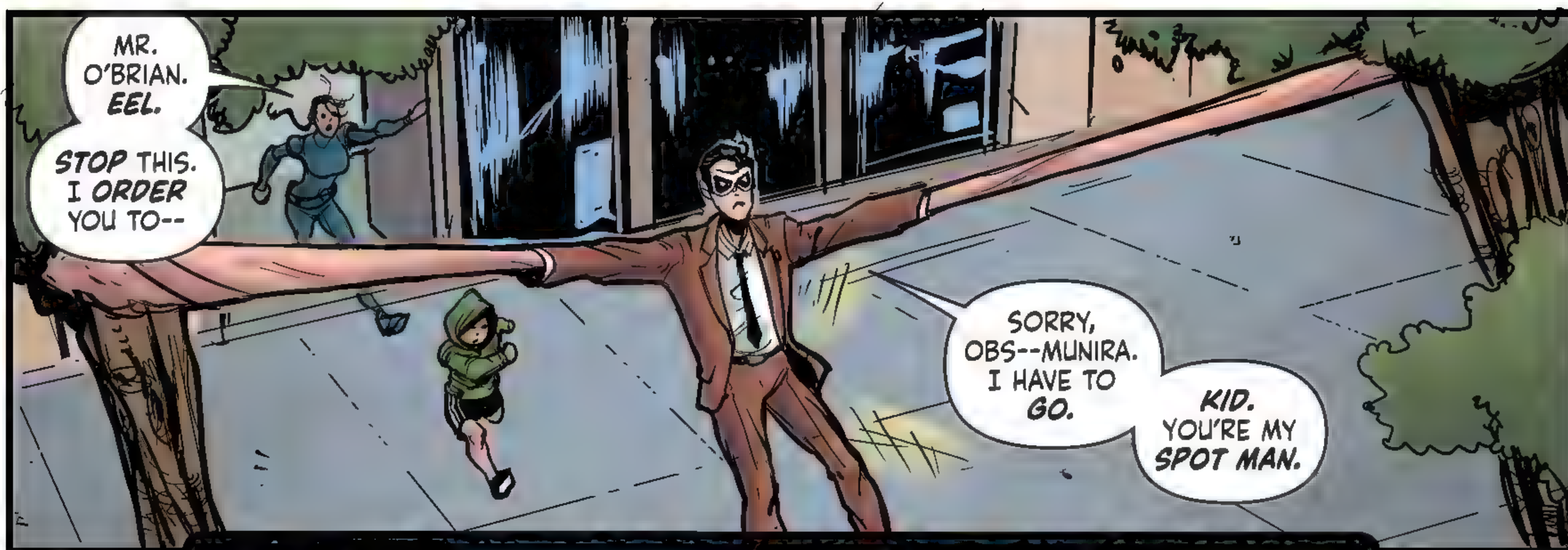
WH...

WHERE
ARE YOU?

WHERE ARE
YOU *RIGHT*
THIS MINUTE,
LILA?

...O'BRIAN?

WHAT'S
HAPPENING?

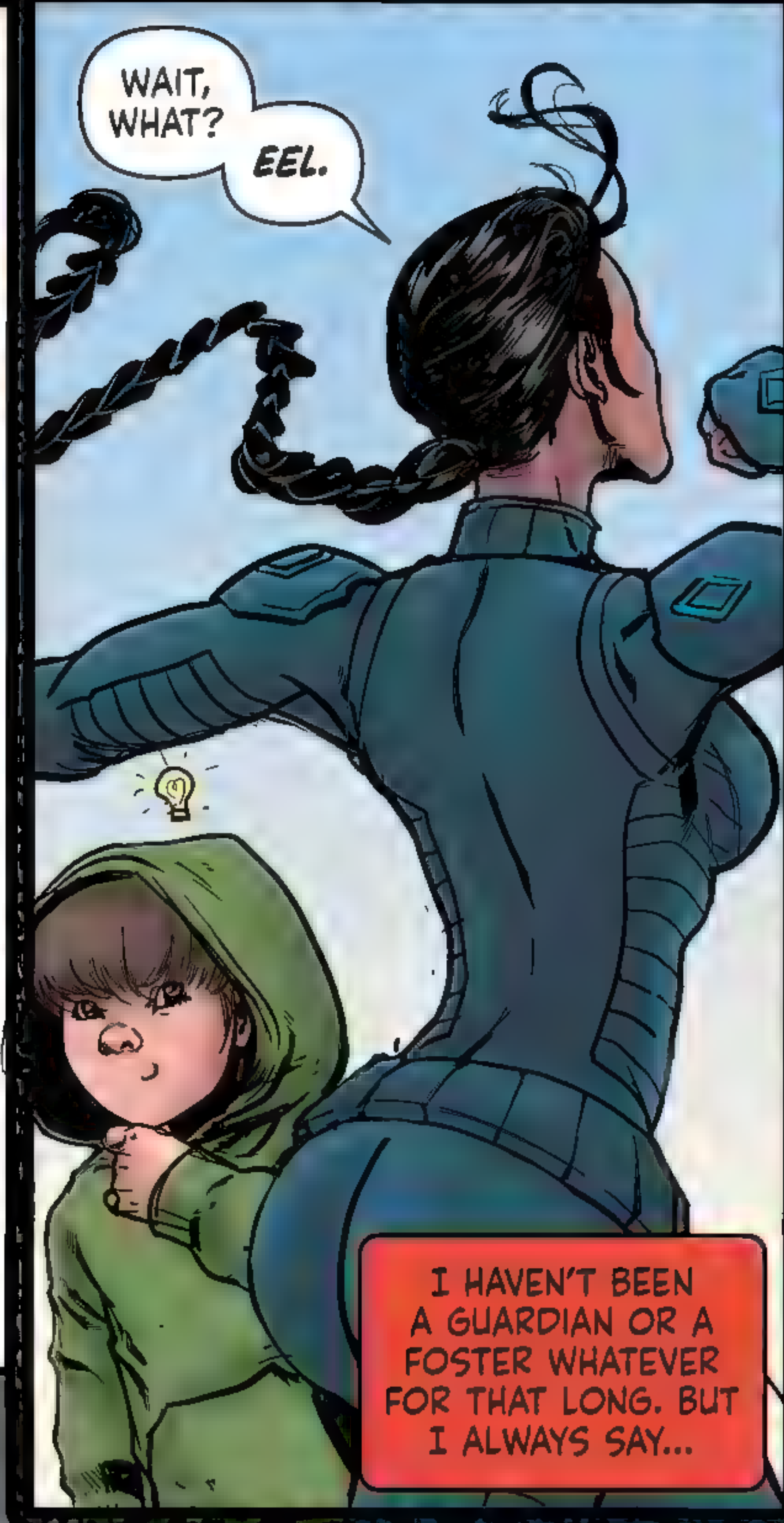


MR.
O'BRIAN.
EEL.

STOP THIS.
I ORDER
YOU TO--

SORRY,
OBS--MUNIRA.
I HAVE TO
GO.

KID.
YOU'RE MY
SPOT MAN.



WAIT,
WHAT?

EEL.

I HAVEN'T BEEN
A GUARDIAN OR A
FOSTER WHATEVER
FOR THAT LONG. BUT
I ALWAYS SAY...

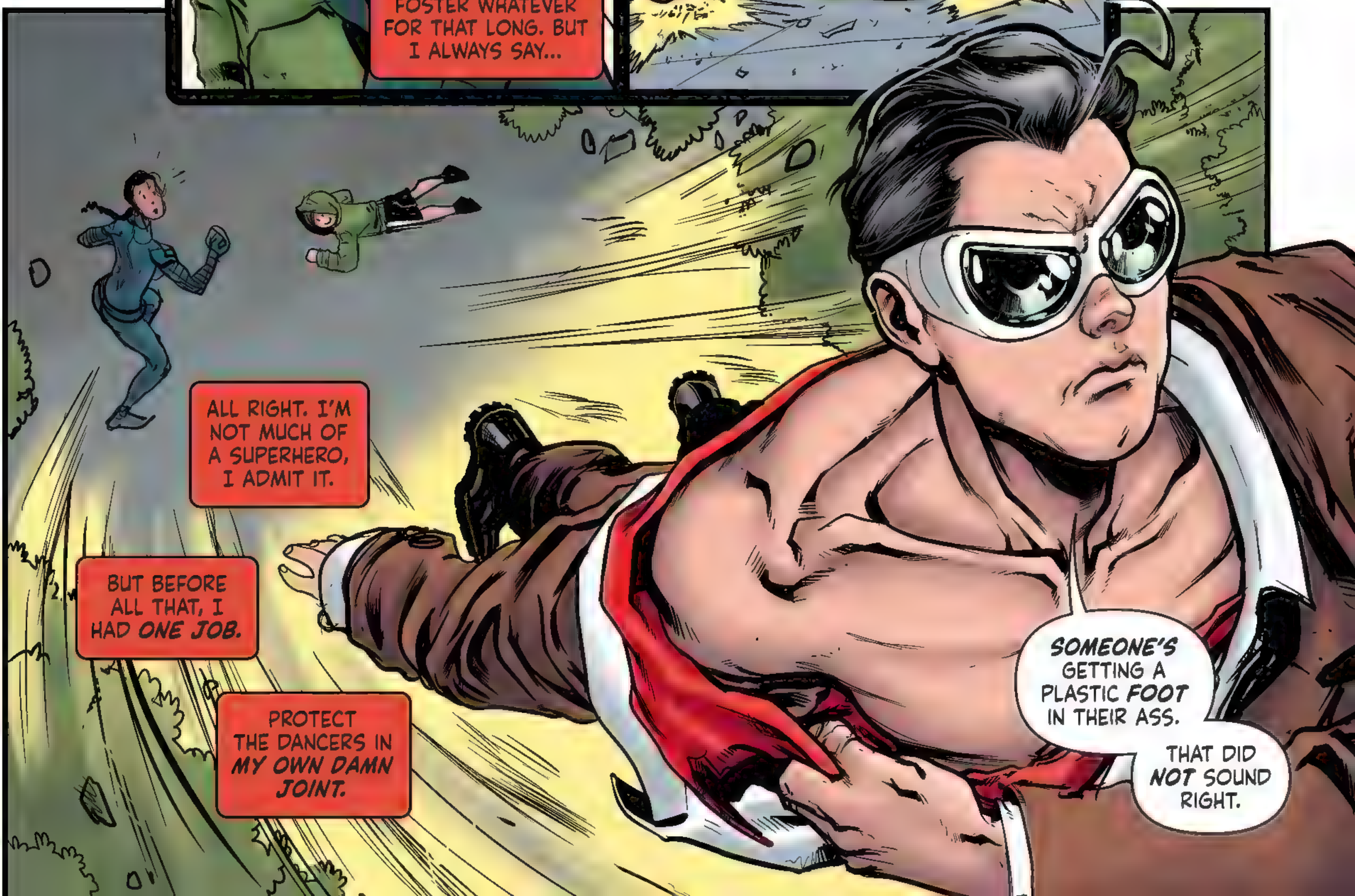


GET YOU A
KID WHO CAN
DO BOTH.

WAAAAUGH!

I WANT
MY MOMMY!
WHERE'S MY
MOMMY?

WAIT.
WHAT?



ALL RIGHT. I'M
NOT MUCH OF
A SUPERHERO,
I ADMIT IT.

BUT BEFORE
ALL THAT, I
HAD ONE JOB.

PROTECT
THE DANCERS IN
MY OWN DAMN
JOINT.

SOMEONE'S
GETTING A
PLASTIC FOOT
IN THEIR ASS.

THAT DID
NOT SOUND
RIGHT.

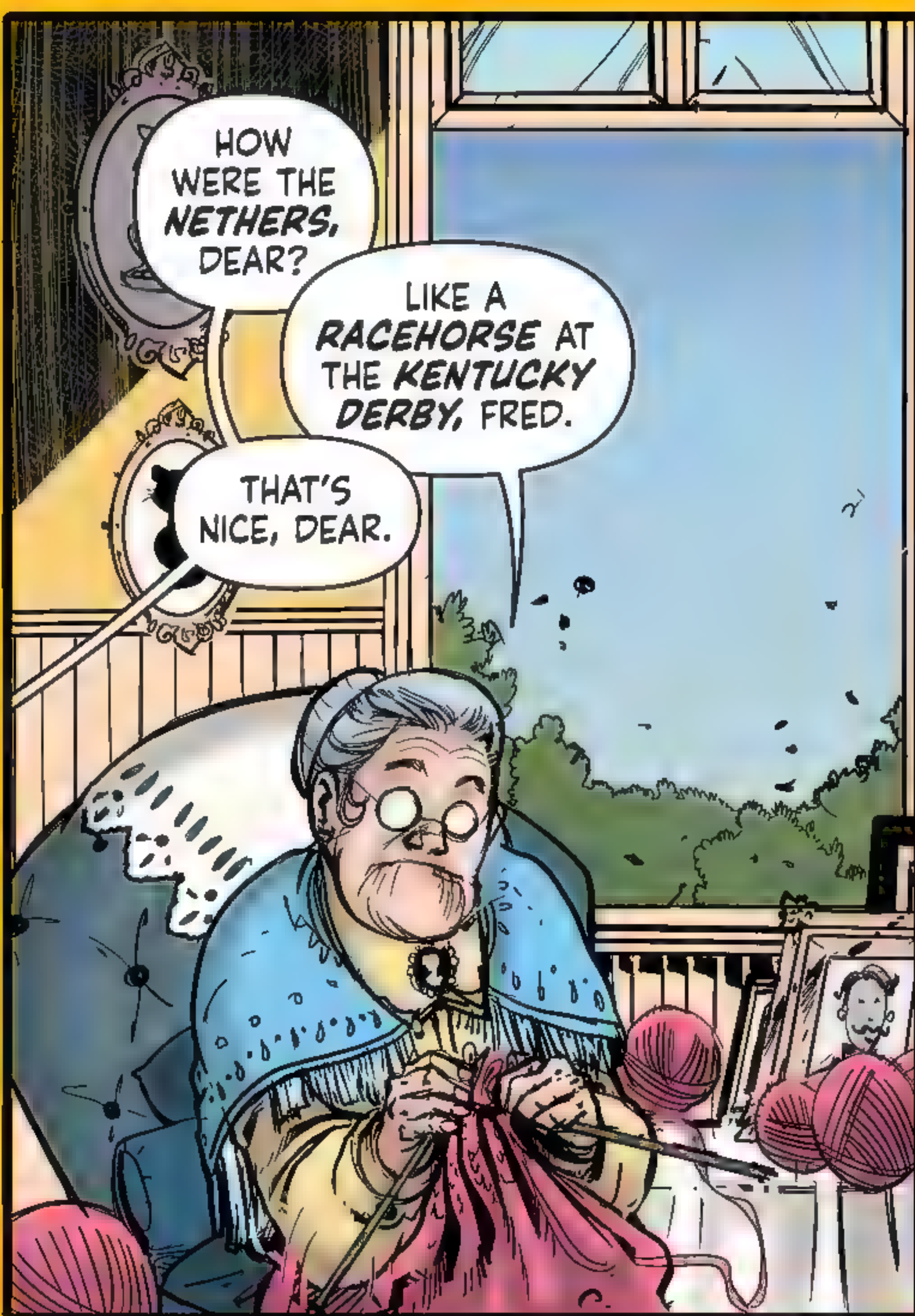


FRED...?

YES,
DEAR?

THEY'RE
FIRING NAKED
MEN ACROSS
THE SKY,
FRED.

THAT'S
NICE, DEAR.



HOW
WERE THE
NETHERS,
DEAR?

LIKE A
RACEHORSE AT
THE *KENTUCKY*
DERBY, FRED.

THAT'S
NICE, DEAR.



OH
CRAP.

YOU
FRIGHTENED
THEM, THOMAS.

I DIDN'T
MEAN TO.

WELL, ALL
RIGHT, I *DID*
MEAN TO, BUT
NOT LIKE
THIS.

DAMN.

JEANNETTE,
CAN YOU TEAR THE
DOOR OFF SO WE
CAN GET THEM
OUT?

PREFERABLY
BEFORE THE CAR
EXPLODES AND
COOKS THEM
ALIVE?

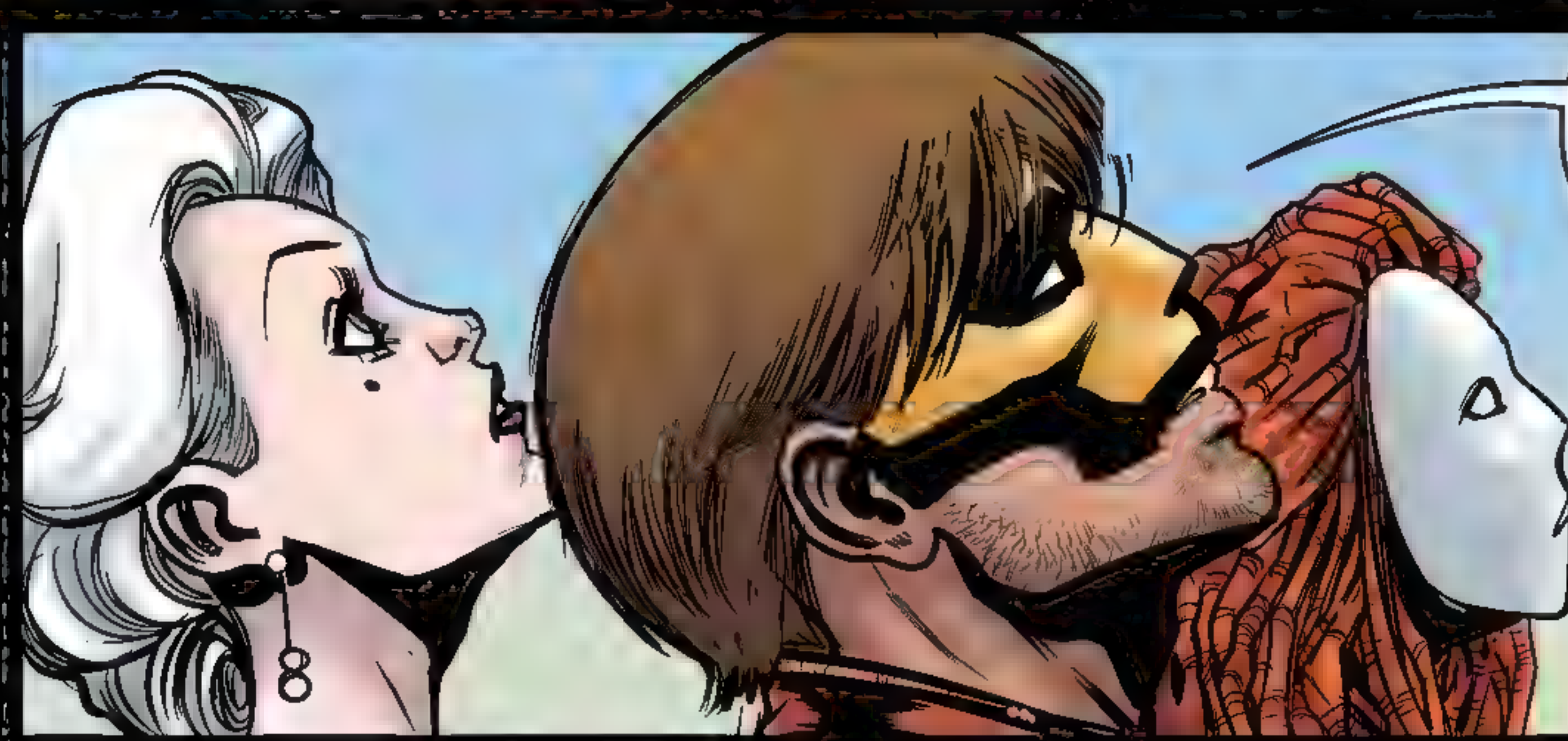


A *MOST*
UNPLEASANT
CAMPFIRE,
THAT!



HEY.
MEATHEADS.

UP
HERE.



OH
MY LUMPY
LITTERBOX.

I KNOW
WHO YOU
ARE.

YOU'RE
WITH THE
SECRET SIX,
RIGHT?

HATE TO
SAY THIS
TO FELLOW
SCUM...



BUT YOU
JUST PISSED
OFF THE
WRONG DAMN
SLINKY!

GET
READY, TEAM.

THOMAS,
DEAR, I'M
ALWAYS
READY.

I DON'T
EVEN KNOW
WHAT'S GOING
ON.

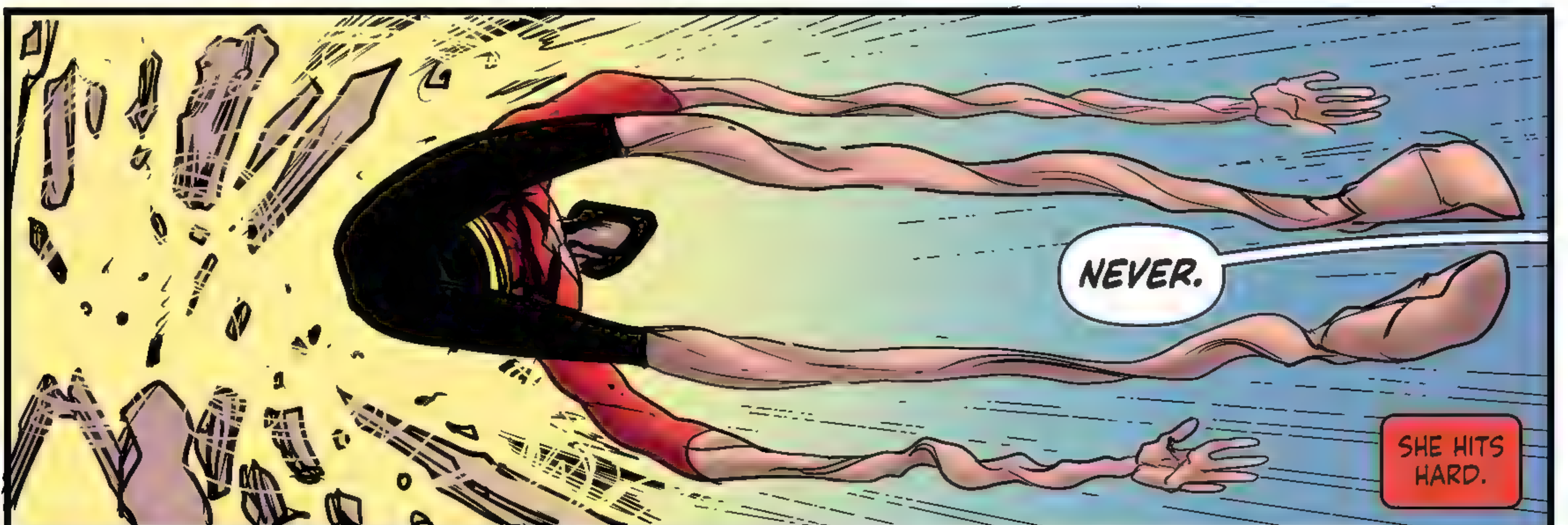
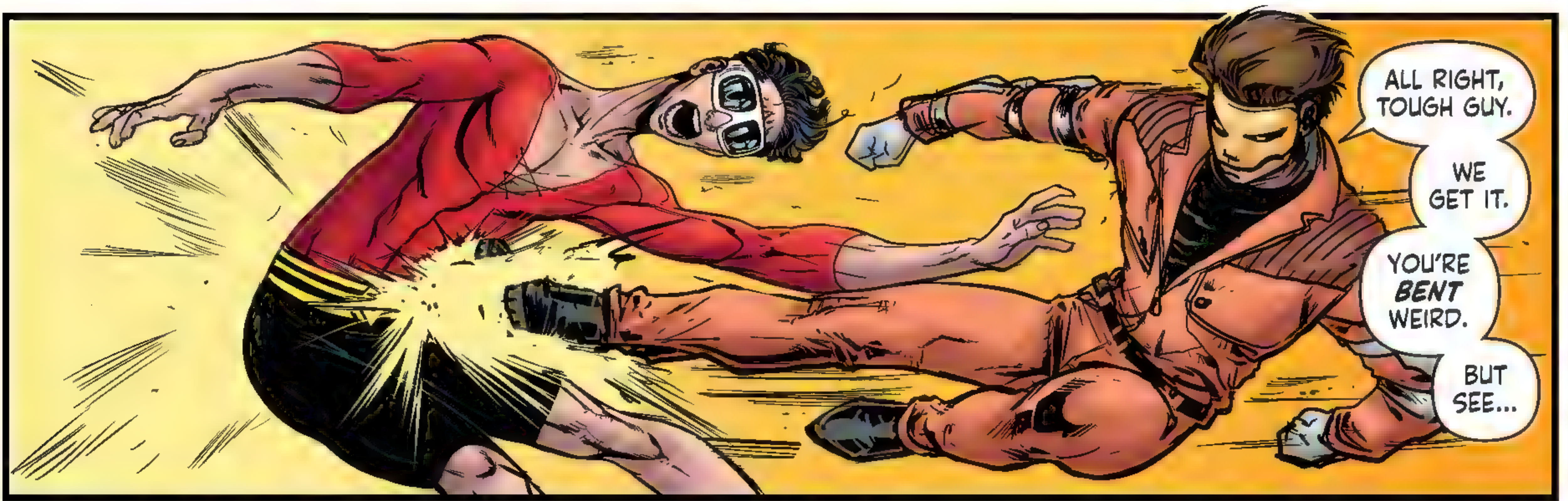
WHY
IS *THIS*
FELLOW SO
SWOLE?

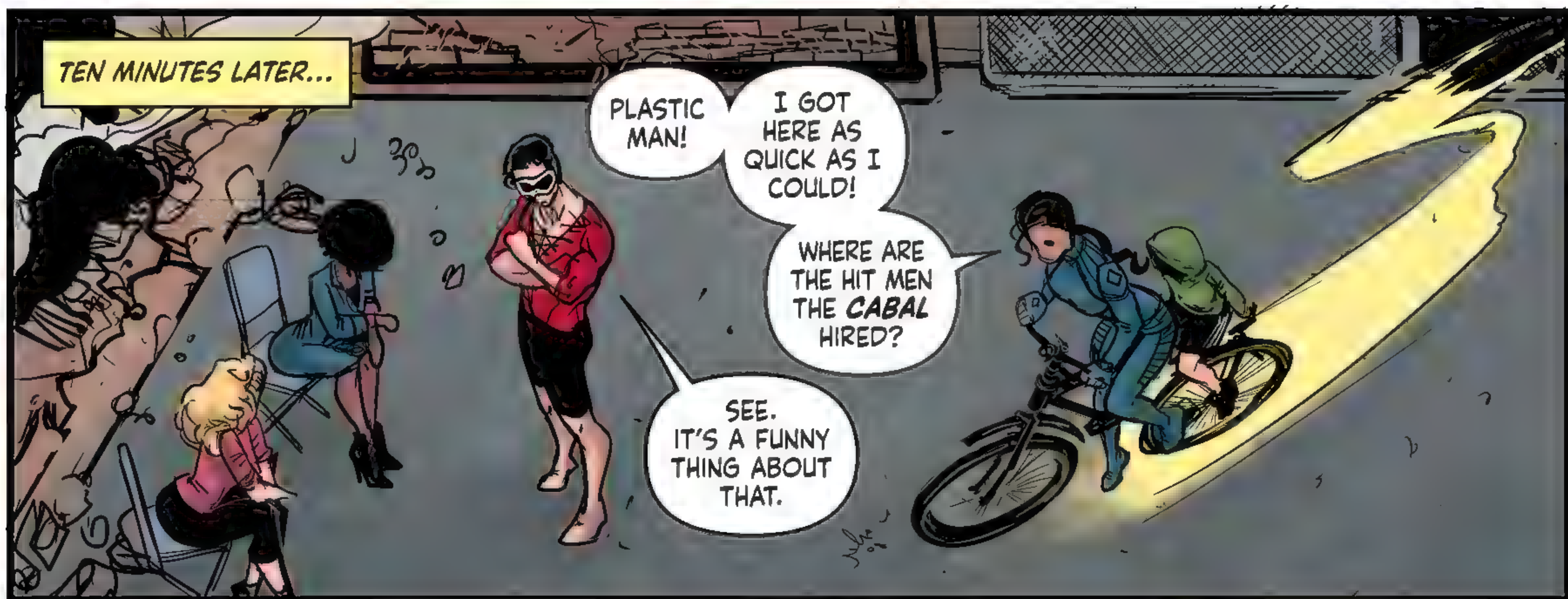
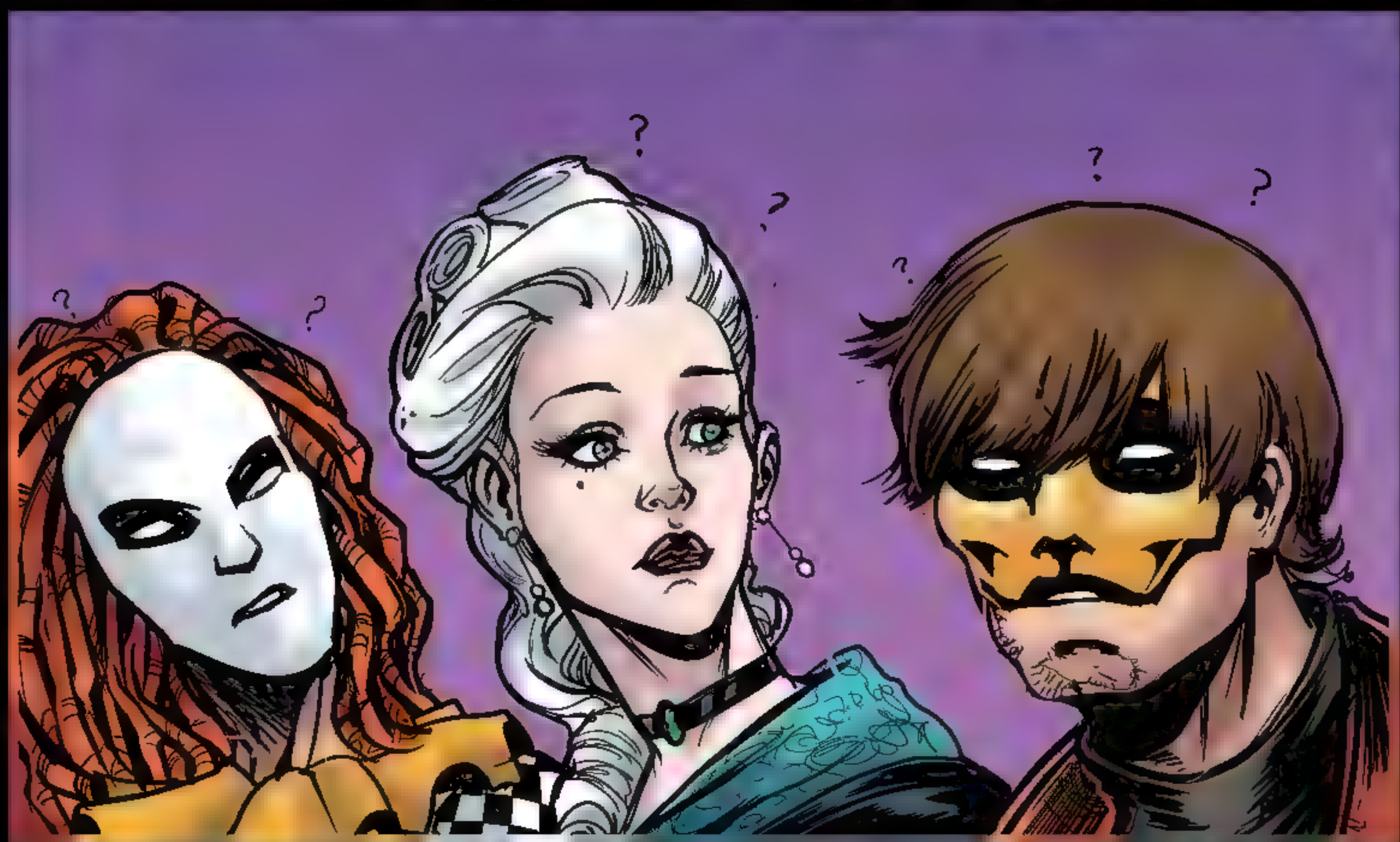
YOU MESS
WITH *MY*
FRIENDS?

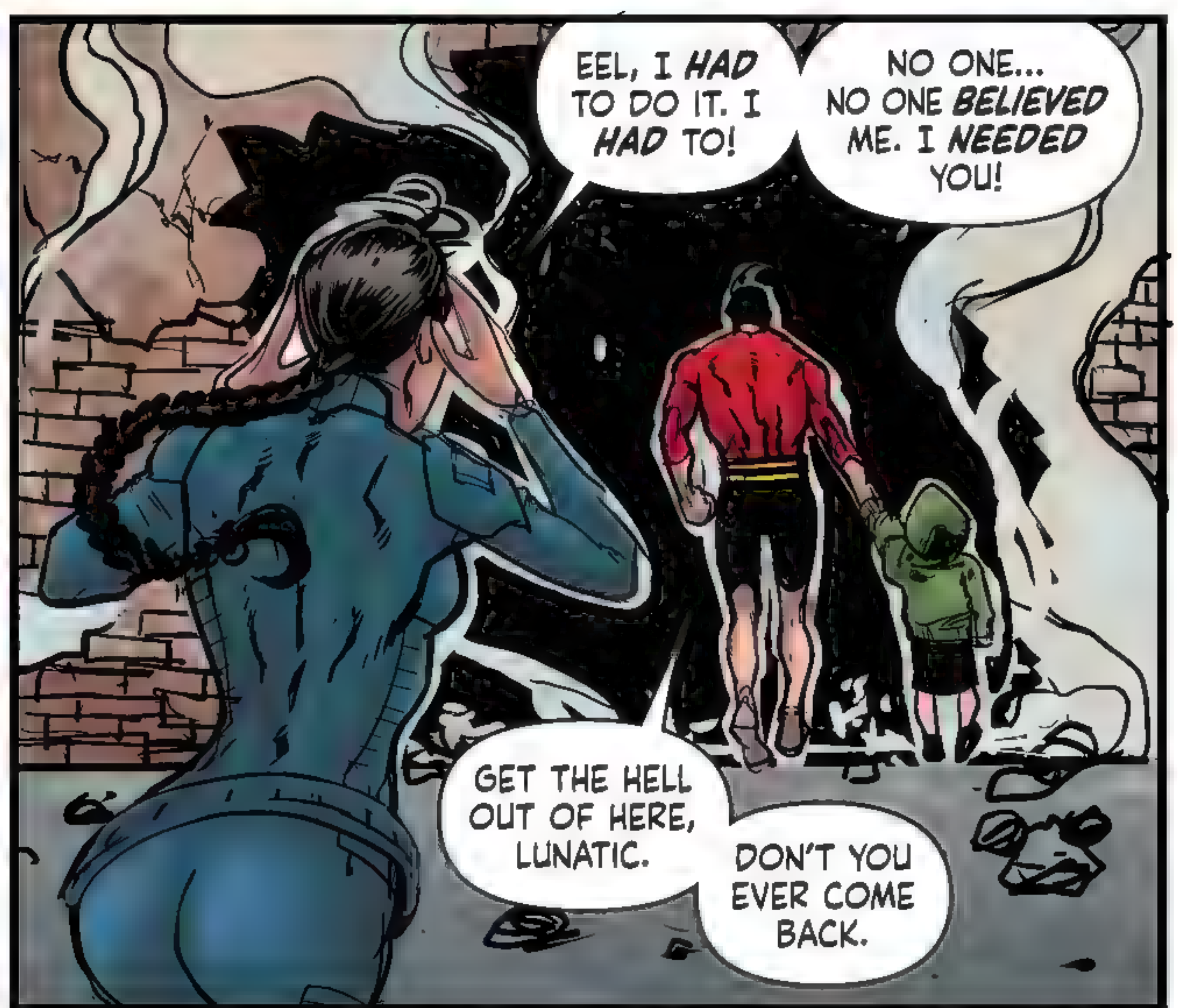
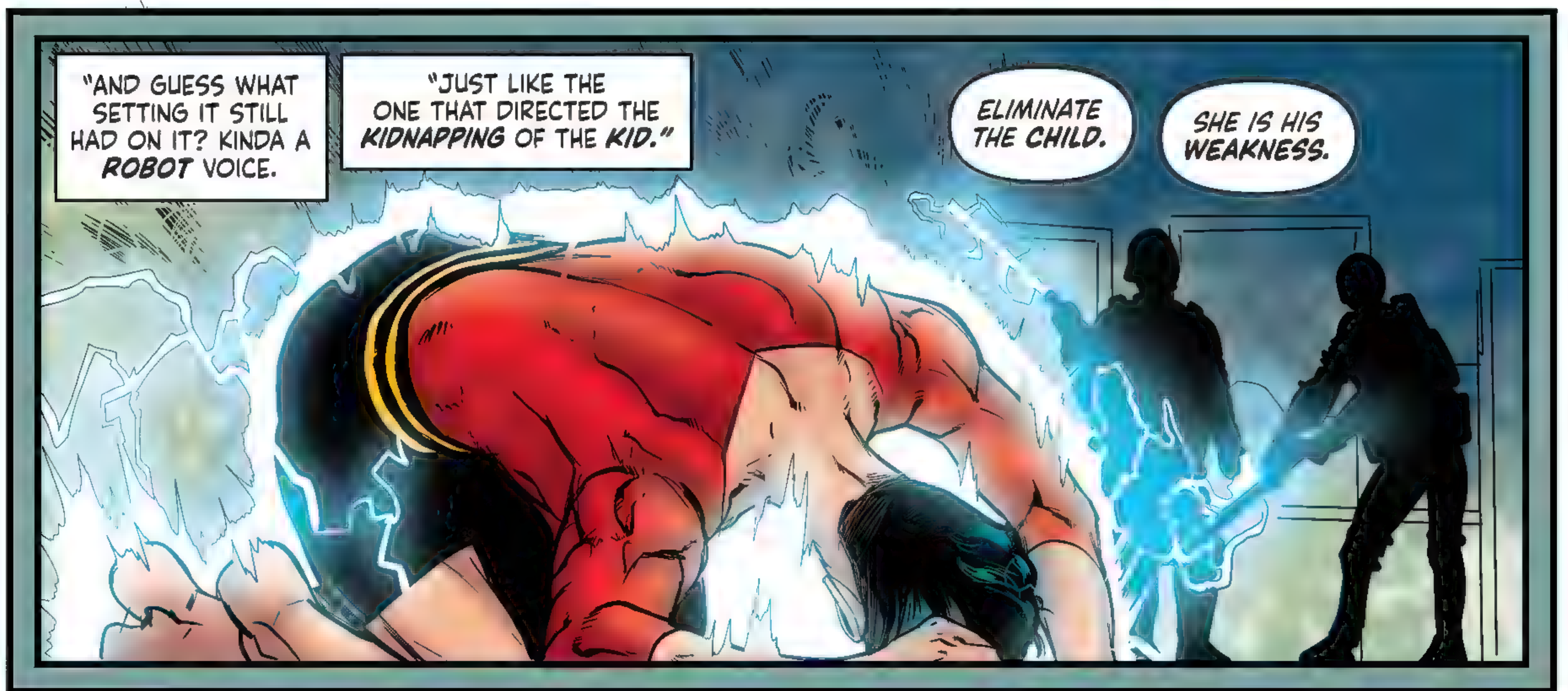
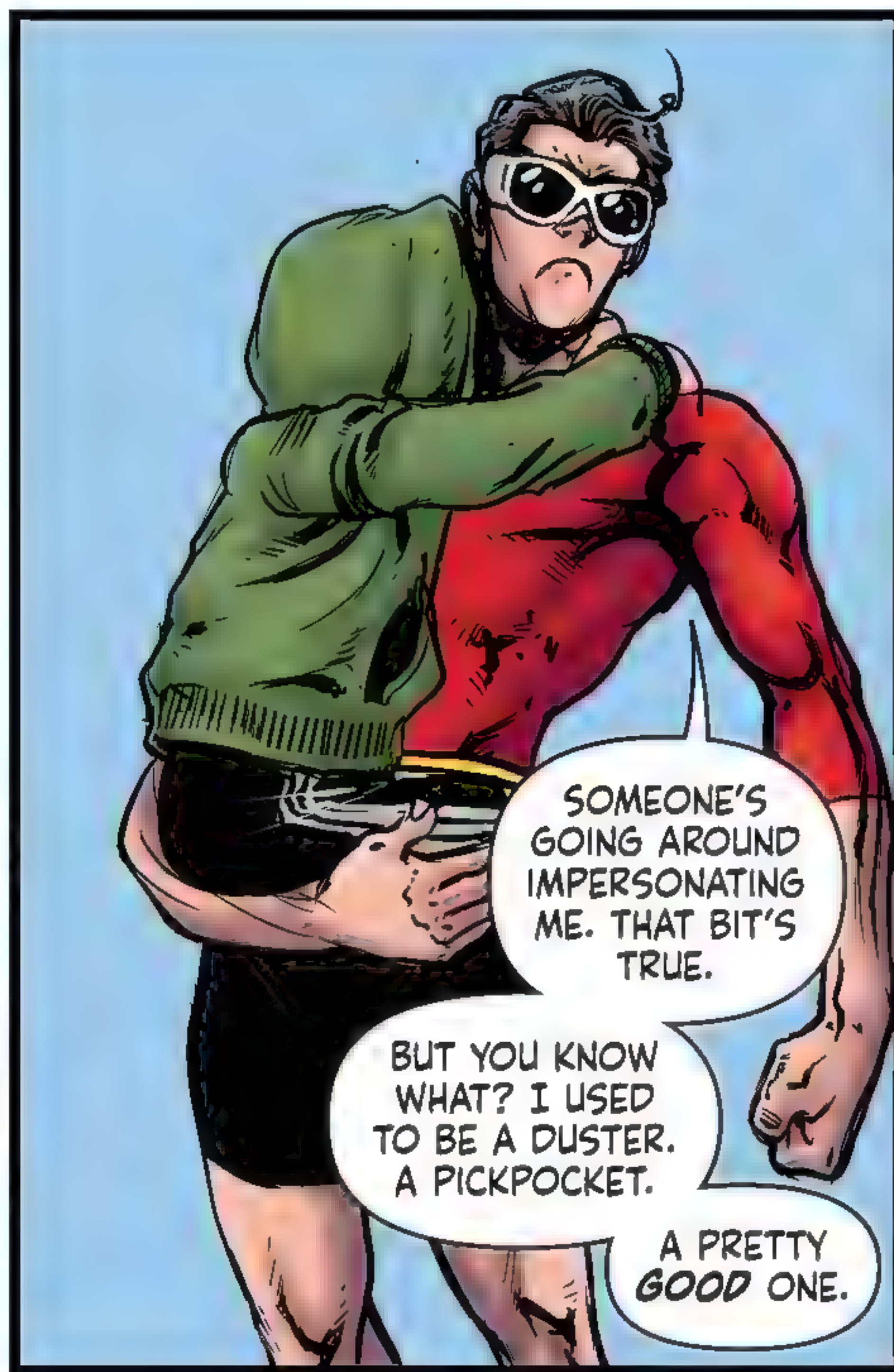
AT *MY*
CLUB?











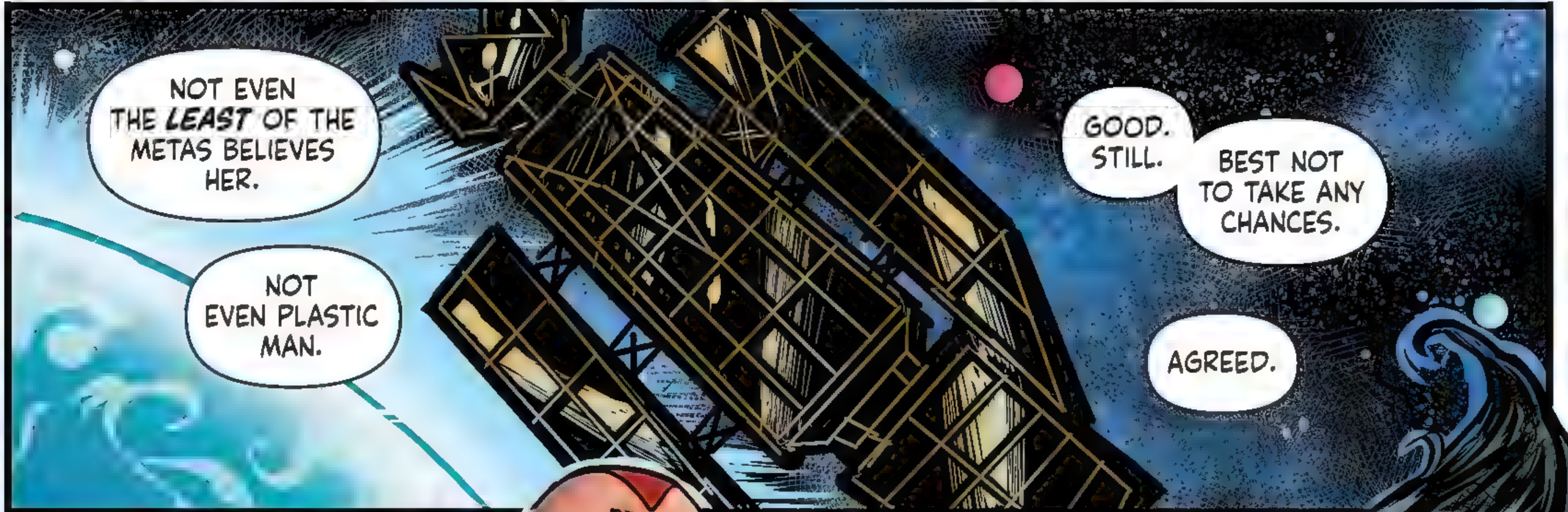


AH. THAT
WENT BETTER
THAN WE COULD
HAVE HOPED
FOR.

POOR
LITTLE AGENT,
DISGRACED AND
ALONE.

AGREED.

AGREED.



NOT EVEN
THE **LEAST** OF THE
METAS BELIEVES
HER.

NOT
EVEN PLASTIC
MAN.

GOOD.
STILL.

BEST NOT
TO TAKE ANY
CHANCES.

AGREED.



AGREED.

AGREED.

AGREED.



CHAPTER FIVE

THE WRONG MAN TO SAVE THEM

Cover art by Tess Fowler
with Tamra Bonvillian

OKAY, SO LET
ME GET YOU
ALL CAUGHT
UP, RIGHT?

SO I WAS A JERK, A GRIFTER, A
CREEP, BUT WAS TOTALLY GOOD IN
THE SACK, YADDA YADDA, GOOD IN
THE SACK, YADDA YADDA, STOLE
MILK FROM BABIES, WAS GOOD IN
THE SACK, YOU GET THE DRIFT.

THEN SOME WEIRDNESS,
I GOT COVERED IN TOXIC
GOOP, MY OWN GANG
THREW ME OUT OF A CAR,
AND THAT WAS THE *NICE*
PART OF THE EVENING.

AND I WAKE UP
WITH POWERS.
NOT THE USEFUL
KIND, EXACTLY.

MOSTLY THE WEIRD
KIND. I FEEL LIKE I'M
IN PERPETUAL PUBERTY.
BITS ARE GROWING
WHEN THEY SHOULDN'T
DOUGHTA

AND I HAVE THIS IDEA,
WHAT IF I MAYBE TRIED TO
MAKE UP FOR SOME OF
THE SH...STUFF I DONE?
WHAT ABOUT THAT?

*I KNOW. KEEP
DREAMING, EEL.*

BUT THEN I MEET THIS
GIRL, HER NAME'S *OBSCURA*.
AND SHE SAYS THERE'S THIS
ORGANIZATION OF JUST THE
ROTTENEST MANGOES,
RIGHT?

AND I CAN BE
THE ONE TO TAKE
THEM DOWN. BE
A HERO.

NOT BE
A RAT.

AND I JUMP
AT IT. I JUST
JUMP WHEN SHE
CALLS. ONLY--

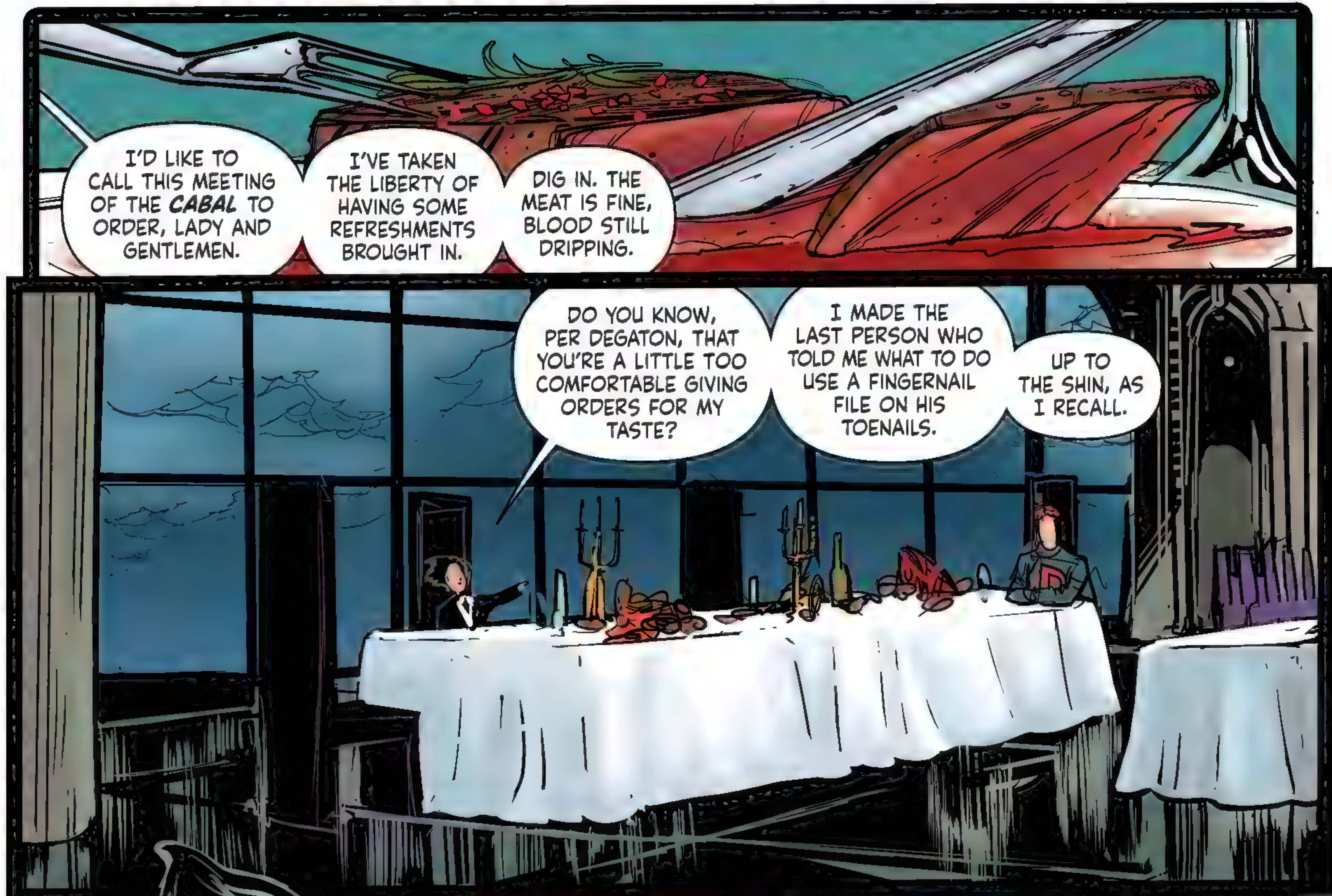
SHE *LIED* TO
ME. THERE *AIN'T*
NO ORGANIZATION.
THERE *AIN'T* NO
"CABAL."

AND THAT,
DEAR PALS...

...LEAVES ME
A *CHUMP*.

The WRONG MAN to SAVE THEM





I'D LIKE TO
CALL THIS MEETING
OF THE **CABAL** TO
ORDER, LADY AND
GENTLEMEN.

I'VE TAKEN
THE LIBERTY OF
HAVING SOME
REFRESHMENTS
BROUGHT IN.

DIG IN. THE
MEAT IS FINE,
BLOOD STILL
DRIPPING.

DO YOU KNOW,
PER DEGATON, THAT
YOU'RE A LITTLE TOO
COMFORTABLE GIVING
ORDERS FOR MY
TASTE?

I MADE THE
LAST PERSON WHO
TOLD ME WHAT TO DO
USE A FINGERNAIL
FILE ON HIS
TOENAILS.

UP TO
THE SHIN, AS
I RECALL.



THE SMELL
OF THE FOOD
YOU EAT IZZZ
REVOLTING.

BUT DR.
PSYCHO IZZZ
CORRECT,
DEGATON.

THE CABAL
WILL BROOK NO
GENERALZZZ.

NONE OF
UZZZ HAVE BENT
A KNEE TO MAN
NOR GOD.

IT
IZZZ UNLIKELY
WE WOULD
TOLERATE SUCH
A POZZITION
NOW.



...



YOU ARE
CORRECT, MY
DEAR QUEEN.

I LET MORTAL
MANNERS BETRAY
THE **NATURE** OF
THIS GROUP.

IF ANY OF
US EVER **HAD**
BOWED TO
ANYONE...

...THEN
WE'D NOT BE
MEMBERS,
WOULD WE?



AMAZO
JOINED FOR THE
PURPOSES OF SIMPLE
MATHEMATICS.

PREVIOUS SUCH
COLLABORATIONS
FAILED BECAUSE OF
THE **WEAKNESS** OF
THEIR **CIRCUITRY.**



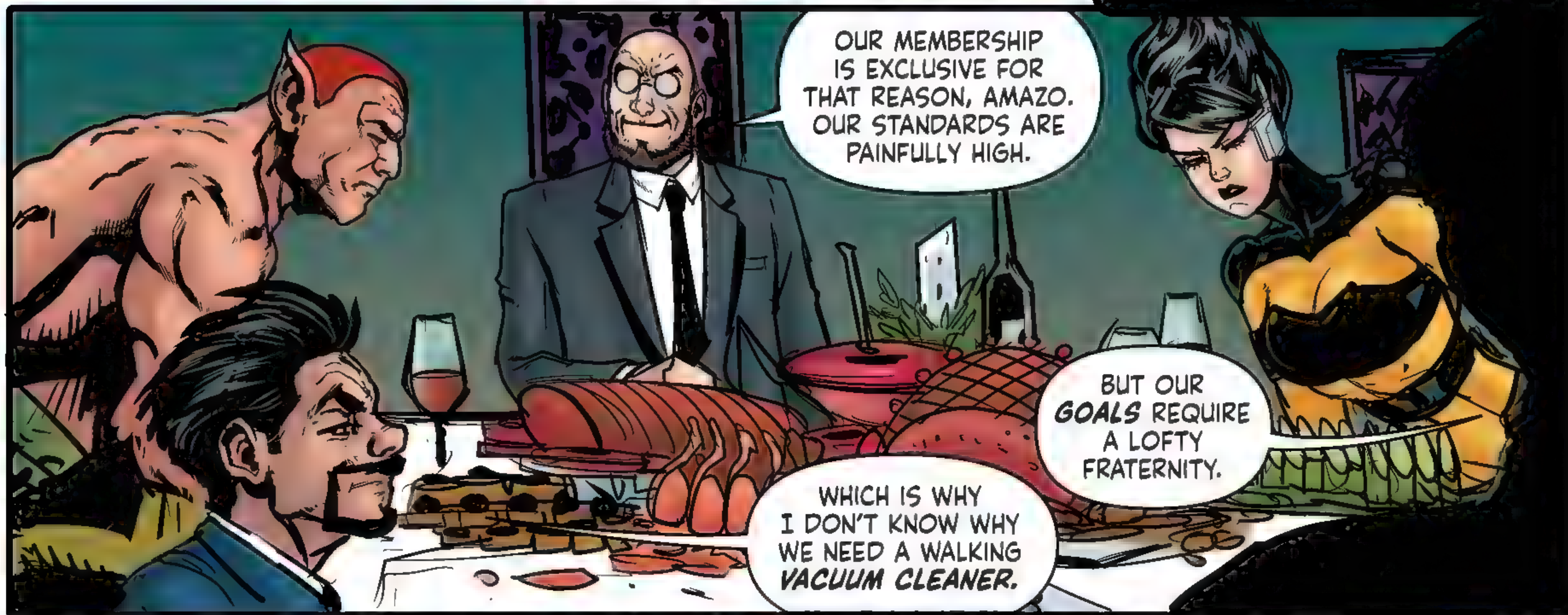
"WHAT **MATTER** IF AN ORGANIZATION HAS A DEGATON, A HUGO STRANGE, AN **AMAZO**.

"IF THAT **SAME** ORGANIZATION ALSO LEAVES A PLACE AT THE TABLE FOR CRAZY QUILT? FOR MR. TERRIBLE?



THE BUG IN THE SMALLEST CIRCUIT INFECTS THE ENTIRE MOTHERBOARD.

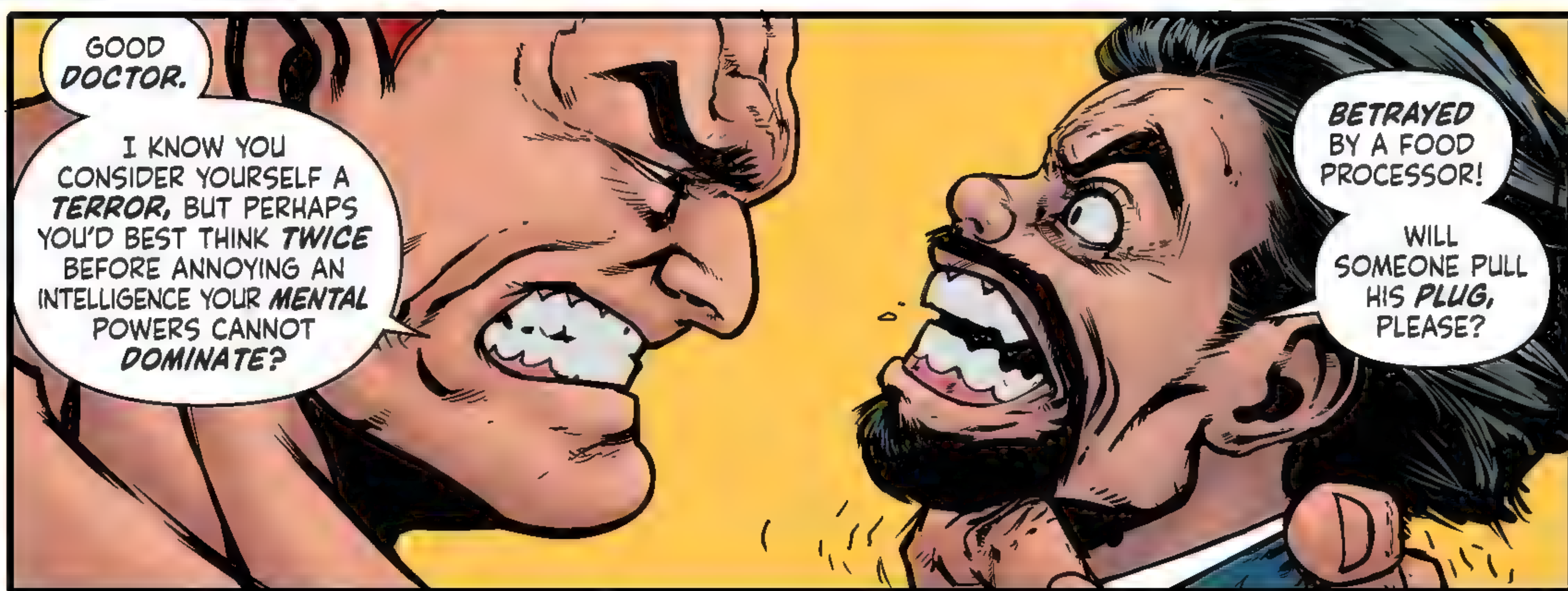
CAREFUL WITH THE "**BUG**" TALK, ROBOT.



OUR MEMBERSHIP IS EXCLUSIVE FOR THAT REASON, **AMAZO**. OUR STANDARDS ARE PAINFULLY HIGH.

BUT OUR **GOALS** REQUIRE A LOFTY FRATERNITY.

WHICH IS WHY I DON'T KNOW WHY WE NEED A WALKING **VACUUM CLEANER**.

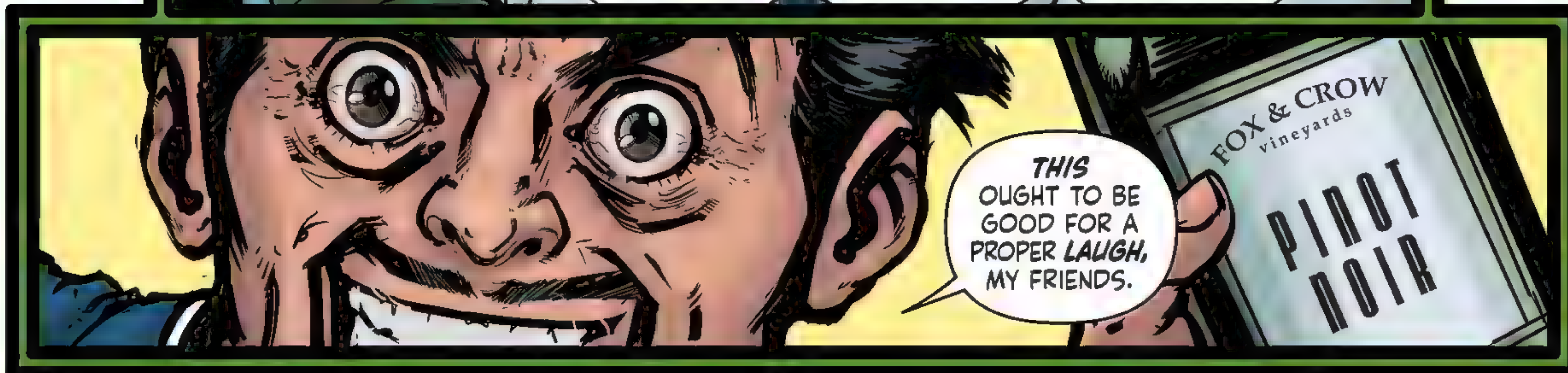
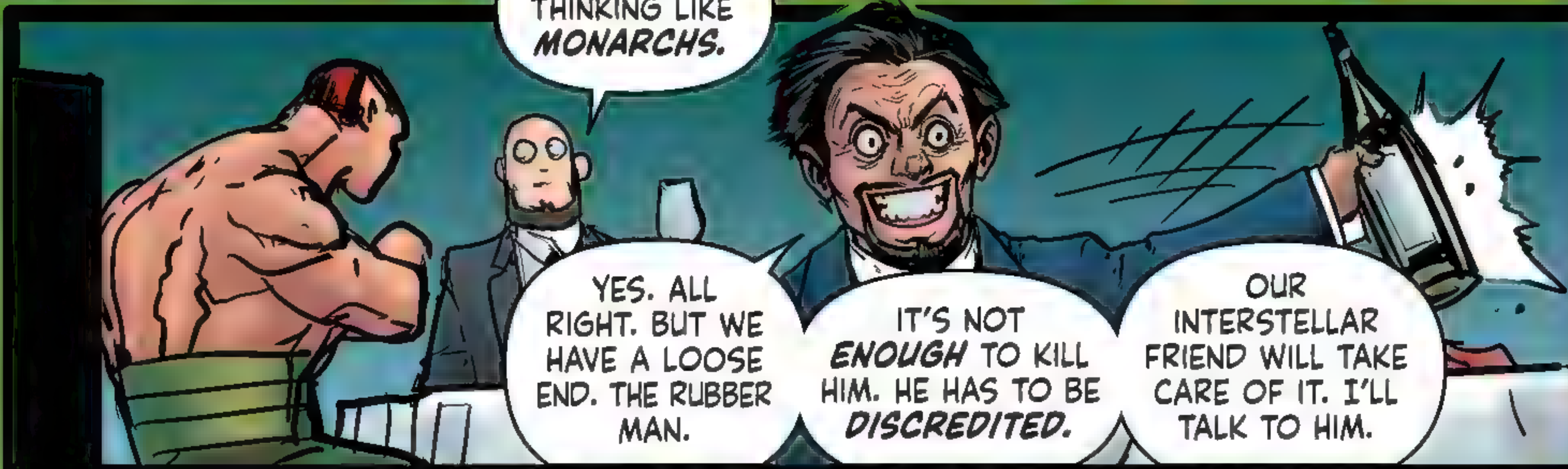
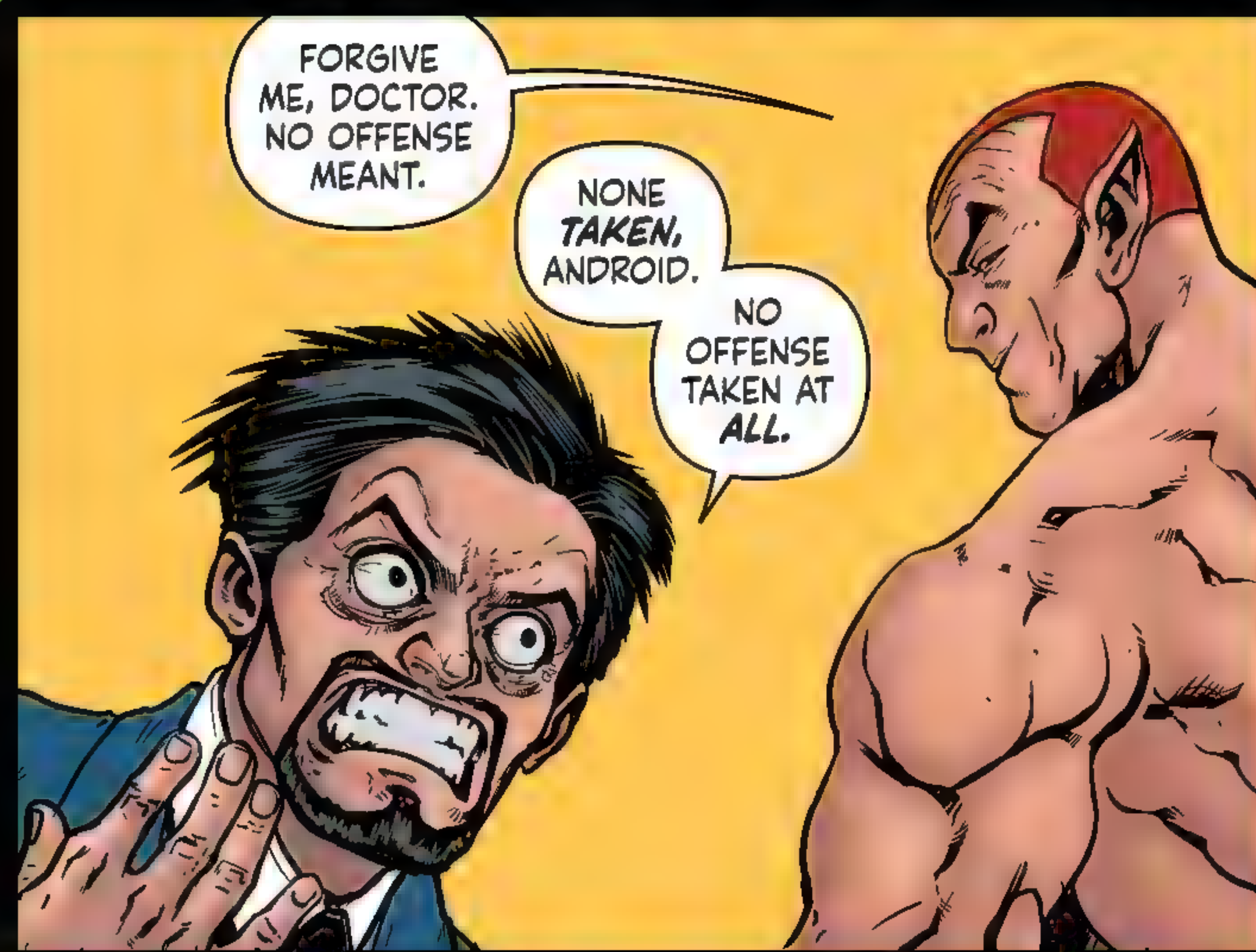
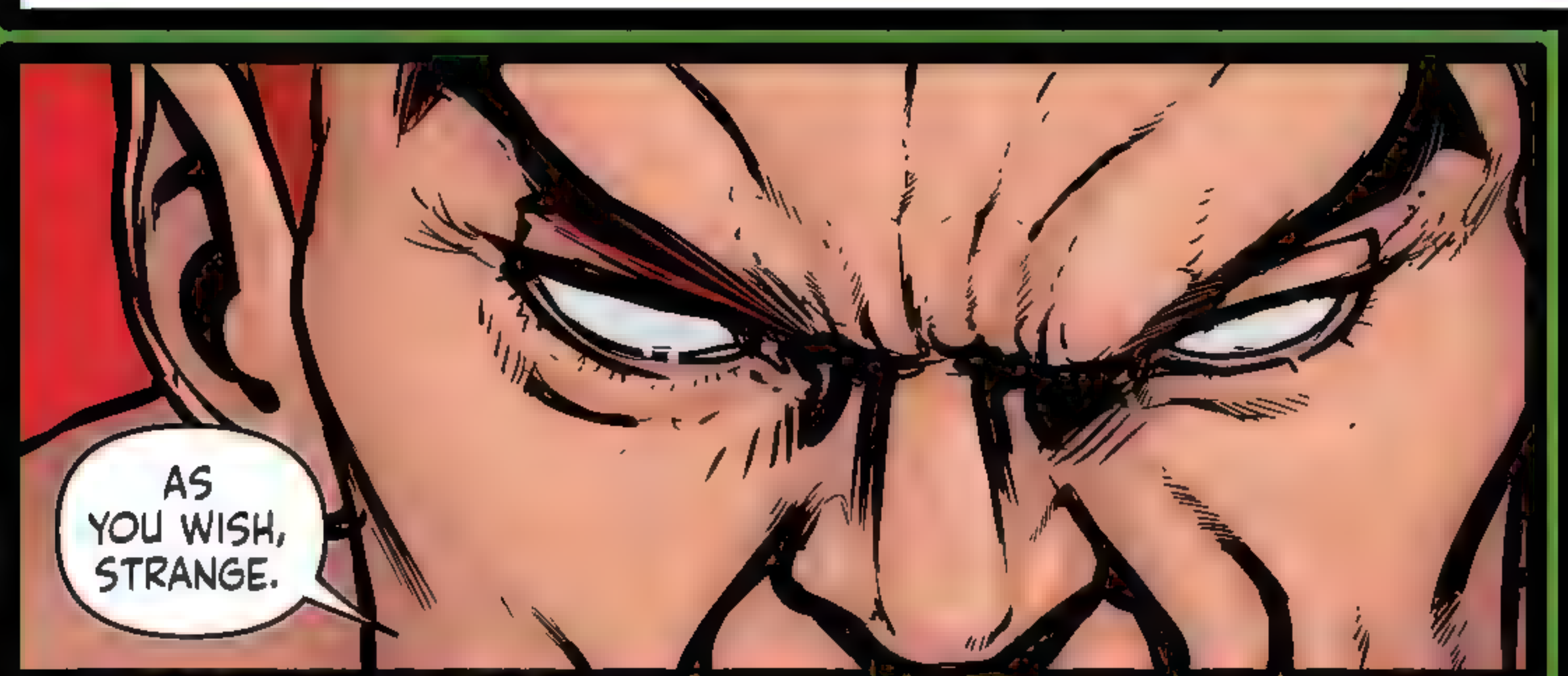


GOOD **DOCTOR**.

I KNOW YOU CONSIDER YOURSELF A **TERROR**, BUT PERHAPS YOU'D BEST THINK **TWICE** BEFORE ANNOYING AN INTELLIGENCE YOUR **MENTAL** POWERS CANNOT **DOMINATE**?

BETRAYED BY A FOOD PROCESSOR!

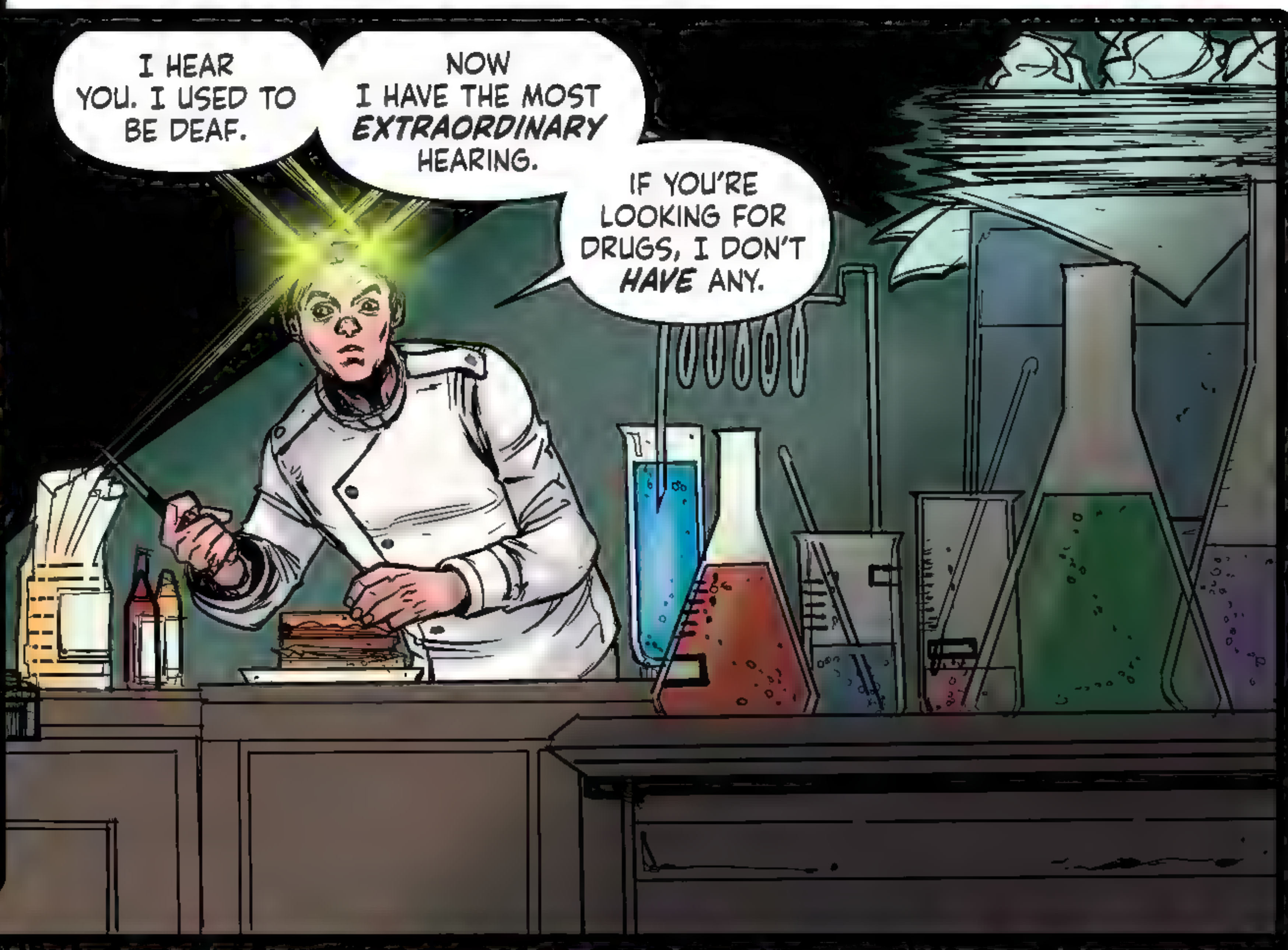
WILL SOMEONE PULL HIS **PLUG**, PLEASE?





Eh...?

HELLO?



I HEAR
YOU. I USED TO
BE DEAF.

NOW
I HAVE THE MOST
EXTRAORDINARY
HEARING.

IF YOU'RE
LOOKING FOR
DRUGS, I DON'T
HAVE ANY.



I KNOW
SOMEONE'S
IN HERE.

LEAVE
NOW.

OR...
OR...

SOMEONE
BAD'S GOING TO HAVE
THE REST OF THIS
CONVERSATION.



SO
BE IT.

I
WARNED
YOU.



YOU KNOW,
THIS ONE TIME,
I **JUST** HAD MY CAR
WASHED. AND WE'RE
TALKING **CHERRY**,
RIGHT?

AND I RUN
INTO THE STORE
TO GRAB SOME
BREATH MINTS FOR
A HOT DATE.

AND I COME
BACK, JUST A
HUGE DUMP OF
GUANO RIGHT
ON THE **HOOD**,
MAN.

SO,
I HAVE TO
ASK...



WAS THAT
YOU, PROFESSOR
LANGSTROM?

THIS POOR
FURRY GONE
WRONG, HIS NAME'S
PROFESSOR *KIRK*
LANGSTROM.

HE WAS IN
WITH OBSCURA'S
SCHEME, TO TRICK
ME INTO BELIEVING
IN THE *CABAL*.

HE'S JUST A
POOR SAP WITH
A CONDITION,
REALLY.

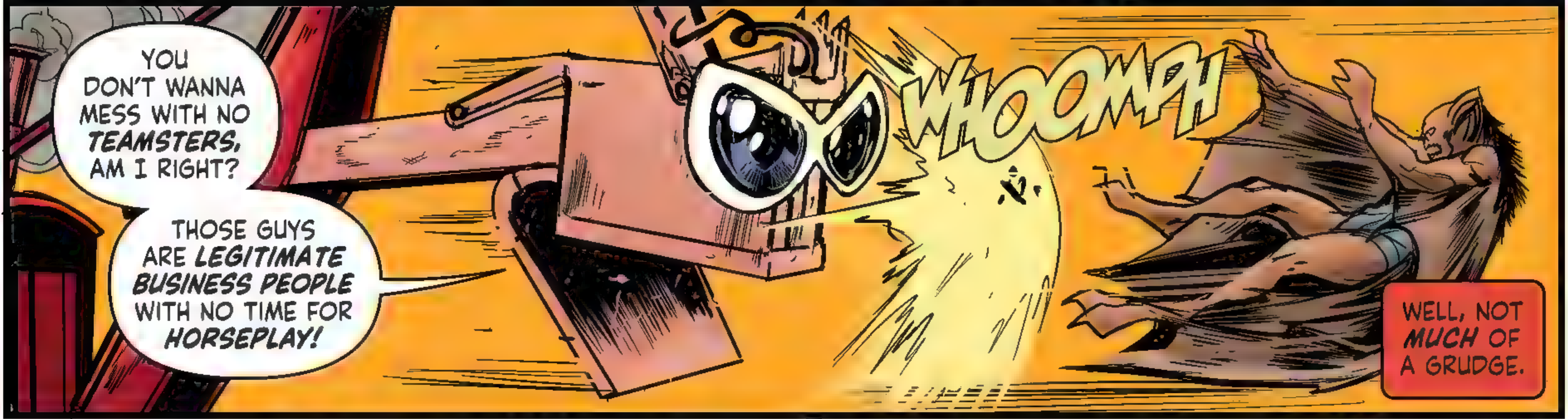
NEEDS A BUCK
LIKE ANY GRIM
STREET DOPE.



SO DON'T
WORRY, I AIN'T
HOLDING A
GRUDGE OR
ANYTHING.

AH, AH, AH,
PROFESSOR.

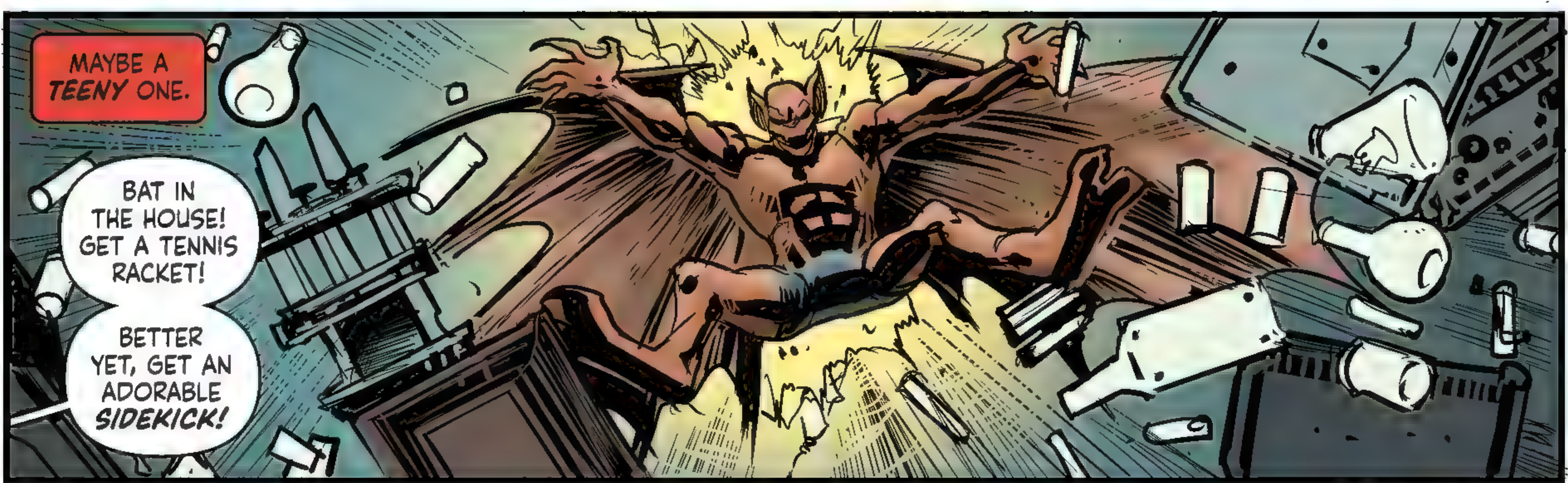
THIS HERE'S
A UNION JOB,
AND BELIEVE
ME...



YOU
DON'T WANNA
MESS WITH NO
TEAMSTERS,
AM I RIGHT?

THOSE GUYS
ARE **LEGITIMATE**
BUSINESS PEOPLE
WITH NO TIME FOR
HORSEPLAY!

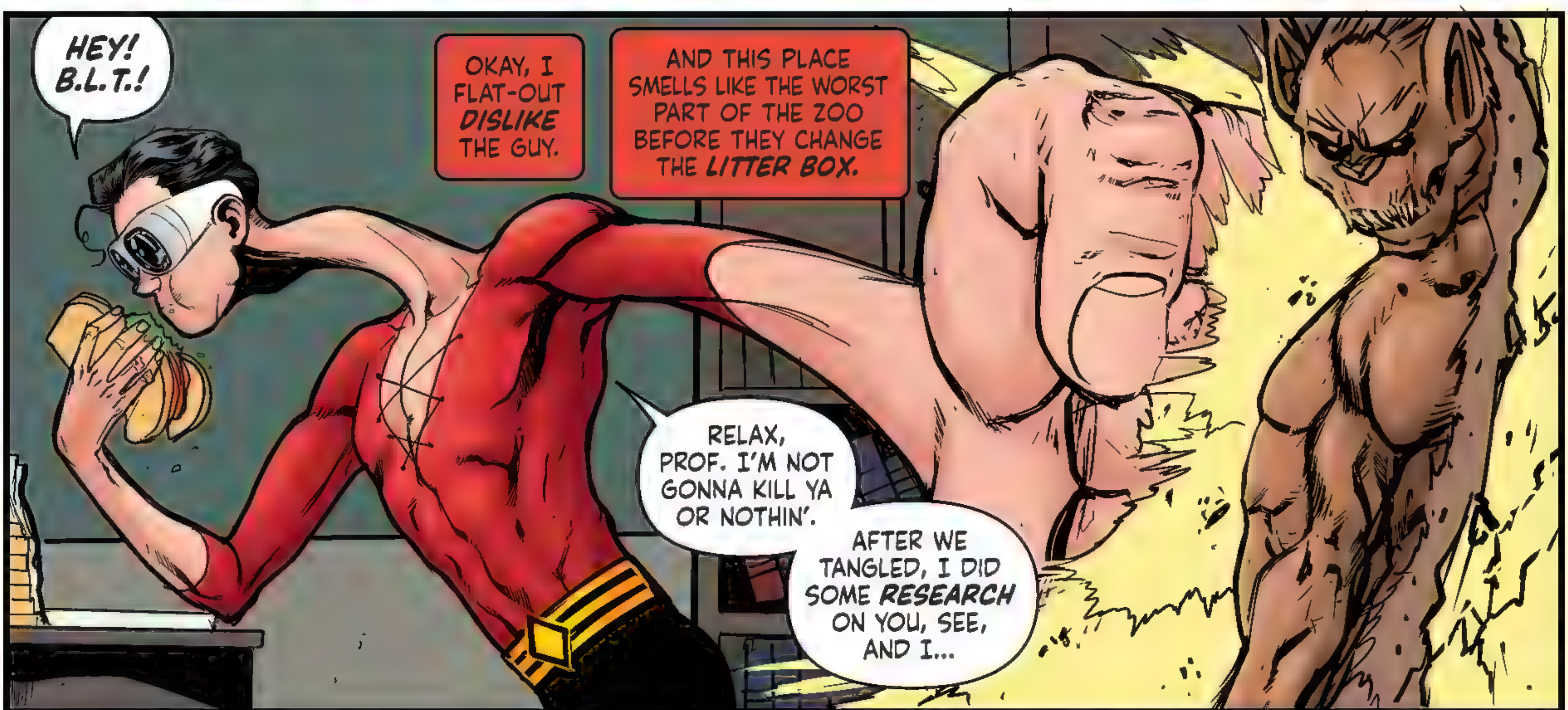
WELL, NOT
MUCH OF
A GRUDGE.



MAYBE A
TEENY ONE.

BAT IN
THE HOUSE!
GET A TENNIS
RACKET!

BETTER
YET, GET AN
ADORABLE
SIDEKICK!



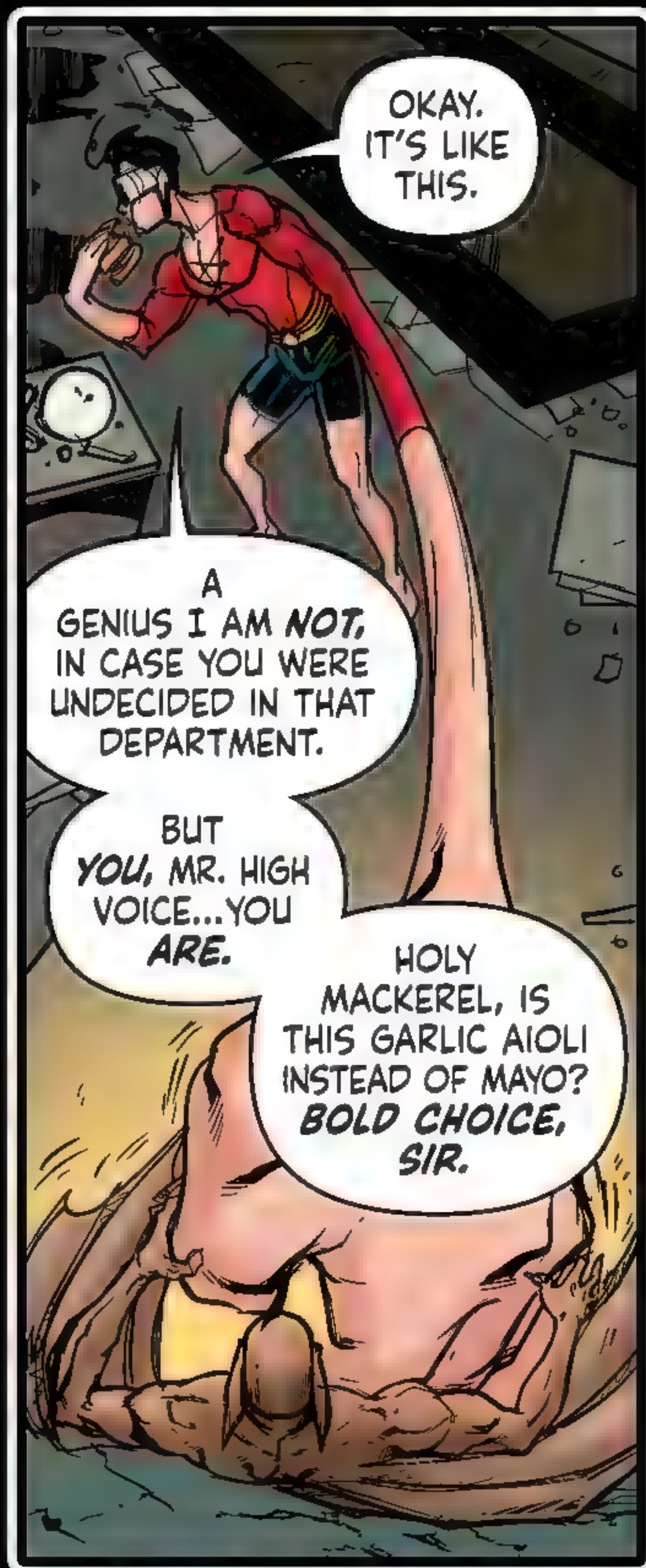
HEY!
B.L.T.!

OKAY, I
FLAT-OUT
DISLIKE
THE GUY.

AND THIS PLACE
SMELLS LIKE THE WORST
PART OF THE ZOO
BEFORE THEY CHANGE
THE **LITTER BOX.**

RELAX,
PROF. I'M NOT
GONNA KILL YA
OR NOTHIN'.

AFTER WE
TANGLED, I DID
SOME **RESEARCH**
ON YOU, SEE,
AND I...

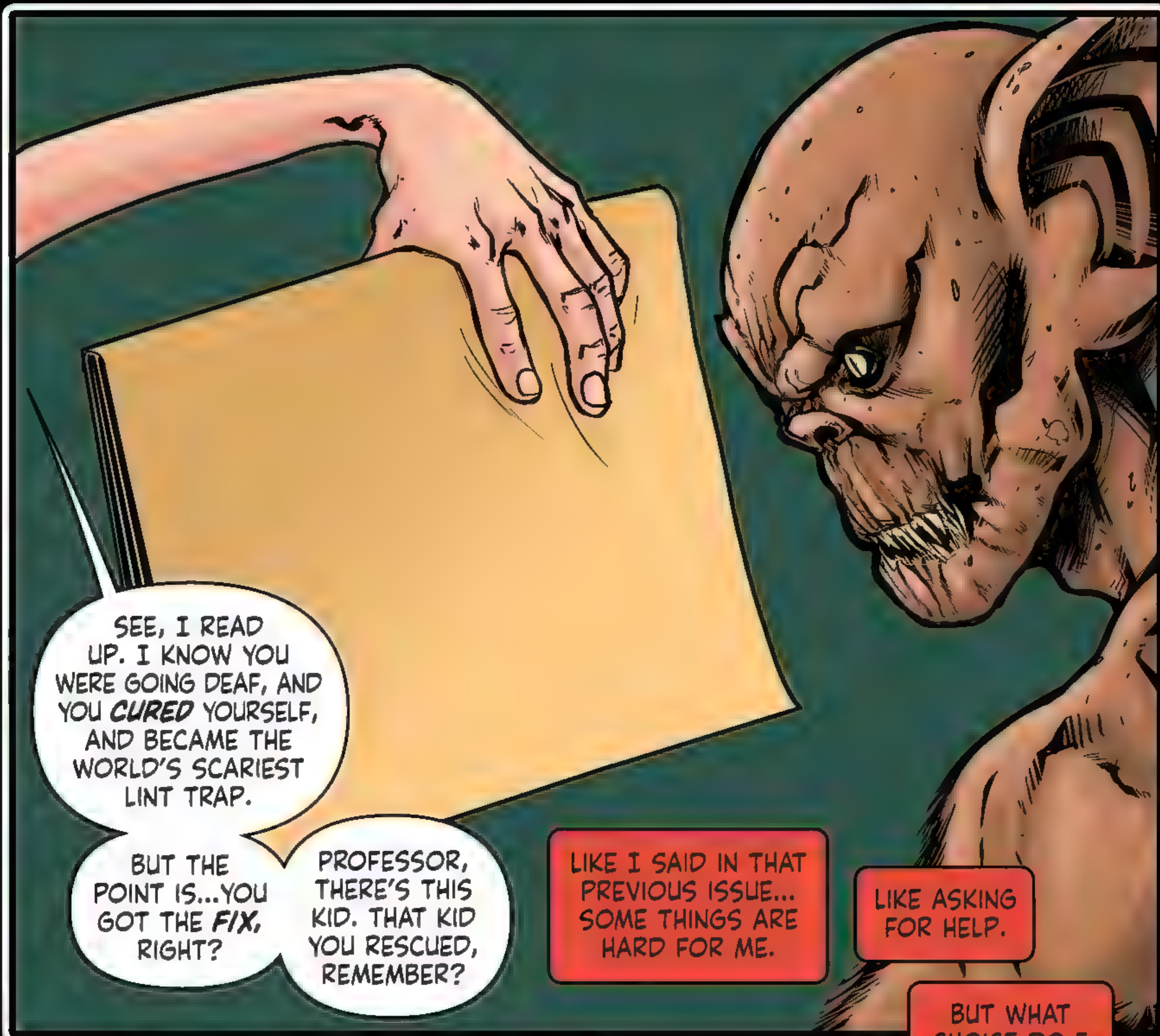


OKAY.
IT'S LIKE
THIS.

A
GENIUS I AM *NOT*,
IN CASE YOU WERE
UNDECIDED IN THAT
DEPARTMENT.

BUT
YOU, MR. HIGH
VOICE...YOU
ARE.

HOLY
MACKEREL, IS
THIS GARLIC AIOLI
INSTEAD OF MAYO?
**BOLD CHOICE,
SIR.**



SEE, I READ
UP. I KNOW YOU
WERE GOING DEAF, AND
YOU *CURED* YOURSELF,
AND BECAME THE
WORLD'S SCARIEST
LINT TRAP.

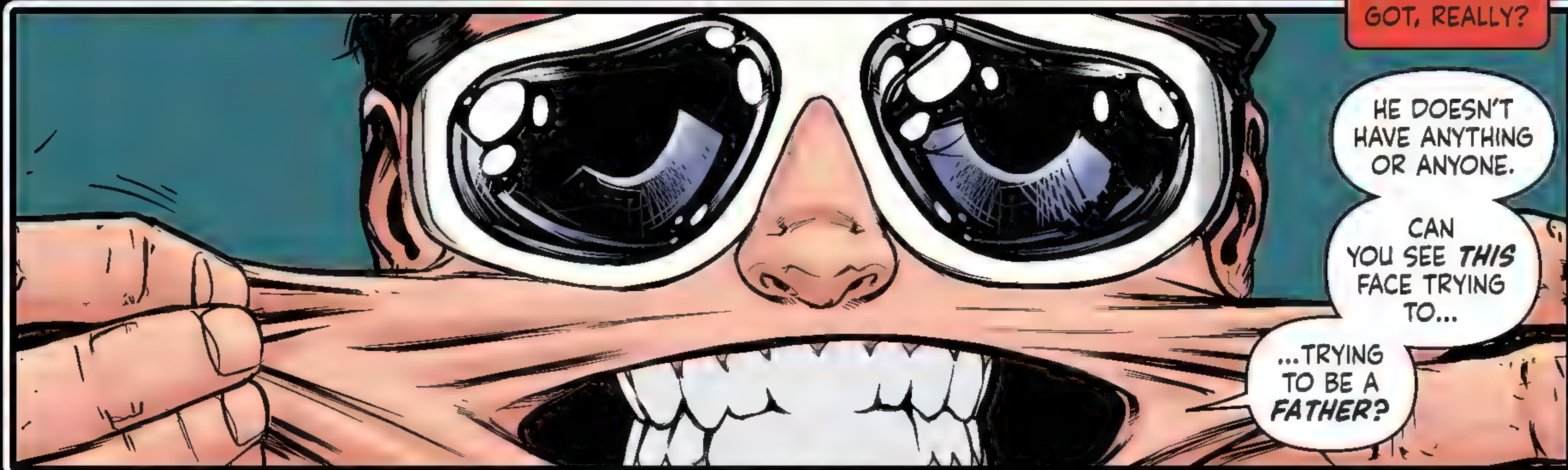
BUT THE
POINT IS...YOU
GOT THE *FIX*,
RIGHT?

PROFESSOR,
THERE'S THIS
KID. THAT KID
YOU RESCUED,
REMEMBER?

LIKE I SAID IN THAT
PREVIOUS ISSUE...
SOME THINGS ARE
HARD FOR ME.

LIKE ASKING
FOR HELP.

BUT WHAT
CHOICE DO I
GOT, REALLY?



HE DOESN'T
HAVE ANYTHING
OR ANYONE.

CAN
YOU SEE *THIS*
FACE TRYING
TO...

...TRYING
TO BE A
FATHER?



PLEASE, PROFESSOR.
TELL ME THE REAL GUY,
THE GUY WHO ONCE HAD
HUMAN DREAMS, IS STILL
IN THERE.

HELP
ME.

CURE
ME.



CAN'T.

WOULD
TAKE... YEARS.
MAYBE. AND
MAYBE...



YOU JUST
END UP LIKE
MONSTER.

MONSTER
LIKE ME.

OKAY.

SURE.

DON'T
NEED TO GO ALL
AFTER-SCHOOL
SPECIAL ON ME.



PLAS-TIC
MAN.

SORRY.

MAN-BAT
SORRY.

YEAH.

ME,
TOO.



THAT'S THE
THING ABOUT TRYING
TO ASK FOR HELP
WHEN YOU GOT
NOWHERE ELSE TO
TURN.



IT CAN
DOWNRIGHT ROB
YOU OF YOUR
DIGNITY.

DAMMIT.

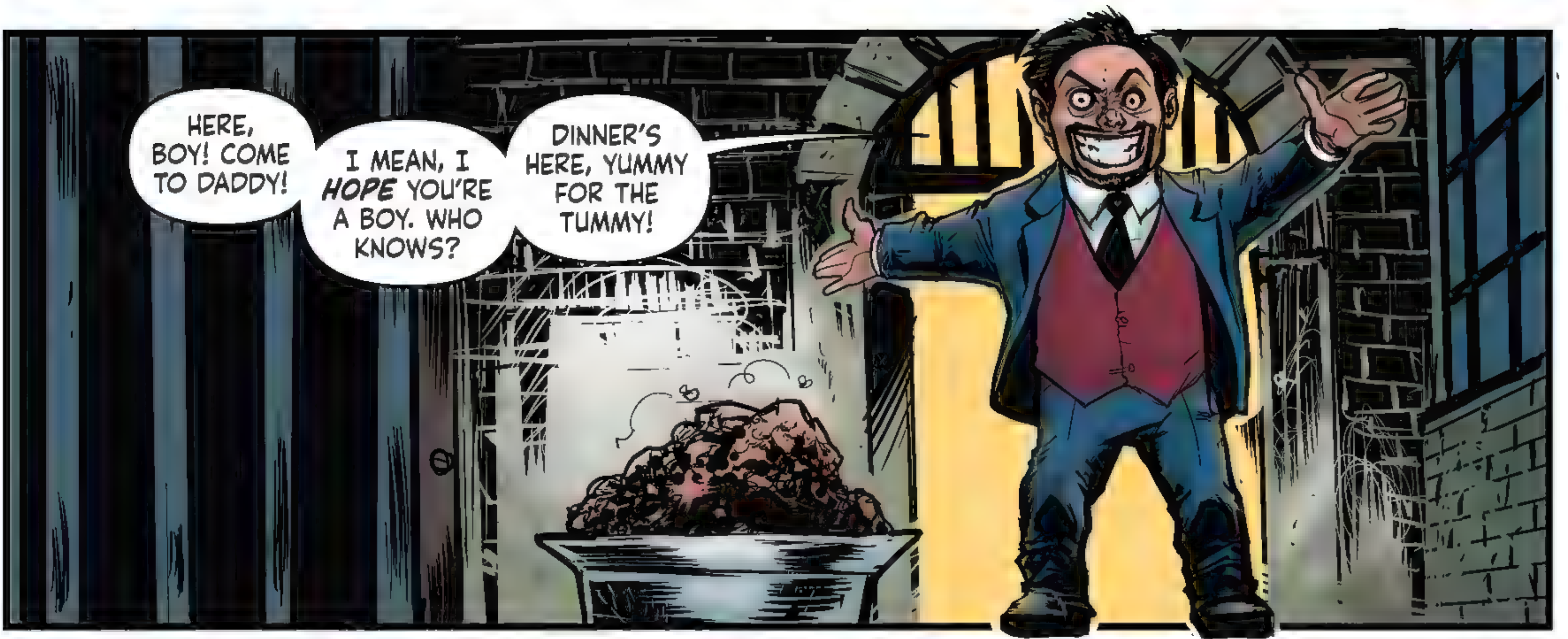
I'M
SORRY,
PADO.



♪♪ SUPPERTIME
SUPPERTIME,
SUP-SUP-SUPPER
TIME! ♪♪

♪♪ TIME
FOR DIN-DINS,
LITTLE SPOT! ♪♪

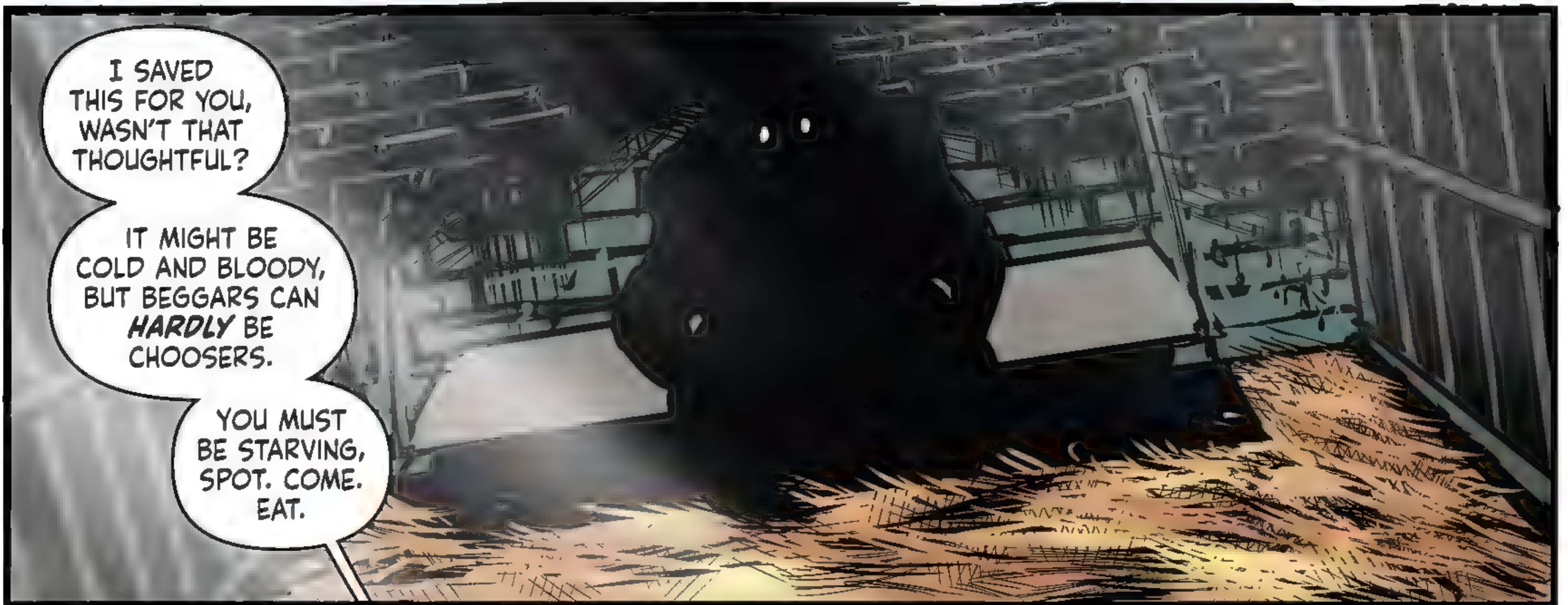
♪♪ YOUR
BELOVED MASTER
IS HOME! ♪♪



HERE,
BOY! COME
TO DADDY!

I MEAN, I
HOPE YOU'RE
A BOY. WHO
KNOWS?

DINNER'S
HERE, YUMMY
FOR THE
TUMMY!



I SAVED
THIS FOR YOU,
WASN'T THAT
THOUGHTFUL?

IT MIGHT BE
COLD AND BLOODY,
BUT BEGGARS CAN
HARDLY BE
CHOOSERS.

YOU MUST
BE STARVING,
SPOT. COME.
EAT.



NO,
SPOT. *BAD*
ALIEN!

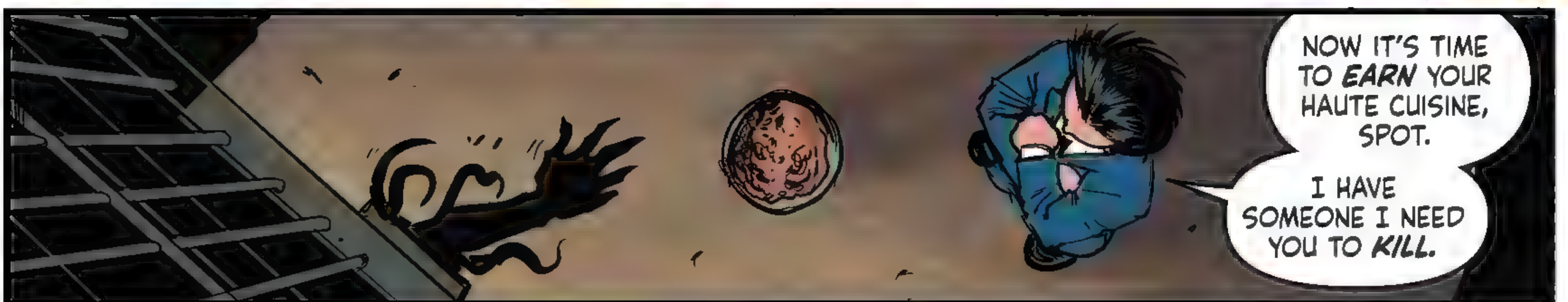
IF I'D
WANTED YOU TO
EAT LIKE A *PERSON*,
I'D NOT *BOTHER*
TO CONTROL YOUR
LITTLE IMMIGRANT
MIND.

CRAWL FOR
IT. *CRAWL*, I
COMMAND
YOU!



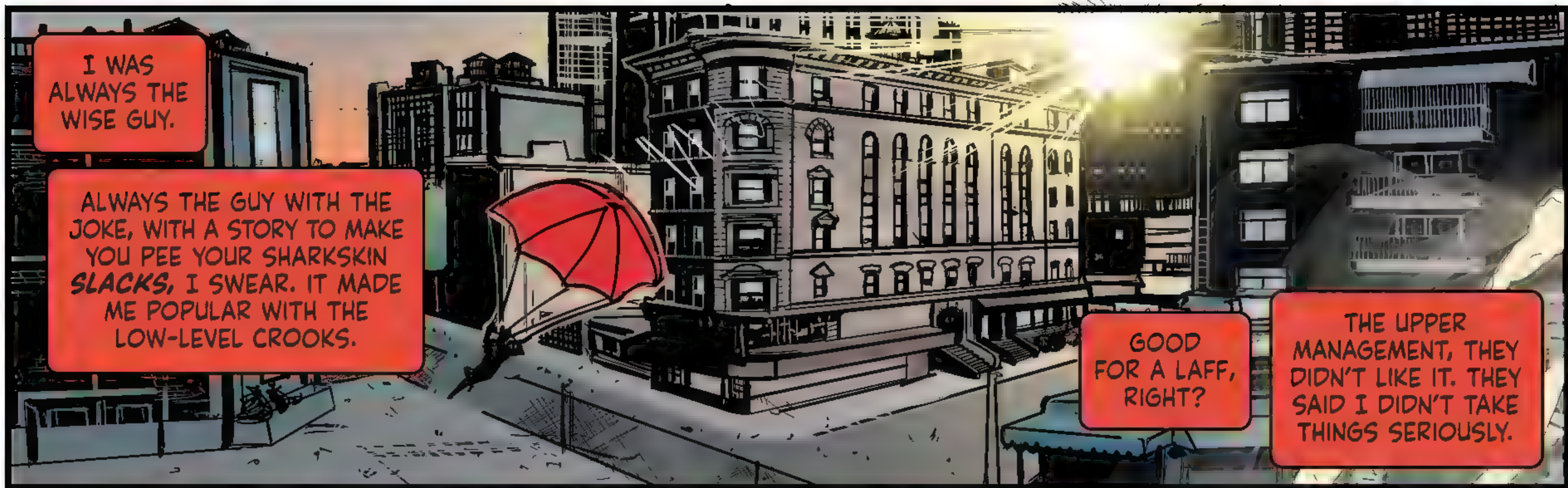
YES.
THAT'S IT.

THAT'S
A GOOD
BOY.



NOW IT'S TIME
TO *EARN* YOUR
HAUTE CUISINE,
SPOT.

I HAVE
SOMEONE I NEED
YOU TO *KILL*.

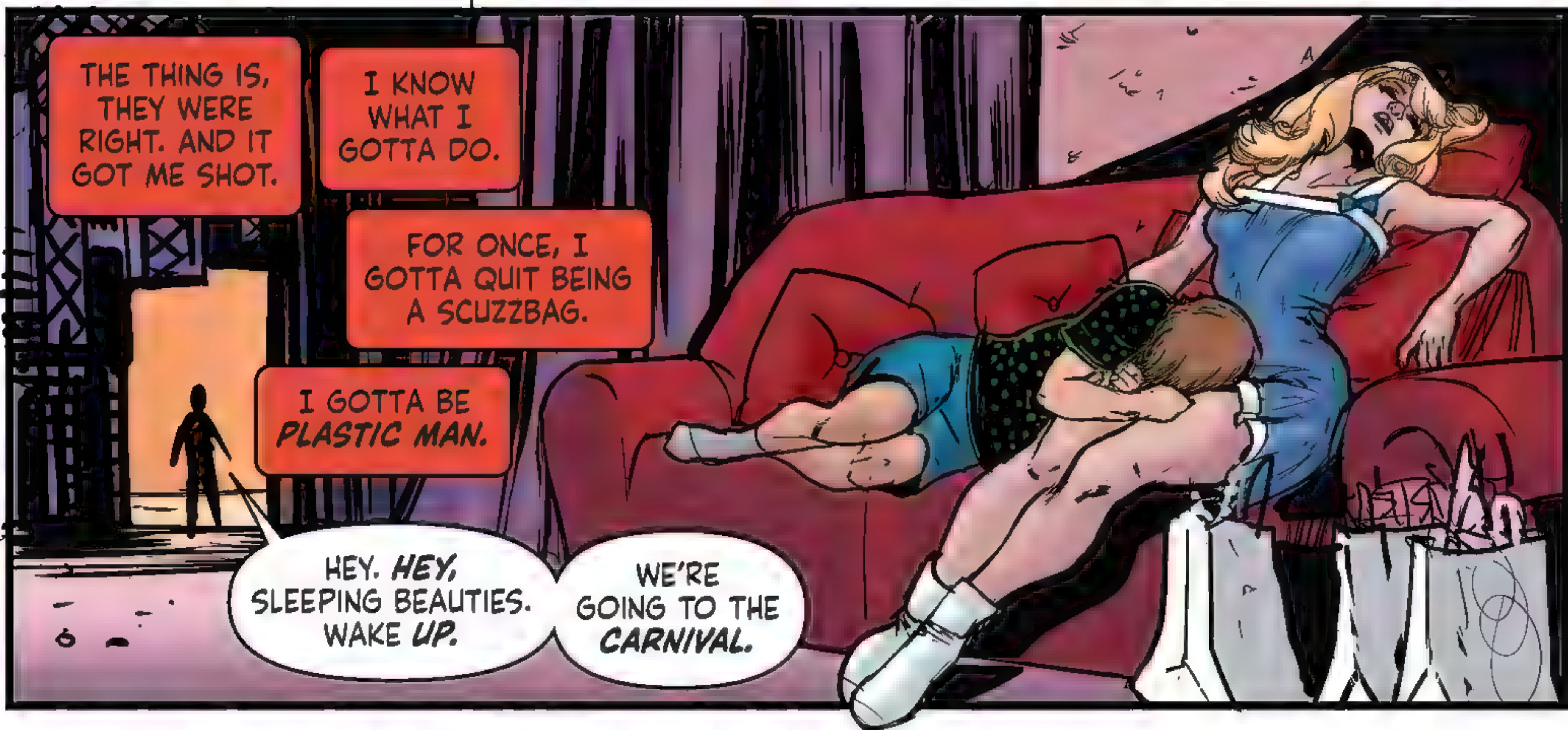


I WAS ALWAYS THE WISE GUY.

ALWAYS THE GUY WITH THE JOKE, WITH A STORY TO MAKE YOU PEE YOUR SHARKSKIN SLACKS, I SWEAR. IT MADE ME POPULAR WITH THE LOW-LEVEL CROOKS.

GOOD FOR A LAFF, RIGHT?

THE UPPER MANAGEMENT, THEY DIDN'T LIKE IT. THEY SAID I DIDN'T TAKE THINGS SERIOUSLY.



THE THING IS, THEY WERE RIGHT. AND IT GOT ME SHOT.

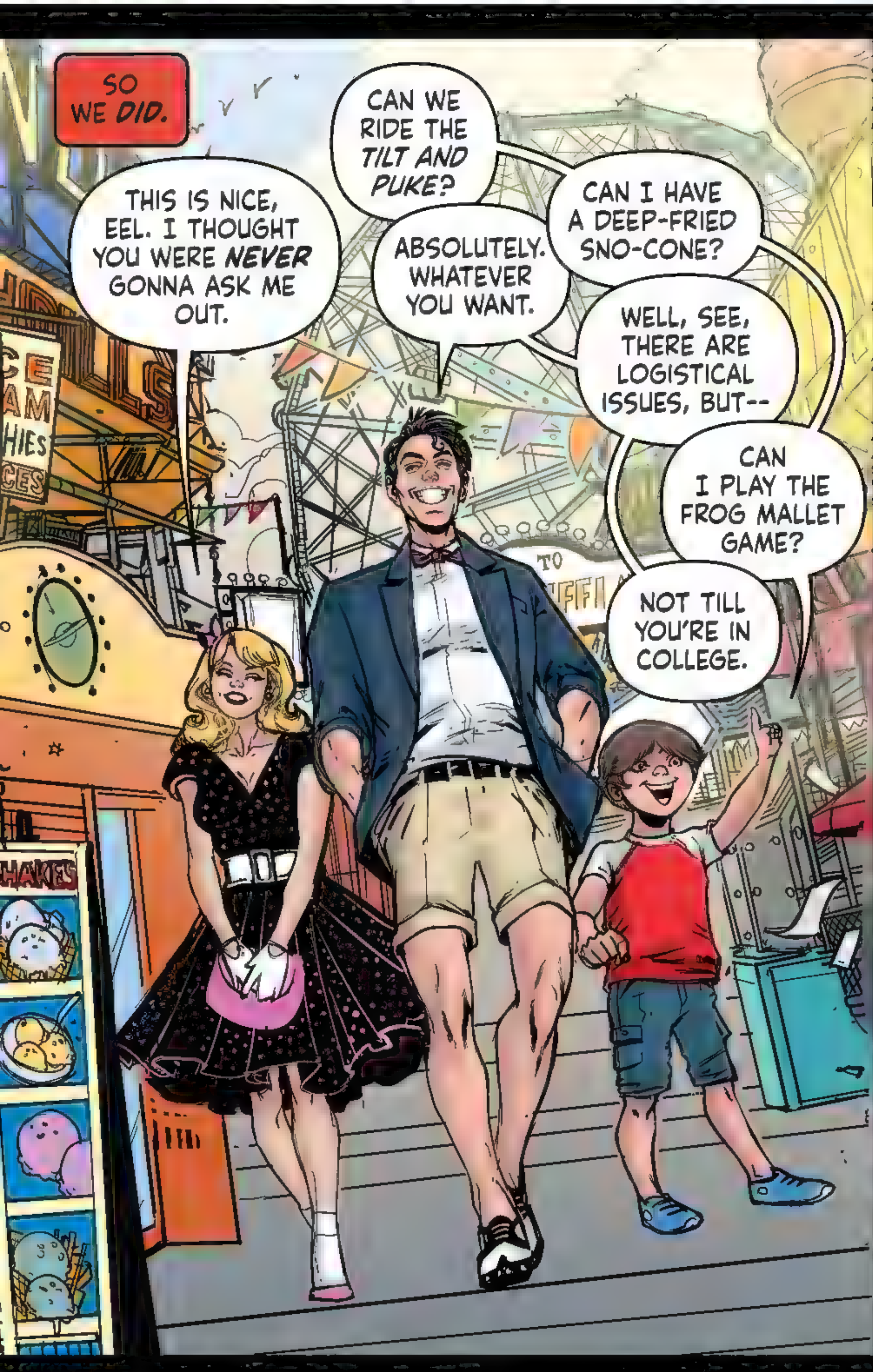
I KNOW WHAT I GOTTA DO.

FOR ONCE, I GOTTA QUIT BEING A SCUZZBAG.

I GOTTA BE PLASTIC MAN.

HEY. HEY, SLEEPING BEAUTIES. WAKE UP.

WE'RE GOING TO THE CARNIVAL.



SO WE DID.

THIS IS NICE, EEL. I THOUGHT YOU WERE NEVER GONNA ASK ME OUT.

CAN WE RIDE THE TILT AND PUKE?

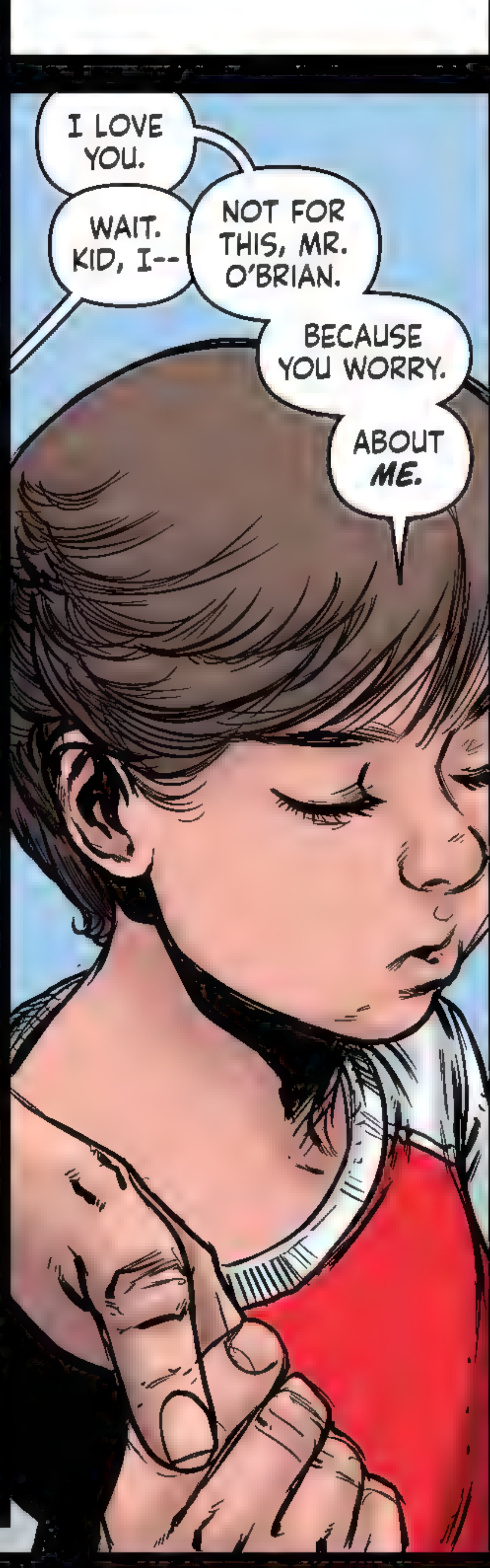
ABSOLUTELY. WHATEVER YOU WANT.

CAN I HAVE A DEEP-FRIED SNO-CONE?

WELL, SEE, THERE ARE LOGISTICAL ISSUES, BUT--

CAN I PLAY THE FROG MALLET GAME?

NOT TILL YOU'RE IN COLLEGE.



I LOVE YOU.

WAIT. KID, I--

NOT FOR THIS, MR. O'BRIAN.

BECAUSE YOU WORRY. ABOUT ME.



SO I LOVE YOU. NO TAKEBACKS.

SHCKE THAT'S...

THAT'S REAL, REAL NICE, PADO.



ONLY,
YOU GOTTA QUIT
WORRYING ABOUT
ME BEING ME.

OR I'LL
PUNCH YOUR
NARDS WITH A
SET OF BRASS
KNUCKLES.

YOU MAKE
A GOOD
CASE, KID.

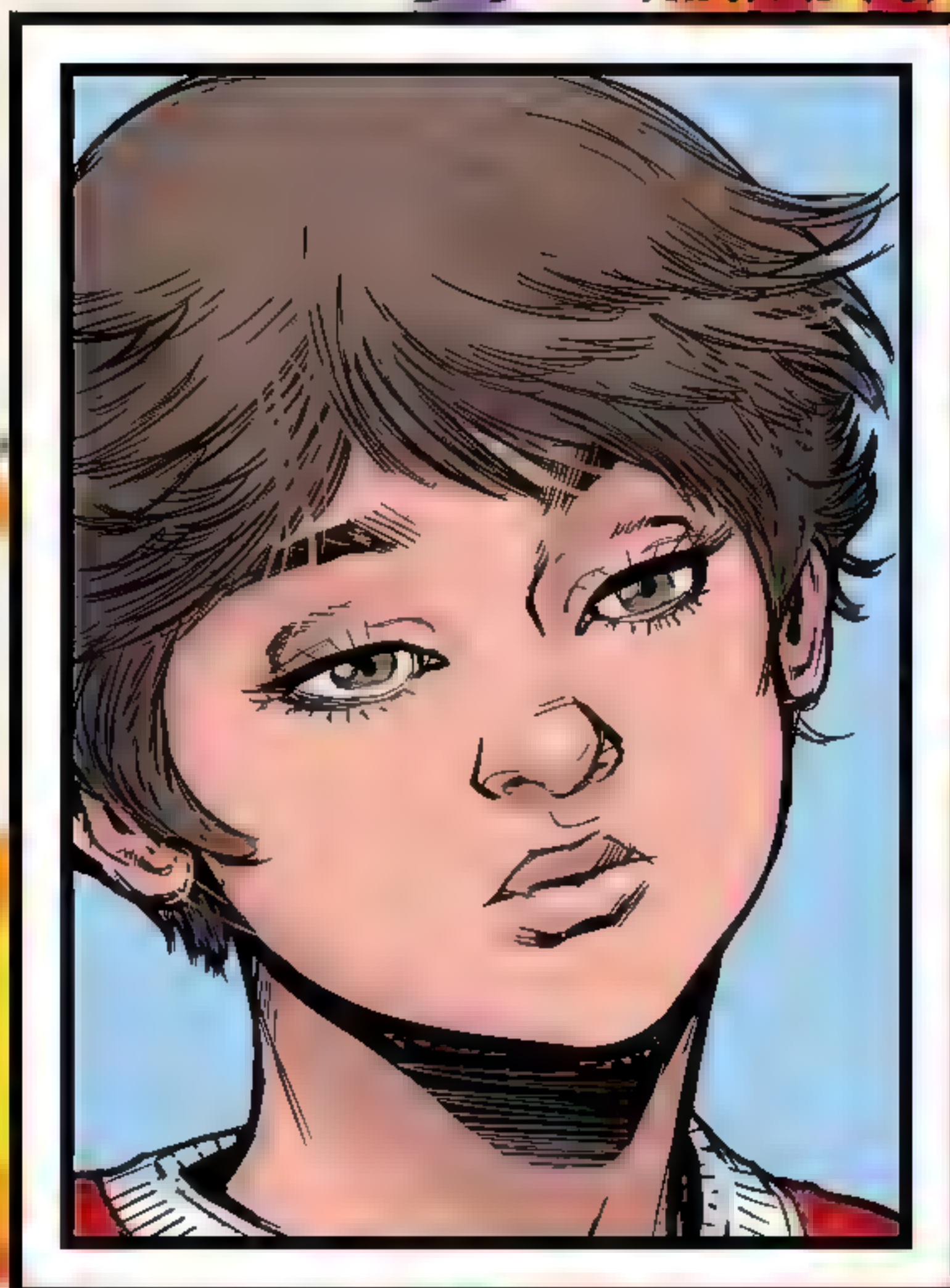
HEY,
YOU KNOW
WHAT? LOOK
AROUND.

LOOK AT
THOSE PEOPLE.
THAT'S US,
THAT'S ALL OF
US.

DO THEY
LOOK LIKE THEY
GOT ALL THE
ANSWERS?

YOU BE
WHO YOU ARE.
I'M GOOD
WITH IT.

AND
I'LL SOCK ANY
JERK WHAT SAYS
DIFFERENT RIGHT
ON THE **MUSH**.



NO
TAKEBACKS?

NO,
KID.

NO
TAKEBACKS.

MR.
O'BRIAN?

I'M MS. CHU,
FROM CHILD
SERVICES.

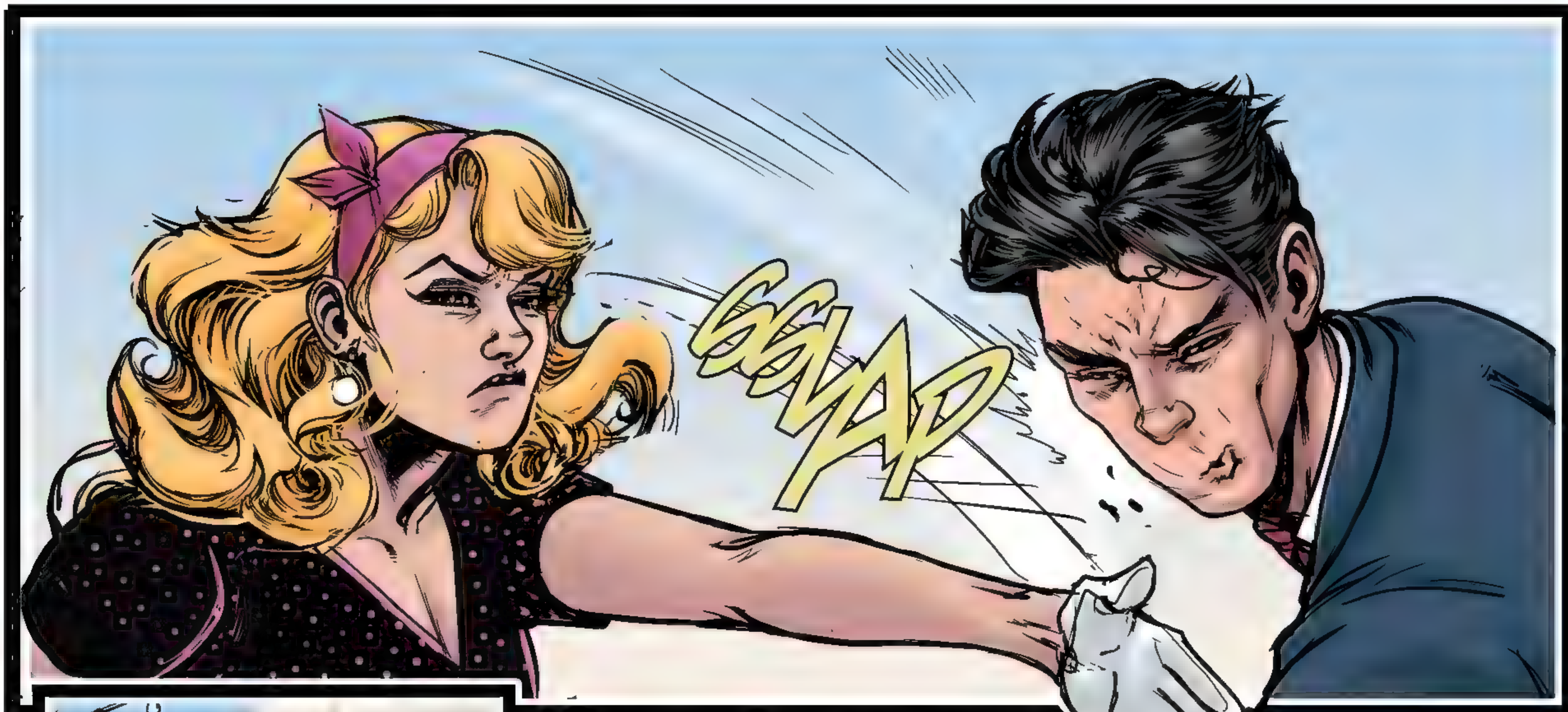
THANK YOU
FOR CALLING
US.

WE'LL
TAKE THE
GIRL NOW.

WHAT?

NO.





MORE
THE FOOL,
ME, RIGHT?

MORE
THE FOOL,
ME.

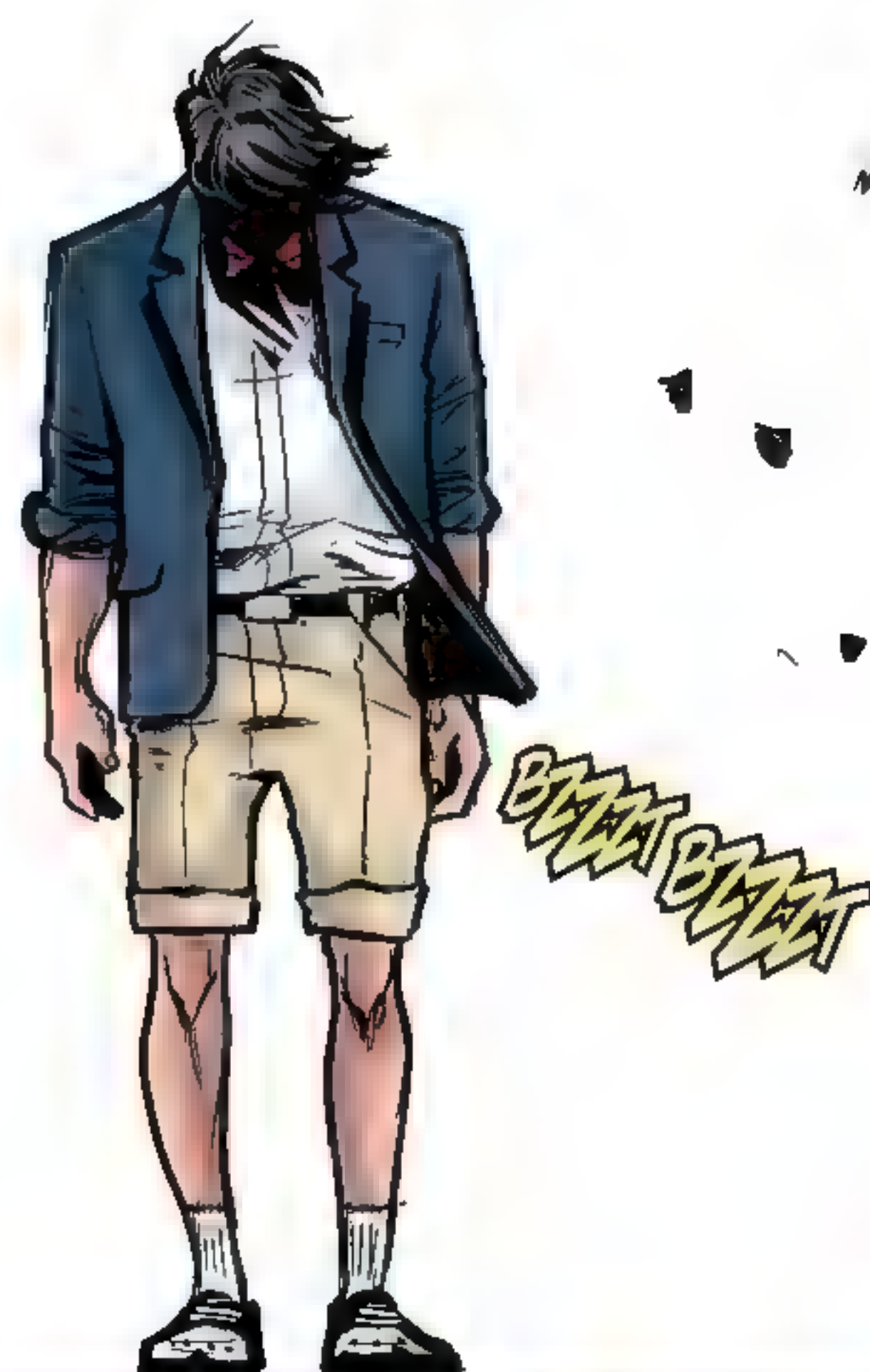
REMEMBER WHEN
I SAID I DIDN'T
WANT TO BE A
RAT NO MORE?

TURNS OUT
I'M STILL IN
THE MAZE.

I CAN'T DO IT. NO
ONE WARNED ME.
NO ONE EVER TOLD
ME. FROM MY OLD
MAN ON DOWN.

DOING
THE RIGHT
THING?

IT
DAMN WELL
SUCKS.



WHOEVER
THIS IS, NOW
ISN'T A GOOD
TIME.

EEL.
PLEASE. I
NEED YOUR
HELP NOW.



YOU MEAN
THE HIPPIE-DIPPY
WITH THE FAKE
SUPER-CRIMINAL GANG
YOU WANTED ME TO
DESTROY? GET LOST,
KITTEN. I GOT ALL
THE GRIEF I
NEED.

NO.
PLEASE.
LISTEN.

IT'S ALL
TRUE. AND
THEY'VE SENT
SOMEONE TO
KILL ME!

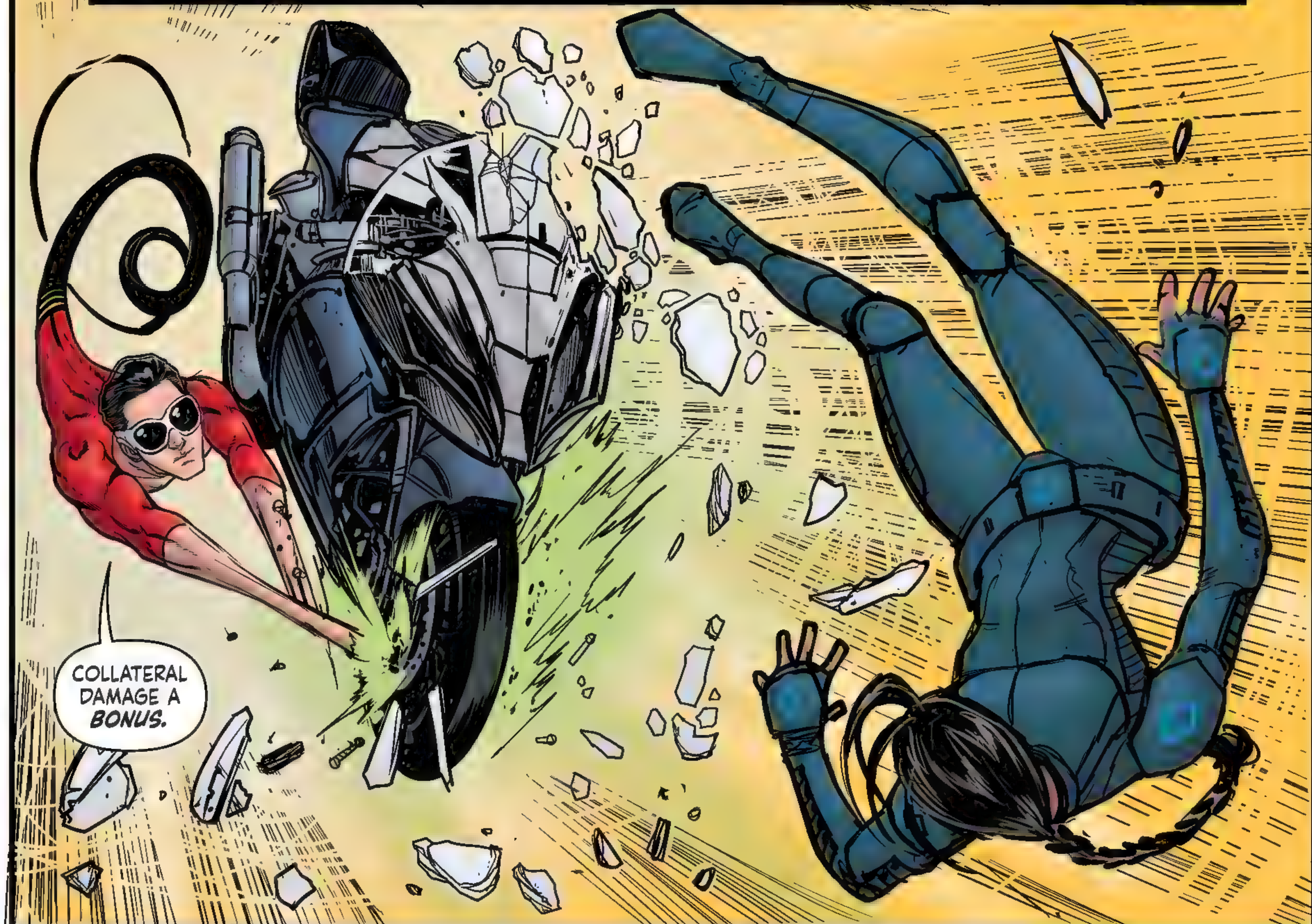
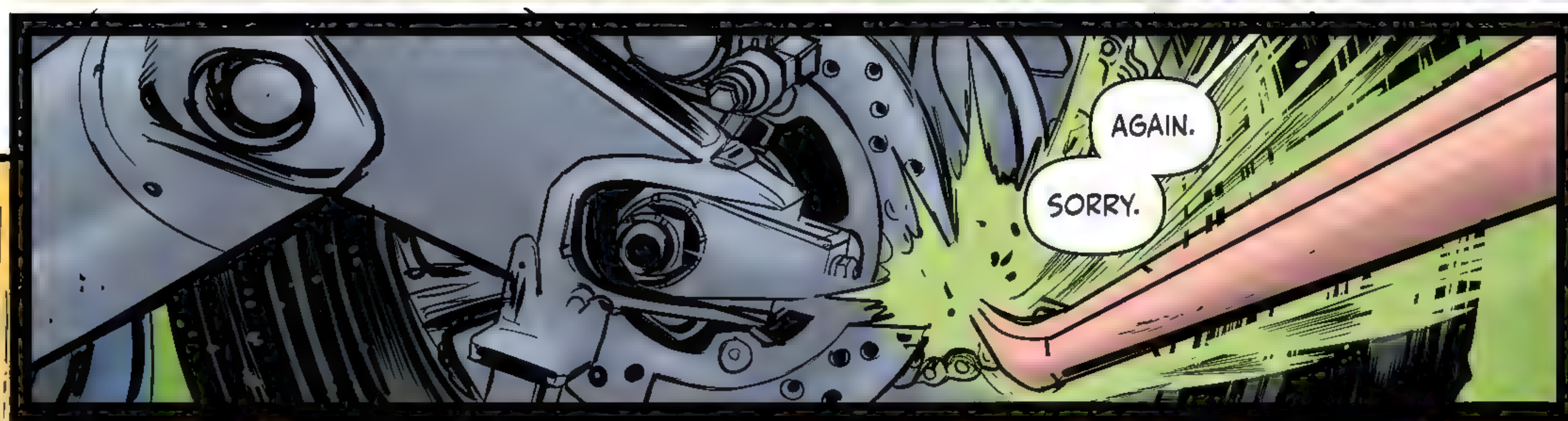
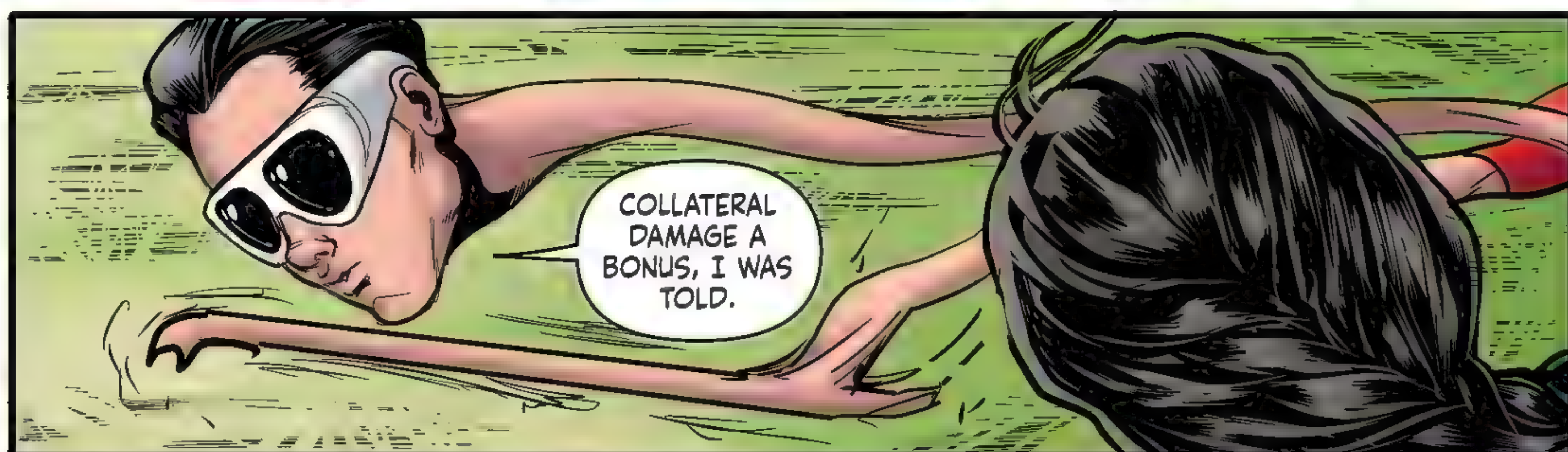
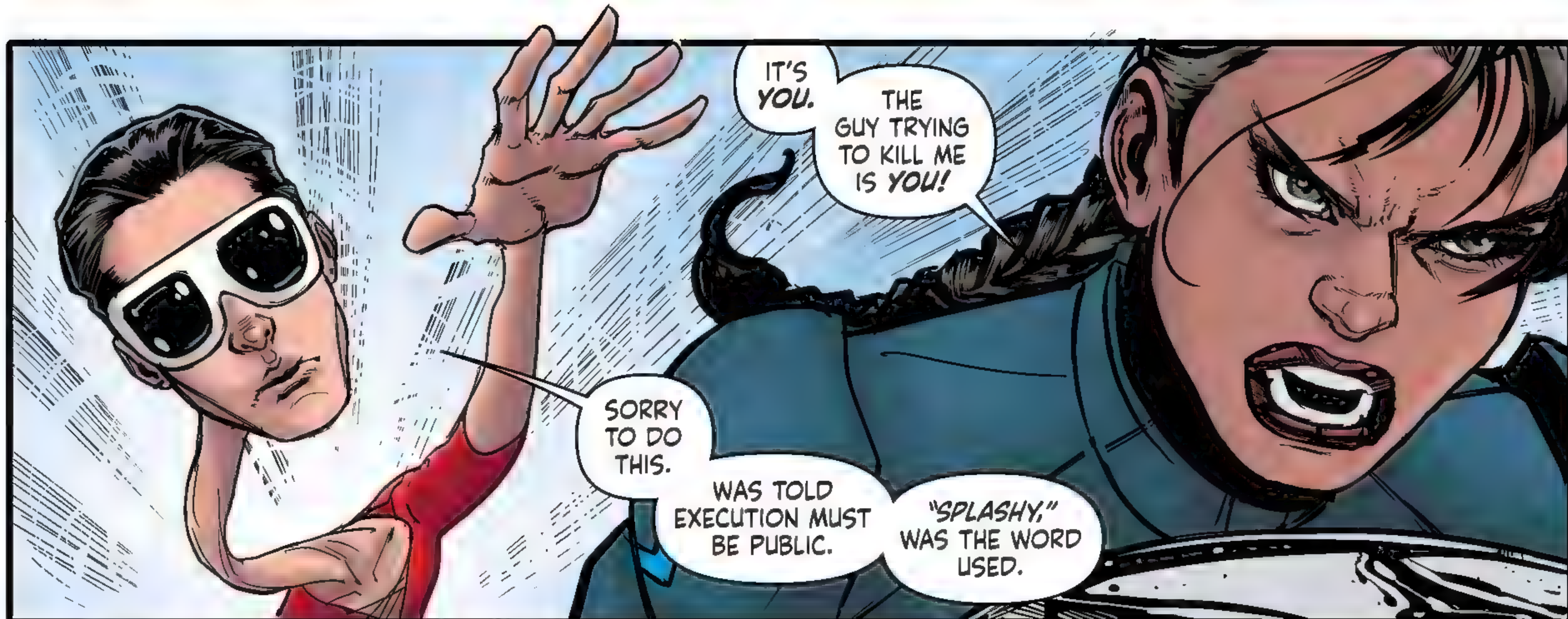
HE'S
CHASING
ME RIGHT
NOW.

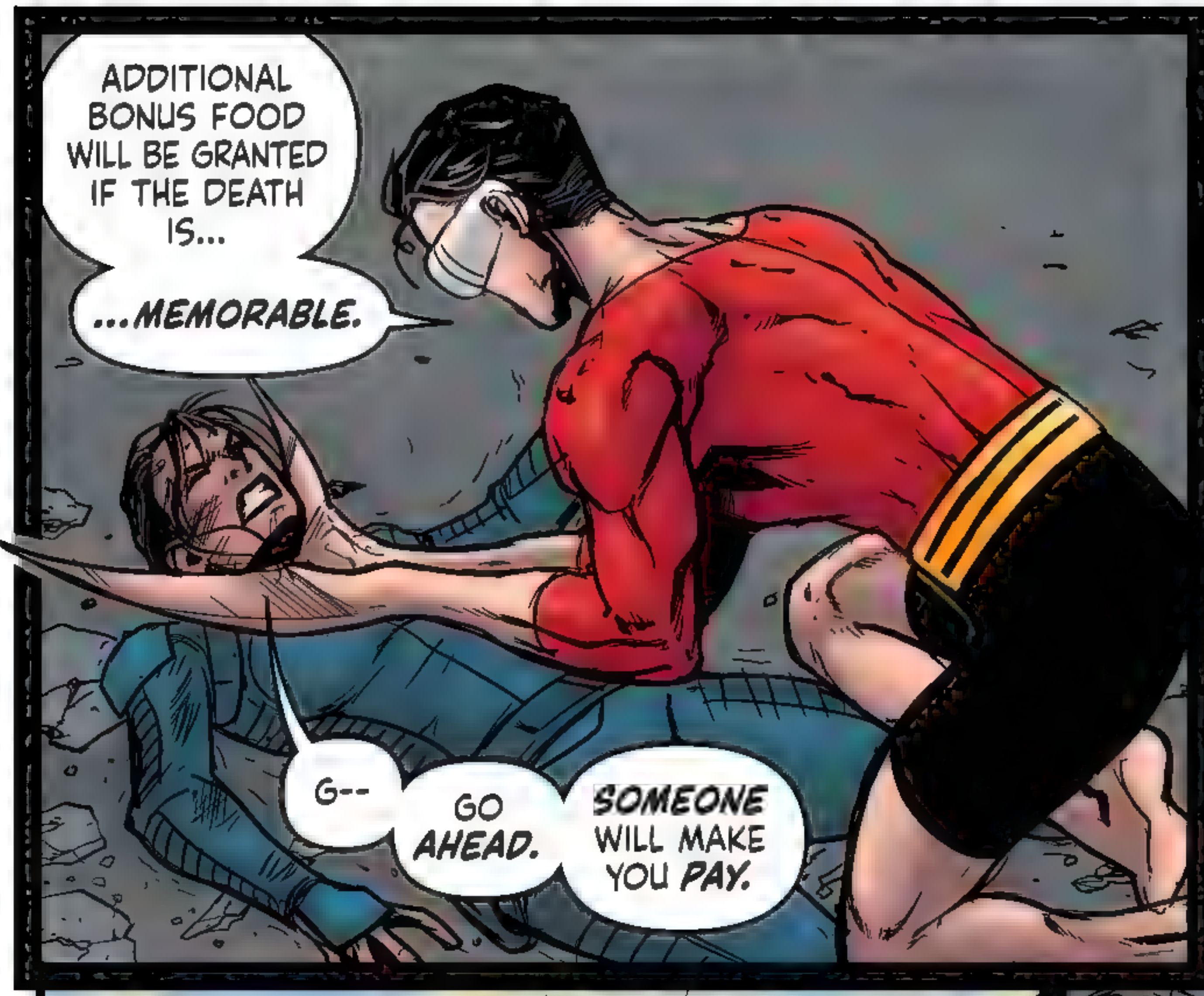


YEAH?

AND WHO IS
THIS FICTIONAL
BASTARD WHO CAN
TAKE DOWN THE BIG
TOUGH SECRET
AGENT?

EEL.
THAT'S THE
PROBLEM...!







SEE, THIS IS THE THING. I GOT THESE GIRLFRIENDS?

WELL, THEY'RE GIRLS WHO ARE **FRIENDS**.

WOMEN!

WOMEN WHO ARE--YOU KNOW WHAT? NEVER MIND.

STAND UP THERE, SAILOR. WE'RE NOT DONE.

AND **THEY** FIGURED YOU OUT, PALLY-ROO.

THEY SAID YOU'RE A CREEPY **ALIEN** WEIRDO.

FROM THE PLANET **DOODLE**.

DURLA.

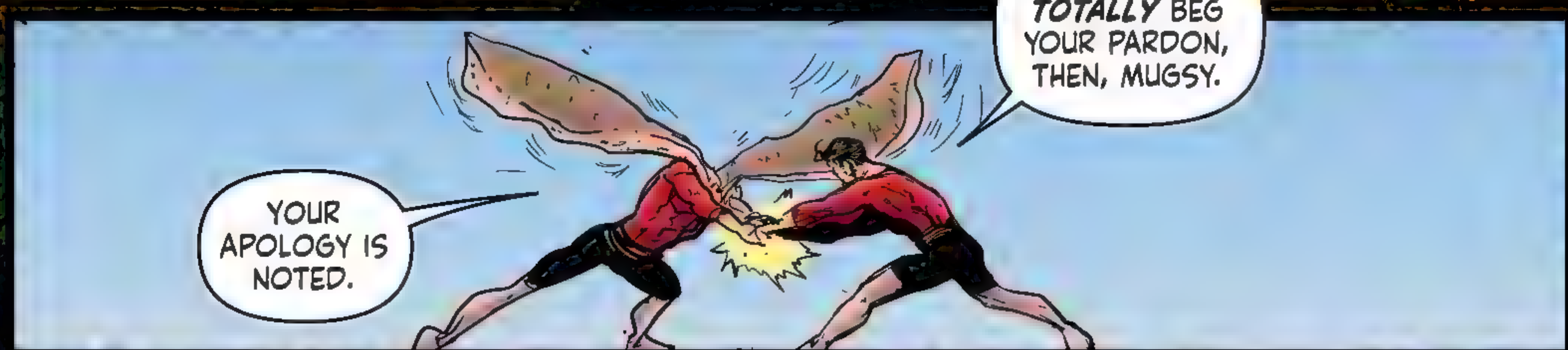


EX-SQUEEZE ME?

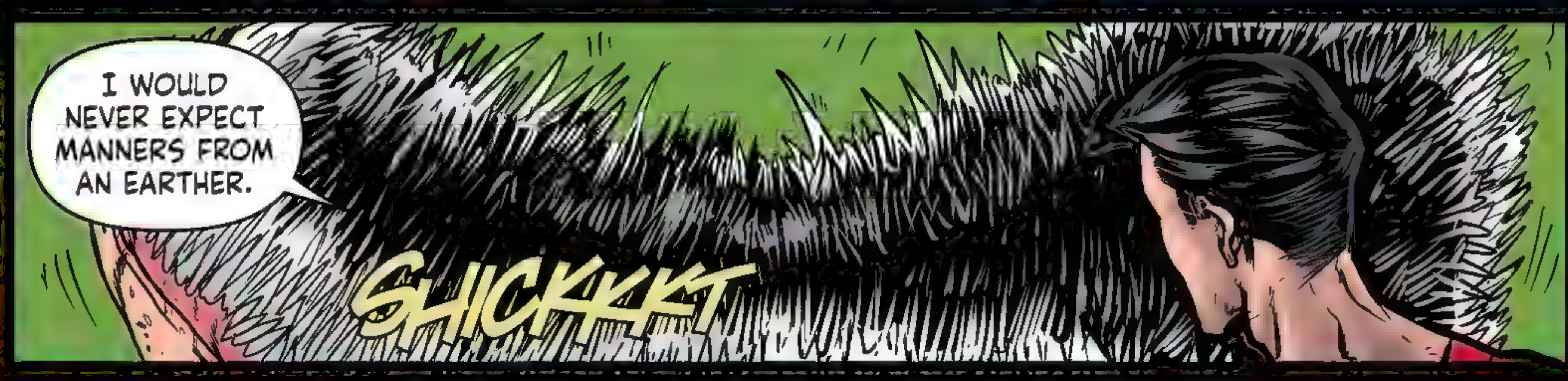
I AM FROM THE PLANET **DURLA**.

OH.

WELL, I JUST **TOTALLY** BEG YOUR PARDON, THEN, MUGSY.

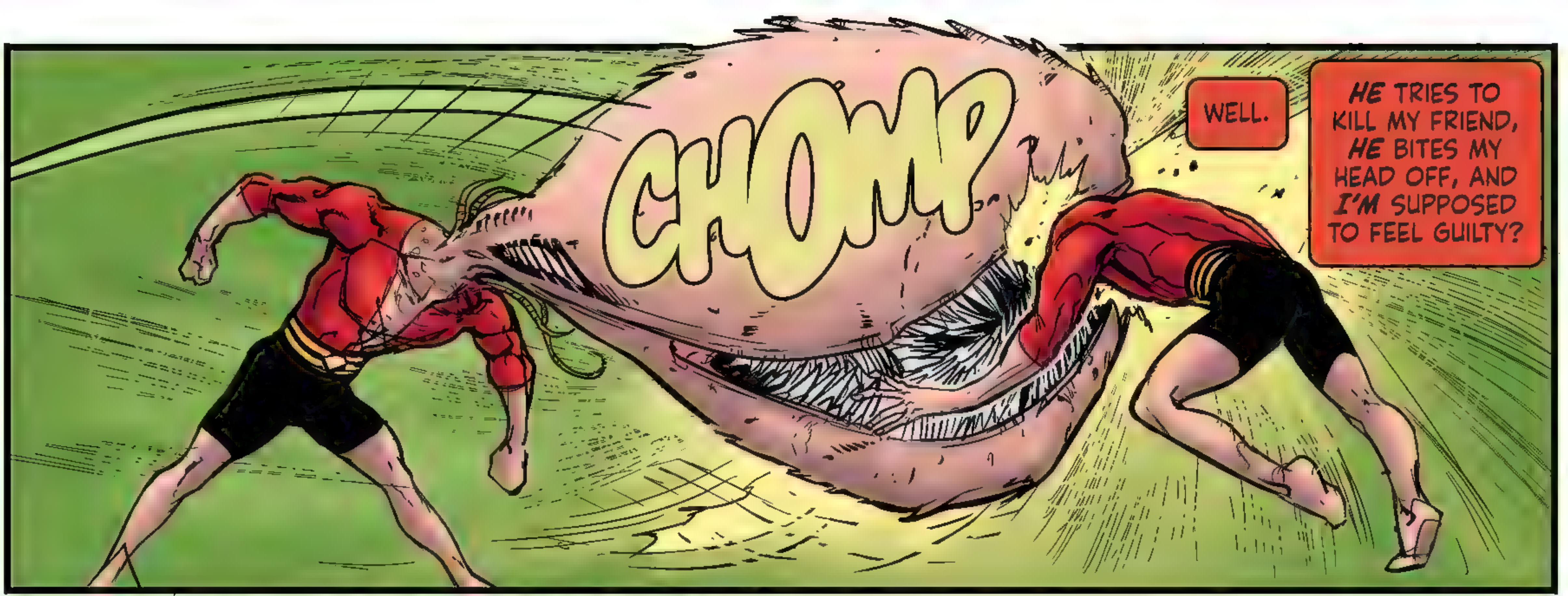


YOUR APOLOGY IS NOTED.



I WOULD NEVER EXPECT MANNERS FROM AN EARTHER.

SHICKKKT



WELL.

HE TRIES TO
KILL MY FRIEND,
HE BITES MY
HEAD OFF, AND
I'M SUPPOSED
TO FEEL GUILTY?

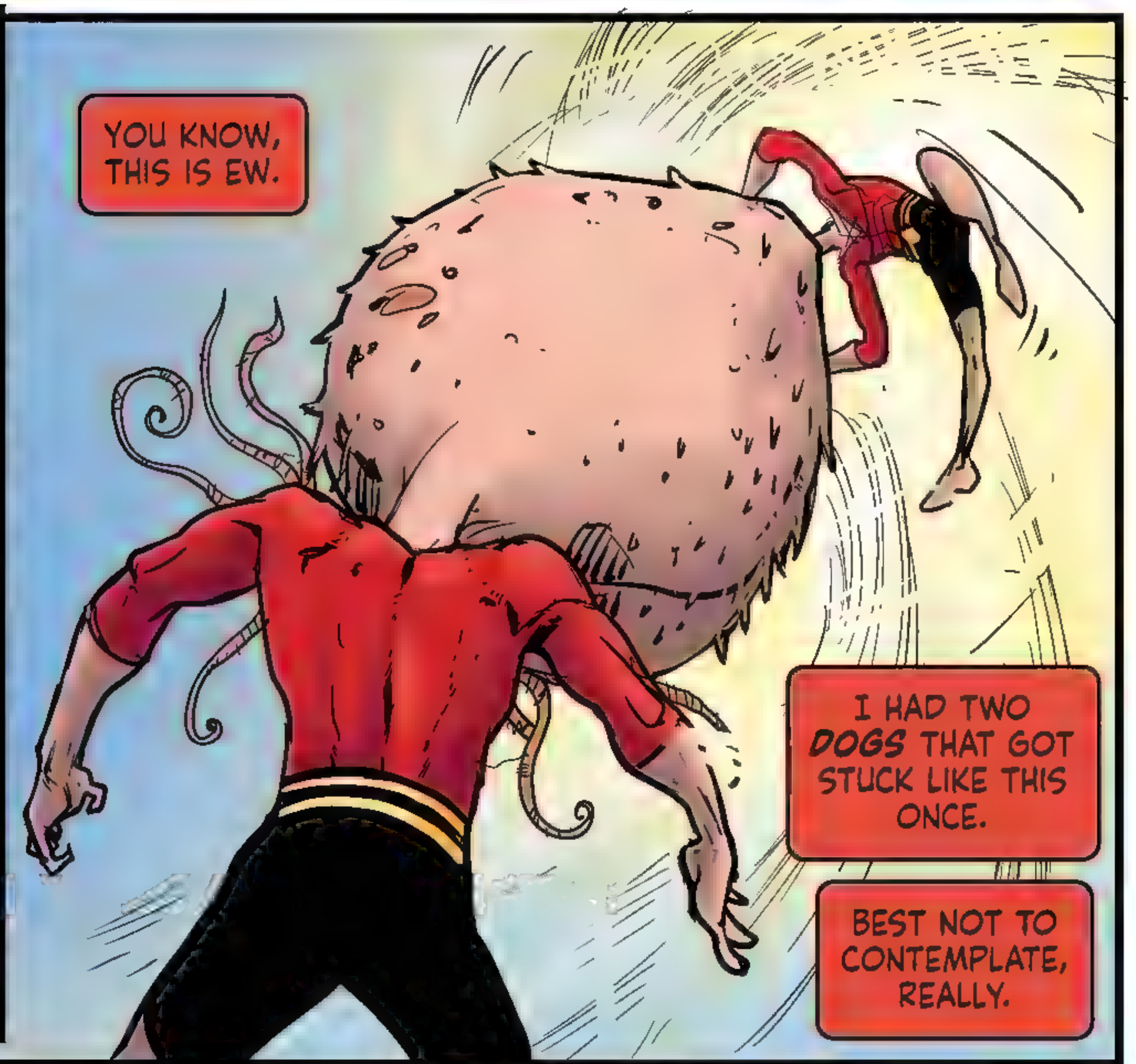


THIS IS
TOTALLY REVERSE
DISCRIMINATION,
FOR SURE.

WAS IT
PINOCCHIO?
CAPTAIN QUINT?

NOW, WHO WAS IT
IN THE BIBLE WHO
GOT SWALLOWED
BY A WHALE?

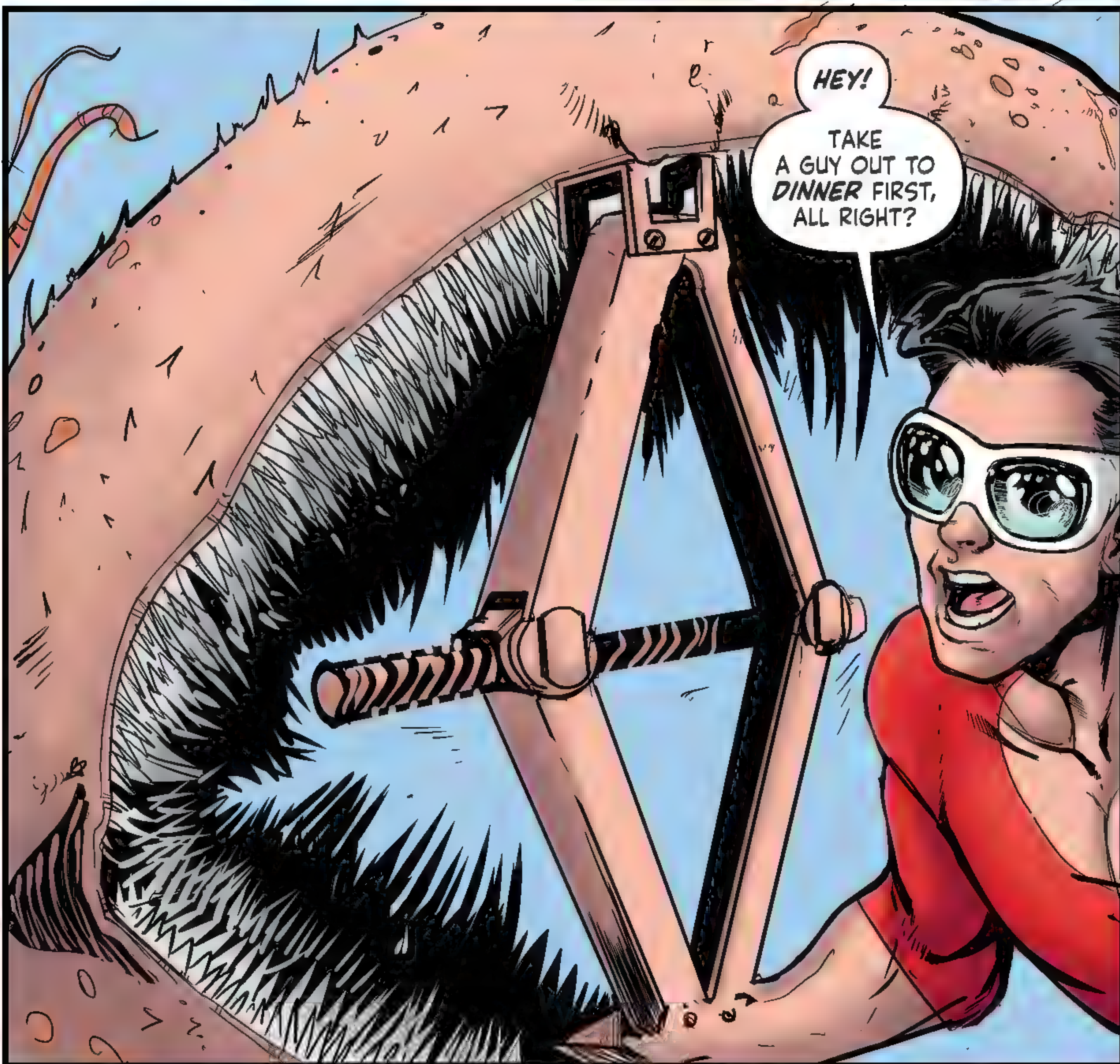
MAN, I
GOTTA READ THE
BIBLE MORE.



YOU KNOW,
THIS IS EW.

I HAD TWO
DOGS THAT GOT
STUCK LIKE THIS
ONCE.

BEST NOT TO
CONTEMPLATE,
REALLY.



HEY!
TAKE
A GUY OUT TO
DINNER FIRST,
ALL RIGHT?



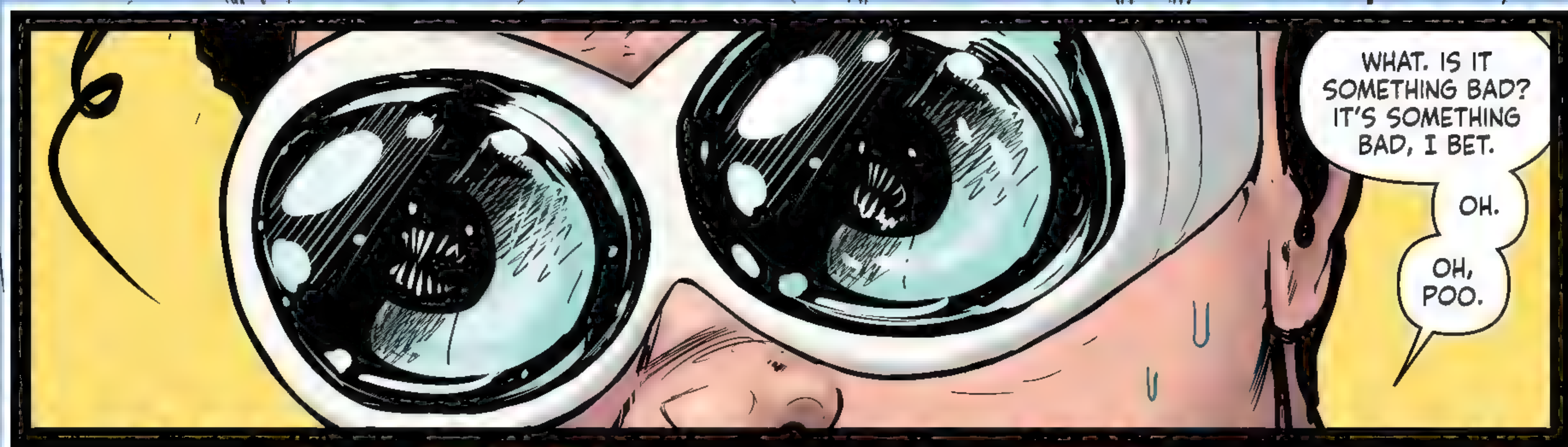
OH, MAN.
LISTEN, LADY. I'M
SORRY I DIDN'T
TRUST YOU.

IT'S ALL TRUE.
THE CONSPIRACY,
THE CABAL. IT'S
ALL TRUE.

YOU OKAY?
I'LL GET YOU
OUT OF HERE,
ALL RIGHT?

PLASTIC
MAN...

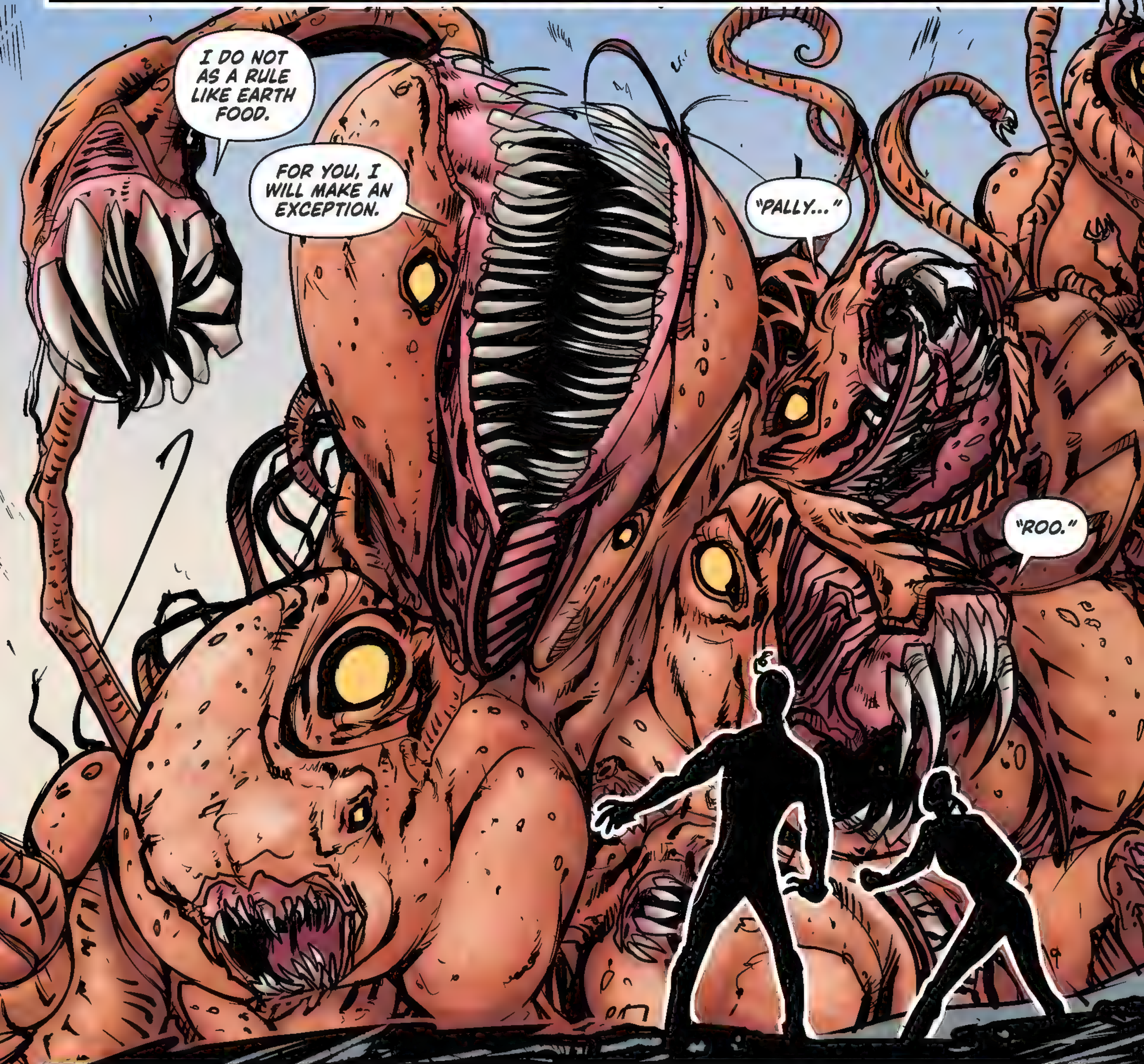
LOOK
OUT!



WHAT. IS IT
SOMETHING BAD?
IT'S SOMETHING
BAD, I BET.

OH.

OH,
POO.



I DO NOT
AS A RULE
LIKE EARTH
FOOD.

FOR YOU, I
WILL MAKE AN
EXCEPTION.

"PALLY..."

"ROO."



YEP.

IT'S
BAD.

ELSEWHERE...

SO BABY, LET
ME TIE YOUR TIE, AND
LET ME LOOSEN YOUR
BELT, BECAUSE LOVE IS
LIKE A KNOT, HONEY, AND
EVEN STONY HEARTS
CAN MELT...

ARE YOU *KIDDING*
ME, SAMMY? NOT
ONLY CAN SHE *STILL*
NOT *SING*, NOW SHE
LOOKS LIKE A HUMAN
LAWN GNOME.

NO CLUB
IN THE *WORLD*
WILL HIRE THAT
FREAK.

LISTEN,
DOLL FACE, IT'S NOT
PERSONAL.

BUT MY *CLIENTS* LIKE
TO SEE A SINGER THEY
COULD...YOU KNOW...*MAKE*
IT WITH. SOMEONE WITH,
OH, WHAT'S THAT
PHRASE AGAIN?

*HUMAN
FLESH?*

I
UNDERSTAND,
MR. LEONARD.

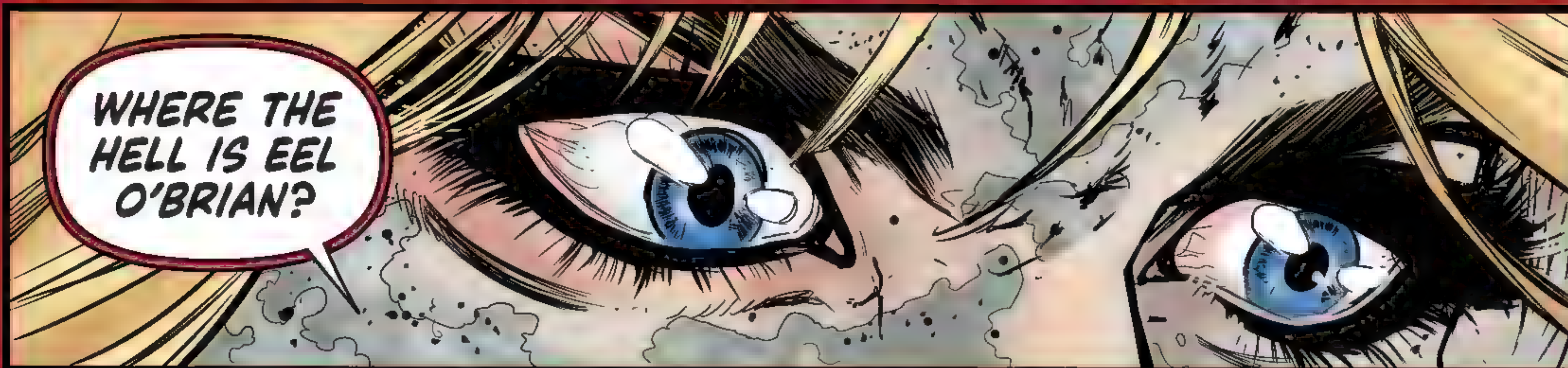
THANK
YOU FOR THE
AUDITION.



THIS IS EEL
O'BRIAN'S FAULT,
SAMMY.

I'LL NEVER
WORK AGAIN,
AND IT'S *EEL'S*
FAULT.

WHERE THE
HELL IS EEL
O'BRIAN?





CHAPTER SIX

TO THE MOON AND BACK

Cover art by Jason Badower



REMEMBER WHEN SUPERHEROES USED TO WEAR SPANDEX?

I MISS IT, I'LL TELL YOU WHAT.



FIRST, IT WAS SEXY AS HELL, RIGHT?

I SWEAR, WATCHING THE JUSTICE LEAGUE WALKING AWAY WAS GUARANTEED TO PUT SOME **STARCH** IN YOUR SHORTS.



I USED TO **LIVE** FOR VIGILANTE VPL, BROTHER.

IT WAS ALMOST WORTH GETTING **CAUGHT** JUST TO SEE.



NOW IT'S ALL **ARMOR**.

YOU'RE A GYMNAST? LET'S ARMOR YOU UP, MAN.

YOU'RE A DETECTIVE? HOW 'BOUT SOME **KEVLAR**.



Huh. NO CUPS.

ANYWAY, SEE, I COULD DO IT. I COULD **MAKE** ARMOR.

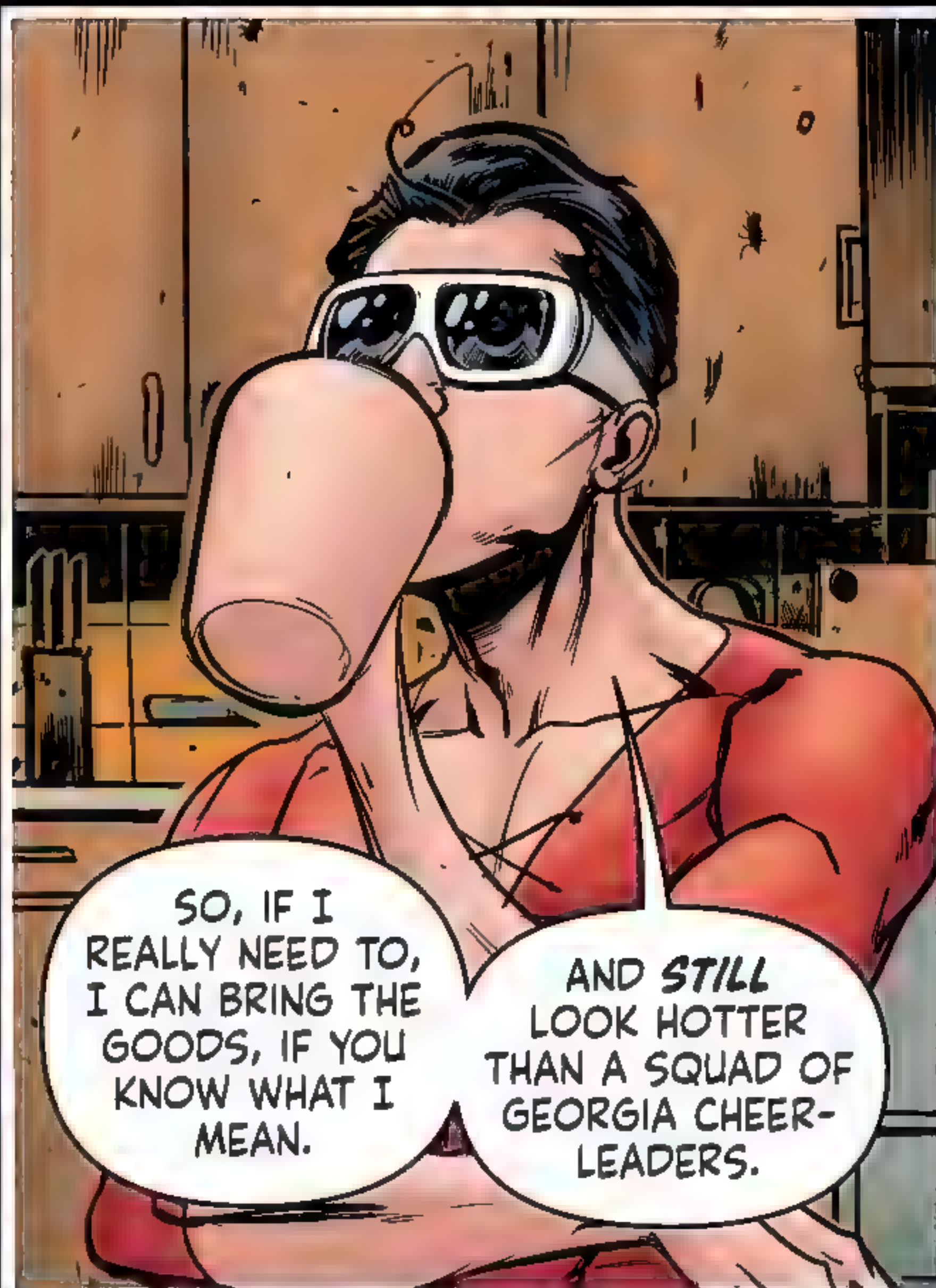


BUT I'VE BEEN EXPERIMENTING A LITTLE, AND IT TURNS OUT, I DON'T REALLY **NEED** TO.

TURNS OUT THERE'S PLASTIC TEN TIMES HARDER THAN STEEL.

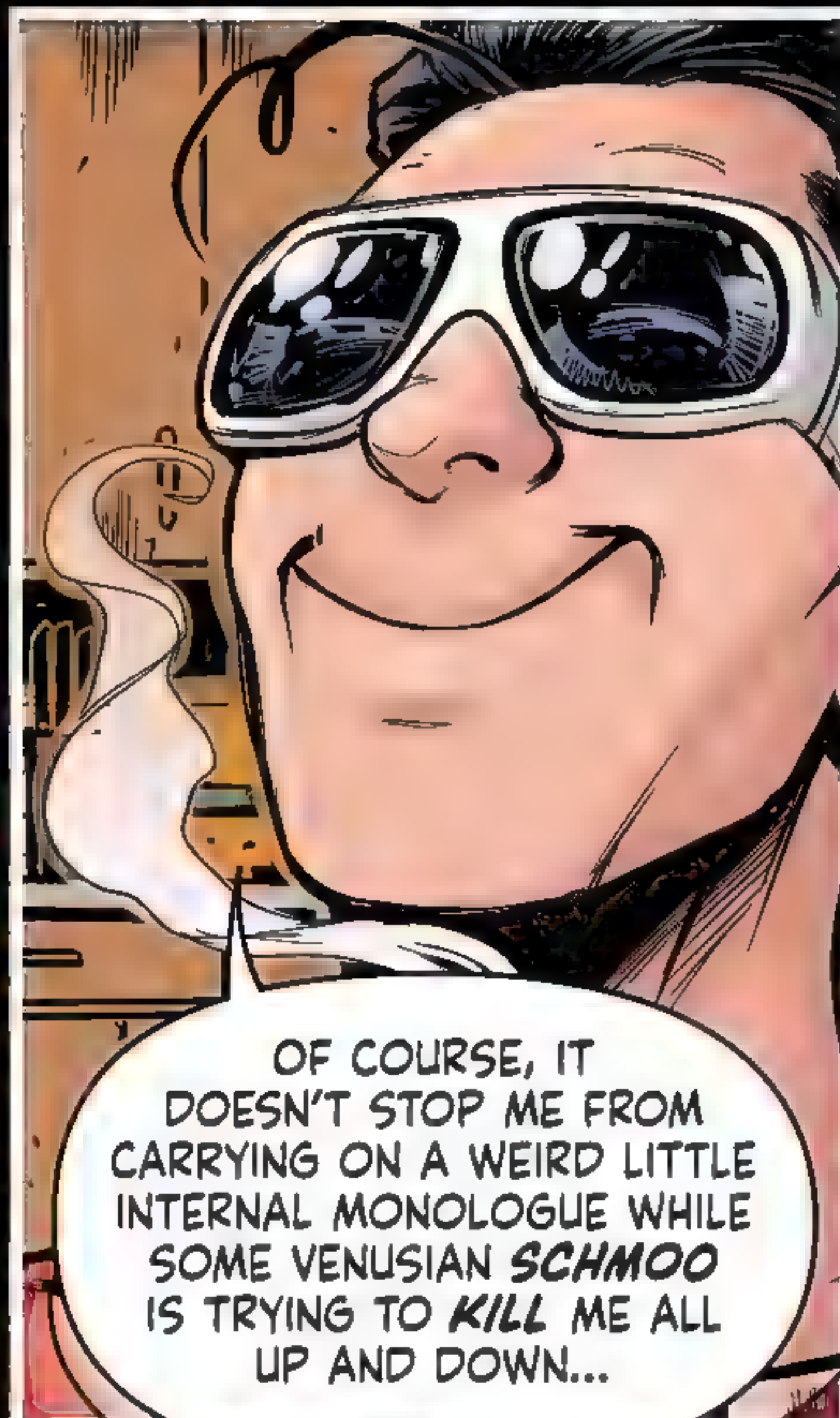


THAT CAN RESIST TEMPERATURES OF 1,400 DEGREES. THAT'S 200 DEGREES MORE THAN IT TAKES TO MELT ALUMINUM.



SO, IF I REALLY NEED TO, I CAN BRING THE GOODS, IF YOU KNOW WHAT I MEAN.

AND **STILL** LOOK HOTTER THAN A SQUAD OF GEORGIA CHEER-LEADERS.



OF COURSE, IT DOESN'T STOP ME FROM CARRYING ON A WEIRD LITTLE INTERNAL MONOLOGUE WHILE SOME VENUSIAN **SCHMOO** IS TRYING TO **KILL** ME ALL UP AND DOWN...

To the MOON AND BACK

DO YOU
THINK YOU CAN
ESCAPE DEATH
AT MY HANDS,
EARTH MAN?

I MASTERED
THE THREE
THOUSAND FORMS
BEFORE MY TENTH
LUNAR CYCLE.

OR
MAYBE HE'S
KRYPTONIAN.

I DON'T
KNOW MY
PLANETS.

ALL I KNOW IS
THAT HE'S A MASSIVE
POINTY DOUCHEBAG
AND I'M RUNNING
OUT OF OXYGEN.

I KNOW
HOW TO KILL
A SHAPE-
SHIFTER!

I AM ALMOST
POSITIVE I READ
THIS IN AN EROTIC
MANGA ONCE.

MOTHER?
MOTHER,
IT'S EEL.

I'M ON
MY WAY TO
HEAVEN.
MOTHER.

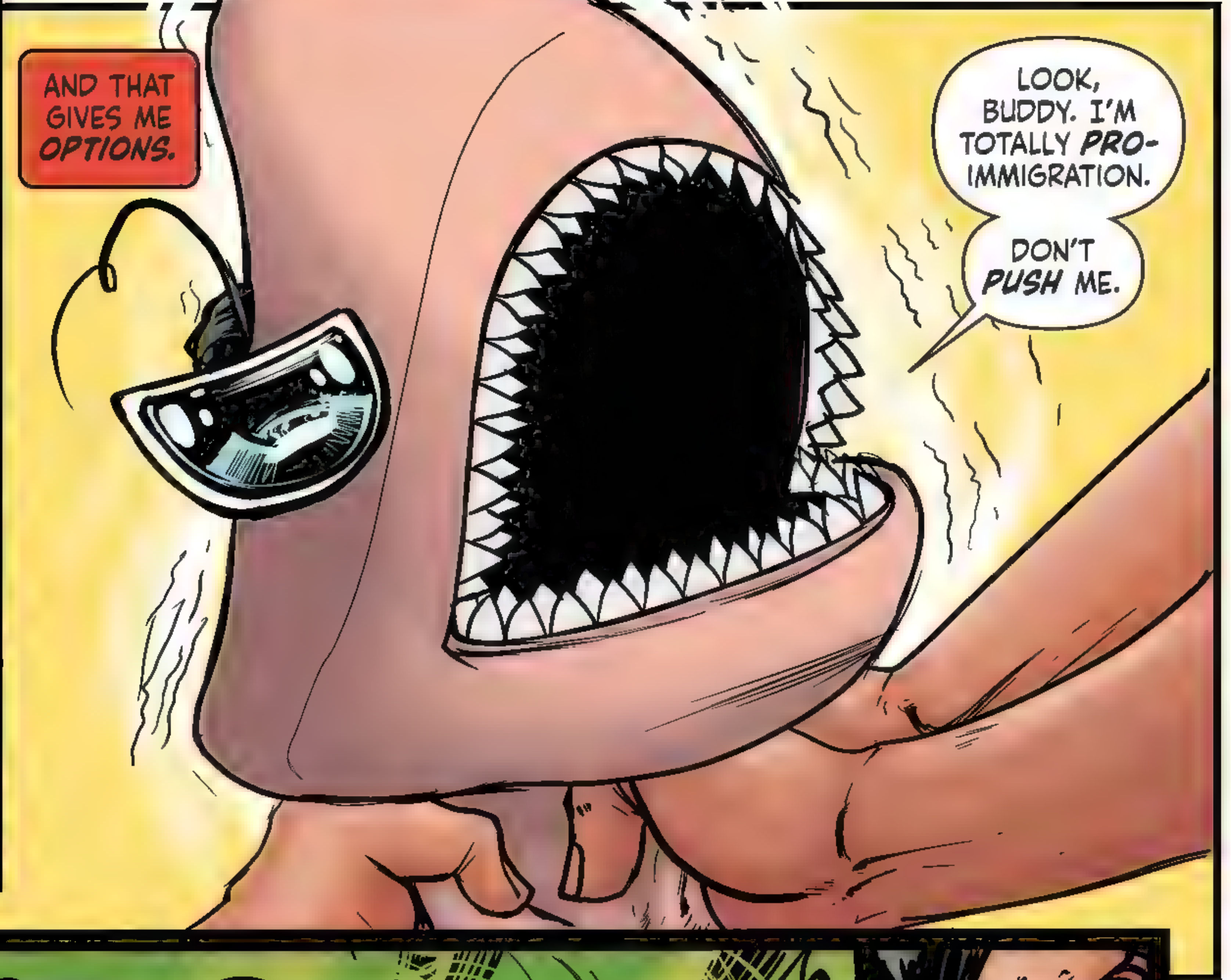




OH, WAIT.

I'M PLASTIC MAN.

AND THAT GIVES ME OPTIONS.



LOOK, BUDDY. I'M TOTALLY PRO-IMMIGRATION.

DON'T PUSH ME.



I AM A *G^%%\$ SHARK!

ALSO, I WAS JUST KIDDING BEFORE.

THERE'S NO WAY MY MOM'S IN HEAVEN.

CHOMP



REALLY? OKAY, THIS IS GROSS.

ALL RIGHT, PAL. YOU'RE THE GENIUS, AND AS USUAL, I'M THE DOOFUS.

YOU SAY YOU CAN TAKE ME?

GOODY.

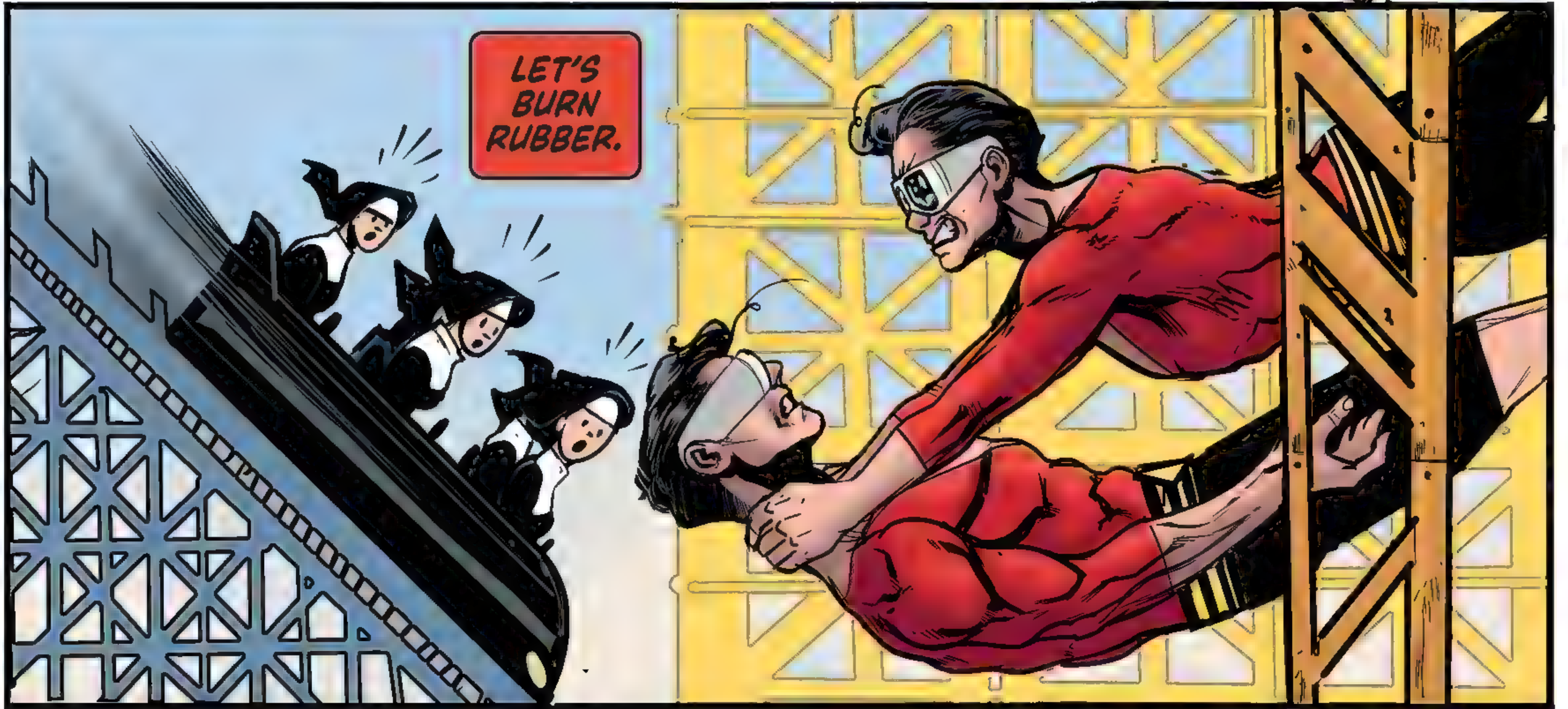
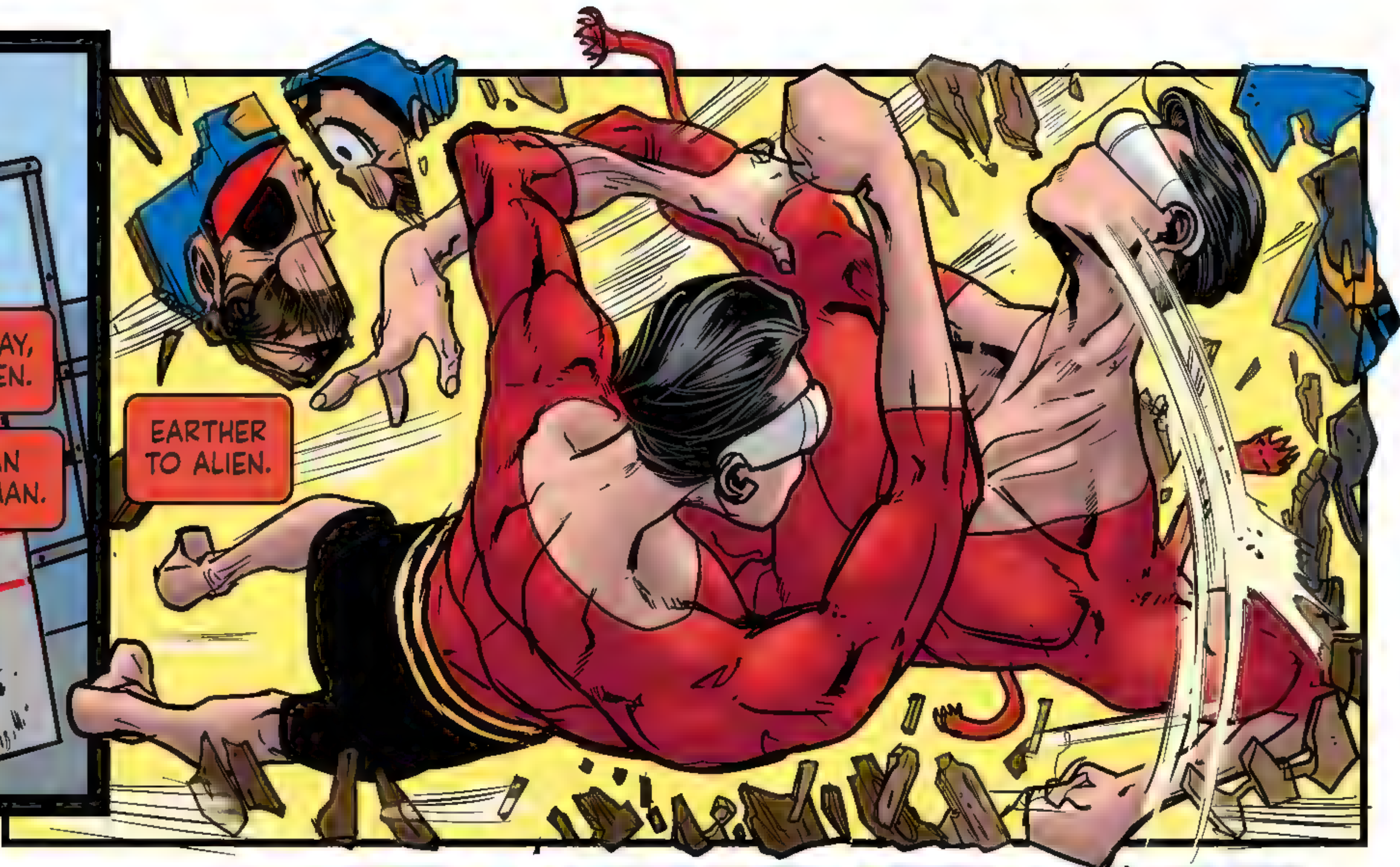


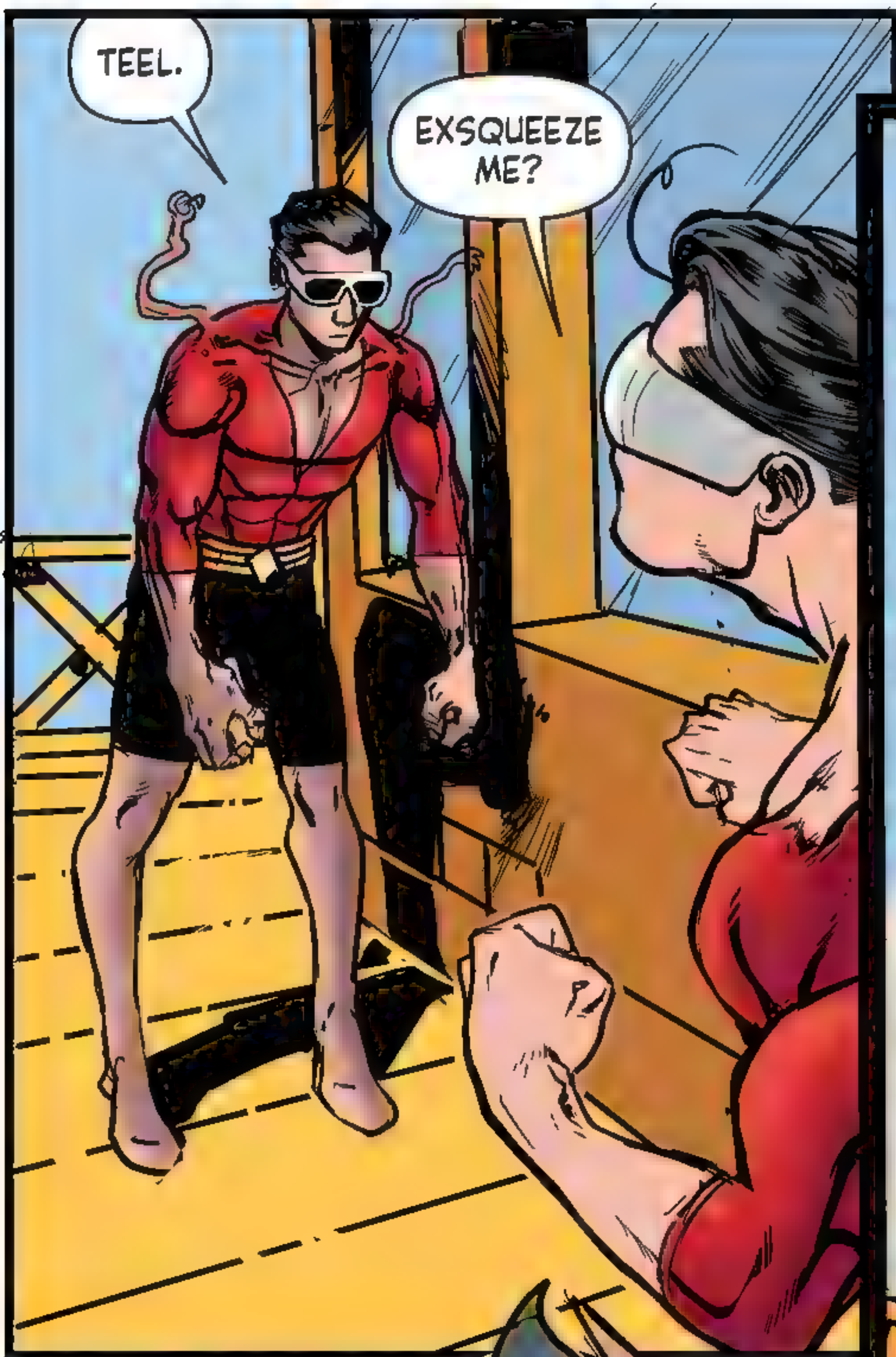
LET'S GET STRETCHED, KLAATU.

CHALLENGE ACCEPTED, EARTH MAN.



OKAY,
THEN.
MAN
TO MAN.





TEEL.

EXSQUEEZE
ME?



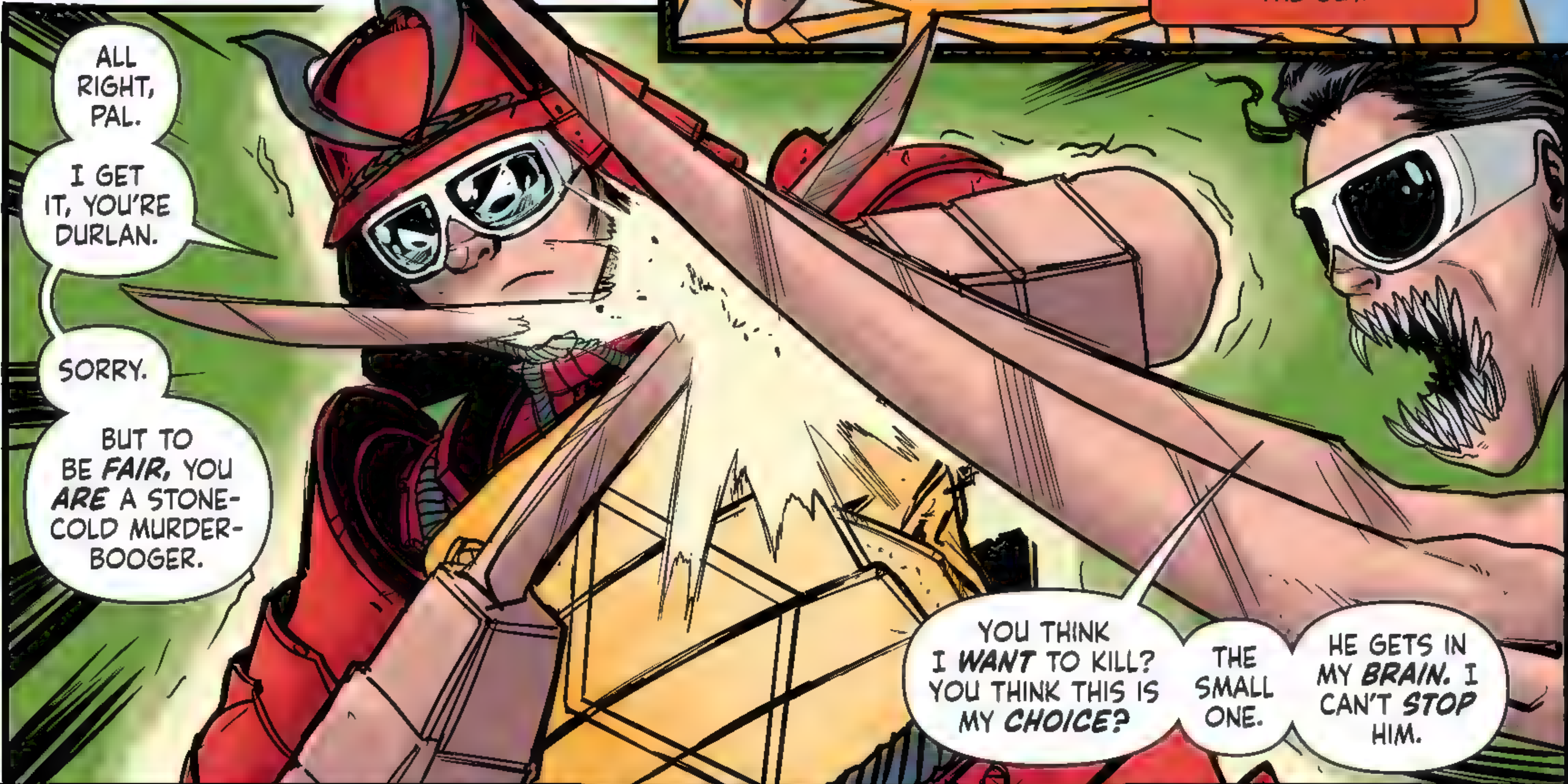
MY NAME
IS **TEEL**.

AND
I'M NOT
MARTIAN.

I'M
DURLAN.

Huh.

IF HE WASN'T
MURDERING PEOPLE
WHILE PRETENDING TO
BE **ME**, I'D ACTUALLY
FEEL KINDA **BAD** FOR
THE GUY.



ALL
RIGHT,
PAL.

I GET
IT, YOU'RE
DURLAN.

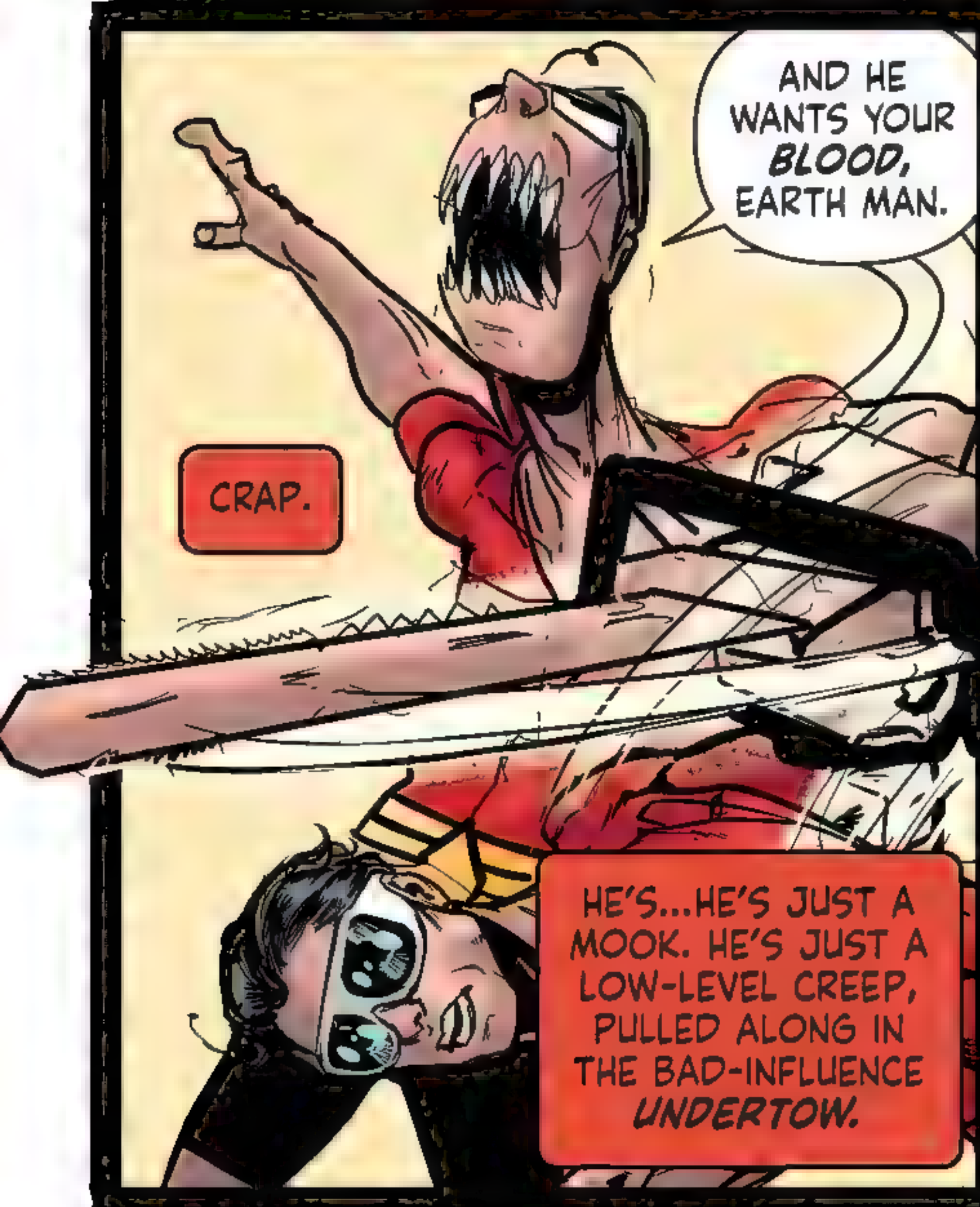
SORRY.

BUT TO
BE **FAIR**, YOU
ARE A **STONE-
COLD MURDER-
BOOGER**.

YOU THINK
I **WANT** TO KILL?
YOU THINK THIS IS
MY **CHOICE**?

THE
SMALL
ONE.

HE GETS IN
MY **BRAIN**. I
CAN'T **STOP**
HIM.



AND HE
WANTS YOUR
BLOOD,
EARTH MAN.

CRAP.

HE'S...HE'S JUST A
MOOK. HE'S JUST A
LOW-LEVEL CREEP,
PULLED ALONG IN
THE **BAD-INFLUENCE**
UNDERTOW.



JUST
LIKE...



JUST
LIKE...

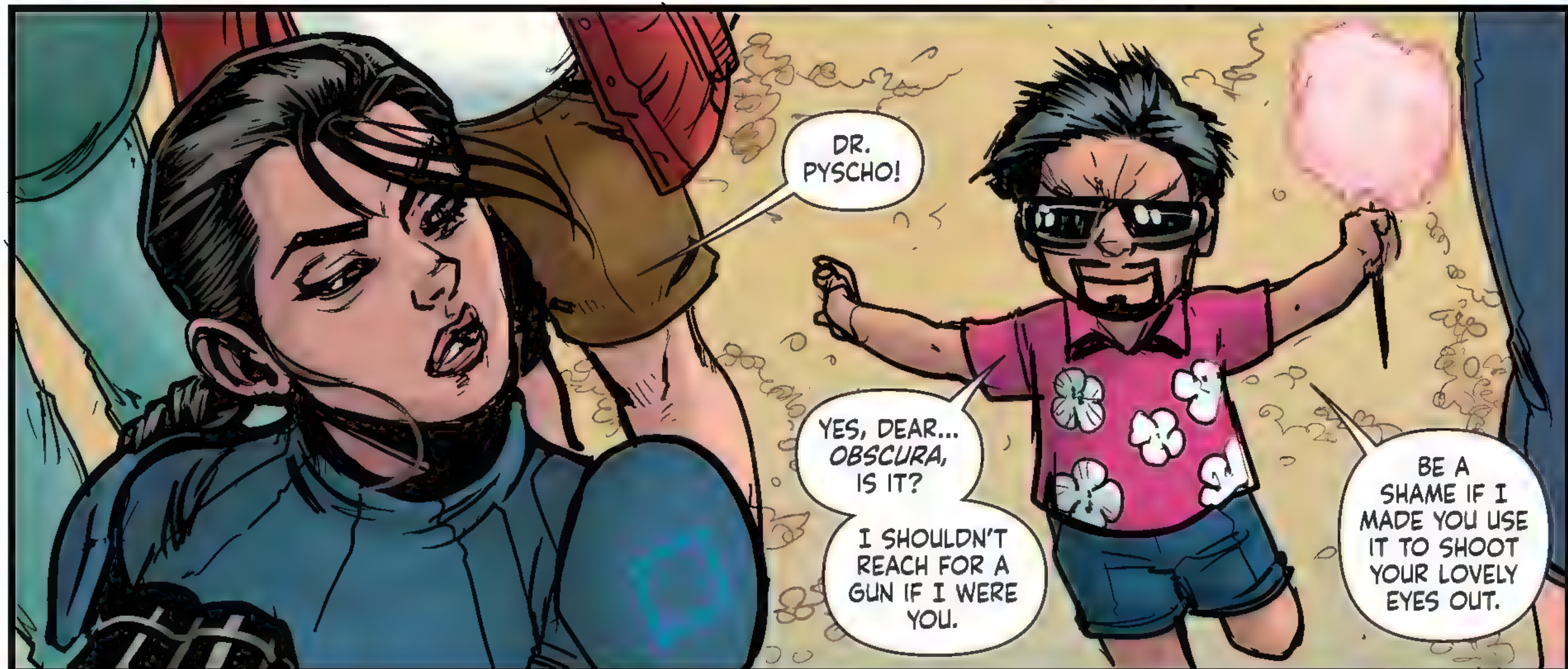
...A CERTAIN
LOSER BY THE
NAME OF **EEL**
O'BRIAN.



COME ON, EEL. I BELIEVE IN YOU.

OH.

NOW THAT IS OPTIMISTIC, DEAR.



DR. PSYCHO!

YES, DEAR... OBSCURA, IS IT?

I SHOULDN'T REACH FOR A GUN IF I WERE YOU.

BE A SHAME IF I MADE YOU USE IT TO SHOOT YOUR LOVELY EYES OUT.



COTTON CANDY?

NO?



WELL, WHY *DON'T* YOU JUST KILL ME, THEN, PSYCHO?

OH, WE HAD A QUICK CHANGE OF PLANS AFTER THIS...THIS DEBACLE.

DEATH ISN'T ENOUGH--YOU HAVE TO BE DISCREDITED.

WE DON'T FEAR FORCE, YOU SEE.

IT'S EXPOSURE WE DETEST.



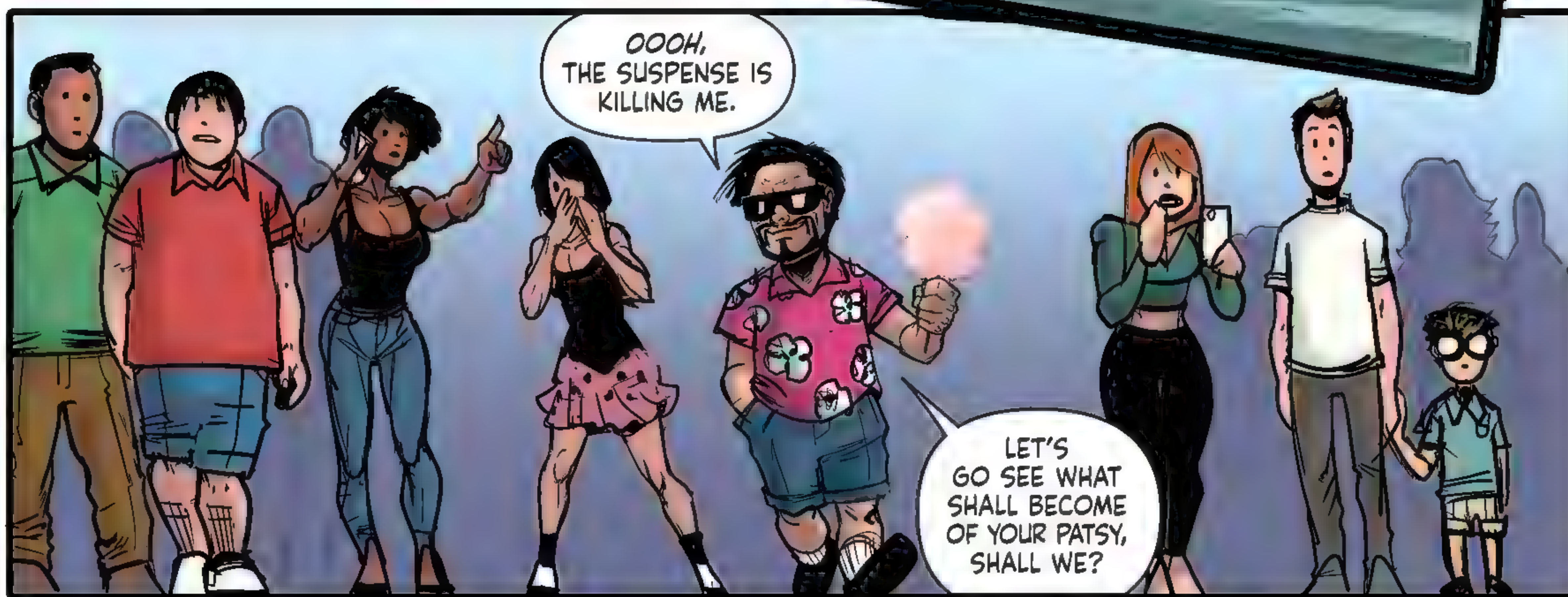
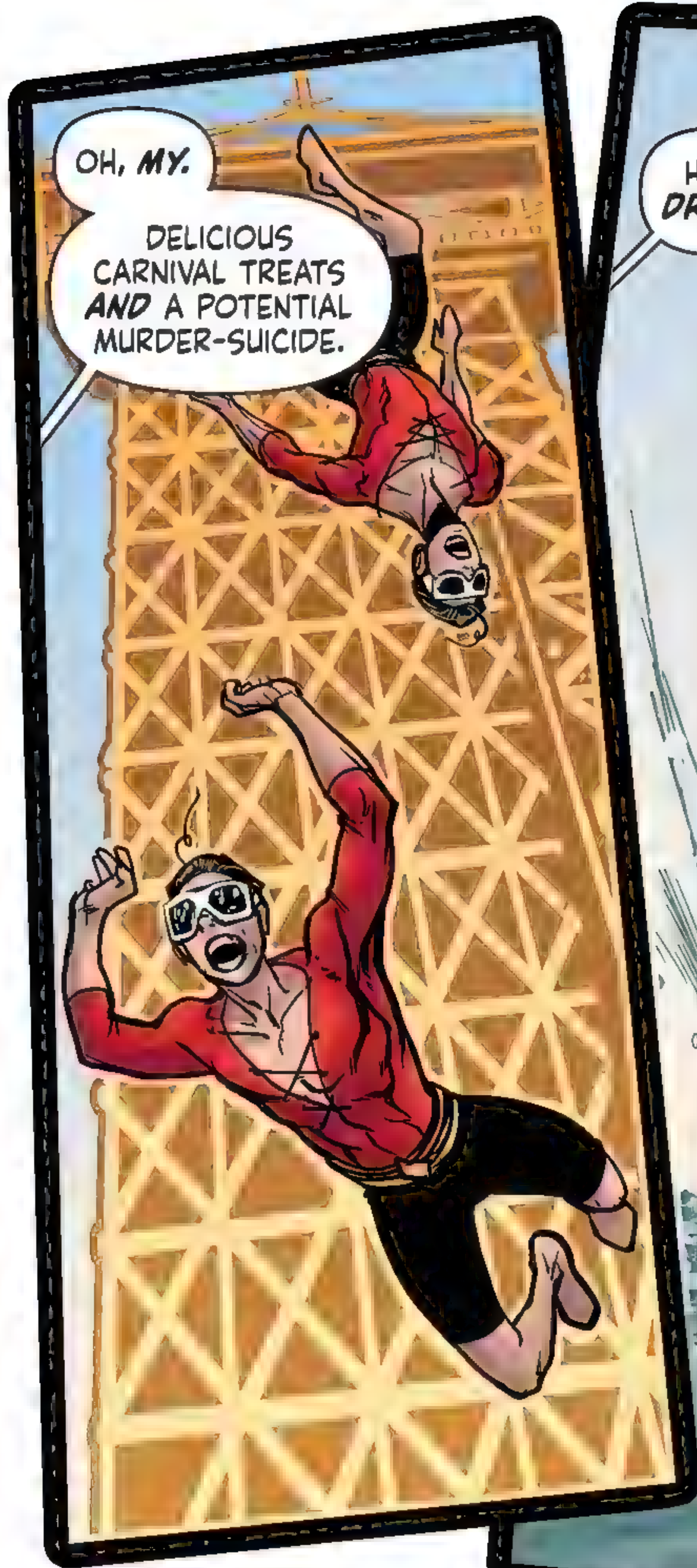
SO IT'S IMPORTANT, A LESSON FOR YOU.

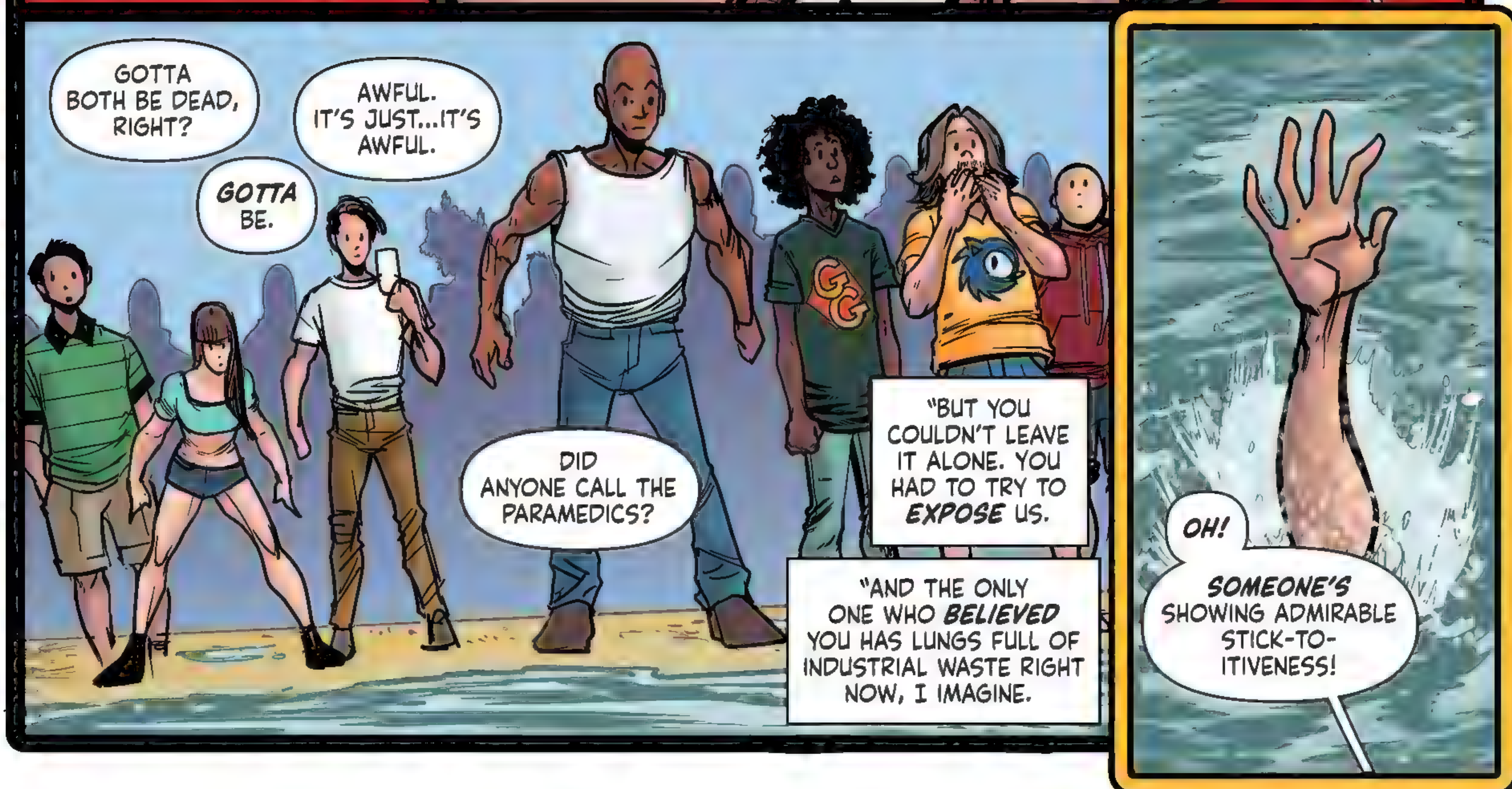
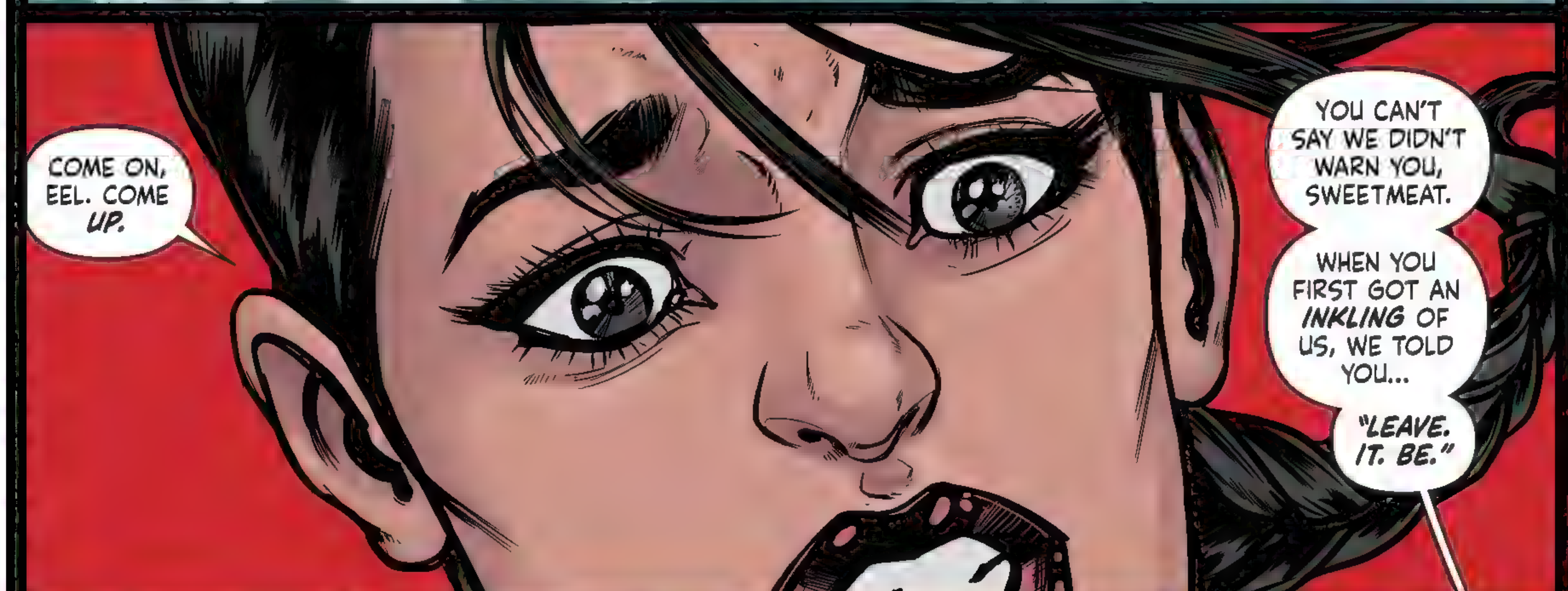
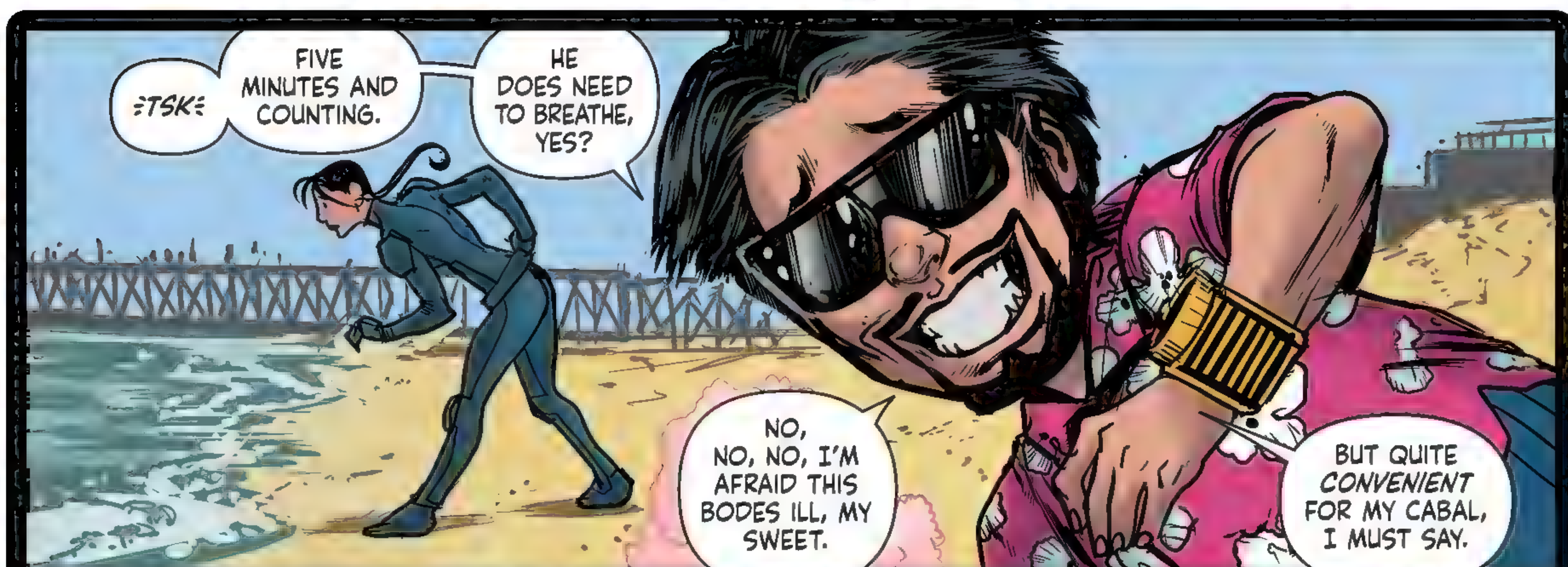
THAT *ANYONE* YOU TRY TO ALLY WITH...?

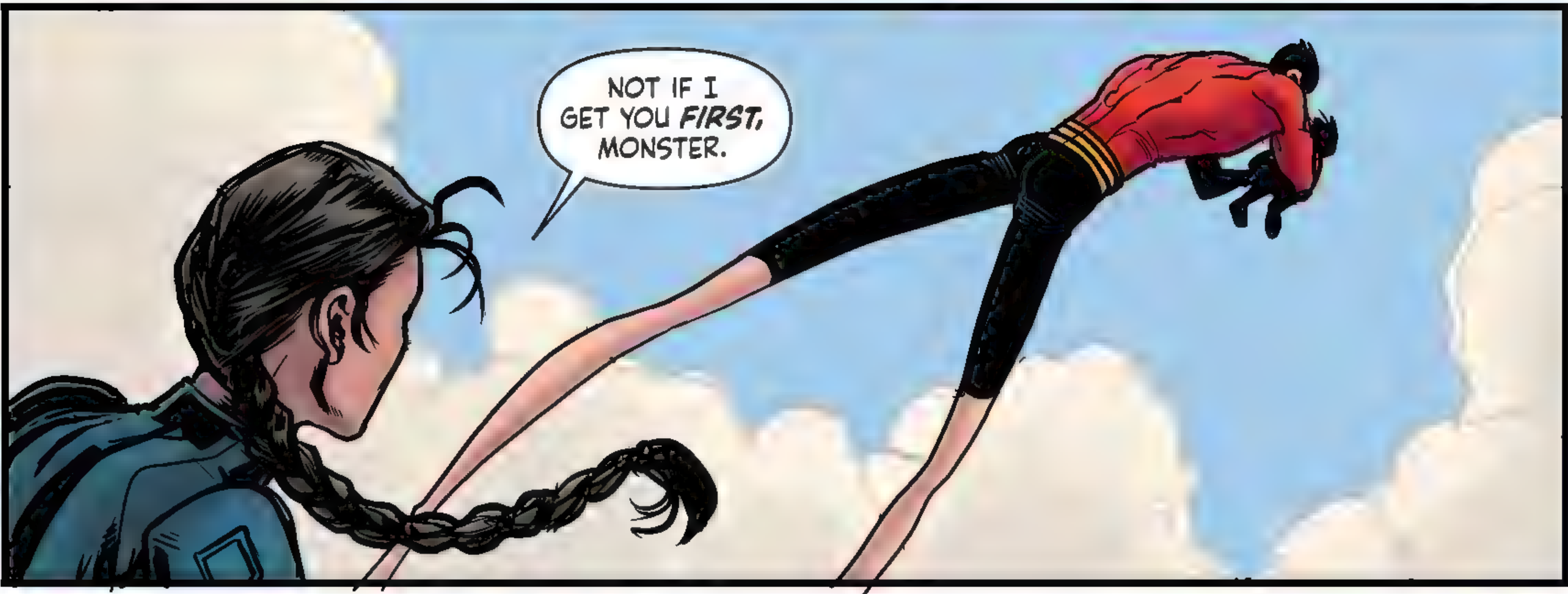
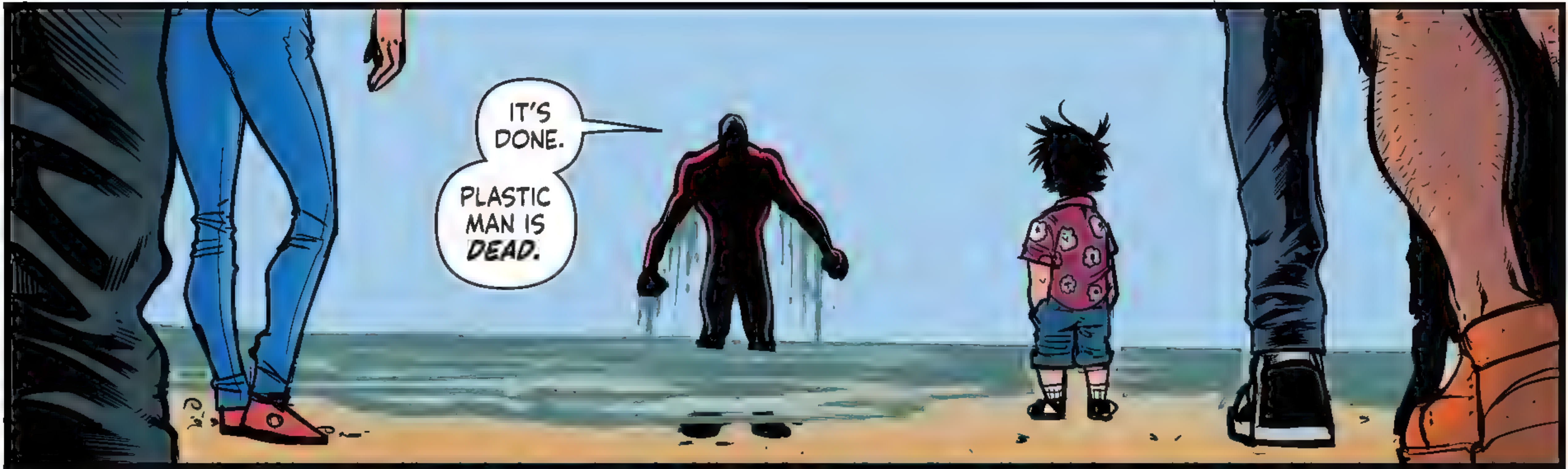
THEY END UP MOST MESSILY MURDERED.

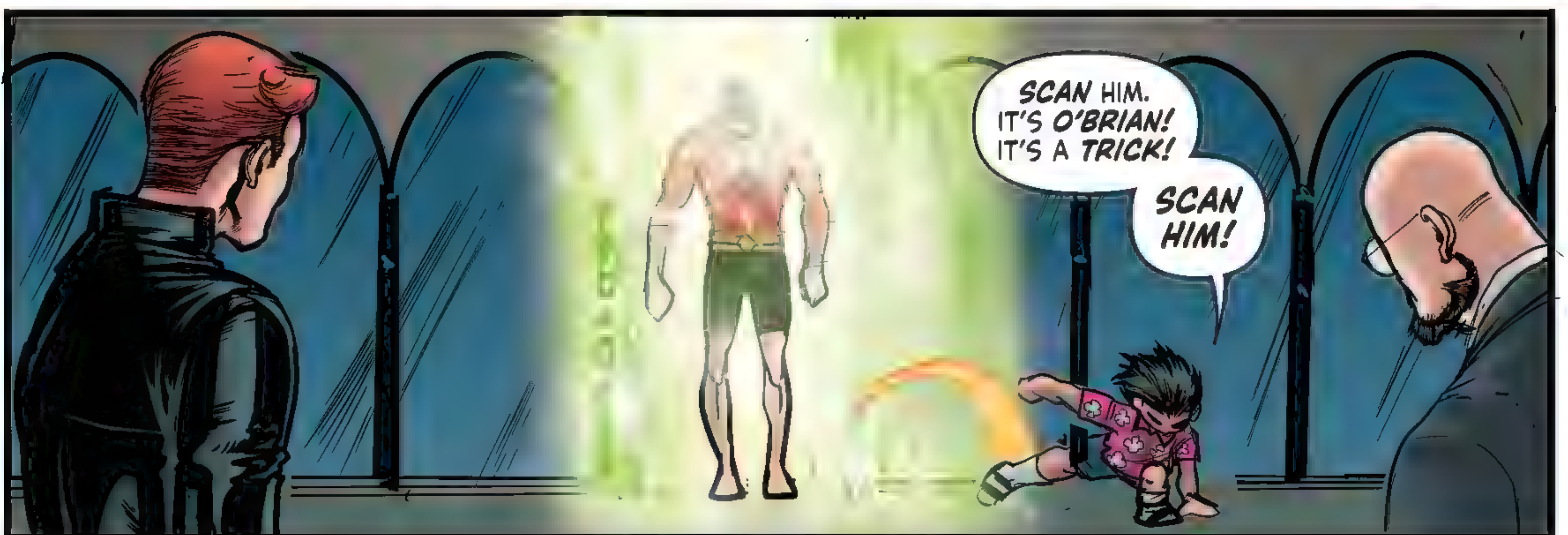
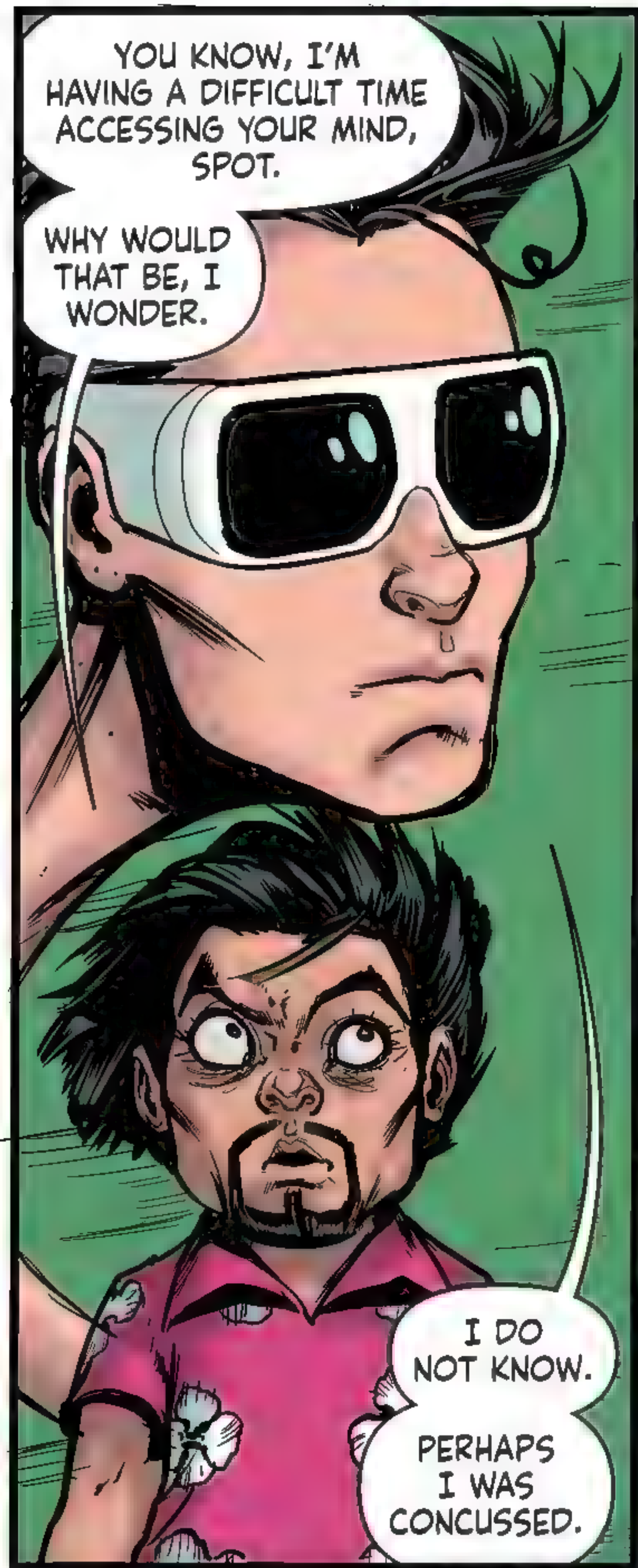
IT'S ALL ON YOUR HEAD, I'M AFRAID.

THEY'RE FALLING! THE FREAKS ARE FALLING OFF THE TOWER!









I KNOW THIS IS
AN ADJUSTMENT
FOR YOU,
MARGARET.

BUT BELIEVE
ME, I'VE SEEN WHAT
A PROPER SETTING
CAN DO FOR A CHILD
WHO'S BEEN ON
HER OWN.

HIS.

HIS OWN.
NOT HER
OWN.

THIS HOME,
IT'S NOT FANCY.
BUT THEY FEED
YOU AND TEACH YOU
THE VALUE OF HARD
WORK AND SELF-
RESPECT.

WON'T
THAT BE
NICE?

WE'LL GET YOU
SOME NICE TOYS,
AND MAYBE SOME
PROPER DRESSES,
AND--

LADY.

MY
NAME'S NOT
MARGARET.

I'M PADO
SWAKATOON,
THE SUAVE
PRINCE OF PINE
STREET!

AND
EVERYONE I
KNOW SUCKS
BUT ME!



I AM
NOT THE
EARTH MAN.

PLEASE,
MASTER, NO MORE
PUNISHMENT.

LIAR.

O'BRIAN'S
A **SNEAKY** LITTLE
BASTARD, AND THIS
IS **JUST** THE STUNT
HE'D **PULL**.

YOU'RE EITHER
HIM, OR YOU'RE
CARRYING HIM,
SOMEHOW.



HIS
PHYSIOGNOMY
IS ALIEN,
PSYCHO.

THERE'S
NO HITCHHIKER.
HE'S CLEAN.



THAT...THIS
DOESN'T SEEM RIGHT.
O'BRIAN'S ENTIRE M.O.
IS INFILTRATION. HE
WOULDN'T MISS THIS
CHANCE.

AND HE
CAN CHANGE HIS
BODY FUNCTIONS,
YES?



OH.
OH, NO.

THAT'S
RIGHT, MY
CREEPY
FRIEND!

ONLY, I
DIDN'T **HITCH**
ON THE POOR
ALIEN WRETCH
YOU'VE BEEN
TORTURING.



I RODE
IN ON YOU,
YOU GOOFY
SKID MARK!

JUST
CALL ME **WET**
WILLIE!



OH, DID THAT *HURT*? SORRY, THAT WAS ME JUST KICKING YOUR *EARDRUM* FOR A BIT.

AND I WOULDN'T TRY USING YOUR *POWER* ON ME, DOC.

SEE, I'M NOT THE SMARTEST GUY...BUT I KNOW HOW TO DO *RESEARCH*.

UNNNNGGGH



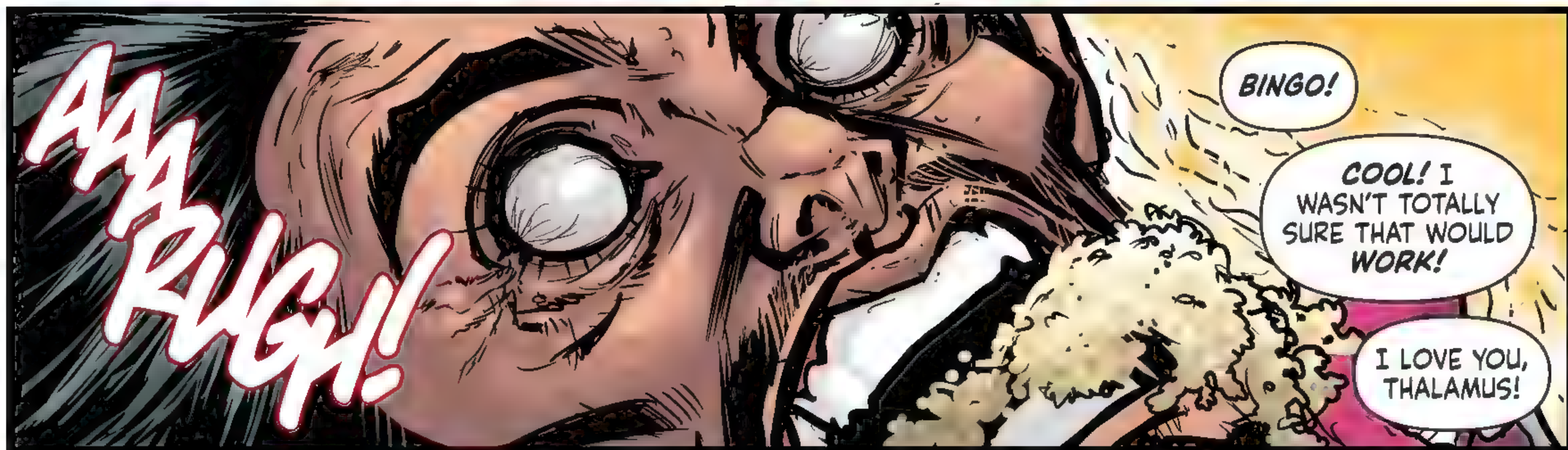
FOR EXAMPLE, DID YOU KNOW THAT YOU CAN *COMPRESS* SOME PLASTICS TO A *TINY* PERCENTAGE OF THEIR FORMER SIZE?

AND DID YOU KNOW THAT IF I WERE TO *SMACK* YOU RIGHT IN THE SOMATOSENSORY CORTEX, IT WOULD CAUSE *EXCRUTIATING* PAIN?

WHAT'S WRONG WITH HIM?

A ZZZEZZZURE OF ZZZOME KIND?

WE'RE UNDER ATTACK. PREPARE YOURSELVES.

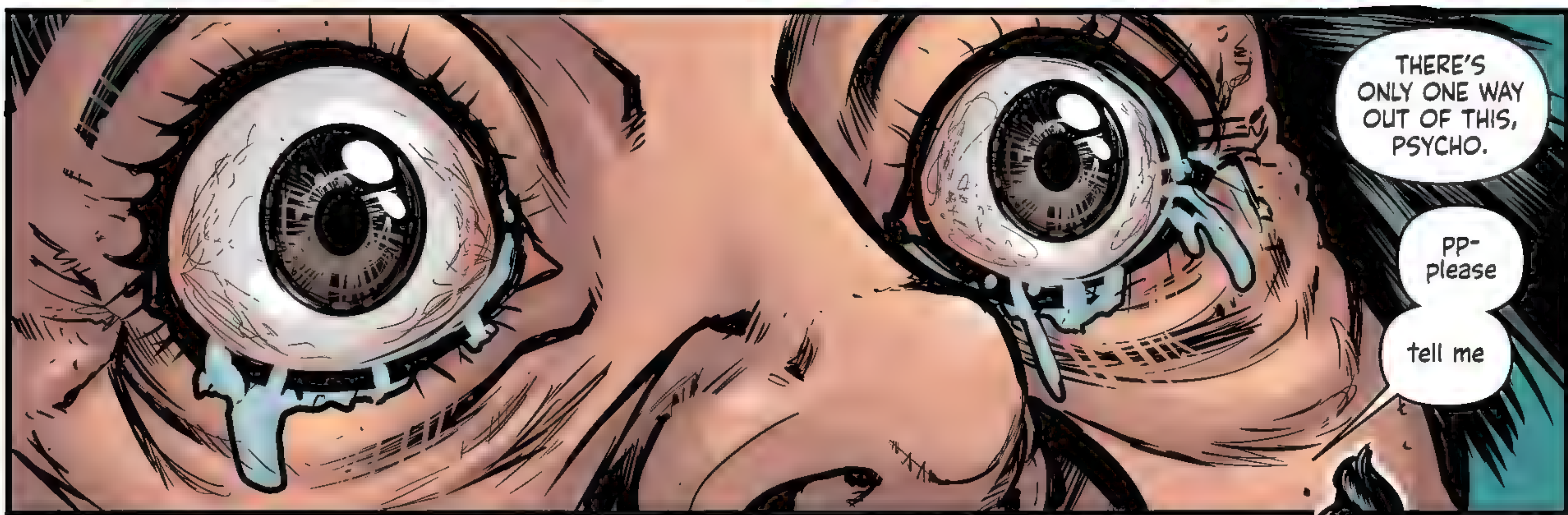


AAA RUGH!

BINGO!

COOL! I WASN'T TOTALLY SURE THAT WOULD WORK!

I LOVE YOU, THALAMUS!



THERE'S ONLY ONE WAY OUT OF THIS, PSYCHO.

pp-please

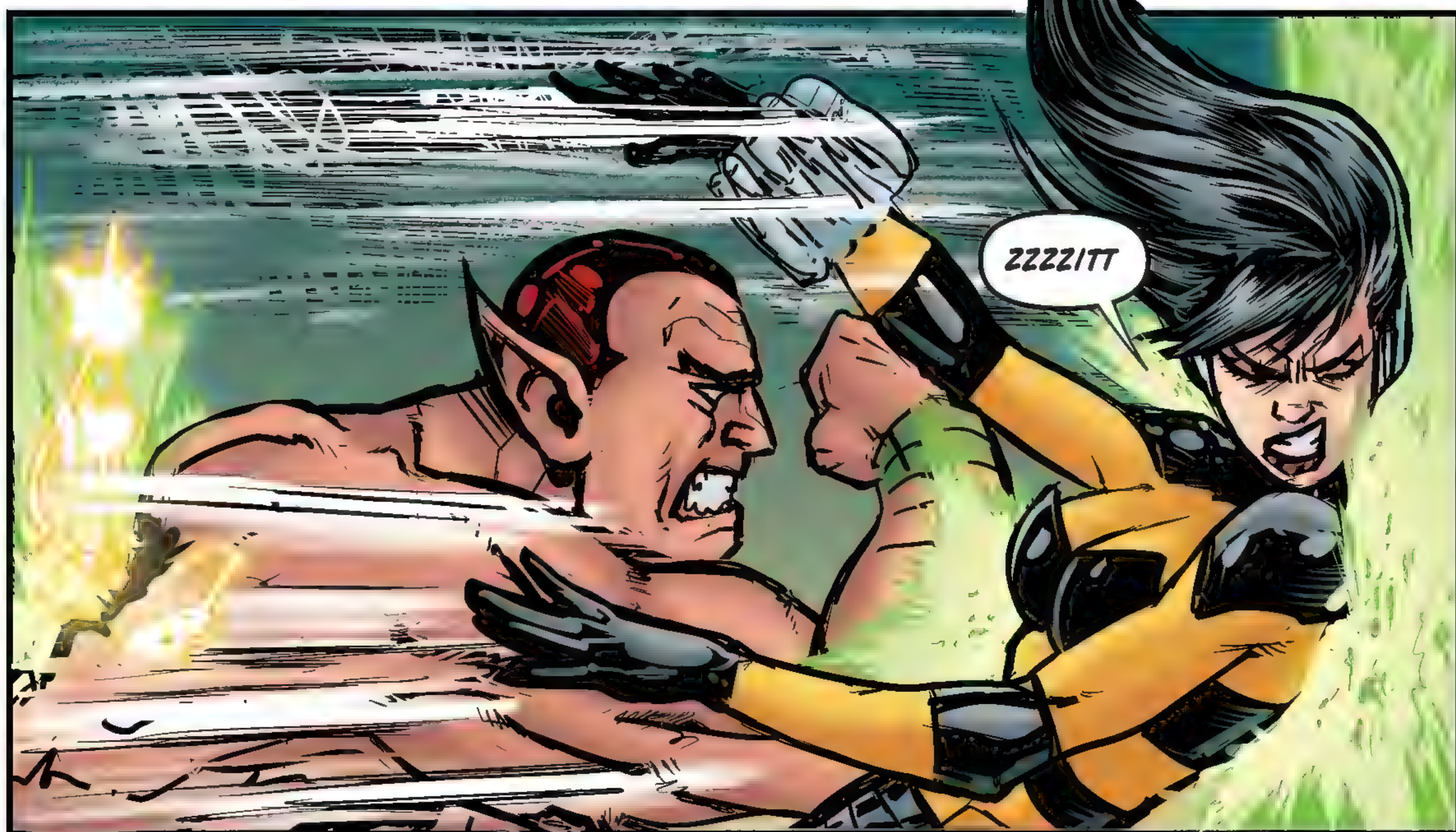
tell me

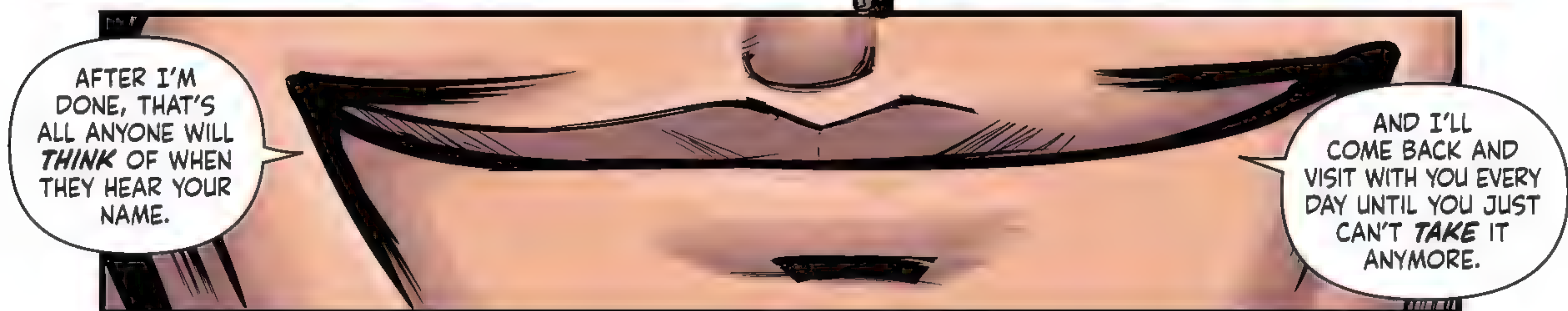
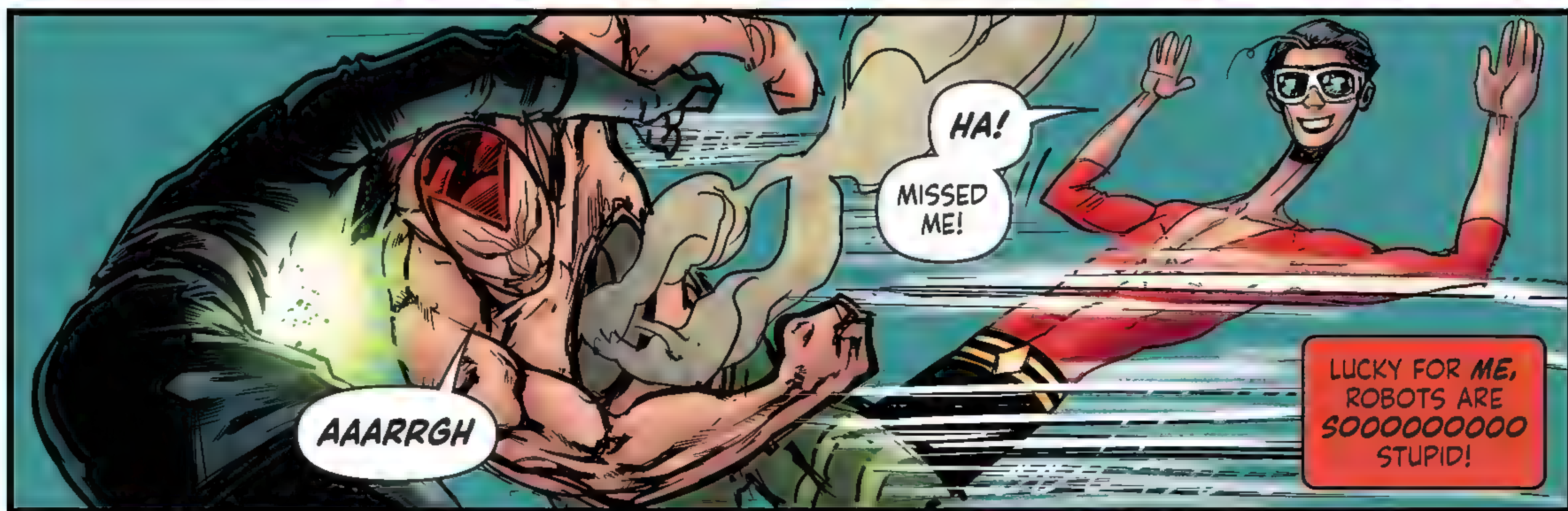


OH, I WILL.

TAKE THE *GIRL*.

OH.







AND THAT IS SO
WAAAAANG!



OKAY. SO **EEL**
MIGHT BE A LOSER.
LOST A NICE GIRL,
LOST THE KID.

BUT **PLASTIC**
MAN, WELL...

HE KINDA
KICKED **ASS**.

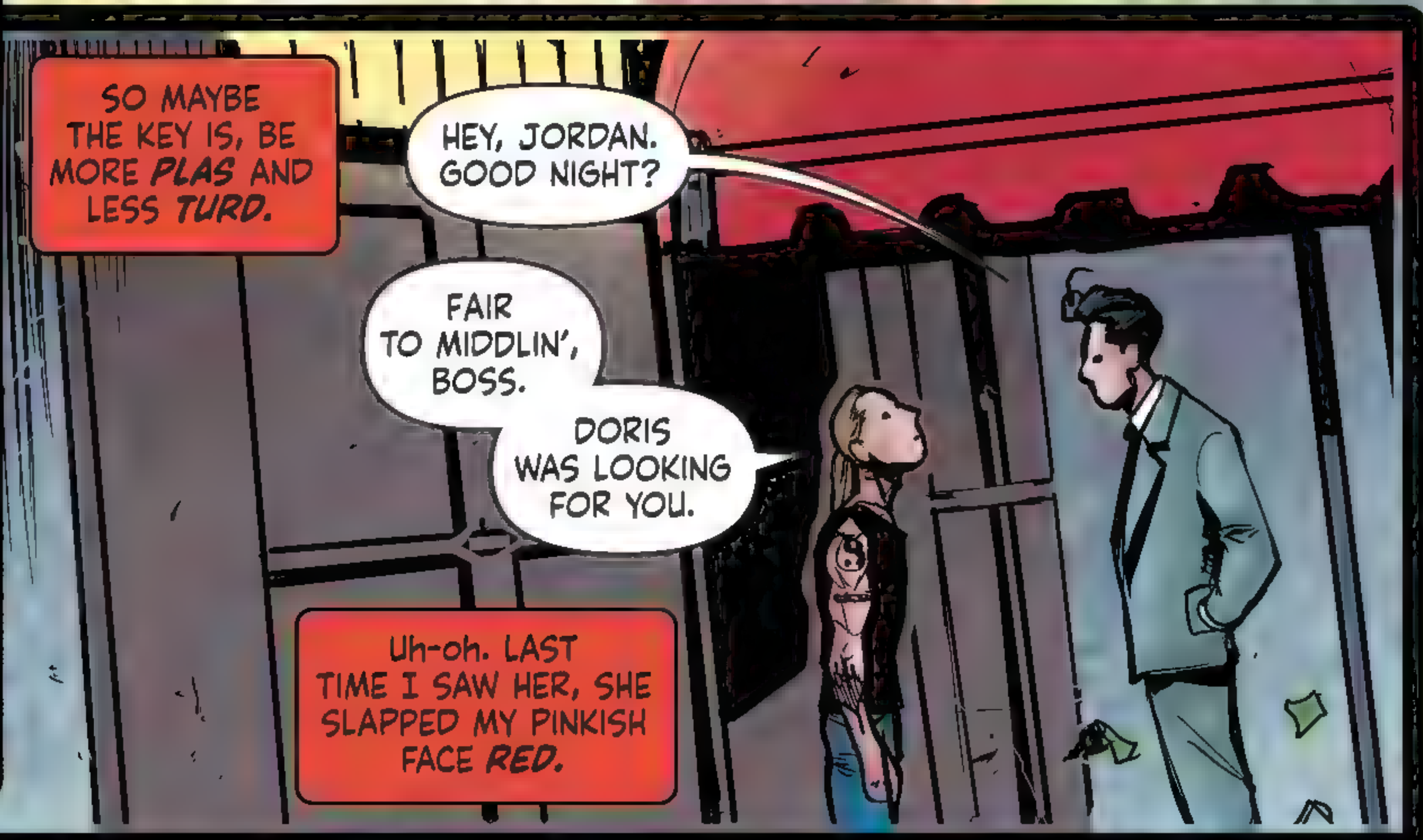
SO MAYBE
THE KEY IS, BE
MORE **PLAS** AND
LESS **TURD**.

HEY, JORDAN.
GOOD NIGHT?

FAIR
TO MIDDLIN',
BOSS.

DORIS
WAS LOOKING
FOR YOU.

Uh-oh. LAST
TIME I SAW HER, SHE
SLAPPED MY PINKISH
FACE **RED**.



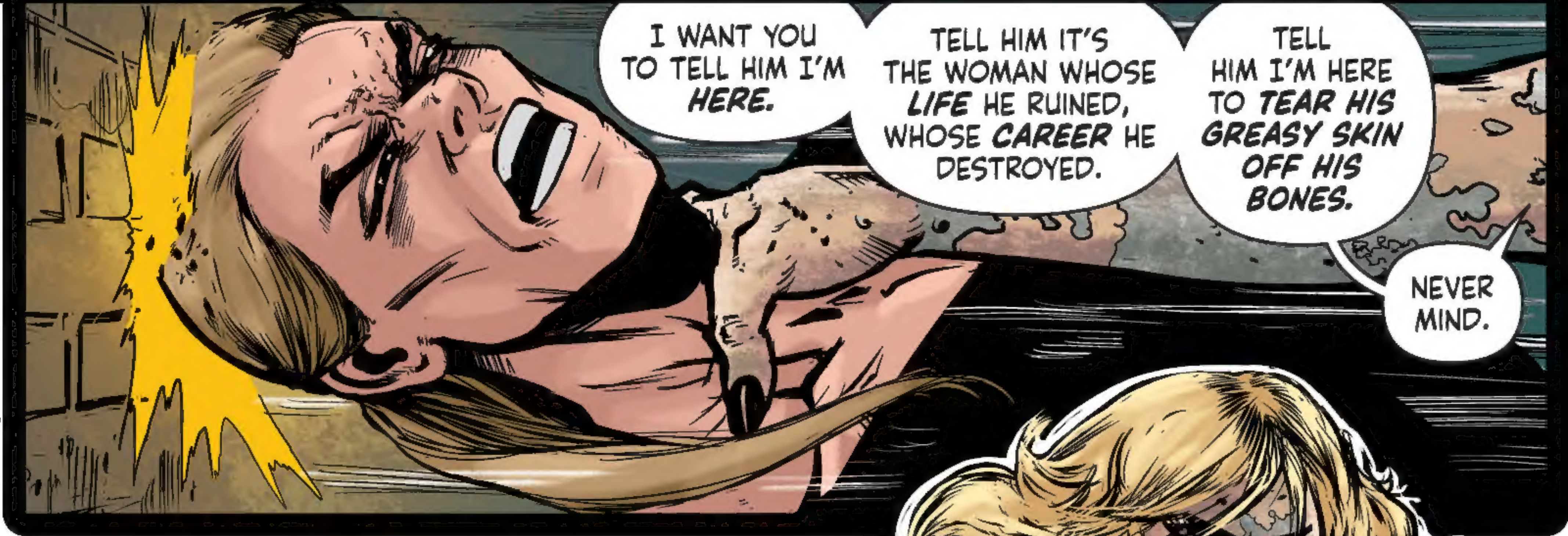


FIFTEEN
MINUTES
LATER...

NO, HONEST.
EEL AIN'T
BEEN AROUND
IN *DAYS*.

I DON'T
THINK I
BELIEVE YOU,
OLD MAN.

I DON'T
THINK I BELIEVE
YOU AT *ALL*.



I WANT YOU
TO TELL HIM I'M
HERE.

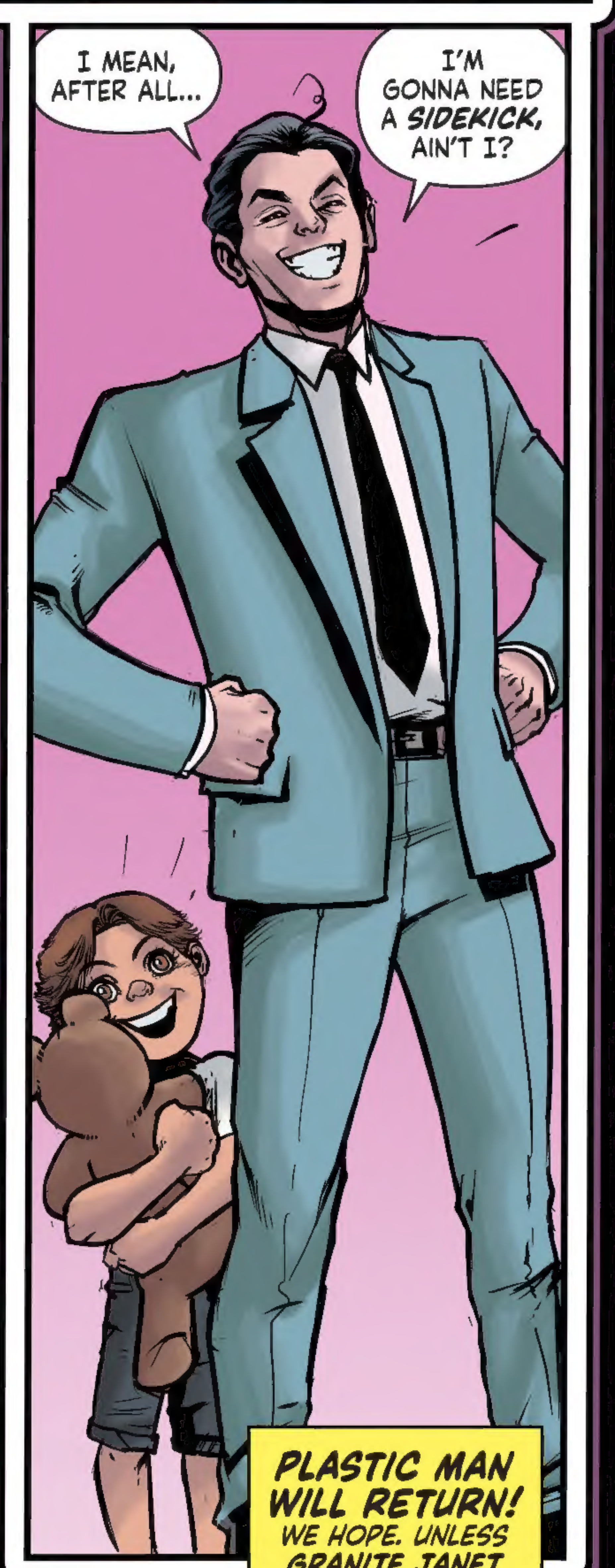
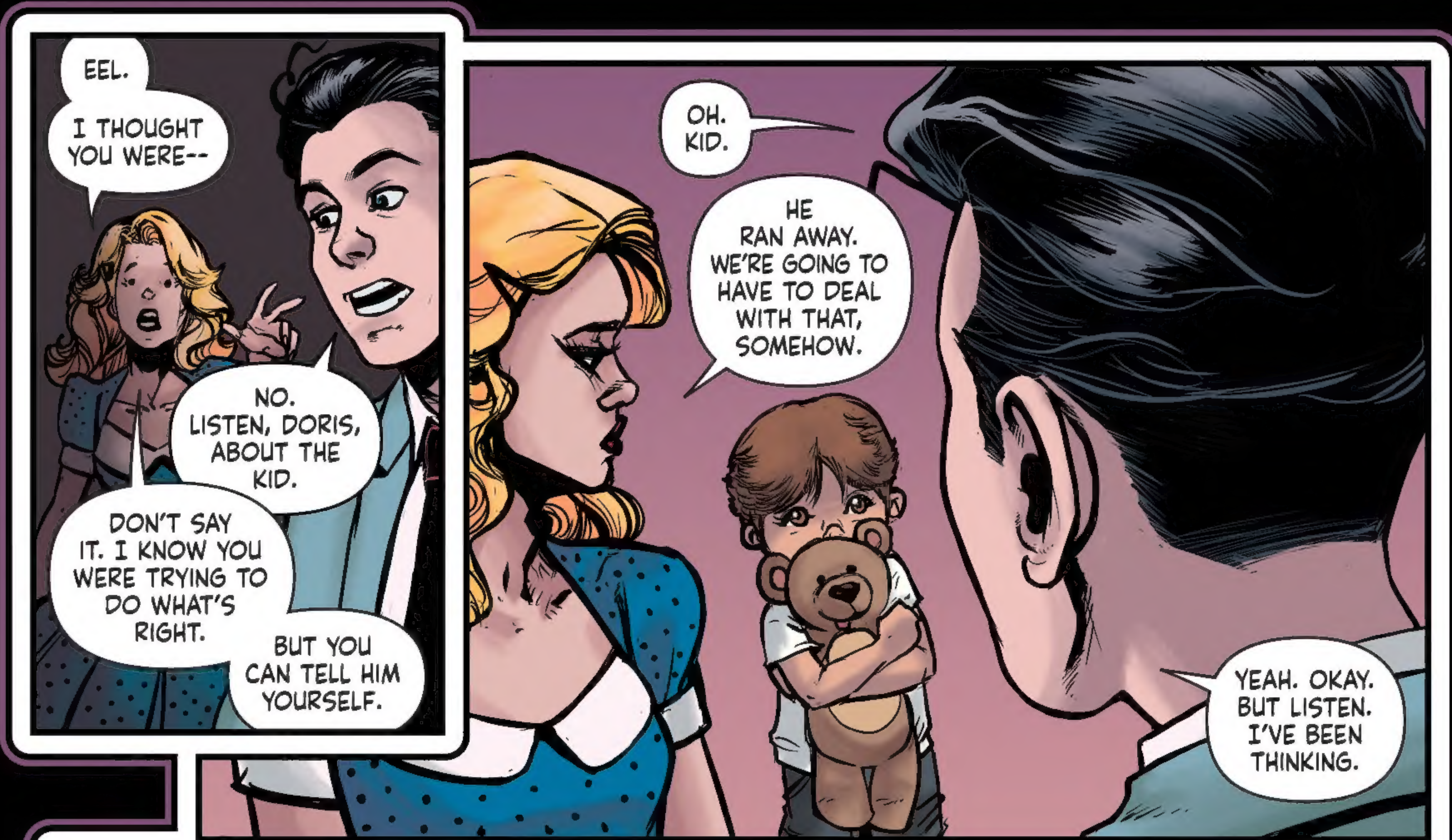
TELL HIM IT'S
THE WOMAN WHOSE
LIFE HE RUINED,
WHOSE *CAREER* HE
DESTROYED.

TELL
HIM I'M HERE
TO *TEAR HIS*
GREASY SKIN
OFF HIS
BONES.

NEVER
MIND.



I'LL
TELL HIM
MYSELF.



**PLASTIC MAN
WILL RETURN!**
WE HOPE. UNLESS
GRANITE JANET
GETS HER WAY...!



"PLASTIC MAN does an excellent job not only of starting out a new miniseries but also re-establishing Plastic Man in the post-Rebirth DC Universe."

—Comicosity

STRETCHING THE BOUNDS OF GOOD TASTE!

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SON OF ULTRON

"THIS FAN...
THIS MONSTER!"

